Gerald Tesha

A DATA-DRIVEN MEMOIR



Every day since my first upload, one turn per year. A mark is a day out, longer for more km on foot. Orange: the 315-day streak, still going.

Showing up.

MY STRAVA JOURNEY

2,076 OUTINGS

13,295 KM ON FOOT

85,159 METRES CLIMBED

315 DAY STREAK

Showing up.

Seven years on foot, from my own log

Gerald Tesha

This edition covers every activity I logged on Strava from 17 August 2019 to 8 November 2026: 2,076 of them.

Every number in this book comes from that log, and every chart is drawn from it. Distance and climb only count my four sports on foot: runs, walks, trail runs and hikes. I took out activity names and exact locations before publishing.

The book is my website, My Strava Journey, put together as one volume. I print a new edition each time the data is refreshed.

Annex A explains how I made it, and my contact details are on the page before the back cover.

Contents

Prologue

I The story

01 The Journey

II The mountains

02 Kilimanjaro

03 Hanang

04 Uluguru

05 Ngong Hills

III The lessons

06 What It Means

IV The Record

07 Year in Sport

08 Sports

09 Records

10 Where

11 Timeline

12 Goals

V The proof

13 The Habit on Trial

Epilogue

ANNEX A How this book was made

ANNEX B About the data

Get in touch

Prologue

This habit nearly ended before it started. In my first months I logged 62 outings, most of them runs on a treadmill. Then I stopped for 353 days, from July 2020 to June 2021.

I had heard about Strava and wanted to give it a try, and the push to move came from Jocko Willink and his words, discipline equals freedom. The silence came when I changed jobs and moved from Arusha to Kilimanjaro, in the time of COVID-19. A medical check-up brought me back: it told me to move about 30 minutes a day.

When I started again, I did not stop. Since June 2021 I have been out on 1,449 of 1,961 days, and my longest layoff has been ten days. As I finish this edition, I am on a 315-day streak.

This book is me going back through that record, all 2,076 activities of it.

There are five parts: the story of the seven years, the four mountains, what I think it all means, the record in full, and last, the tests that check whether it is true. To everyone who gave me kudos along the way, asanteni sana, thank you very much.

HOW TO READ IT

Every chapter is a page of my site, set in print. Each section starts with what I learned, in a few words, then the numbers that show it, then two charts side by side. Under the charts there is a short note on how to read each one, and after them comes the longer story.

Distance and climb count only my four sports on foot: runs, walks, trail runs and hikes. Everything else I count as others. Those outings still count as outings and as days out, but they add no distance and no climb. A week runs from Sunday to Saturday, and a day out is any day with at least one outing.

The numbers stop on 8 November 2026. The log keeps growing, and each new edition of this book is drawn again from the latest data, so a number here can differ a little from the one on the site a week later.

I

The story

Seven years in the order they happened, from the quiet first months to the year with no zero day.

CHAPTER 1

01 The Journey

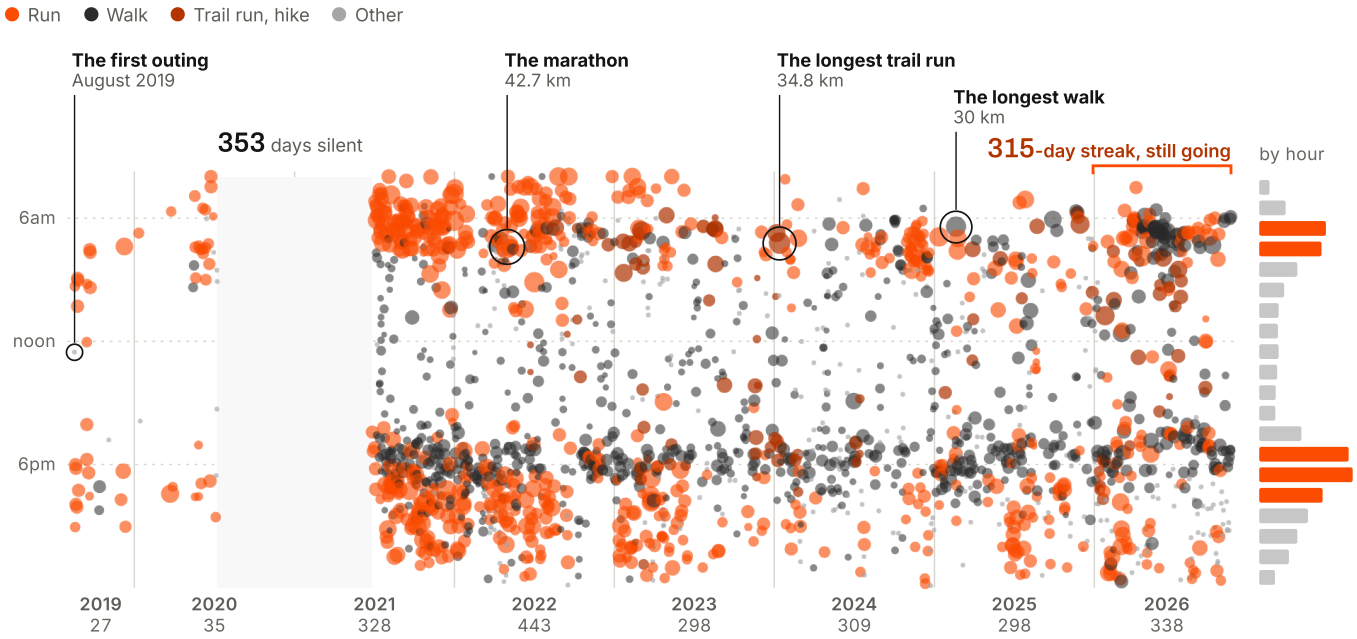
The habit almost ended before it began, and how it came back is the spine of this book. This first chapter is the record seen from far away: how one day leads to the next, which days carry the distance, when in the day I go out, and how running gave way to walking.

The chapter runs in six parts, in the order the years happened. Each section answers one question in its title, so the titles alone read as a summary. Under each title is a statement with the numbers that support it, a row of figures and, in most sections, two charts that look at the answer from two sides.

Haba na haba hujaza kibaba, little by little fills the measure. That saying runs through this chapter. Most of the findings here are about small things repeated: short walks on tired days, the same hours of the morning and evening, the same roads I know well.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

The charts in this chapter set the visual rules for the whole book. Orange marks the thing a section is about and grey holds the context. Bars start at zero, values are printed on the marks, and every pair of charts shares one height so they can be read side by side. Under each pair there is a note on how to read the charts and a design lesson on why they were drawn that way.



2,076 ACTIVITIES

13,295 km ON FOOT

85,159 m CLIMBED

315 days CURRENT STREAK

In 2019, my first year, I went out 27 times. Now most months have about that many, or more. Very little of it would make a photo: a walk after work, an easy run

before it, an hour or so at a time. This record is built from those hours, done again the next day.

THE STORY

Seven years sounds long, but most of this record comes from the last five. Before the long layoff I went out on 50 days in total. In 2026 alone I have gone out on 312. The habit really started in the middle of 2021, when I came back, and it has stayed since.

In the sky above, every dot is one outing, placed by its date and by the hour it started, and bigger for a longer distance. The empty band is the long layoff. After it, the dots never thin out again, and the two thick bands of mornings and evenings run all the way to today.

Each part below opens with its years as cards, one line each. Read them in order and the same thing repeats: every year after the pause is much fuller than the two before it.

PART 1 · 2019 TO MID 2021

1 Before the habit

It did not look like a habit yet: 27 outings in my first year, 35 in my second.

I heard about Strava and decided to give it a try, so I bought a Samsung Gear S3 Frontier watch to record what I did. My first runs were indoors, testing the watch and learning the app. The push to move came from Jocko Willink and his words, discipline equals freedom. I listened to many of his episodes, and to the story of David Goggins too.

THE YEARS OF THIS PART

2019 →

A small beginning

Every habit starts small. Most of my outings were runs, 85% of them, and most of those on the treadmill.

27 outings **231** km on foot **21** days out

2020 →

The layoff

A habit can stop very easily. In July I went out in Kenya, and after that nothing for almost a year.

35 outings **191** km on foot **29** days out

MOMENTS IN THIS PART

17 Aug 2019	**My first outing** where my log starts	17 Aug 2019	**Manyara** region 1 of 31
19 Aug 2019	**First 10 km** 10.0 km	12 Oct 2019	**Dar es Salaam** region 2 of 31
3 Nov 2019	**Arusha** region 3 of 31	9 Dec 2019	**First half marathon** 21.3 km
15 Jan 2020	**67 days with nothing** back out on 22 Mar 2020	7 Jul 2020	**Kenya** 1 day out on that trip
9 Jul 2020	**353 days away** a new job, a move and COVID-19, then back on 27 Jun 2021		

Nothing in the log from July 2020 to June 2021.

I changed jobs and moved from Arusha to Kilimanjaro, in the time of COVID-19. For almost a year I did nothing.

WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Keep the days.

PART 2 · MID 2021 TO 2022

2

The comeback

This time it stayed. 35 outings in 2020, 328 the year after.

A medical check-up told me to move about 30 minutes a day, so I started again. Since then my longest layoff has been ten days.

THE YEARS OF THIS PART

2021 →

Coming back

Thirty minutes a day was the advice. I often gave it two outings: on 57% of my days out.

328 outings **2,885** km on foot **180** days out

2022 →

The busiest

My busiest year, built from short outings of about 56 minutes, with my first marathon in May.

443 outings **2,907** km on foot **266** days out

One day leads to the next.

The day after a break is the hardest one to go out, and my own log shows why. Every extra zero day makes the next one easier to take, and every day in a row makes the next one easier to keep. Once I have the rhythm, a missed day feels like a debt I have to repay. So on a tired evening I still go: after a few kilometres I feel better, with more energy and a fresh mind.

CHANCE THE NEXT DAY IS ACTIVE

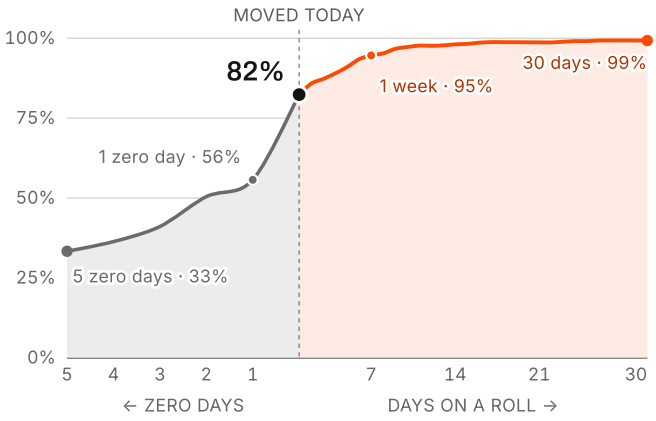
33% after five zero days

56% after one zero day

82% after a day out

95% after a week on a roll

THE ODDS, DAY BY DAY



GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

	TOMORROW YOU MOVE	TOMORROW YOU REST
If you moved today	82%	18%
If you rested today	50%	50%

HOW TO READ · THE ODDS, DAY BY DAY

The middle point is a day I went out. Going right, each step is one more day on the streak, and the orange line is the chance I go out again the next day. Going left, each step is one more zero day, and the grey line is the chance I come back the next day. The gap between the two sides is the lesson: a chain is easier to keep than to restart.

HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I go out tomorrow and the right box the chance I rest, and the two add up to 100%. The darker the box, the more likely that next day.

DESIGN LESSON · PUT THE STARTING POINT IN THE MIDDLE

When two forces pull in opposite directions, a shared centre lets them be compared directly. Both sides grow from the same point on the same scale, so the difference in how steeply they move is the finding, and nobody has to line up two separate charts.

In your own work. When two forces push in opposite directions, give them a shared centre and let them grow apart.

DESIGN LESSON · A SMALL TABLE CAN BE A CHART

Four numbers in a two-by-two grid, each cell shaded by its size, read faster than four bars. The grid keeps the numbers exact and the shading gives the pattern, so the table works as a table and as a picture.

In your own work. For a handful of numbers in rows and columns, shade the cells of a table instead of drawing a chart.

THE STORY

Since I came back I have taken 257 breaks of one day or more. 143 of them were a single day, and only 21 lasted five days or more. The longest was ten days.

The left side of the chart is the part I watch. Each extra day of rest makes the next one easier to take, and after five zero days I am more likely to stay in than to go out. So on a tired day I take a short walk.

The right side is the reward. The longer the chain, the closer the next day comes to certain. In 2026 I have not had a single zero day, so this year the whole story sits on the right.

BIG DAYS AND SMALL DAYS

Ordinary days did the work.

My marathon is the longest day I have ever had, and it is less than half of one percent of everything I have covered. The kilometres came from somewhere less exciting: ordinary days of ten kilometres or more, one after another, for years. The short days did a different job. They kept me in the habit until the next long one.

SHARE OF ALL DISTANCE ON FOOT

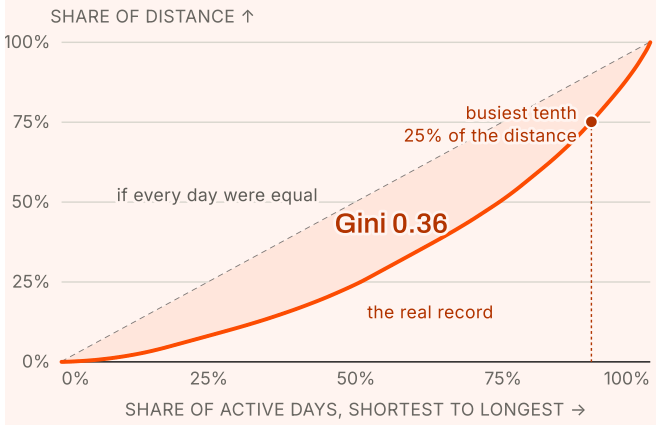
24% the quietest half of days

42% the busiest fifth of days

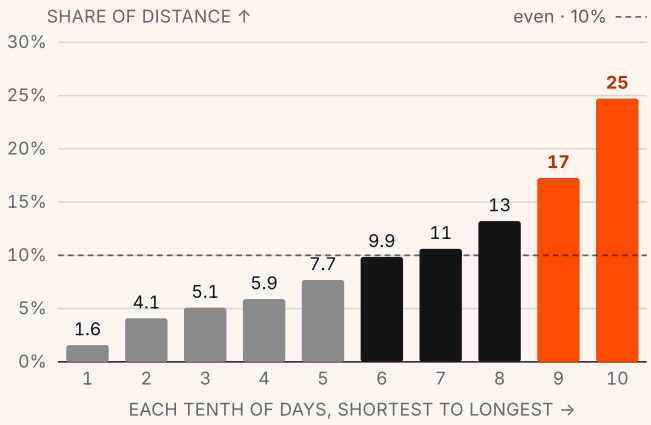
25% the busiest tenth of days

3% the 13 biggest days

EVERY DAY, ADDED UP



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY, ADDED UP

Every day I went out on foot is lined up from the shortest on the left to the longest on the right, and the line adds up the distance as it goes. If every day were the same size, the line would follow the dashed diagonal. The more it sags below the diagonal, the more of the total comes from the long days.

DESIGN LESSON · DRAW THE LINE OF EQUALITY

A line of equality gives the curve something to be measured against. Without it, a bowed line is only a shape; with it, the reader sees at once how far the record is from even, and the shaded gap turns that distance into a single number, the Gini coefficient.

In your own work. When you show how unequal something is, draw what equal would look like. The gap is easier to see than to describe.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

The same days, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest tenth on the left to the longest on the right. Each bar is that group's share of all my distance on foot. If every day were equal, every bar would stop at the dashed 10% line.

DESIGN LESSON · THE SAME DATA, CUT MORE SIMPLY

A curve like the one beside it is exact but unfamiliar, and a row of ten bars is rough but easy. Showing the same days both ways lets each reader take the view that suits them, and each view checks the other.

In your own work. Pair an exact but unfamiliar chart with a simpler view of the same numbers.

THE STORY

My usual day on foot is about 8.8 km. Half of my days out are shorter than that and half are longer. The very long days carry a lot for how few they are: 149 days of 20 km or more gave 27% of all my kilometres.

23 of my days on foot reached 30 km or more, and the year with the most of them was 2021.

At the other end are 233 days under 5 km. Together they gave only 4% of the distance, so on a chart of days they count the same as a marathon. Each one kept the chain going.

HOW MY DAYS ARE SHAPED

One outing instead of two.

When I came back I was in a hurry. After years of ignoring my health I made it my first priority, and the results came quickly, in how I felt and in my work, so I often ran in the morning and walked in the evening. Now one longer outing does the job of both, and when I come home the day's work is done. The time I give the habit each day has hardly changed since 2021, about an hour and a half.

HOW THE DAYS WERE SPLIT

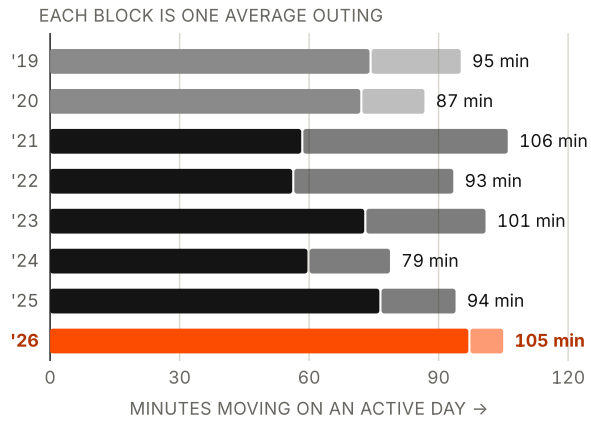
57%
of active days doubled up in 2021

8%
of active days doubled up in 2026

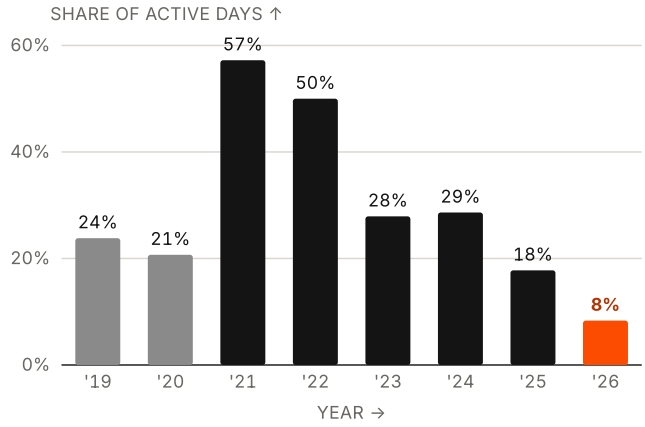
58 min
the average outing in 2021

97 min
the average outing in 2026

A TYPICAL ACTIVE DAY, YEAR BY YEAR



DAYS WITH TWO OR MORE OUTINGS



HOW TO READ · A TYPICAL ACTIVE DAY, YEAR BY YEAR

One row for each year. The length of the bar is the minutes I spent moving on a day I went out. The bar is cut into blocks, one for each outing on a typical day, so many short blocks mean I split the day and one long block means one longer outing. Grey rows are the years before the long layoff, and orange is this year.

HOW TO READ · DAYS WITH TWO OR MORE OUTINGS

Each bar is a year, and its height is the share of my days out that had two or more outings. The higher the bar, the more often I split the day.

DESIGN LESSON · SPLIT A BAR INTO ITS UNITS

Each row is a typical day, cut into blocks, one block per average outing. A row of short blocks is a day of doubles, one long block is a single long outing. The same length can be made in different ways, and the blocks show which.

In your own work. When a total is made of countable pieces, draw the pieces.

DESIGN LESSON · BARS START AT ZERO

A bar is read by its length, so the axis under a bar chart always starts at zero. Cut the axis short and a small difference looks huge, because the eye still reads the whole bar.

In your own work. If your values sit far from zero and the change is what matters, use dots or a line, which do not need a zero.

THE STORY

In 2021 I did about 1.8 outings on an average day out. In 2026 it is 1.1. The time stayed about the same, and only the number of pieces changed.

Much of the change came from walking. My usual walk in 2021 was under 3 km, a short walk that fits between other things. Now my usual walk is about 8 km, and a walk like that takes one long block of the day. My runs moved the same way, from short treadmill sessions to longer runs outside.

One long outing also means one start, one finish and one upload, and then the day is done.

Less treadmill every year.

The treadmill is where I learned to run, and for years it was where I ran: 6,905 of my 8,288 km of running, the marathon included. It was my answer when time was short. Only lately has more of my running moved outside.

SHARE OF SESSIONS INDOORS

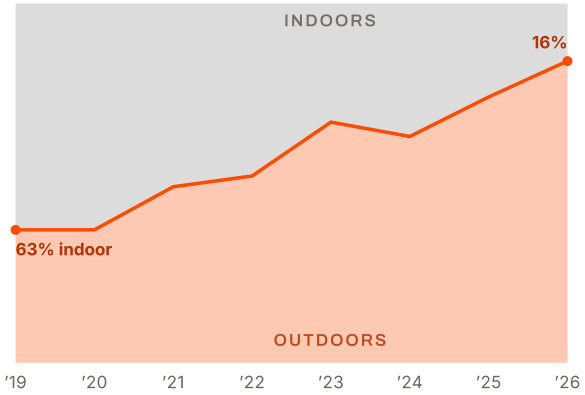
63% of sessions in 2019

16% of sessions in 2026

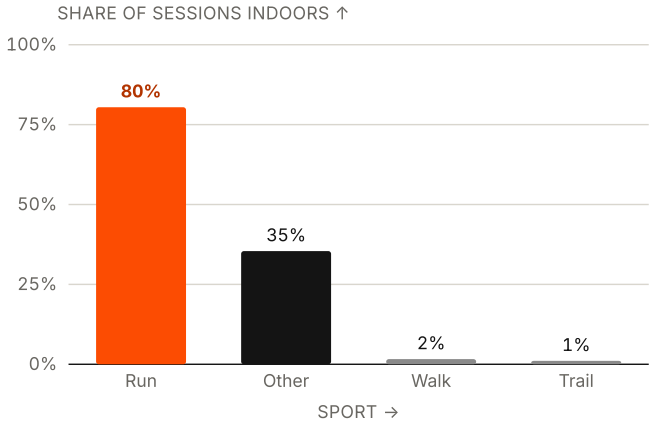
80% of all runs

2% of all walks

INDOORS AND OUTDOORS, YEAR BY YEAR



SHARE INDOORS, BY SPORT



HOW TO READ · INDOORS AND OUTDOORS, YEAR BY YEAR

Each year is split in two and always adds up to 100%: outings indoors on a machine at the top, outings outside at the bottom. When the line between them climbs, more of that year moved outside.

DESIGN LESSON · STACK TO 100% WHEN ONLY THE BALANCE MATTERS

Every year is scaled to the same full height, so the totals disappear and only the split between the two bands remains. The line between them can be read like a water level.

In your own work. Use 100% stacks for shares over time, and give the totals somewhere else if they matter.

HOW TO READ · SHARE INDOORS, BY SPORT

The share of each kind of outing that was done indoors. Runs are mostly indoors, while walks, trail runs and hikes almost never are.

DESIGN LESSON · PUT THE NUMBER ON THE BAR

Each bar carries its value on top, so nobody has to slide across to the axis and guess. The gridlines stay faint because they only give the scale; the printed values do the exact work.

In your own work. When there are fewer than about fifteen bars, label them directly and lighten the gridlines or drop them.

THE STORY

In both 2021 and 2022, 95% of my running kilometres were on the treadmill, more than 2,000 km a year. In 2025 the share fell to 61%, and in 2026 it is 45%.

The treadmill has not gone away. I have run 481 km on it in 2026. The long runs are the ones that moved outside.

Walks almost never happen indoors. For me a walk means going outside, and that is part of why the outside grew as walking grew.

MOMENTS IN THIS PART

2 Jul 2021	**46 days in a row** to 16 Aug 2021	6 Jul 2021	**Kilimanjaro** region 4 of 31
18 Jul 2021	**Dodoma** region 5 of 31	25 Jul 2021	**Morogoro** region 6 of 31
14 Aug 2021	**First 30 km** 30.0 km	25 Aug 2021	**109 days in a row** to 11 Dec 2021
26 Sep 2021	**First 500 m climbed** 600 m up	23 Oct 2021	**Mwanza** region 7 of 31
10 Dec 2021	**Pwani** region 8 of 31	19 Dec 2021	**First trail run** 10.5 km
6 Mar 2022	**Zanzibar Urban/West** region 9 of 31	28 Mar 2022	**My 500th outing** 169 days after the 250th
16 Apr 2022	**Mara** region 10 of 31	1 May 2022	**First marathon** 42.7 km
23 Jun 2022	**First 1,000 m climbed** 1,425 m up	23 Jun 2022	**First hike** 11.3 km
26 Sep 2022	**Iringa** region 11 of 31	15 Oct 2022	**Mbeya** region 12 of 31

WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Streak savers count.

3

The mountains

This was the year the habit left the flat ground: Kilimanjaro in March, Hanang in April, and Bondwa Peak, where I trained for Kilimanjaro.

In the same March I took a challenge from the Activate Uganda team: 25 km a day for four days in a row, indoors, on dates I chose. Running indoors day after day is tiring and dull, and the hardest part was not putting the sessions off until late at night.

THE YEAR OF THIS PART

2023

The hills

I began the year knowing nothing about climbing, and ended it with 303 km on trails.

298 outings **1,769** km on foot **215** days out



Kilimanjaro, chapter 2 · Hanang, chapter 3 · Uluguru, chapter 4

MOMENTS IN THIS PART

22 Jan 2023	**First half marathon outside** 22.7 km	2 Jun 2023	**My 1,000th outing** 248 days after the 750th
4 Aug 2023	**Tanga** region 13 of 31	12 Oct 2023	**Zanzibar Central/South** region 14 of 31

WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Long days come in bunches.

4

The road

Wherever I went that year, the shoes came with me.

A remote job and a few consultancies took me across borders, and the habit came along.

THE YEAR OF THIS PART

2024

Travelling

The habit came with me to five countries, even when a day only had room for a short outing.

309 outings **1,214** km on foot **234** days out

WHERE I GO

The climbing is in two regions.

Where I go out most, the ground is flat, so the climbing waits for trips. One hike in Morogoro climbed almost 2,000 m. In Dodoma, the same height would take me about sixty outings.

WHERE THE OUTINGS HAPPEN

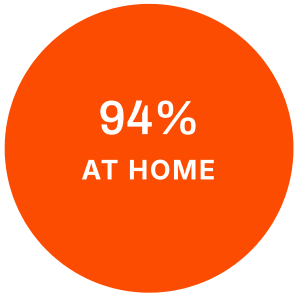
94% of located outings are in Tanzania

6% outside Tanzania

30% of Tanzania's outings are in Kilimanjaro and Morogoro

63% of Tanzania's climbing is there

HOME AGAINST AWAY

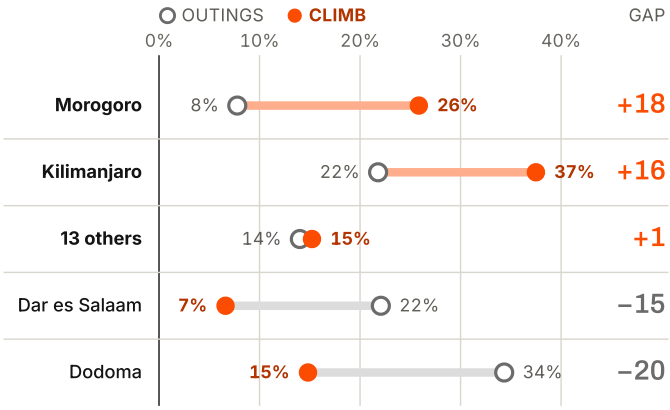


Tanzania · 1,092 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 73 OUTINGS

Kenya	32	2020
Malawi	23	2024
South Africa	13	2024
Rwanda	2	2024
Others	3	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of my outings with a GPS start that began there. The other African countries are listed beside it with the year I first went out there. Anything outside Africa is counted together as others.

DESIGN LESSON · ONE BIG SHAPE FOR THE MAIN SHARE

When one part holds almost everything, a pie or a stack makes the small parts unreadable slivers. Giving the main part one big shape of its own, and setting the small ones apart in a list, lets both be read.

In your own work. When one part dominates, show it big and simple, and list the rest.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there, the second its share of my climbing. The number at the end is the gap. A region with more climbing than outings is where the hills are.

DESIGN LESSON · A DUMBBELL SHOWS A GAP

Each row has two dots, one for each share, joined by a bar. The length of the bar is the gap, and the rows are sorted by it, so the places that climb far more than they are visited sit together.

In your own work. When the story is the difference between two values, draw both and join them. Two separate bar charts hide the gap.

THE STORY

Dodoma and Dar es Salaam, where I go out most, hold 56% of my outings in Tanzania and only 21% of the climbing. That is what flat ground looks like in a log.

Kilimanjaro and Morogoro are the other way round. I go there less, but most of my metres up were done there. Every big climb in this record came on a trip.

Outside Tanzania I have gone out in Kenya, Malawi, South Africa and Rwanda. Kenya comes first, with 32 outings over a few visits.

MOMENTS IN THIS PART

27 Apr 2024	**South Africa** 8 days out on that trip	18 Aug 2024	**Rwanda** 2 days out on that trip
20 Oct 2024	**Malawi** 16 days out on that trip	31 Oct 2024	**67 days in a row** to 5 Jan 2025

WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Keep a floor.

5

No zero days

The streak that is still going started in the last days of 2025.

I started it on purpose. My first target is to reach 31 December 2026 without a zero day. After that the targets go up in odd numbers: three years, then five.

THE YEARS OF THIS PART

2025 →

Walking

I chose walking, outside and for the long hours: 47% of my outings, and my longest walk, 30 km.

298 outings **1,609** km on foot **242** days out

2026 →

Every day

One outing a day, and a longer one, about 97 minutes.

338 outings **2,488** km on foot **312** days out

Ngong Hills, chapter 5

WALKING AND RUNNING

Walks took over.

Walking was a choice. Running, for me, mostly happens indoors, a hard session on the treadmill when time is short. Walking takes me outside, where I can enjoy what is around me, and it builds perseverance over the long hours. My usual walk in 2021 was under 3 km. Now it is about 8 km, and since 2022 walks have outnumbered runs every year.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

42% walks

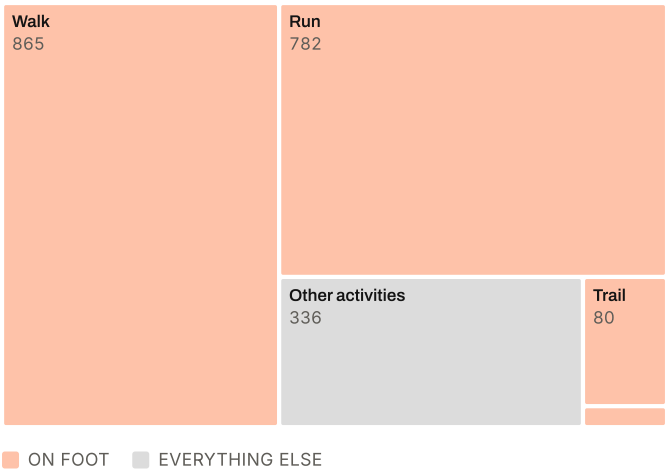
38% runs

4% trail runs and hikes

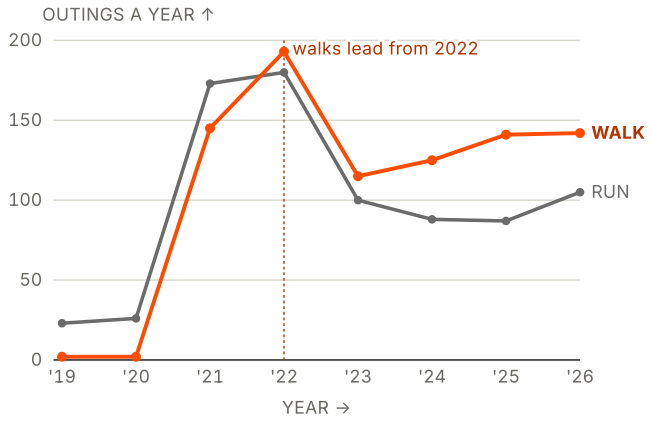
16% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

84% of all my outings are on foot.



WALKS AGAINST RUNS, YEAR BY YEAR



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Walks and runs are the two big blocks. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

DESIGN LESSON · AREA FOR THE PARTS OF A WHOLE

Each tile's area is its share of all outings. A treemap fits many parts into a small rectangle and keeps the biggest ones obvious, though areas close in size are hard to rank.

In your own work. Use a treemap for many parts of one whole; use bars when the reader must rank parts of similar size.

HOW TO READ · WALKS AGAINST RUNS, YEAR BY YEAR

Two lines count my walks and my runs each year. Where the walk line rises above the run line, walking became my more common outing, and the mark shows the year it happened.

DESIGN LESSON · LABEL LINES AT THEIR ENDS

Each line is named where it finishes, with no legend box. The eye follows the line to its name instead of jumping between the chart and a key.

In your own work. With up to four or five lines, drop the legend and write each name at the end of its line, in the line's colour.

THE STORY

Walking grew in number first. From 2022 on, every year has had more walks than runs. In 2026 I have done 142 walks and 105 runs so far.

Then it grew in distance. 2026 is the first year my walks covered more kilometres than my runs, 1,157 km against 1,065 km.

Running is still a big part of my week. My biggest running year was 2021, with 2,402 km, most of it on the treadmill.

Before work and after it.

An office job sets my hours, so the habit lives at the edges of the day: early in the morning, or in the evening once work lets go, with 6pm the busiest hour. Through the week my outings are spread almost evenly, and Saturday, the busiest day, has its own reason, told below. When a target is close, the hours stretch: one walk began just before two in the morning, and one run close to midnight.

WHEN OUTINGS START

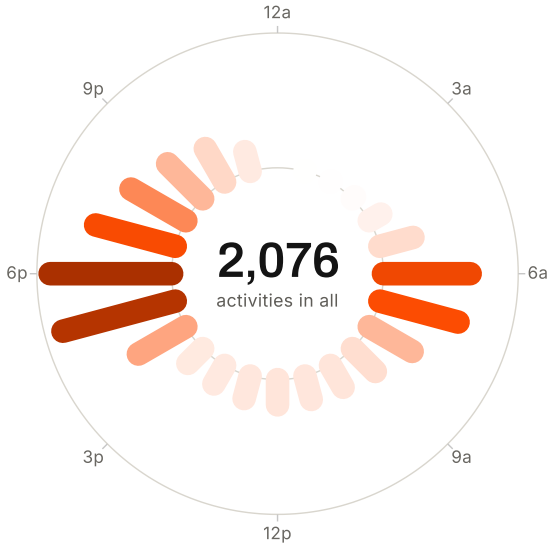
30% before 10 in the morning

14% between 10am and 4pm

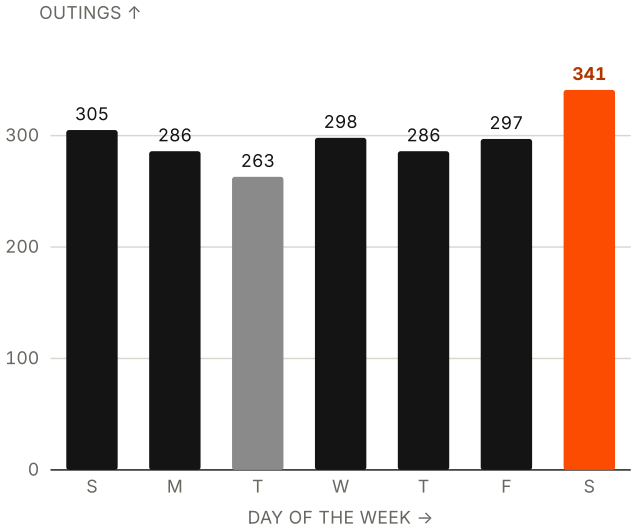
44% between 4 and 9pm

11% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour. The long spokes on the left and right are my mornings and evenings.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

DESIGN LESSON · USE A CIRCLE ONLY FOR THINGS THAT GO ROUND

The hours of the day loop: eleven at night sits next to midnight. On a clock face the morning and evening bulges read at once, and no hour is cut at the edge.

In your own work. Radial charts suit cycles such as hours, days of the week or seasons. For anything that does not loop, use a straight axis.

DESIGN LESSON · COLOUR ONLY WHAT THE STORY IS ABOUT

The bars here are grey or black, and the ones the story is about are orange. The colour points at the bar the headline is about, so the eye lands there first.

In your own work. Choose one colour for the point you are making and keep everything else neutral. If everything is coloured, nothing stands out.

THE STORY

From 2021 to 2025 my busiest hour was always in the late afternoon or evening, after the working day. In 2026 it moved to 6am, and the mornings took the lead.

The weekend holds 31% of all my outings, close to the 29% an even week would give. Saturday is a little busier than the rest, and the gap between the busiest and quietest day is 78 outings over seven years.

THE SABBATH

Saturday is for the outdoors.

Rest from work does not have to mean sitting still. I am a Seventh-day Adventist, and on the Sabbath the jobs and the busy week give way: part of my day is going outside to enjoy creation. One day in seven has given me 30% of all my climbing since 2021. The Adventist health message asks us to look after the body we were given, so if you keep a day of rest, try spending part of it outside on your feet.

SATURDAYS SINCE 2021

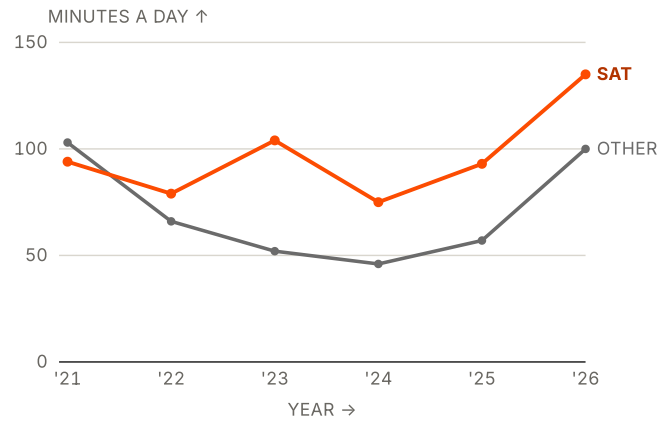
80%
of Saturdays with an outing, 224 of 280

96 min
on the move on a Saturday, against 67 on other days

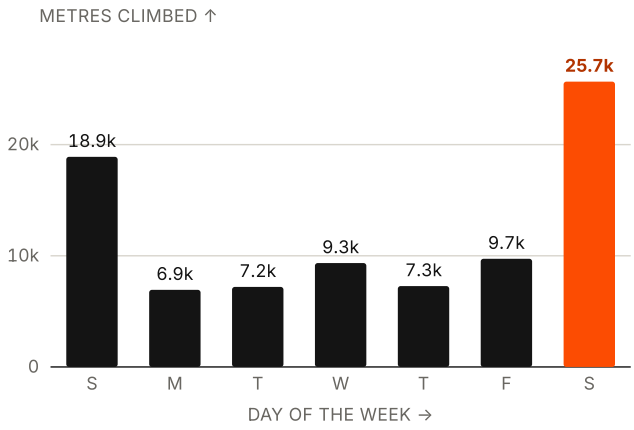
10
of my 20 biggest climbs came on a Saturday

41%
of my trail runs and hikes were on a Saturday

MINUTES ON THE MOVE A DAY, ZERO DAYS INCLUDED



METRES CLIMBED ON EACH DAY OF THE WEEK, SINCE 2021



HOW TO READ · MINUTES ON THE MOVE A DAY, ZERO DAYS INCLUDED

Two lines, one for Saturdays and one for the other six days. Each point is the average time I spent moving on such a day in that year, with the days I stayed in counted as zero.

HOW TO READ · METRES CLIMBED ON EACH DAY OF THE WEEK, SINCE 2021

All the climbing I have done on foot since the comeback, added up by the day of the week it happened on. Saturday is the orange bar.

DESIGN LESSON · A HEADLINE THAT SAYS THE FINDING

Each section is titled with what its charts show, in one short sentence. The title is the first thing read, so it carries the conclusion.

In your own work. Write chart titles as findings. "Walks took over" tells the reader what to see; "Walks and runs by year" only names the data.

DESIGN LESSON · KEEP THE NATURAL ORDER

These bars keep the order their labels already have, such as years, months or days of the week. Sorting them by height would make the tallest easy to find and the pattern over time impossible to see.

In your own work. Sort bars by value only when the categories have no order of their own, like countries or products.

THE STORY

Saturdays are where the hills live. 10 of my 20 biggest climbs came on a Saturday, and so did 41% of my trail runs and hikes. The 34.8 km up to Mweka Gate on Kilimanjaro and my biggest climb, on Bondwa Peak, were both Sabbath outings.

None of this was planned as training. It came from going outside on the Sabbath, week after week, and the log only shows what that adds up to.

THROUGH THE YEAR

Two quieter months.

After months of doing a lot, the body asks for a breather. August and September have been my thin months every year, a natural pause before I pick it up again for the festive season. September 2024 was the lowest point of all, with only eight days out: I was juggling a remote job, a retreat, a camping trip to Mikumi and getting ready for a consultancy in Malawi. In 2026 I went out on every single day of both months.

SHARE OF DAYS ACTIVE, 2022 TO 2025

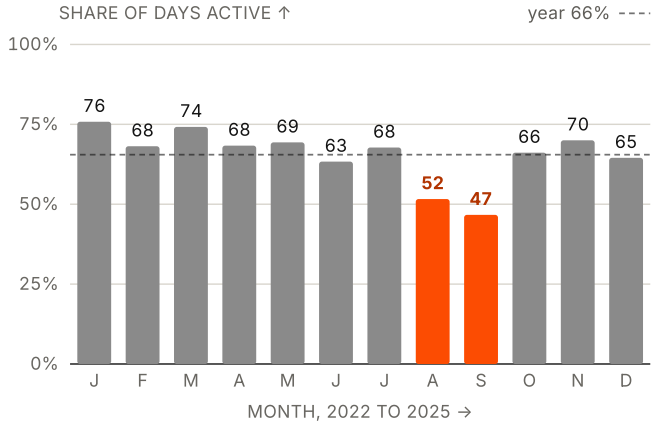
76%
in January, the strongest month

68%
in a typical month

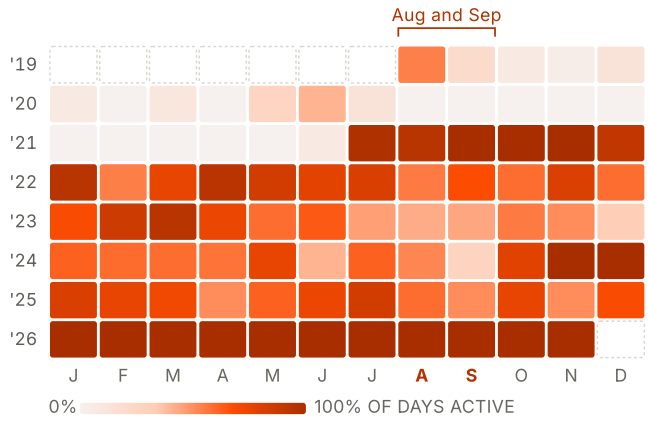
52%
in August

47%
in September

SHARE OF DAYS ACTIVE, BY MONTH



EVERY MONTH OF THE RECORD



HOW TO READ · SHARE OF DAYS ACTIVE, BY MONTH

One bar for each month, showing the share of its days that had an outing, from 2022 to 2025. The dashed line is the level for the whole year. The two orange bars are the quieter months.

DESIGN LESSON · A REFERENCE LINE TURNS BARS INTO ANSWERS

The dashed line is a benchmark: an average, an even share or a target. With it, each bar answers a plain question, above or below? Without it, the reader has to carry the benchmark in their head.

In your own work. Add one reference line and label it at its end, away from the bars. One is enough; three become clutter.

HOW TO READ · EVERY MONTH OF THE RECORD

Years run down and months run across. Each cell is one month, shaded by the share of its days with an outing: pale is a thin month and deep orange is a month with something almost every day. The bracket marks the two quieter months.

DESIGN LESSON · A HEATMAP FOR TWO TIME SCALES

Data with two kinds of time, such as years and months, is hard to show with lines: twelve lines tangle and eight lines tangle. A grid with one time on each axis keeps every value in its place, and shade is enough to see the season and the trend.

In your own work. When data has two kinds of time, put one on each axis and colour the cells.

THE STORY

The start of the year is my strongest time. January has the highest share of active days, and January, February and March are all above the level for the whole year.

The months grow fuller as the years go on. In the grid, the rows from 2021 on are much darker than the first two, and the row for 2026 is solid, every month with something every day.

The end of 2024 shows how quickly it can turn. September 2024 was my quietest month since the comeback, and from the last day of October I went out every day to the end of the year.

DISTANCE AND CLIMB

Where the height comes from.

Running gives me distance and almost no height, about 1.4 m for every kilometre. At that rate I would have to run more than 1,400 km to climb what one hike in Morogoro climbed in a day. The height comes from walking and the hills.

SHARE OF DISTANCE AND CLIMB ON FOOT

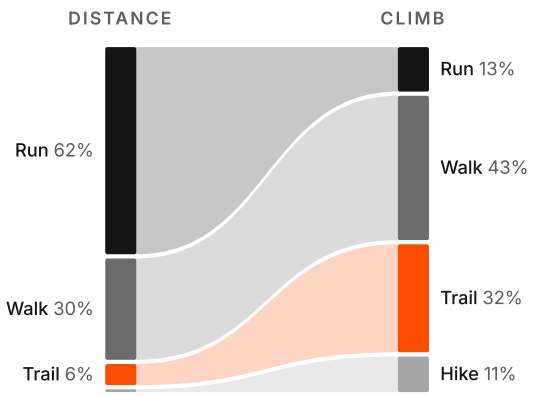
62%
of the distance is running

13%
of the climb is running

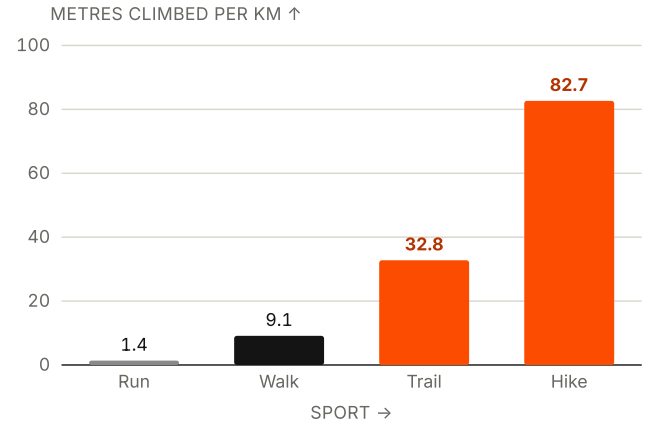
43%
of the climb is walking

43%
of the climb is trail runs and hikes

DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, BY SPORT



METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE



HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, BY SPORT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot, on the right its share of my climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport. A ribbon that narrows climbs less than its distance, and one that widens climbs more.

HOW TO READ · METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE

The average metres climbed for every kilometre, for each sport. A taller bar means steeper ground.

DESIGN LESSON · RIBBONS SHOW HOW SHARES SWAP

The same sports are stacked twice, by distance and by climb, and a ribbon joins each sport's two shares. When a ribbon crosses, the order has flipped, which is the point of this chart.

In your own work. To show how the same parts rank on two different measures, stack them side by side and connect them.

DESIGN LESSON · TWO VIEWS OF ONE FINDING

Each section sets two charts side by side at the same height: one shows the pattern, the other explains or tests it. Together they make an argument that one chart alone cannot.

In your own work. When one chart raises a question, put the chart that answers it right beside it.

THE STORY

A kilometre of hiking climbs about 60 times more than a kilometre of running. Hikes are rare in my log, only 13 of them, and still they gave 11% of all my climbing.

If I had only run, seven years would have given me 11,393 m of climbing, about 1.3 times the height of Everest. With the walks and the hills, the total is 7 times as much.

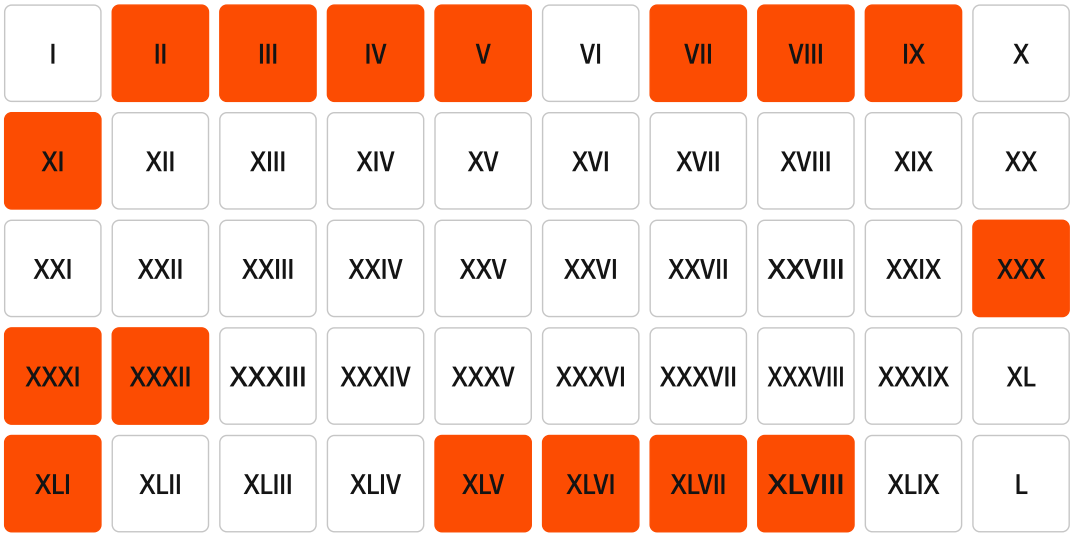
Trail runs sit in between. They are 6% of my distance and 32% of my climbing. Walks are the quiet worker: they gave more climbing than any other sport, because there are so many of them.

ONE PLACE, AGAIN AND AGAIN

Fifty trips to Ras Kilomoni.

Bandu bandu humaliza gogo, chip by chip finishes the log. I counted the trips to the headland in Roman numerals, I to L, 34 walks and 16 runs, over 173 days.

EVERY TRIP, IN THE NUMBERS I COUNTED THEM



run walk

MOMENTS IN THIS PART

19 Feb 2025	**First half-marathon walk** 30.0 km	28 Feb 2025	**My 1,500th outing** 275 days after the 1,250th
29 Dec 2025	**315 days in a row** and still going	13 Feb 2026	**Rukwa** region 15 of 31
20 Jun 2026	**Njombe** region 16 of 31	8 Aug 2026	**Singida** region 17 of 31
28 Aug 2026	**My 2,000th outing** 231 days after the 1,750th	8 Nov 2026	**2,076 outings** my latest on record

WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

How a year adds up.

PART 6 · LOOKING BACK

6

What it taught me

Seven years of logging, read back as a few plain lessons.

What It Means, chapter 6

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Train, train, train. And when you think you have trained enough, keep training.”

JODY MITIC

II

The mountains

Four mountains, told from my memory and from the line my watch drew on each.

02 Kilimanjaro 03 Hanang 04 Uluguru 05 Ngong Hills

CHAPTER 2

02 Kilimanjaro

The roof

I went up Kilimanjaro knowing nothing about climbing it. I joined a group of friends who were getting ready for it, five of us in all, and in March 2023 we went up the Marangu route to Uhuru Peak, 5,895 m.

3,860 m
climbed in four days

45.4 km
on foot, up and back to Horombo

4,015 m
from the gate to the summit

3
huts on the way up

THE WAY UP

Three days to Kibo Hut.

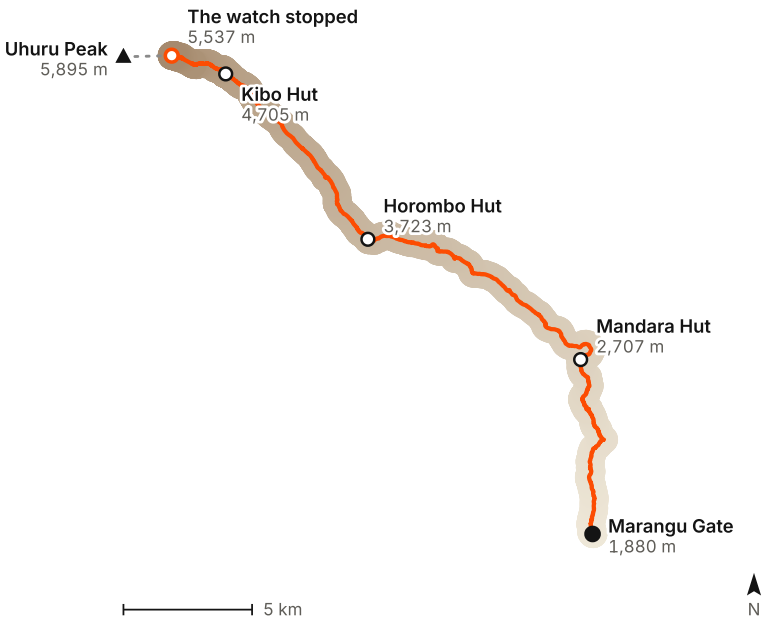
Marangu is known as the Coca-Cola route, the easy one, while Machame is the Whiskey route. I was born and raised in Moshi, at the foot of the mountain, so I thought the height would not trouble me.

From the gate at 1,880 m to Kibo Hut at 4,705 m took three days and 30.4 km, and every night was spent higher than the night before.

The air cooled at every hut. It was 27 degrees when I left the gate and 8 when I left Kibo Hut for the top.

Day 1	Marangu Gate to Mandara Hut	8.5 km · 4 h 55 min · 27° at the start
Day 2	Mandara Hut to Horombo Hut	12.6 km · 7 h 37 min · 14° at the start
Day 3	Horombo Hut to Kibo Hut	9.3 km · 7 h 26 min · 11° at the start
Summit night	Kibo Hut towards the top	3.2 km recorded · 8° at the start

THE MARANGU ROUTE, AS MY WATCH DREW IT



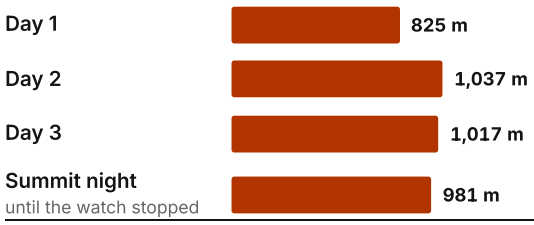
My watch drew all four stages. The dotted end is the part of the summit night it missed.

ONE HUT AT A TIME

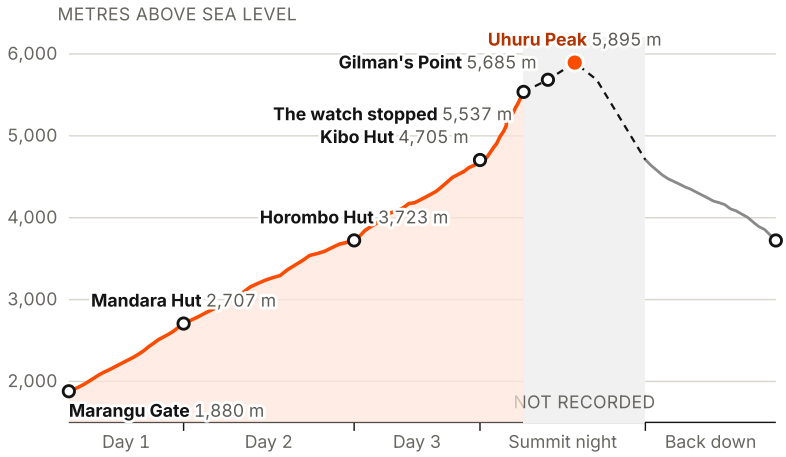
I almost quit at the first hut.

We reached Mandara Hut around eight at night, and it was colder than anything I had felt before. I asked myself what the higher camps would be like. The sunrise in the morning brought warmth, and I could tell it was going to be a good day.

The days before the summit carried most of the climb: 2,879 m of the 3,860 m, about 1,000 m a day.



THE CLIMB, STAGE BY STAGE



The whole way up, one stage after another, each as wide as the ground it covered. The orange line is what my watch recorded. On the summit night it stopped near the crater rim, so the dashed line in the grey band is the part of the night it missed: Gilman's Point, Uhuru Peak and the way back to Kibo Hut. The grey line is the walk down to Horombo that same afternoon.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW THE GAP IN THE DATA

When a recording fails, the easy thing is to join the last point to the next one and move on. Here that straight line would say I came down from near the crater rim to Kibo Hut in a moment. The grey band and the dashed line keep the gap in view and say plainly which part was not recorded.

In your own work. Never let a line quietly bridge missing data. Break it, mark the gap, and say why it is there.

THE SUMMIT NIGHT

The part my watch did not finish.

At Kibo Hut my head ached like never before, and I thought I would not wake up in time to join the summit team at midnight. I did some deep breathing, fell asleep, and woke around ten at night to go.

The early sunrise caught us near Gilman's Point. I have never seen anything like it in my life. The top was clear and there was no crowd. We reached Uhuru Peak around half past ten in the morning, and after about 30 minutes a storm was coming, so we started down.

My watch saw none of it. The cold and the power saver of the Samsung watch I had then stopped the recording at 5,537 m, about 150 m below Gilman's Point, and the next point it logged was back at Kibo Hut. One day I will go back and record the whole way.

5,895 m Uhuru Peak. The last 358 m are not in the log.

Mwenda pole hajikwai, the one who goes slowly does not stumble.

Back every year, a little faster.

The Kilimanjaro Half is part of the Kilimanjaro International Marathon, run in Moshi, the town where I was born and raised. The half is my size. The race is close to 25 years old, and the week around it is one big celebration in town, the kind you have to be there to feel.

I never ran it until this habit started. Now I go back every year, and the same road shows me plainly where I stand.

In 2026, two days after the race, I walked back up to Mandara Hut: 8.7 km and 805 m of climbing in one afternoon.



CHAPTER 3

03 Hanang

The long day

Coming down can take as long as going up. On Mount Hanang in Manyara I set out before six in the morning and was not back down until after two the next morning.

20.6 h
from the start to the finish

1,718 m
climbed

17.2 km
up and back down

8.6 h
of it counted as moving

30 APRIL 2023

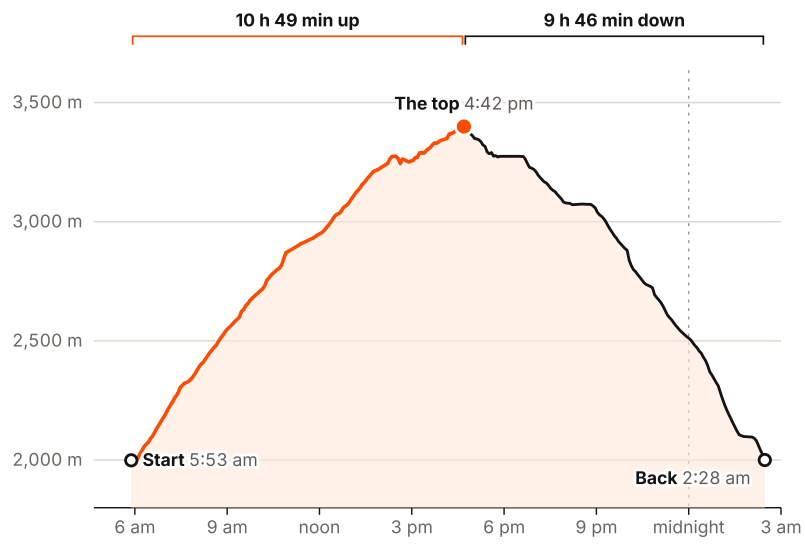
The top came slowly.

The last 300 m of height took 3 h 35 min, about a third of my time on the way up. I was with a friend who was very tired, so we took it easy. It was raining hard, the path up there had no marks and we had no guide, so for a while we were lost.

We stood on the top at 16:42, 10 h 49 min after the start.

05:53	The start	1,999 m
16:42	The top	3,399 m on my watch
21:00	Still coming down	3,040 m
00:00	Midnight	2,510 m
02:28	Back down	2,000 m

ALTITUDE AGAINST THE CLOCK



The hike against the clock, from the early-morning start to the finish after midnight. The orange line is the way up and the black line the way down, and the brackets above give the hours each took. The dotted line marks midnight.

DESIGN LESSON · CHOOSE THE AXIS THAT TELLS THE STORY

The same hike could be drawn against distance, and it would show a mountain. Drawn against the clock, it shows a day: the slow morning climb, the long way down, the hours past midnight. The choice of axis decides which story the chart tells.

In your own work. Before you draw, ask what the reader should feel: the shape of the ground, or the length of the effort. Put that on the horizontal axis.

AFTER DARK

Most of the way down came at night.

Coming down took 9 h 46 min, only 1 h 3 min less than going up. At nine in the evening I was still at 3,040 m, and at midnight at 2,510 m.

The rain did not stop. Halfway down we waited for other friends to reach us, so we could all go down together. I had no lamp of my own, so I used a friend's torch first and then the torch on my phone.

20.6 hours — On my feet, stops included.

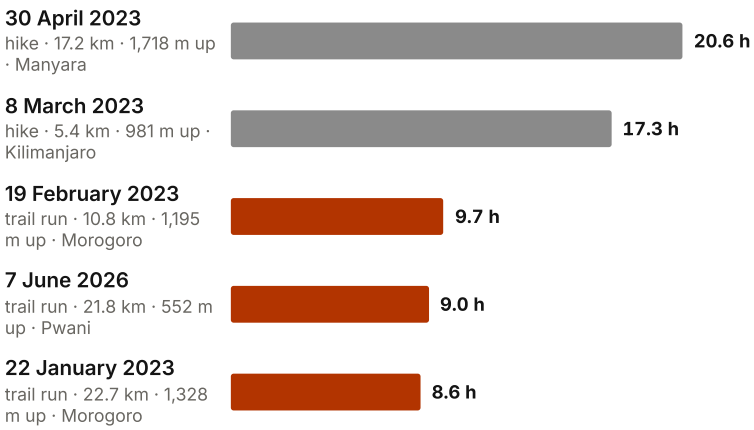
Subira huvuta heri, patience brings good things.

AGAINST MY OTHER DAYS

No other day in my log is this long.

The next longest is my summit night on Kilimanjaro, in March of the same year. It was 3 h 15 min shorter.

MY LONGEST DAYS OUT ON FOOT, FROM THE START TO THE FINISH



My five longest outings on foot, counted from the start to the finish, stops included. The line under each date gives the kind of outing, the distance, the climb and the region.

THE LINE ON THE MOUNTAIN

Hanang called me back.

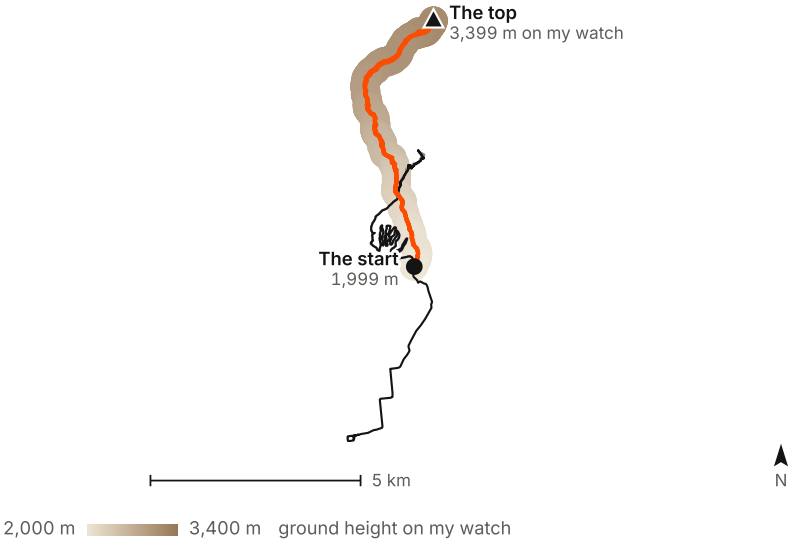
The forest reserve on Hanang runs an adventure race, and I went back for it in 2025 and 2026. It goes about halfway up and then turns to a place called Little Ngorongoro, shaped like a crater. There is camping too, and for me it is time away from the busy city. After the race in 2026 I walked all the way down to the bus stand.

30 April 2023
17.2 km · 1,718 m up
20 h 35 min

31 May 2025
14.9 km · 939 m up
5 h 1 min

12 July 2026
21.1 km · 879 m up
7 h 49 min

THREE DAYS ON HANANG



The hike to the top is orange. The races stay on the lower half of the mountain.

CHAPTER 4

04 Uluguru

The mountain I go back to

A mountain you can reach becomes a habit of its own. Bondwa Peak stands above Morogoro, in the Uluguru Mountains, and I have been up four times.

4
trips to Bondwa Peak

1,979 m
climbed on 29 March 2025

21,238 m
climbed in Morogoro, all outings

25%
of all the climbing in my record

FOUR TIMES UP

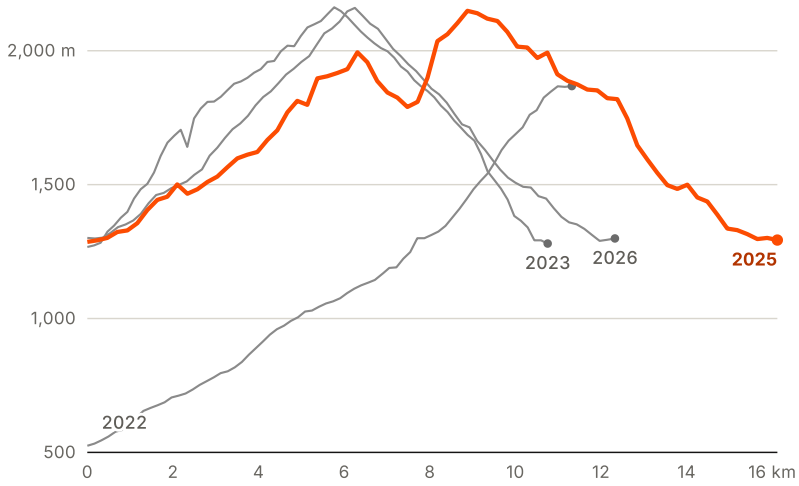
First for training, then for camping.

The first two trips were training for Kilimanjaro. On the first, in June 2022, I started down in the town at 525 m and climbed 1,425 m.

After Kilimanjaro I go for the camping. With friends I camp at Morningside, go up to the peak, come back to camp, and leave for town the next day. We take it easy now.

The later trips start higher, near 1,280 m, and top out at about 2,160 m.

EVERY TRIP TO BONDWA PEAK, ALTITUDE AGAINST DISTANCE



Orange is March 2025, my biggest climb. The other trips carry their year.

June 2022	**1,425 m up · 11.3 km**	4 h 22 min from start to finish · clear, 15°
February 2023	**1,195 m up · 10.8 km**	9 h 42 min from start to finish · partly cloudy, 19°
March 2025	**1,979 m up · 16.1 km**	7 h 40 min from start to finish · rain, 17°
May 2026	**935 m up · 12.3 km**	8 h 8 min from start to finish · cloudy, 17°

29 MARCH 2025

My biggest climb came in the rain.

It rained hard that day, the air was at 100% humidity and everything was slippery. The scenery was beautiful all the same. The path went up, came down and went up again: 16.1 km in 7 h 40 min from start to finish.

1,979 m

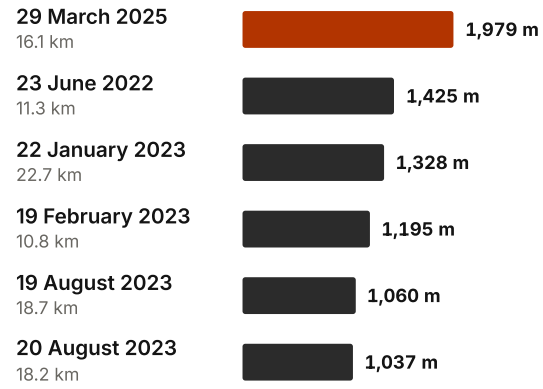
The most I have climbed in one outing.

THE LINES ON THE MOUNTAIN

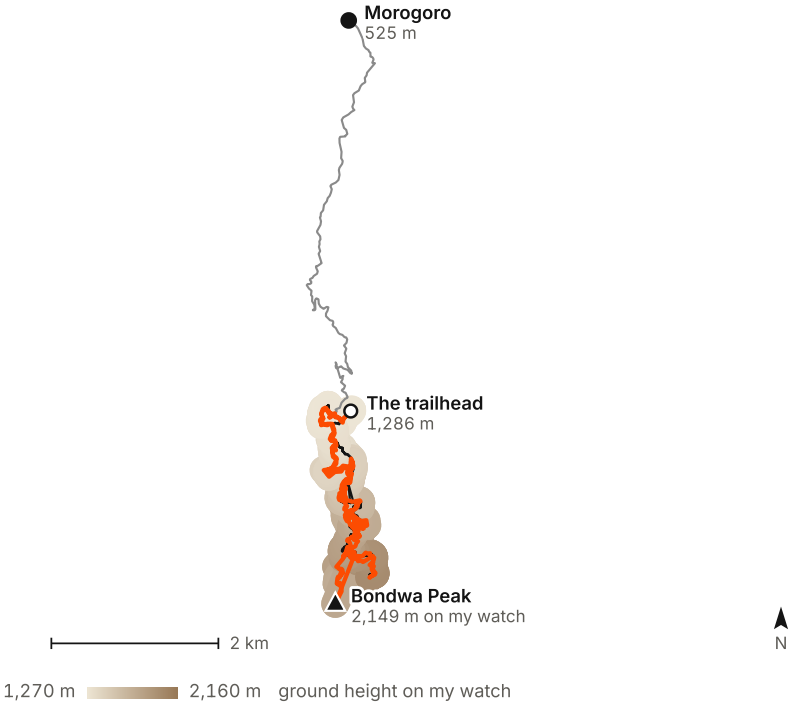
From the town to the top.

Morogoro has given me 72 outings on foot, 433 km and 21,238 m of climbing. Twelve of my twenty biggest climbs are here.

Not every trip goes to the top. In August 2023 I ran the Selous Trail Marathon here, on the route that goes halfway to Bondwa Peak, with a warm-up before it and a cool-down after: four outings and more than 2,000 m of climbing in one day, my biggest day of climb.



EVERY TRIP TO BONDWA PEAK, AS MY WATCH DREW IT



Orange is March 2025. The faint line is June 2022, from the town, with its first 500 m left off. Black are the other trips.

CHAPTER 5

05 Ngong Hills

The ridge across the border

I went to the Ngong Hills for one memorable day, and I did not get all of it. In April 2026 I was in Nairobi with a friend, and I wanted to walk the whole ridge, from Ngong town to Kiserian. Time ran short, so we turned at the highest point and came back.

15.1 km	701 m	2,459 m	5 h 33 min
along the ridge and back	climbed	the highest point, on my watch	from the start to the finish

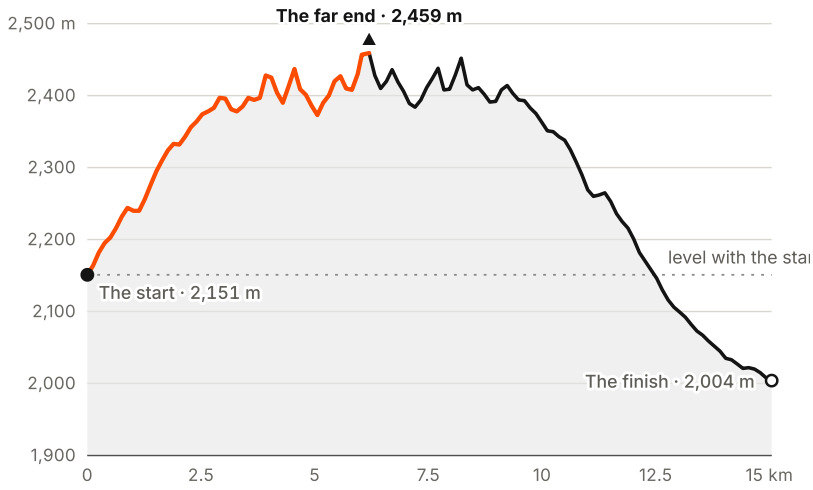
11 APRIL 2026

Up and down, all the way.

A ridge keeps going up and down. Every top was followed by a drop, and then by the next top. The far end was the highest, 308 m above where I started.

We turned there, came back over the same tops and kept going down to Ngong town. The finish was 147 m lower than the start, so the last part was all downhill.

ALTITUDE ALONG THE RIDGE



Out is orange and back is black. The dotted line is where I started.

12:47	The start	2,151 m · cloudy, 22°
15:17	The far end	2,459 m on my watch · 6.2 km
17:42	Level with the start again	12.5 km
18:20	The finish	2,004 m · 15.1 km

701 m

The most I have climbed in one outing outside Tanzania, 3.8 times the next, a walk in Rwanda.

Milima haikutani, binadamu hukutana, mountains do not meet, but people do. On the ridge my friend gave the day a name, the Ngong wisdom: you do not always get what you wanted.

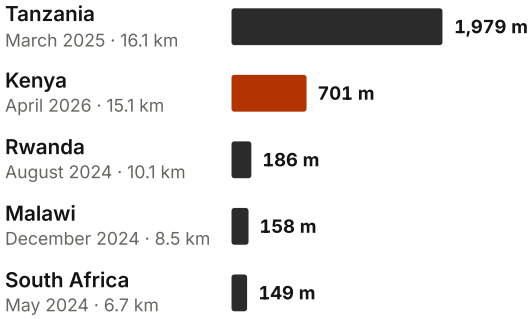
THE LINE ON THE RIDGE

Out, back, and on.

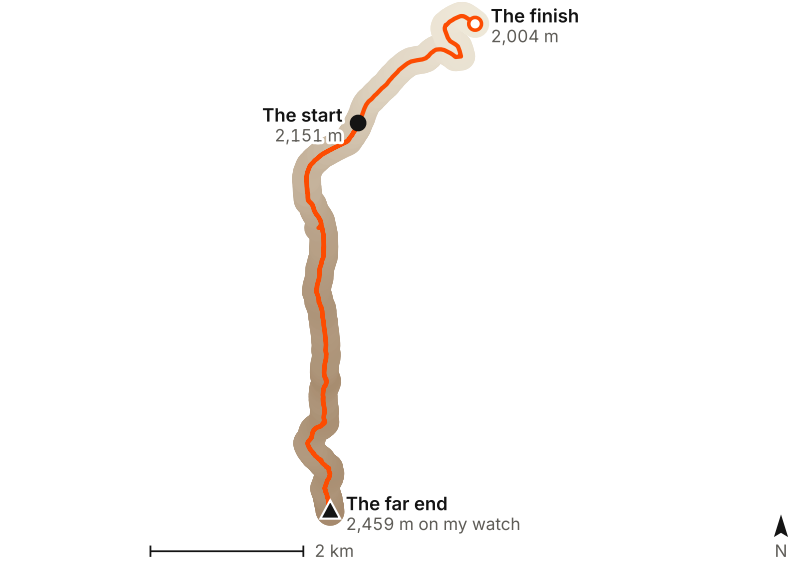
My climbing is at home. Outside Tanzania my outings have been flatter, and this day stands far above the rest of them.

Before this day the most I had climbed in Kenya was 179 m.

In the whole record this day ranks number 25 for climbing in one outing.



THE NGONG HILLS, AS MY WATCH DREW THEM



I went out along the ridge, came back the same way and kept going down to Ngong town.

III

The lessons

What I think seven years of logging have taught me.

CHAPTER 6

06 What It Means

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Break the long challenges into increments, things you can do right now that add up over time.”

DAN CNOSSEN

A medical check-up asked me for thirty minutes a day, and this chapter is what I learned from giving it more. Each section is one lesson, drawn from my own record, about what the habit costs, what keeps it going and how a year adds up.

The lessons are mine and they come from one person’s days. I share them as things that worked for me, and the last section gathers them for anyone starting out.

Usipoziba ufa utajenga ukuta, if you do not fill the crack you will build a wall. Most of the lessons here are about the small cracks: the one zero day that becomes five, the short walk that keeps the chain unbroken.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

The charts in this chapter are chosen to make each lesson easy to feel. Time is drawn as clocks, days are stacked as dots that can be counted, and the trade-off between more days and longer days is drawn as lines of equal total.

It costs time.

The habit costs me about a long lunch break a day, and nothing about it is heavy: mostly walking, some easy running. The check-up asked for thirty minutes. I give it more than twice that.

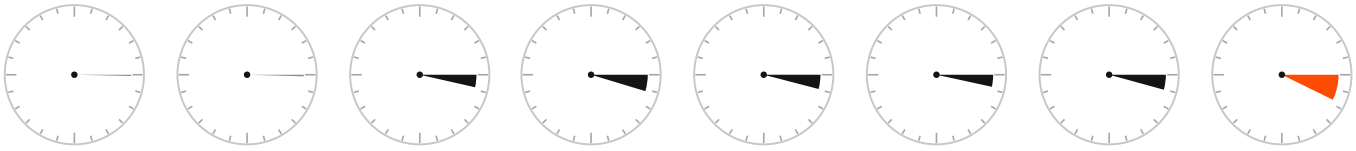
WHAT IT COST

2,400 hours
on the move since the first upload

100 days
if those hours ran end to end

71 min
a day since 2021, zero days included

105 min
a day in 2026



5 min
2019

7 min
2020

52 min
2021

68 min
2022

59 min
2023

50 min
2024

62 min
2025

105 min
2026 SO FAR

A full circle is one day.

DESIGN LESSON · SMALL MULTIPLES

One small chart per year, all drawn the same way and to the same scale. The eye compares them like faces in a row.

In your own work. When one chart gets crowded, split it into a grid of small identical charts.

THE STORY

Each clock is one year, and the filled wedge is the time I spent moving on an average day, zero days included. In 2019 and 2020 the wedges are thin slivers of 5 and 7 minutes a day.

From 2021 to 2025 the clocks are almost the same size, between 50 and 68 minutes a day. The habit was steady long before it became every day. In 2026 the wedge is the biggest of all, more than an hour and a half of every day.

Spread over a day, it is not a lot of time. That is the first lesson, and the rest of this chapter follows from it.

Keep the days.

If I could keep only one thing, I would keep the days. In 2024 my distance fell to less than half of 2022's and the long days nearly vanished, yet I still went out on 234 days. When the kilometres came back in 2026, there was a habit waiting for them.

2022 AGAINST 2024

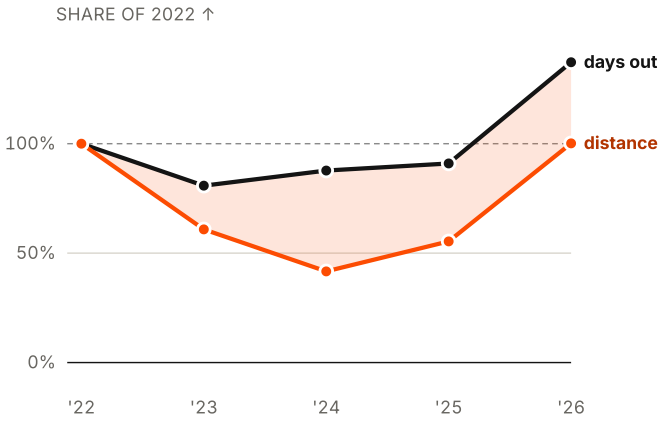
58% less distance per day

12% fewer days out

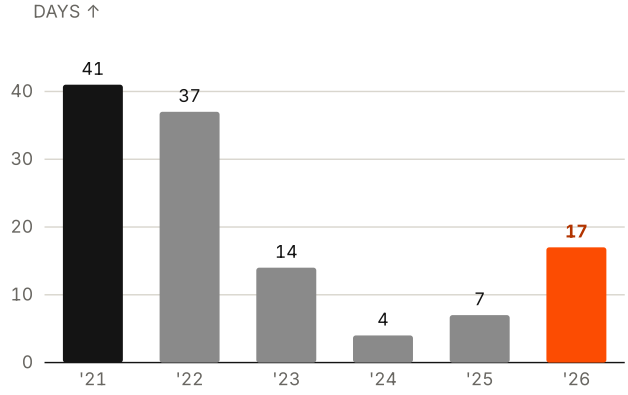
4 days of 21 km or more in 2024, from 37

312 of 312 days out in 2026 so far

DAYS OUT AND DISTANCE, AGAINST 2022



DAYS OF 21 KM OR MORE ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · DAYS OUT AND DISTANCE, AGAINST 2022

Two lines against 2022, my best year for distance per day. The black line is the share of days I went out and the orange line is the distance per calendar day, both as a percentage of 2022. The shaded gap shows how far the distance fell while the days held.

HOW TO READ · DAYS OF 21 KM OR MORE ON FOOT

The number of days each year with 21 km or more on foot. The orange bar is the year in progress.

DESIGN LESSON · INDEX TO A BASE YEAR

Both lines are shown as a share of the same base year, so two measures with different units can share one axis. The gap between them is the story.

In your own work. To compare the shapes of two measures with different units, index both to the same starting point.

DESIGN LESSON · LIGHT GRID, DARK DATA

Gridlines and axes are drawn in the lightest grey that still reads, and the data in black or orange. Everything that is not data stays in the background.

In your own work. Make the data the darkest thing on the chart.

THE STORY

The gap was widest in 2024. That year I went out on 88% as many days as in 2022, and covered only 42% of the distance per day.

In 2026 both lines have climbed back above where they started. I go out on more days than in 2022 and I cover a little more each day. The days came back first, and the distance followed them.

Streak savers count.

Haba na haba hujaza kibaba, little by little fills the measure. Plenty of my days were tiny, under 2 km on foot, and they add almost nothing to the total. I logged them anyway. After one of these streak savers I went out again the next day far more often than after a zero day. I call them busy days, and on a busy day the rule is simple: find a way to do something, even the small version.

STREAK SAVERS SINCE 2021

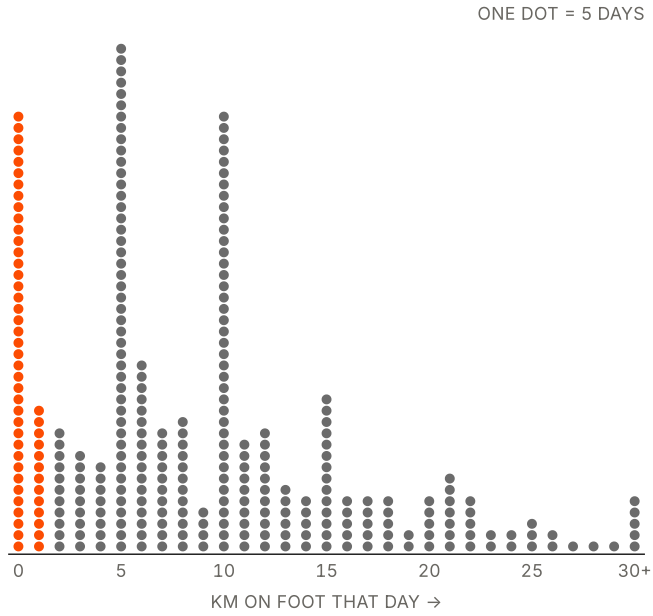
252 days
under 2 km on foot

17%
of all my days out

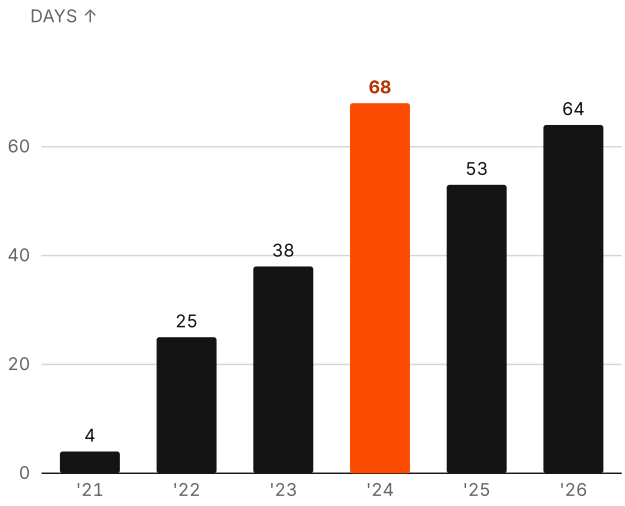
77%
out again the next day

50%
out again after a zero day

EVERY DAY OUT SINCE 2021, BY ITS DISTANCE



DAYS UNDER 2 KM EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OUT SINCE 2021, BY ITS DISTANCE

Every day out since 2021 is a dot, stacked in the 1 km band its distance on foot fell in. The orange dots on the left are the streak savers under 2 km, and the tall stacks show my usual days.

HOW TO READ · DAYS UNDER 2 KM EACH YEAR

The number of streak savers under 2 km in each year.

DESIGN LESSON · A HISTOGRAM YOU CAN COUNT

Stacking one dot per day gives the shape of a histogram while keeping every day as a real mark. People trust what they can count, and a dot plot invites counting in a way bars do not.

In your own work. When the counts are small enough, stack dots instead of drawing bars.

DESIGN LESSON · EXPLAIN IN PLAIN WORDS

Most charts in this book carry a short note on how to read them, in everyday language. A chart is only clear when the reader knows what each mark means, and a sentence costs far less than a misread chart.

In your own work. Add one or two sentences in plain words under every chart you share.

THE STORY

Streak savers were most common in 2024, with 68 of them, in my lowest year. In 2026 so far there have been 64, in a year with no zero day at all.

On those days the outing was short, or it was one of the other activities. Either way, it counted as a day out, and it kept the chain going for the next day.

03 THE DOWN WEEKS

Keep a floor.

My best weeks look much the same as they did years ago. The change is at the bottom. Between 2022 and 2025 some weeks fell very low. In 2026 none has, and half of my weeks sit between 41 and 66 km.

WEEKLY VOLUME

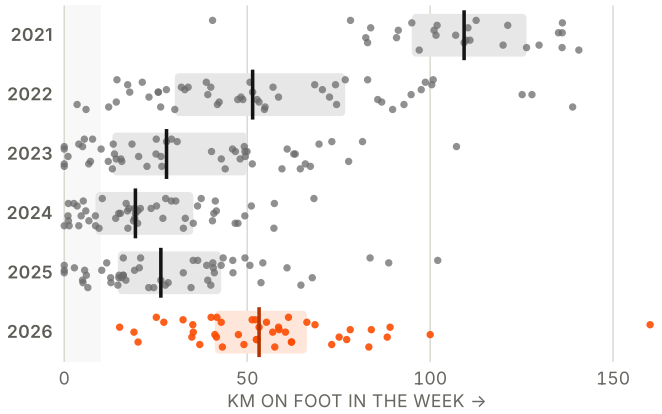
15 km
my lowest week of 2026

0 weeks
under 10 km in 2026

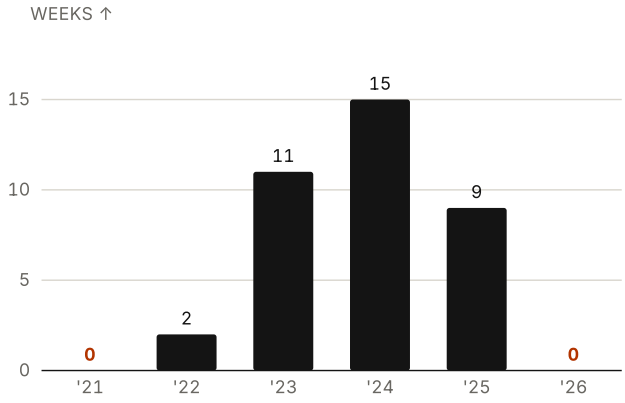
37 weeks
under 10 km, 2022 to 2025

8.0 km
a day in 2026

EVERY FULL WEEK, BY ITS DISTANCE



WEEKS UNDER 10 KM EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · EVERY FULL WEEK, BY ITS DISTANCE

Every full week as a dot, one row per year, placed by its distance on foot. The shaded band holds the middle half of the weeks and the tick is the usual week. The year in progress is orange.

HOW TO READ · WEEKS UNDER 10 KM EACH YEAR

The number of weeks in each year with less than 10 km on foot.

DESIGN LESSON · A DOT FOR EVERY WEEK

Each week is a dot on its year's row, with a band for the middle half and a tick for the median. The reader sees the summary and every week behind it at the same time.

In your own work. With a few hundred values per group, a strip of dots with a band shows more than a box plot.

DESIGN LESSON · UNITS PEOPLE CAN FEEL

Where it helps, numbers are turned into things a reader can picture: Everests climbed, or the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma walked end to end. A unit people can feel makes a number stay.

In your own work. Translate one big number into a comparison your audience knows.

THE STORY

The left edge of each row is where a year was won or lost. In 2024, 15 weeks fell under 10 km, more than in any other year. In 2026 the whole row has moved to the right, and the down weeks are gone.

A floor is easier to keep than a peak. A week of 20 km is three ordinary walks, and I can almost always find time for that.

04 LONG DAYS TOGETHER

Long days come in bunches.

A long day rarely comes alone. The days before it are busier than usual, and the day after I am usually out again, often further than normal. For me a long day sits in the middle of a busy stretch, and a full rest straight after it is rare.

DAYS OF 21 KM OR MORE SINCE 2021

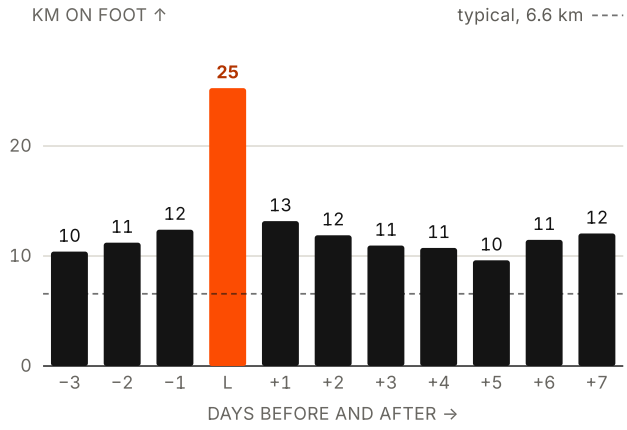
120 days
of 21 km or more on foot

90%
followed by another day out

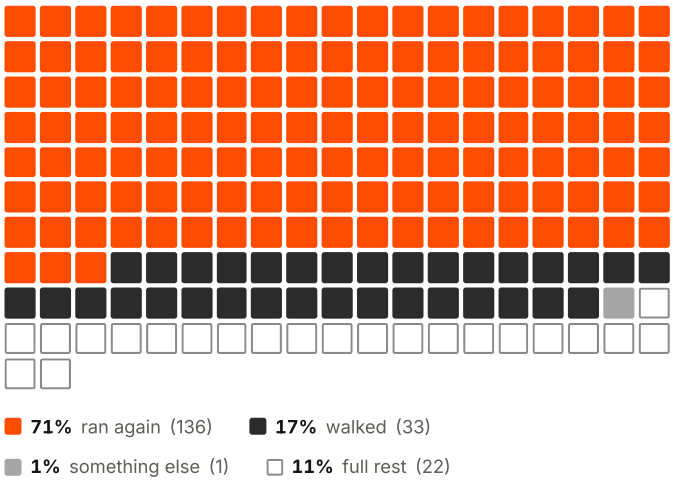
13.2 km
the next day, against 6.6 km on a typical day

11%
full rest after a 15 km run

THE DAYS AROUND A LONG DAY



WHAT CAME THE DAY AFTER A 15 KM RUN



HOW TO READ · THE DAYS AROUND A LONG DAY

The average distance on foot on the days around a long day of 21 km or more, from three days before to seven days after. The tall bar is the long day itself, and the dashed line is a typical day.

DESIGN LESSON · SAY WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM

Each section ends with a source line naming the table the numbers came from. A reader who doubts a figure knows where to look, and the writer has to be sure every number can be traced.

In your own work. Put a short source line under every chart you publish, even when the data is your own.

HOW TO READ · WHAT CAME THE DAY AFTER A 15 KM RUN

One square for each run of 15 km or more, grouped by what I did the next day: ran again, walked, did something else, or rested.

DESIGN LESSON · ONE SQUARE PER CASE

Each long run is a square, grouped by what followed it. Counting squares is easier than reading percentages, and the groups show the split at a glance.

In your own work. For counts under a few hundred, unit charts make the size of each group concrete.

THE STORY

Even a full week after a long day, my daily distance stays above a typical day. The long days come in my strongest weeks, and those weeks stay strong after them.

After a long run I went out again the next day 89% of the time. Rest after a long run is the exception for me.

05 DAYS AND DISTANCE

How a year adds up.

A year's total comes down to two things: how often I go out and how far I go each time. A thousand kilometres is a short outing every day, or about 4.1 km on two days in three, and I have done it both ways. 2021 was long days on about half the days. 2026 is every day, with fewer kilometres each time. 2024 was low on both, and it is my lowest year since the habit began.

THE TWO LEVERS

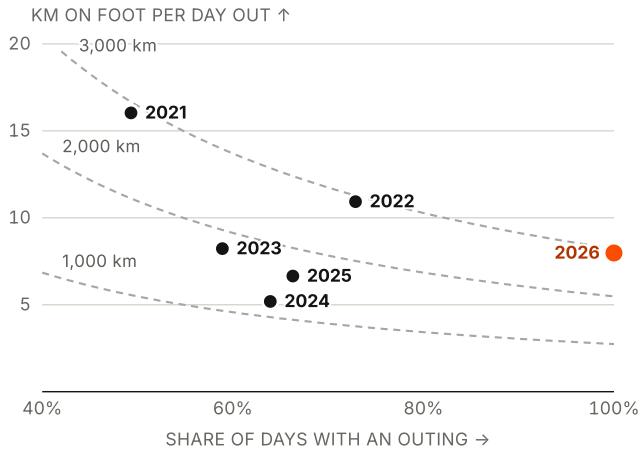
2.7 km
a day makes 1,000 km a year

16.0 km
per day out in 2021, the longest

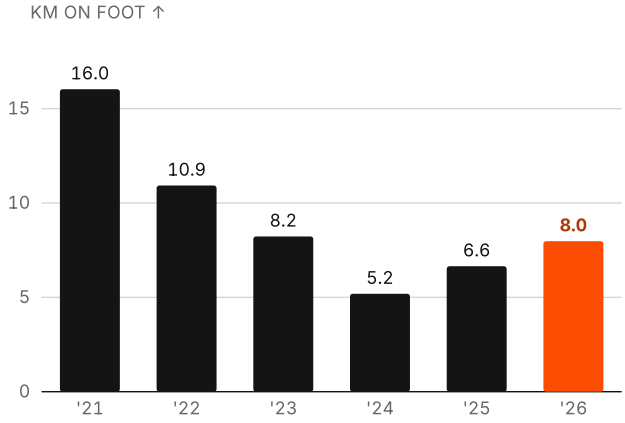
100%
of days out in 2026 so far

1,214 km
in 2024, low on both

EACH YEAR BY ITS TWO LEVERS



DISTANCE PER DAY OUT



HOW TO READ · EACH YEAR BY ITS TWO LEVERS

Across is the share of days I went out, and up is the distance per day out. Each curve is one yearly total, and each year sits where its two levers put it. A year can reach the same total by going further or by going more often.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE PER DAY OUT

The distance I covered on an average day out, each year.

DESIGN LESSON · DRAW THE TRADE-OFF

When an outcome is the product of two inputs, the same total can be reached in many ways. Lines of equal outcome across a chart of the two inputs show all those ways at once, and placing each case among them shows which lever it pulled.

In your own work. When an outcome is the product of two inputs, draw lines of equal outcome across a chart of the two inputs.

DESIGN LESSON · ONE CHART, ONE MESSAGE

Each chart here answers a single question, and the question is in its title. When a chart tries to say three things, the reader usually leaves with none.

In your own work. Before you draw, write the one sentence the chart must prove. If you need two sentences, draw two charts.

THE STORY

The distance per day out fell year after year from 2021 to 2024, and it has climbed again since. At this year's pace, 2026 would finish near 2,910 km.

For me the easier lever is the days. I cannot always go far, but I can almost always go.

06 WHAT I WOULD TELL YOU

If you are starting out.

Jocko Willink says discipline equals freedom. Seven years of logging turned that into a few habits I can keep: about an hour a day, the small version on a busy day, no week allowed to go thin, and the long days placed inside busy weeks. There are 53 days of 2026 left. Kesho tena, tomorrow again.

PART FOUR

IV

The Record

Each year on its own, my sports, my records, the places I went, the timeline and my goals.

07 Year in Sport 08 Sports 09 Records 10 Where 11 Timeline 12 Goals

CHAPTER 7

07 Year in Sport

No two years of this record look alike, and the fair way to see that is to read them all the same way. This chapter goes through the record one year at a time, from the small beginning and the long layoff to the comeback and the years after it. Each year has its own short opening, then the same sections in the same order.

Keeping the same order was a choice. A reader who has learned to read one year can read every other year at once, and what is left to see is the difference between them. The early years are thin, and their pages say so plainly. The later years are full, and the same charts carry far more marks.

Mwaka ni mwaka, a year is a year. Each one is judged on its own days, and the comparisons with the year before are there only to show which way I was moving.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

This chapter is a lesson in small multiples: the same charts repeated for each year, drawn the same way. Because the charts repeat, each design lesson is taught once, under the first year where it appears, and the later years are left to be read with what the reader already knows.

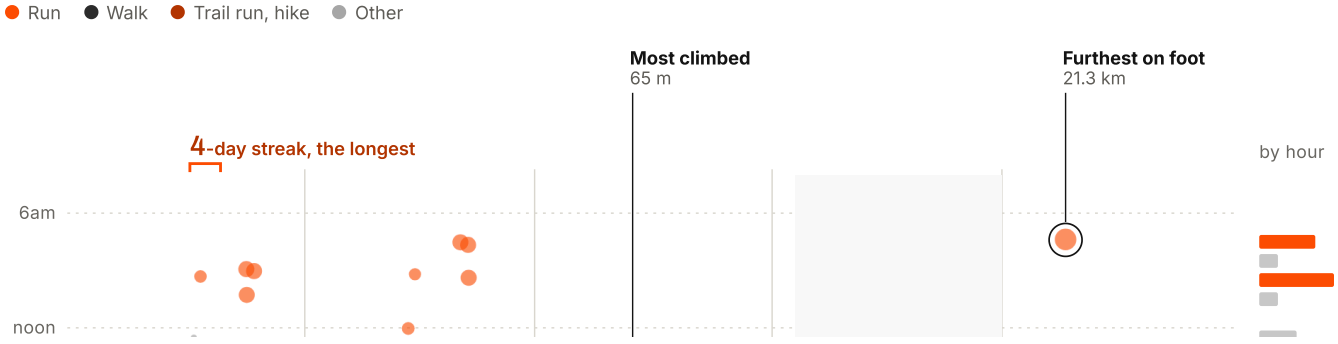
2019

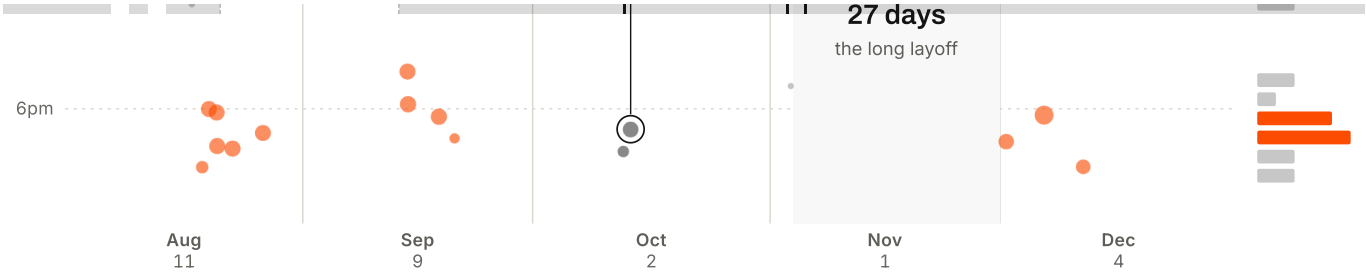
A small beginning.

Every habit starts small. By the end of my first year I had 27 activities, most of them runs on a treadmill, and my longest streak was 4 days.

2019 IN FOUR NUMBERS

27	231 km	85 m	33 h
outings	on foot	climbed	moving





DESIGN LESSON · EVERY POINT, NO SUMMARY

Nothing in this chart is averaged. A few thousand marks fit on one page when each is small, and the eye finds the gaps, the habits and the changes of hour by itself, all things an average would hide.

In your own work. When you have a few thousand records, try plotting all of them before summarising. Patterns appear that averages hide.

THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2019, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

2019 holds 2% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. Almost nobody followed me yet, and the whole year brought 3 kudos.

09 MONTH BY MONTH

August was the busiest.

August was my biggest month for distance too, with 90 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2019 BY THE MONTH

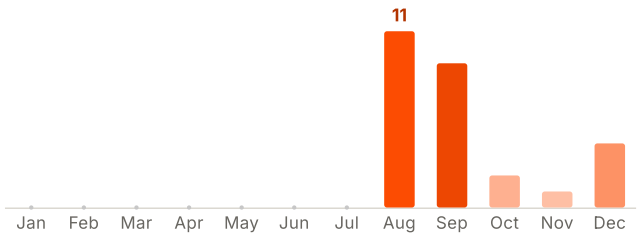
11
outings in August

1
in November, the quietest

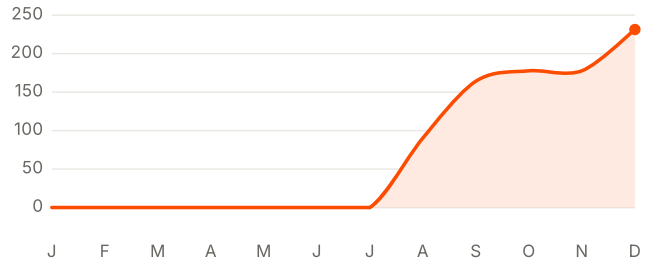
5
outings in an average month

46 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

DESIGN LESSON · MONTHS IN CALENDAR ORDER

Seasonal data keeps the calendar order, so the shape of the year reads like a profile from January to December. Only the bar that matters gets a label of its own; the others are left for the eye.

In your own work. For seasonal data, keep the calendar order and label only the bar you want remembered.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

DESIGN LESSON · DRAW THE YEAR AS IT WAS BUILT

The line adds up each month's distance from January, so it ends at the year's total. Its steep stretches are the strong months, and for a year still running it stops where the record stops.

In your own work. For progress within a period, a running total reads more naturally than separate monthly bars.

THE STORY

In the first three months I covered 178 km on foot, and in the last two 54 km. The line flattens as the year goes on.

No month reached 100 km on foot. The distance was still to come.

10 HOW IT MOVED

Runs led 2019.

Runs led the year, 23 of my 27 outings, against 2 walks. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

7% walks

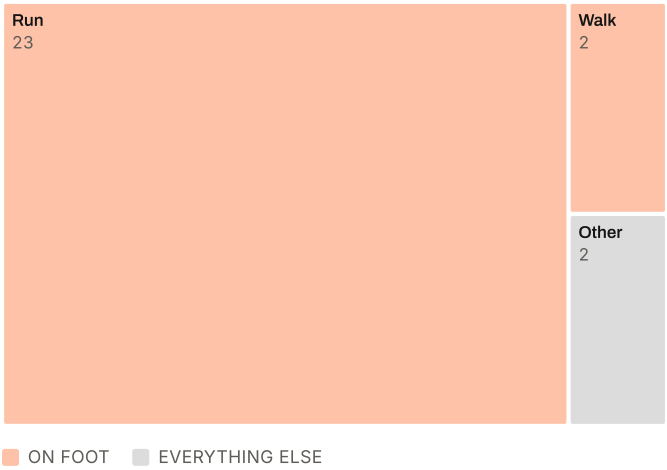
85% runs

0% trail runs and hikes

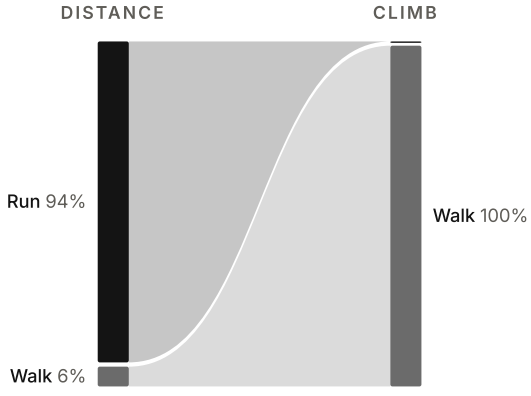
7% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

93% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

DESIGN LESSON · THE SAME CHART FOR THE SAME QUESTION

Every year in this chapter is told with the same charts in the same order. Once a reader has learned to read one year, every other year reads at once, and the differences between years are the only thing left to see.

In your own work. In a report that comes back every month or year, keep the charts the same each time. Change the design only when the question changes.

DESIGN LESSON · CHARTS WITH WORDS, WORDS WITH CHARTS

The charts in this book sit between a statement that says what they show and a story that says why it matters. The chart is the evidence; the words are the argument.

In your own work. Never send a chart alone. Put one sentence before it and one after it.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 6.7 km and my average run 9.5 km.

17 of my 23 runs were on the treadmill.

There were no trail runs or hikes this year, so the climbing came from walks and runs.

The other activities were 7% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2019, and 7pm was the busiest hour. Sunday was my busiest day and Thursday the quietest. 63% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, more than an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

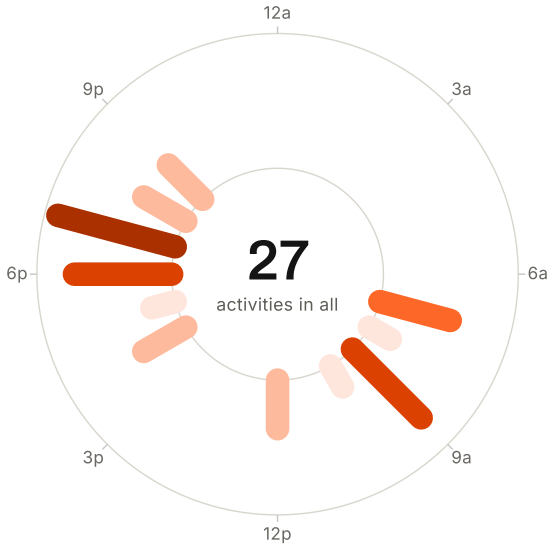
30% before 10am

11% between 10am and 4pm

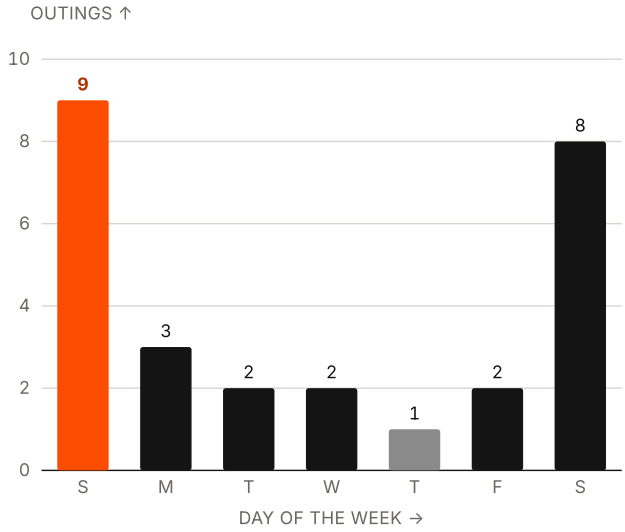
52% between 4 and 9pm

7% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

DESIGN LESSON · GREY IS A COLOUR TOO

Many marks in this book are grey, so the few in orange or black carry the meaning. Grey keeps the context visible without asking for attention.

In your own work. Start every chart in grey, then add colour only where the reader should look.

DESIGN LESSON · EVERY NUMBER NEEDS A COMPARISON

Almost every figure in this book is set against something: last year, the best year, the average, a target. A number alone cannot be called big or small.

In your own work. When you show a figure, show what to compare it with.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 07:24 on 9 Dec, and the latest at 21:02 on 18 Aug.

Runs led both ends of the day: 100% of my outings before 10am and 79% of those between 4 and 9pm.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 8.2 km, against 10.8 km on a weekday.

12 EVERY DAY OF THE YEAR

Out on 15% of days.

My longest streak went from 17 Aug to 20 Aug. My longest layoff ended on 1 Dec.

THE DAYS OF 2019

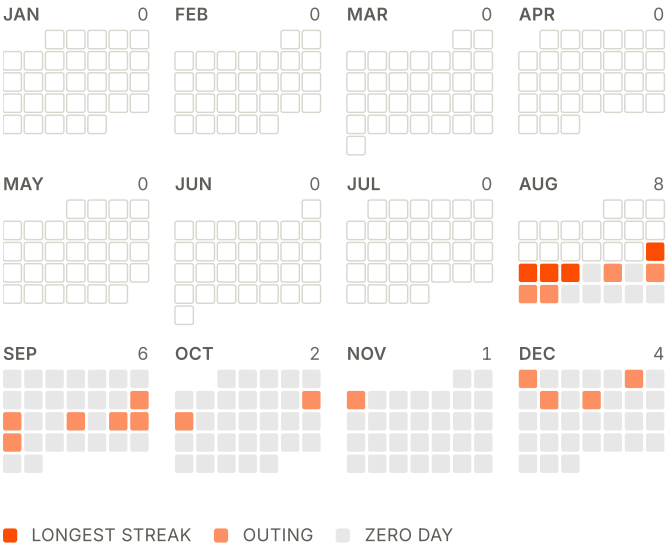
21 days
with an outing, of 137

4 days
the longest run in a row

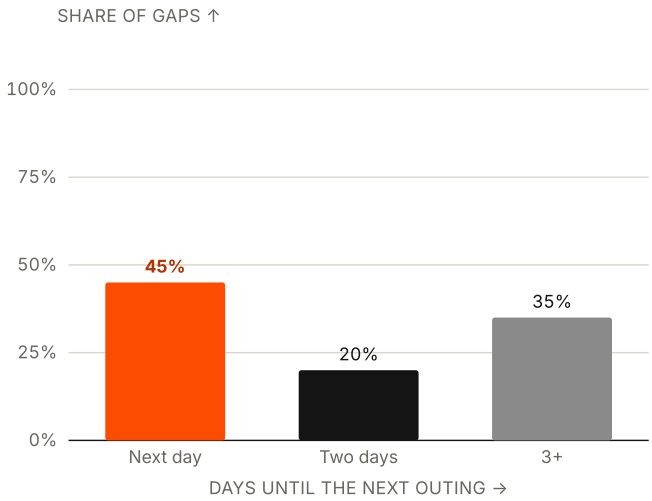
27 days
the longest layoff

45%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2019



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2019

Every day of 2019 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

DESIGN LESSON · BORROW A LAYOUT THE READER ALREADY KNOWS

Every day of the year is set as a wall calendar, Sunday first. Nobody needs a key to find a week or a month, so the attention goes to the pattern of orange days.

In your own work. If your data has a familiar shape, like a calendar or a map, use it. Familiar layouts cost the reader nothing to learn.

DESIGN LESSON · LABEL THE AXIS WITH ITS UNIT

Where a chart has an axis, its label gives the unit in plain words, such as km, outings or share of days. A number without a unit is a guess.

In your own work. Write the unit on every axis, in words your reader uses.

THE STORY

There were 116 zero days in 2019. More of them fell on a Tuesday than on any other day of the week.

The days were scattered, with no real streak yet.

No week of the year had an outing on every day.

On 5 days I doubled up.

13 THE TYPICAL OUTING

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in December.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

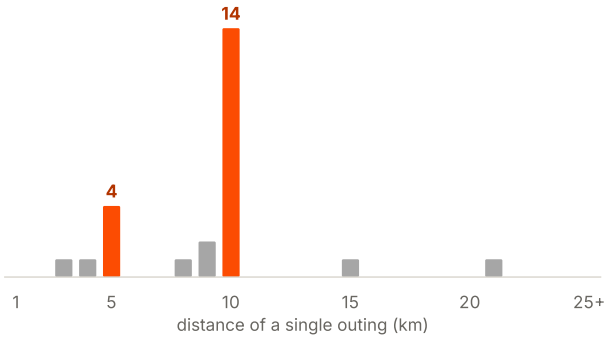
10.0 km
the middle outing

9.3 km
the average outing

21.3 km
the longest

20%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

Too few days on foot to split into tenths.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

DESIGN LESSON · BIN TO THE UNIT PEOPLE THINK IN

Outings are grouped by whole kilometres, the way a runner thinks of distance, and the long tail is folded into one last bar so it does not stretch the axis.

In your own work. Choose bin widths that match how your reader thinks, and gather a long tail into one labelled bin.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

DESIGN LESSON · ROUND TO WHAT THE READER NEEDS

Distances are mostly printed in whole kilometres and shares in whole percents. More digits would look more exact and say nothing more, and they would slow the reading.

In your own work. Round every printed number to the precision the decision needs. Keep the full figures in the table behind the chart.

THE STORY

64% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and one was a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 77% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, one outing was shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 21.3 km, a run in December.

14 BIGGEST DAYS

The biggest days of 2019.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

21.3 km

in a single outing

DEC 2019

LONGEST ON FOOT

2 h 23 min

of moving time in one outing

OCT 2019

MOST CLIMBED

65 m

of climb in one outing

OCT 2019

HARDEST EFFORT

270

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

AUG 2019

PRS

0

best times on Strava segments

2019

MOST CHEERED

1

kudos on one other activity

AUG 2019

EVERESTS

0.0 ×

the height of Everest, from 85 m climbed

2019

DAR TO DODOMA

0.5 ×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

231 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2019 was 10.0 km, so the furthest, 21.3 km in Dec, was 2.1 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

15 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

Eighth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes seventh, and for climbing seventh.

2019 AMONG THE YEARS

8

rank by outings

7

rank by distance

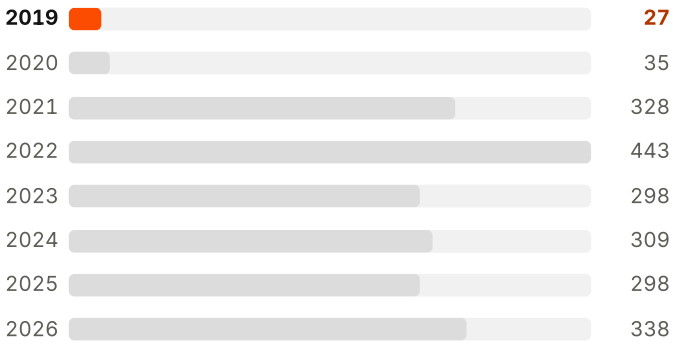
7

rank by climb

8

calendar years on record

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



THE FIRST YEAR

2019 is where my record starts.

HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2019 in orange.

DESIGN LESSON · ONE AGAINST ALL

The year being read is orange and every other year is grey, on one shared axis. The reader sees its place in the field at a glance.

In your own work. To show where one item stands, draw all of them and colour only that one.

HOW TO READ · THE FIRST YEAR

The first year has no year before it to compare with.

DESIGN LESSON · WHITE SPACE IS PART OF THE DESIGN

Each chart has room around it, and the text and the chart do not crowd each other. White space groups what belongs together and separates what does not, without a single extra line.

In your own work. Before adding a border or a box, try adding space.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes eighth, by PRs seventh and by kudos eighth.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 8% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes first of the eight years, at 9.3 km each.

FIRST STEPS

Where it began.

I heard about Strava and decided to give it a try. Most of that first year was runs on the treadmill, and nothing yet looked like the start of a habit.

27	21	231
ACTIVITIES	ACTIVE DAYS	KILOMETRES ON FOOT

DESIGN LESSON · ONE MOMENT, ONE PICTURE

The year's defining moment gets a single small picture and a short statement. A chart does not need axes and gridlines when it carries one fact.

In your own work. For one number that matters, a big figure and a simple shape beat a full chart.

2020

The long layoff.

A habit can stop very easily. In July I went out in Kenya, my first outing outside Tanzania, and the next day once more, in Arusha. Then I changed jobs and moved from Arusha to Kilimanjaro, in the time of COVID-19, and I did not go out again for almost a year.

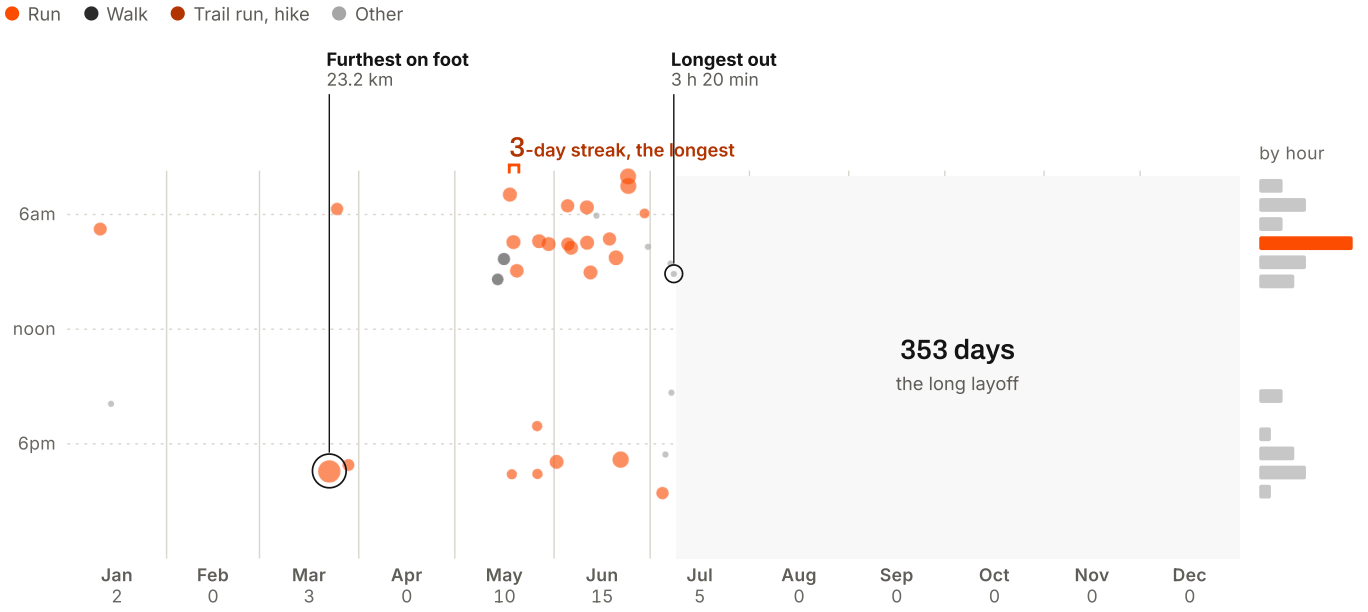
2020 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2019

35
outings, up 30%

191 km
on foot, down 17%

25 m
climbed, down 70%

42 h
moving, up 26%



DESIGN LESSON · SEE-THROUGH DOTS FOR CROWDED CHARTS

The dots are partly transparent, so where many overlap the area grows darker. Density shows without counting.

In your own work. In a crowded scatter, lower the opacity until overlaps become visible.

THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2020, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

2020 holds 1% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. Almost nobody followed me yet, and the whole year brought 30 kudos.

June was the busiest.

June was my biggest month for distance too, with 95 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. I went out in only five of the twelve months.

2020 BY THE MONTH

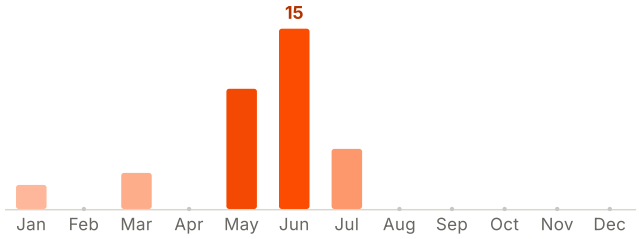
15
outings in June

2
in January, the quietest

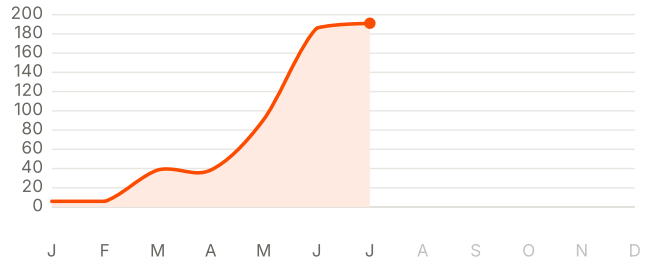
3
outings in an average month

16 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

DESIGN LESSON · FEWER MARKS, MORE MEANING

Nothing on these charts is decoration: no shadows, no 3D, no backgrounds. Every line and every shade carries data or helps read it.

In your own work. For each element of your chart, ask whether the reader would miss it. If not, remove it.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

DESIGN LESSON · IN A RUNNING TOTAL, THE SLOPE IS THE SPEED

A running total only rises or stays flat, so its slope tells the story: steep is a busy spell and flat is a pause. The eye reads slope well, which makes a cumulative line a good way to show pace over time.

In your own work. Use a cumulative line when the journey to a total matters more than the amount in each period.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 186 km on foot, and in the last six 5 km. The line flattens as the year goes on.

No month reached 100 km on foot. The distance was still to come.

Month against month, five of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2019.

Runs led 2020.

Runs led the year, 26 of my 35 outings, against 2 walks. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

6% walks

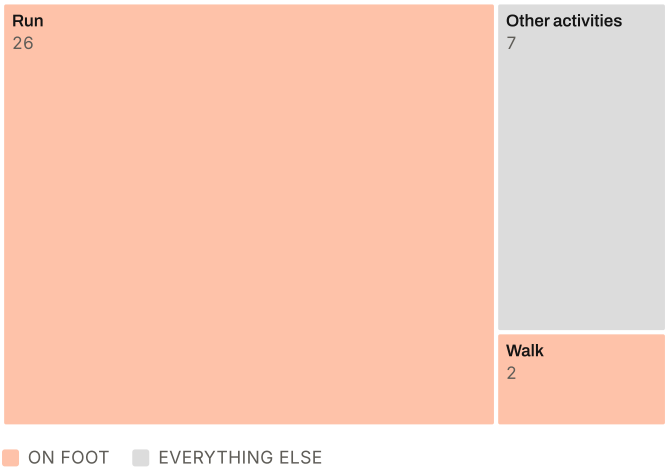
74% runs

0% trail runs and hikes

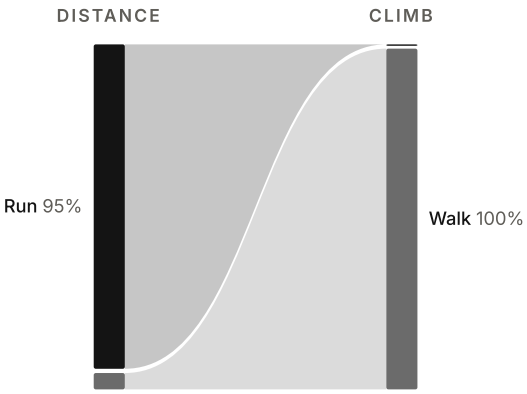
20% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

80% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

DESIGN LESSON · A CHART FOR EVERY READER

On the site, every chart carries a written description for screen readers, with the same numbers the picture shows. Writing it is also a test: if the description is hard to write, the chart is probably unclear.

In your own work. Write a one-line text version of each chart you publish. It helps readers who cannot see it and sharpens the chart for everyone.

DESIGN LESSON · DESIGN FOR PAPER AS WELL AS THE SCREEN

On the site many of these charts move and respond to the pointer. In print they are frozen, so every value that matters must be printed, never left behind a tooltip.

In your own work. Check every chart in its printed form. Anything a reader can only learn by hovering is lost on paper.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 4.6 km and my average run 7.0 km.

22 of my 26 runs were on the treadmill.

There were no trail runs or hikes this year, so the climbing came from walks and runs.

The other activities were 20% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

12 WHEN IT HAPPENED

The mornings led.

The mornings were my time in 2020, and 7am was the busiest hour. Tuesday and Saturday were my busiest days and Friday the quietest. 31% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

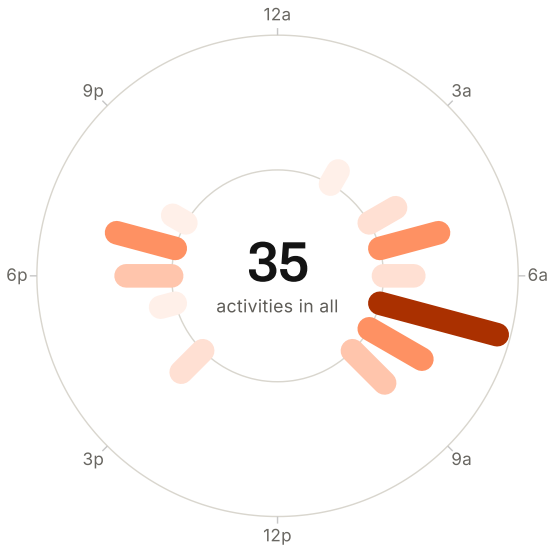
69% before 10am

6% between 10am and 4pm

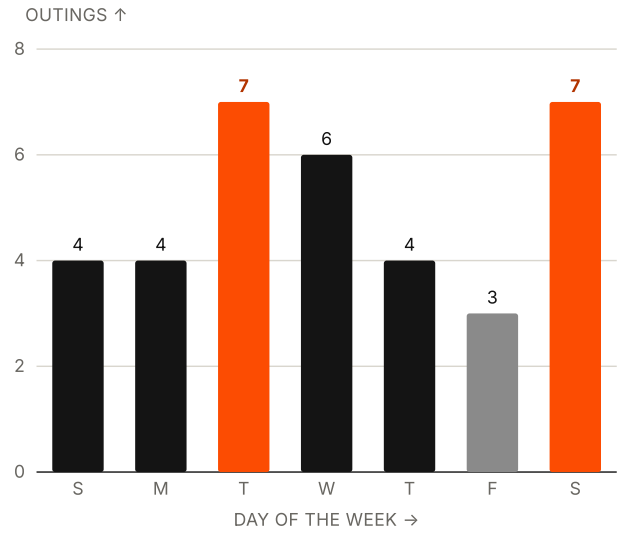
26% between 4 and 9pm

0% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 02:46 on 24 Jun, and the latest at 20:33 on 4 Jul.

Runs led both ends of the day: 75% of my outings before 10am and 89% of those between 4 and 9pm.

Seven outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 8.5 km, against 6.1 km on a weekday. The weekend is when the longer outings fit.

Out on 8% of days.

My longest streak went from 18 May to 20 May. My longest layoff ended on 27 Jun 2021.

THE DAYS OF 2020

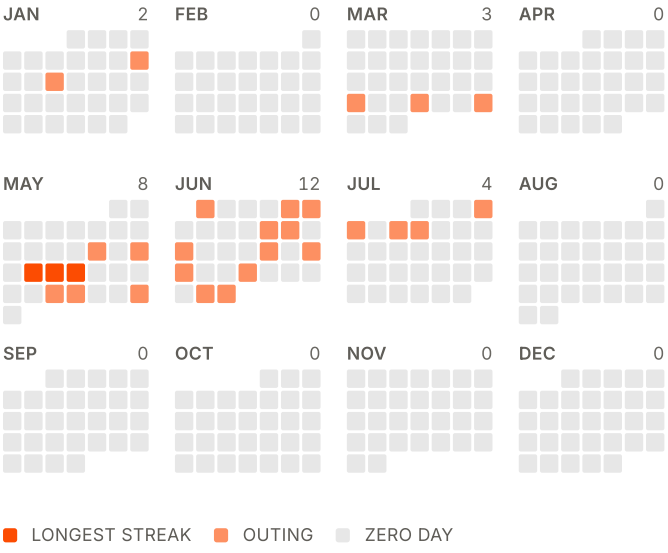
29 days
with an outing, of 366

3 days
the longest run in a row

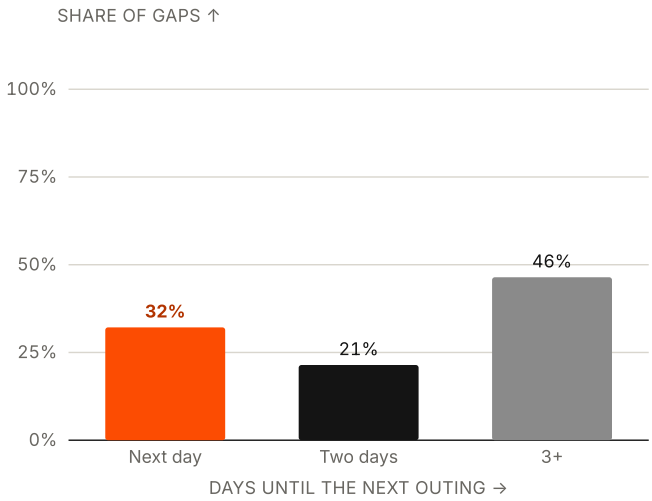
353 days
the longest layoff

32%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2020



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2020

Every day of 2020 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 337 zero days in 2020. More of them fell on a Thursday than on any other day of the week.

The days were scattered, with no real streak yet.

No week of the year had an outing on every day.

On 6 days I doubled up.

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 6 km or 7 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in March.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

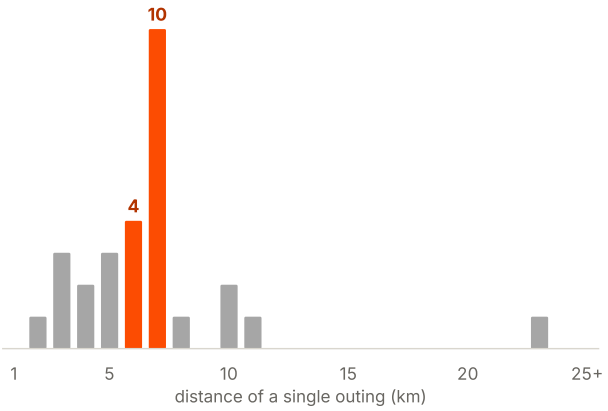
6.8 km
the middle outing

6.8 km
the average outing

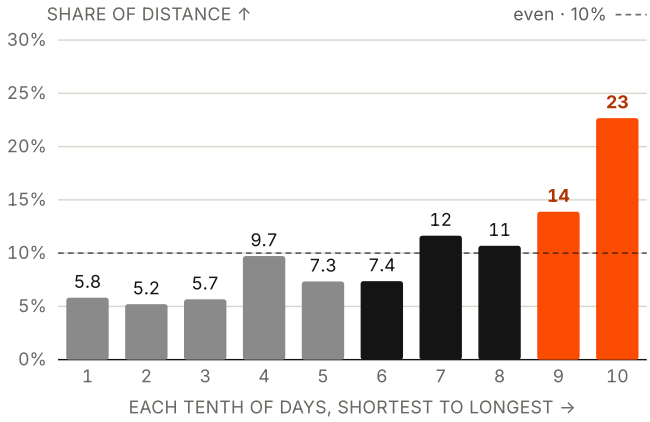
23.2 km
the longest

23%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

14% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and one was a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 28% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, four outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 23.2 km, a run in March.

The biggest days of 2020.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

23.2 km

in a single outing

MAR 2020

LONGEST ON FOOT

1 h 57 min

of moving time in one outing

MAR 2020

MOST CLIMBED

15 m

of climb in one outing

MAY 2020

HARDEST EFFORT

181

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

JAN 2020

PRS

0

best times on Strava segments

2020

MOST CHEERED

5

kudos on one other activity

JUL 2020

EVERESTS

0.0 ×

the height of Everest, from 25 m climbed

2020

DAR TO DODOMA

0.4 ×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

191 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2020 was 6.8 km, so the furthest, 23.2 km in Mar, was 3.4 times a normal day out.

The furthest outing was also the longest in time, 1 h 57 min on my feet. The most climbing came on a different day, 15 m in May.

I set 0 PRs on Strava segments, the same number as in 2019.

16 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

Seventh of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes eighth, and for climbing eighth.

2020 AGAINST 2019

+30%
outings

−17%
distance on foot

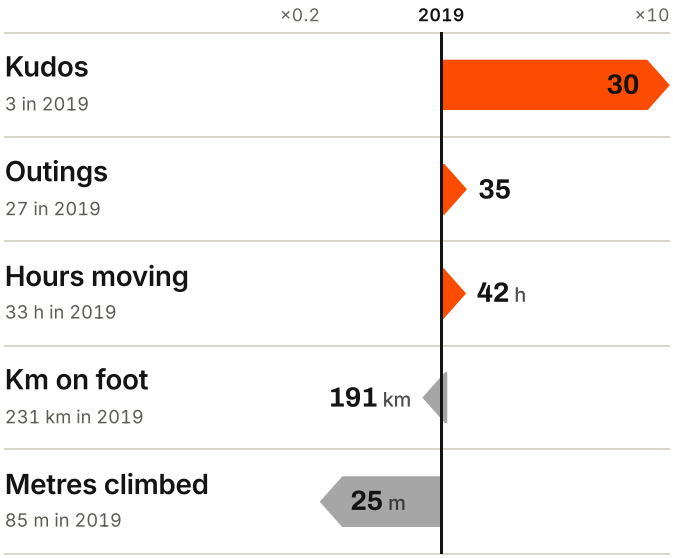
−70%
metres climbed

0%
PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



ALL UP ON 2019 BUT KM ON FOOT AND METRES CLIMBED



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2020 in orange.

HOW TO READ · ALL UP ON 2019 BUT KM ON FOOT AND METRES CLIMBED

Every bar starts at the 2019 total and points to 2020, with the 2020 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

DESIGN LESSON · DRAW THE CHANGE, NOT THE TOTALS

Outings, kilometres and kudos are counted in different units, so their totals cannot share one axis. Their change can: every bar starts from last year and is measured in per cent, so the longest bar is the biggest change. The rows are sorted by it, so the order is the story.

In your own work. To compare change across measures with different units, plot the change from one shared starting line.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes seventh, by PRs seventh and by kudos seventh.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 7% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes sixth of the eight years, at 6.8 km each.

THE QUIET YEAR

Then I stopped.

I changed jobs and moved from Arusha to Kilimanjaro, in the time of COVID-19. After the middle of the year the log went quiet, and it stayed quiet for almost a year.

35	29	3
ACTIVITIES	ACTIVE DAYS	LONGEST STREAK

2021

The year I came back.

Kawia ufike, it is better to arrive late than not to arrive. I came back in June with a 10 km run, after a 353-day layoff. Within weeks I was going out almost every day, and on 57% of my days out I doubled up. Everything after grew from this year.

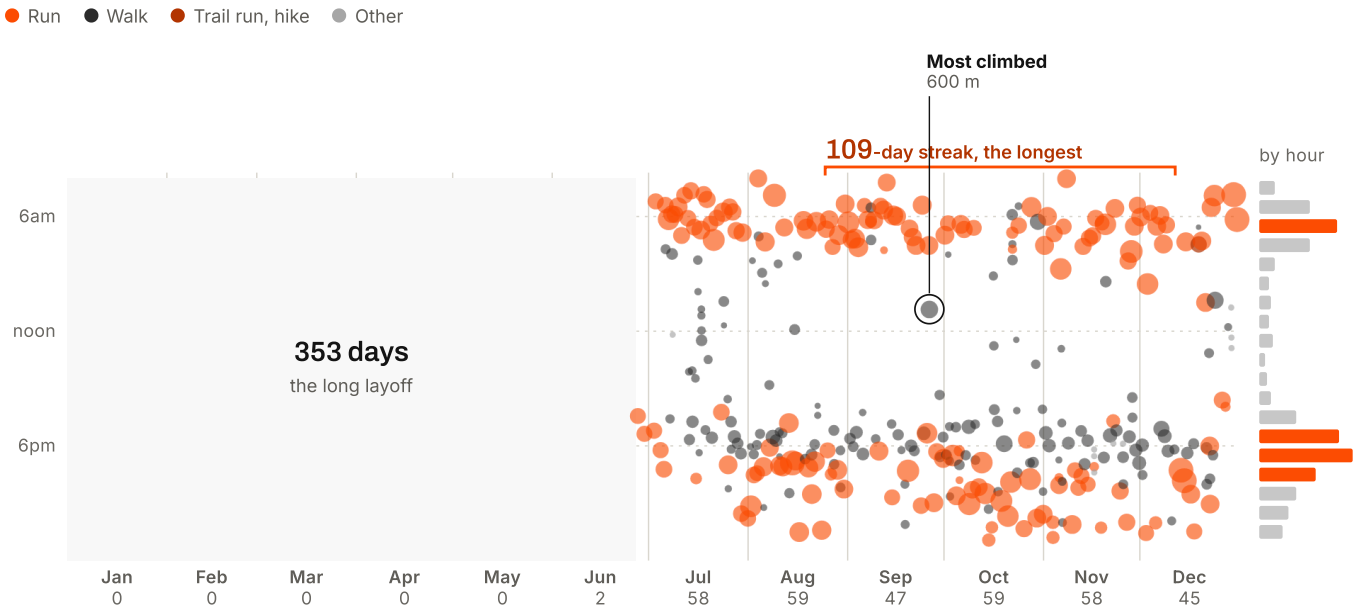
2021 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2020

328
outings, up 837%

2,885 km
on foot, up 1410%

6,560 m
climbed, up 25726%

318 h
moving, up 659%



THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2021, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 318 hours I spent moving in 2021 come to about 13 full days and nights. 2021 holds 22% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 8,674 kudos over the year, about 26 for each outing, and I set 36 PRs on Strava segments.

August was the busiest.

August was my biggest month for distance too, with 559 km on foot. The year started slowly and grew stronger as it went. I went out in only seven of the twelve months.

2021 BY THE MONTH

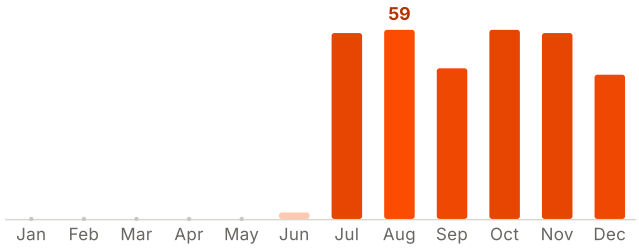
59
outings in August

2
in June, the quietest

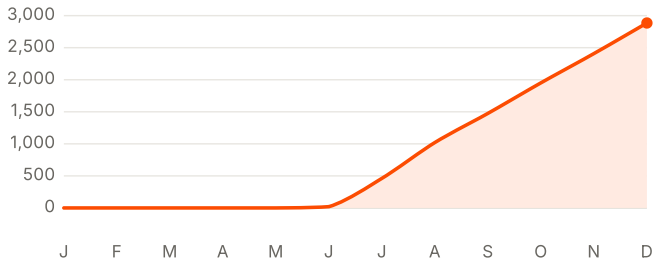
27
outings in an average month

240 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 20 km on foot, and in the last six 2,865 km. The line gets steeper as the year goes on.

Six of the twelve months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was September, with 1,803 m on foot.

Month against month, six of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2020.

Runs led 2021.

Runs led the year, 173 of my 328 outings, against 145 walks and one trail run or hike. Running gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 11 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

44% walks

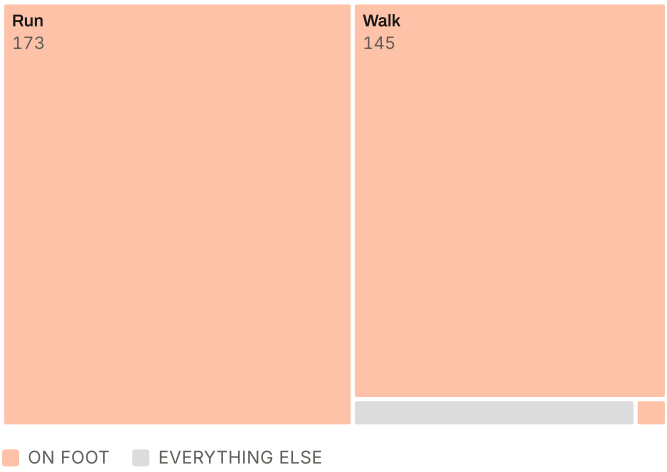
53% runs

0% trail runs and hikes

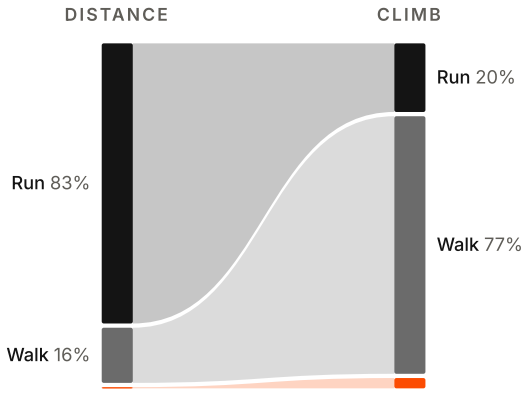
3% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

97% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 3.3 km and my average run 13.9 km. The longest walk was 12.7 km.

158 of my 173 runs were on the treadmill.

I did one trail run. They added only a little to the climbing that year.

The other activities were 3% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2021, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Wednesday was my busiest day and Monday the quietest, but not by much. 29% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

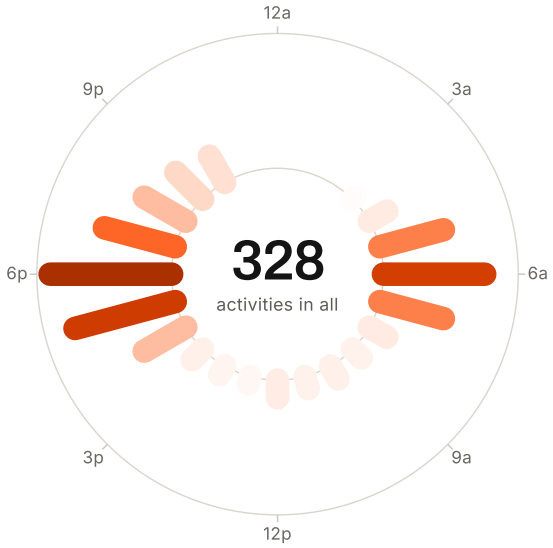
35% before 10am

9% between 10am and 4pm

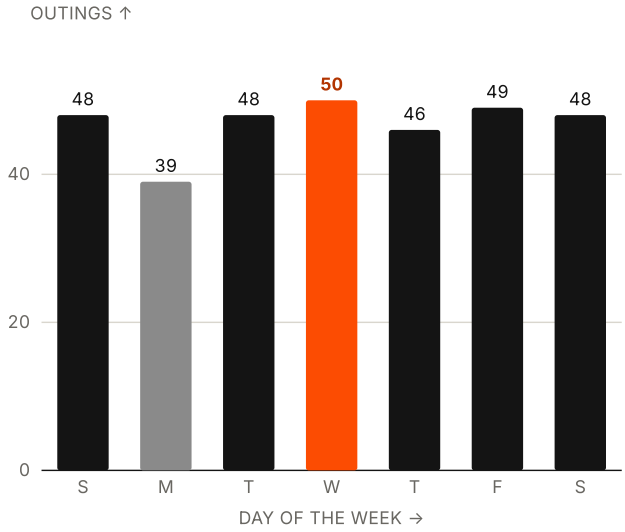
48% between 4 and 9pm

8% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 03:36 on 4 Aug, and the latest at 22:54 on 14 Oct.

The mornings and the evenings held different outings. Runs were 81% of my outings before 10am, and walks were 61% of my outings between 4 and 9pm.

35 outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 7.9 km, against 9.6 km on a weekday.

Out on 49% of days.

My longest streak went from 25 Aug to 11 Dec. My longest layoff ended on 27 Jun.

THE DAYS OF 2021

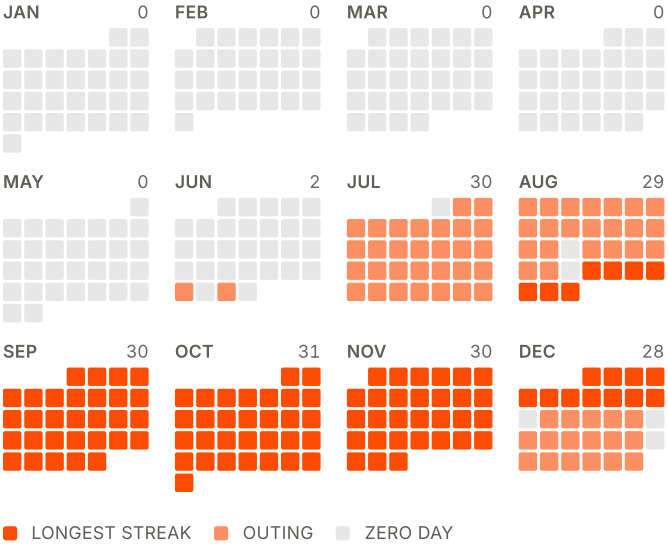
180 days
with an outing, of 365

109 days
the longest run in a row

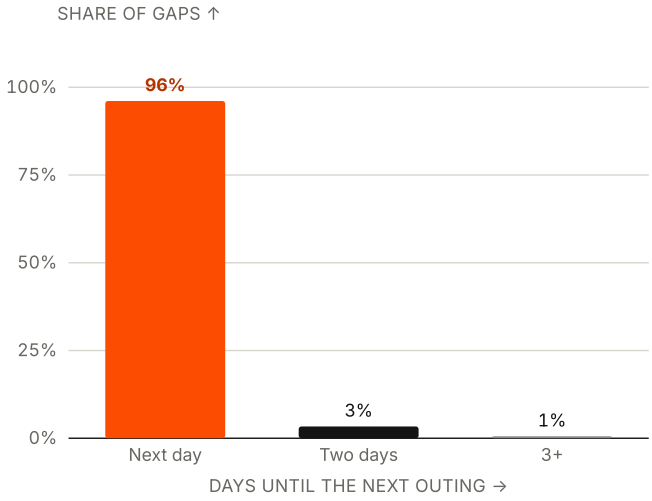
353 days
the longest layoff

96%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2021



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2021

Every day of 2021 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 185 zero days in 2021. More of them fell on a Saturday than on any other day of the week.

The longest streak was 109 days, from 25 Aug to 11 Dec. In the calendar it is the deep orange stretch.

21 full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 103 days I doubled up.

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 2 km or 3 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in December.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

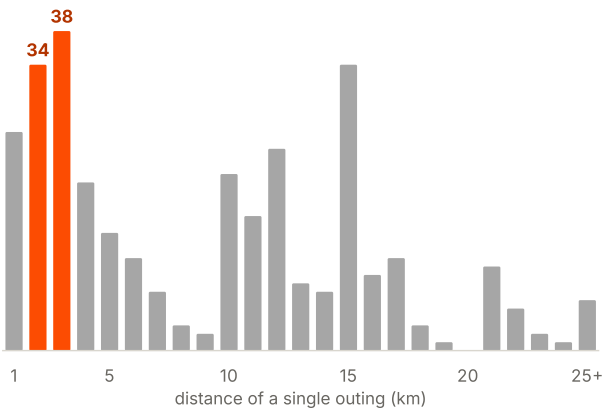
9.9 km
the middle outing

9.2 km
the average outing

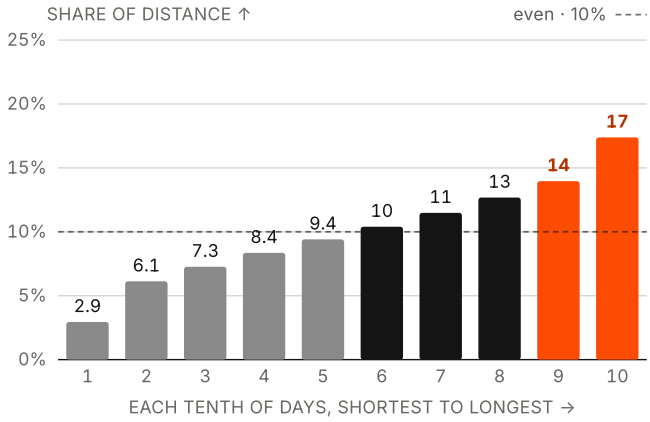
30.1 km
the longest

18%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

48% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and 23 were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 81% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, 85 outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 30.1 km, a run in December.

One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a zero day, I usually rested again. My weeks swung a lot, from almost nothing to very big. My biggest week was 141 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

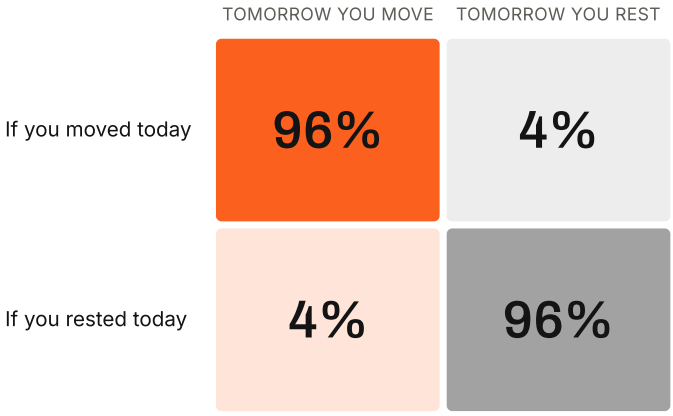
96%
went out again the day after a day out

4%
went out the day after a zero day

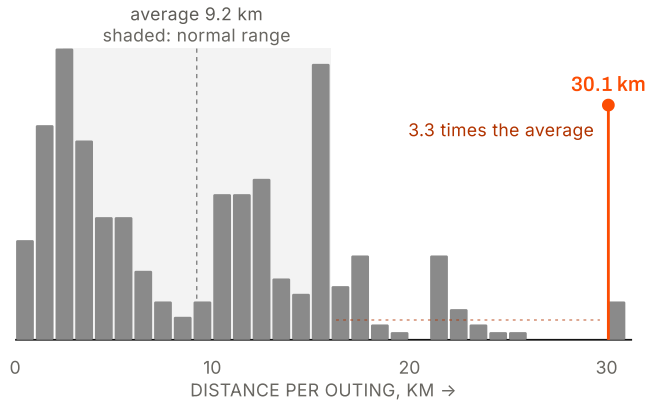
0.23
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.3×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I went out the next day and the right box the chance I rested.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW THE OUTLIER IN ITS CROWD

The record is drawn on top of every ordinary effort it came from, with a band for the usual spread. Distance from the band, counted in standard deviations, says how unusual the record is.

In your own work. To show how extreme a value is, draw the distribution it belongs to.

THE STORY

26 weeks of the year had less than 10 km on foot, and some had none at all.

The biggest week began on 8 Aug, and 26 weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 3.3 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2021.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

30.1 km

in a single outing

DEC 2021

LONGEST ON FOOT

3 h 5 min

of moving time in one outing

DEC 2021

MOST CLIMBED

600 m

of climb in one outing

SEP 2021

HARDEST EFFORT

377

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

OCT 2021

PRS

36

best times on Strava segments

2021

MOST CHEERED

74

kudos on one run

NOV 2021

EVERESTS

0.7 ×

the height of Everest, from 6,560 m climbed

2021

DAR TO DODOMA

6.4 ×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

2,885 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2021 was 9.9 km, so the furthest, 30.1 km in Dec, was 3.0 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

I set 36 PRs on Strava segments, 36 more than in 2020.

All in Tanzania.

All of them were in Tanzania. The climbing was mostly in Dodoma.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

160
outings with a GPS start point

1
country

7
regions of Tanzania

65%
of outings in Dodoma

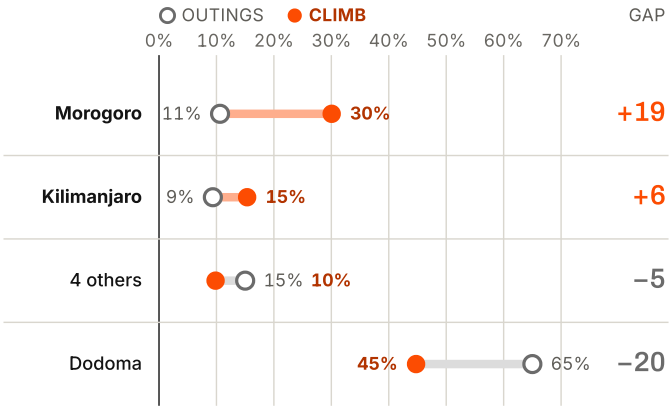
HOME AGAINST AWAY



Tanzania · 160 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 0 OUTINGS

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

168 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in seven regions of Tanzania this year.

Five regions were new to my log this year: Kilimanjaro, Dodoma, Morogoro, Mwanza and Pwani.

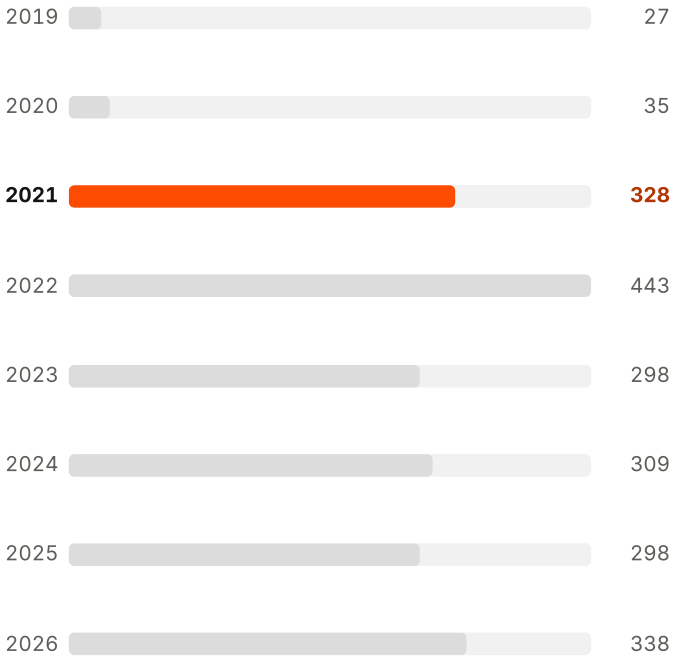
Third of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes second, and for climbing sixth.

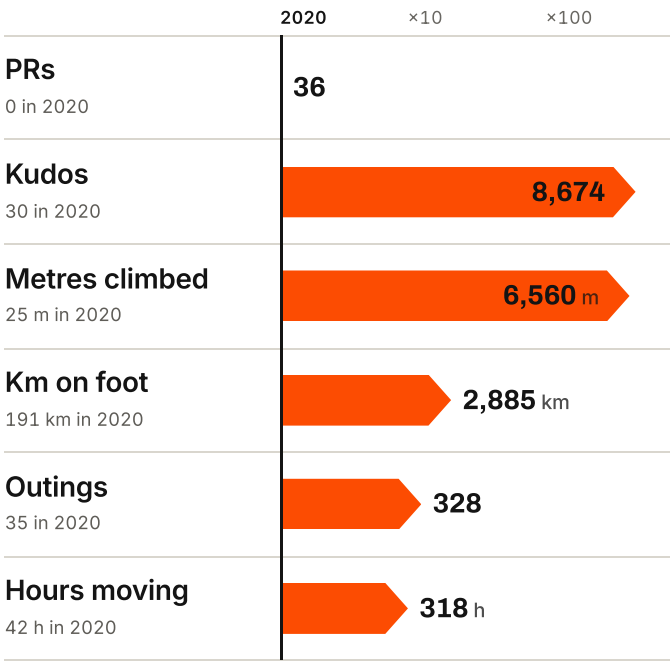
2021 AGAINST 2020

+837%	+1,410%	+25,726%	0%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



EVERY MEASURE UP ON 2020



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2021 in orange.

HOW TO READ · EVERY MEASURE UP ON 2020

Every bar starts at the 2020 total and points to 2021, with the 2021 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes fifth, by PRs sixth and by kudos sixth.

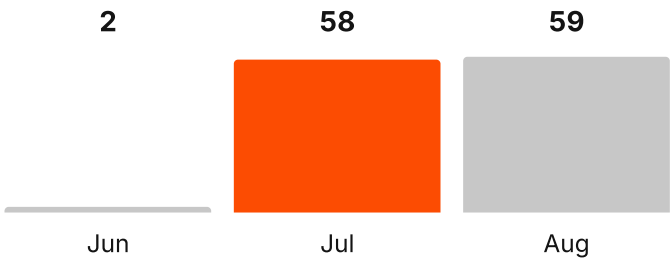
Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 99% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes third of the eight years, at 9.0 km each.

COMING BACK

The year it caught.

After the check-up I came back in June with a 10 km run, and this time I stayed. Before the year ended I was on a 109-day streak.



2022

The busiest year.

When the habit is strong, the big days come. This was my busiest year, and I ran a full marathon indoors, on a loop, the longest outing in my log. It was also the first year I walked more often than I ran, 193 walks to 180 runs.

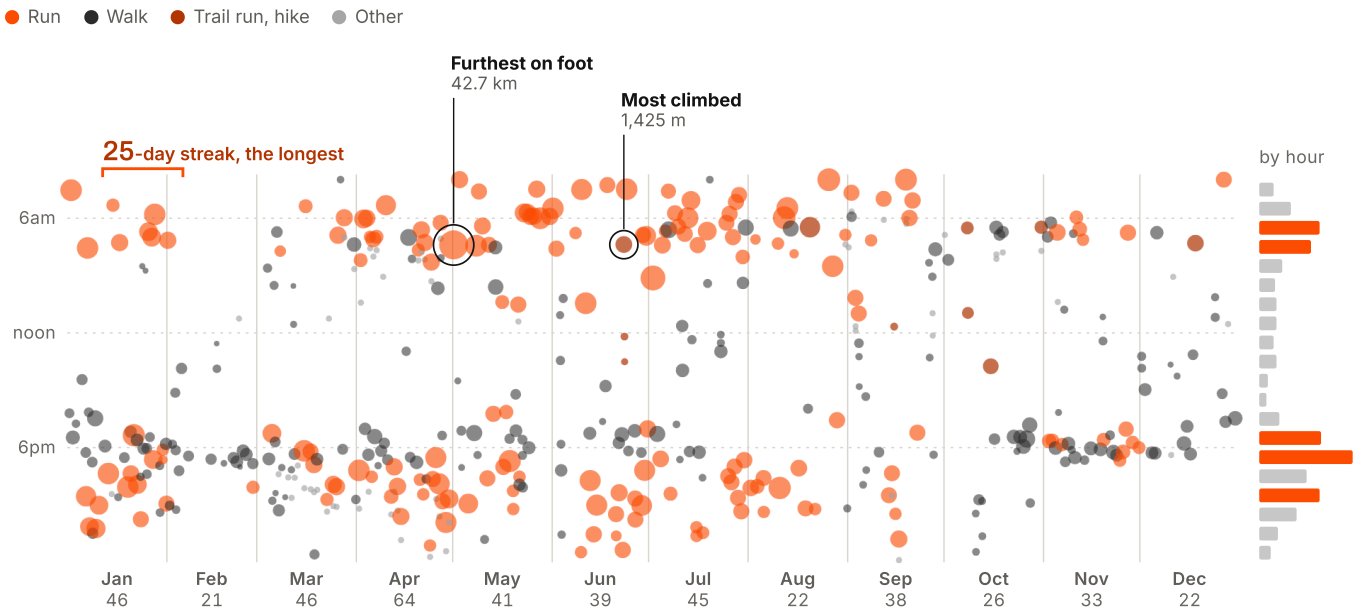
2022 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2021

443
outings, up 35%

2,907 km
on foot, up 1%

12,623 m
climbed, up 92%

414 h
moving, up 30%



THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2022, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 414 hours I spent moving in 2022 come to about 17 full days and nights. 2022 holds 22% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 16,837 kudos over the year, about 38 for each outing, and I set 40 PRs on Strava segments.

10 MONTH BY MONTH

April was the busiest.

The most distance came in January, with 392 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2022 BY THE MONTH

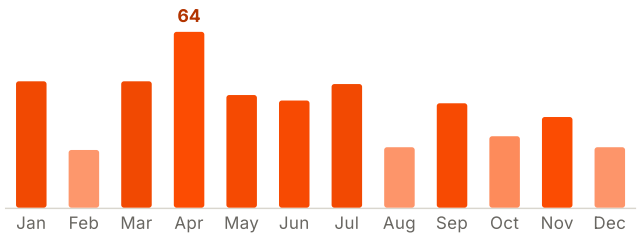
64
outings in April

21
in February, the quietest

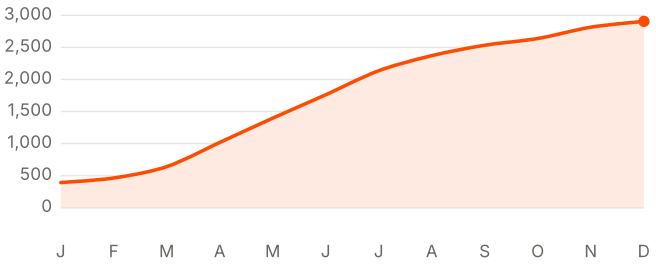
37
outings in an average month

242 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 1,762 km on foot, and in the last six 1,144 km. The line flattens as the year goes on.

Ten of the twelve months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was June, with 2,395 m on foot.

Month against month, six of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2021.

Walks led 2022.

Walks led the year, 193 of my 443 outings, against 180 runs and 10 trail runs or hikes. Running still gave me most of my distance, and walking gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 56 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

44% walks

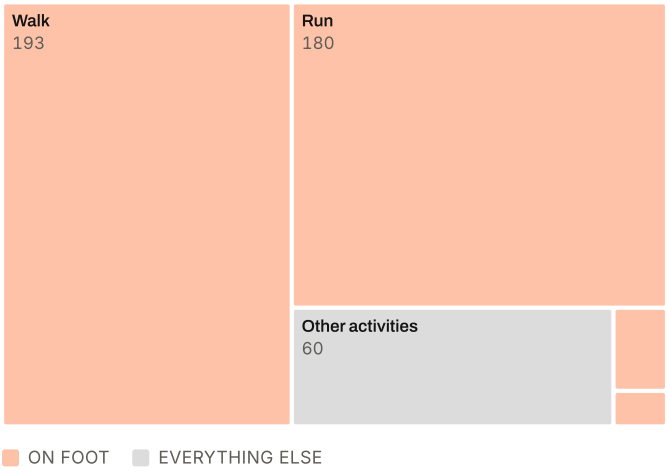
41% runs

2% trail runs and hikes

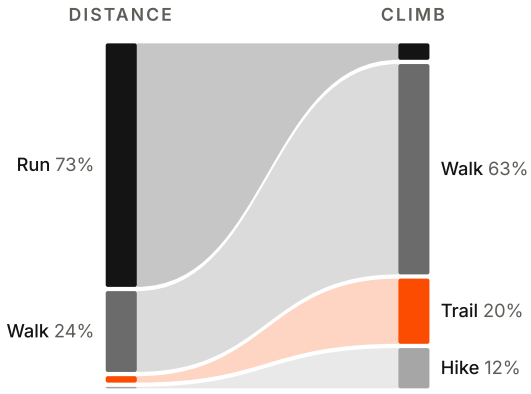
14% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

86% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 3.7 km and my average run 11.8 km. The longest walk was 12.0 km.

165 of my 180 runs were on the treadmill.

I did seven trail runs and three hikes. Together they gave 32% of the year's climbing.

The other activities were 14% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2022, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Sunday, Tuesday and Friday the quietest, but not by much. 30% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

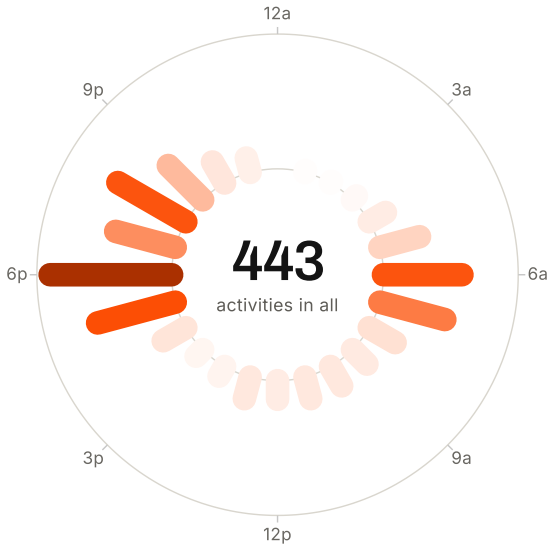
32% before 10am

13% between 10am and 4pm

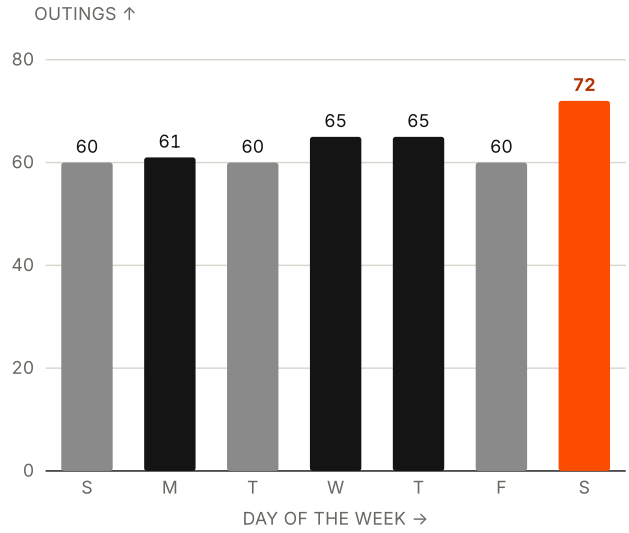
44% between 4 and 9pm

11% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 01:46 on 20 Jul, and the latest at 23:51 on 16 Sep.

The mornings and the evenings held different outings. Runs were 58% of my outings before 10am, and walks were 57% of my outings between 4 and 9pm.

37 outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 7.3 km, against 7.7 km on a weekday.

Out on 73% of days.

My longest streak went from 12 Jan to 5 Feb. My longest break ended on 14 Feb.

THE DAYS OF 2022

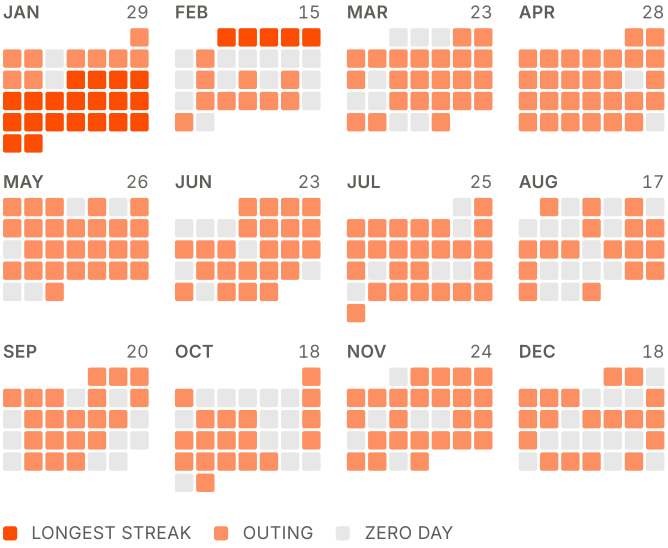
266 days
with an outing, of 365

25 days
the longest run in a row

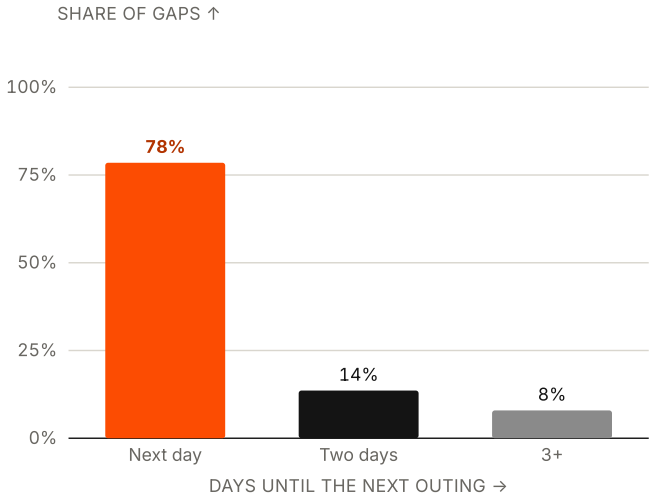
6 days
the longest break

78%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2022



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2022

Every day of 2022 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 99 zero days in 2022. More of them fell on a Sunday than on any other day of the week.

The longest streak was 25 days, from 12 Jan to 5 Feb. In the calendar it is the deep orange stretch.

Ten full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 133 days I doubled up.

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 1 km or 10 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in May.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

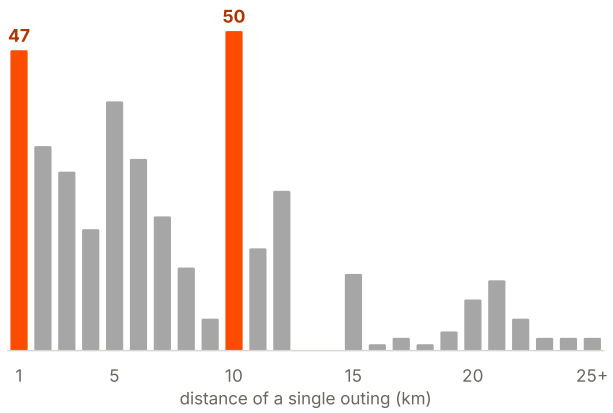
6.1 km
the middle outing

7.8 km
the average outing

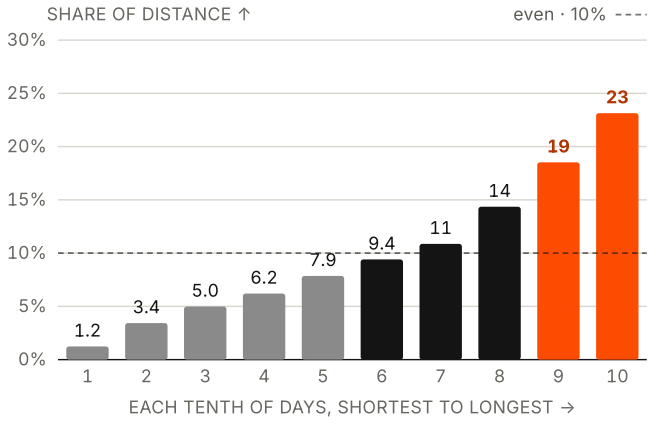
42.7 km
the longest

24%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

36% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and 21 were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 67% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, 97 outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 42.7 km, a run in May.

One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a zero day, it could go either way. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 139 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

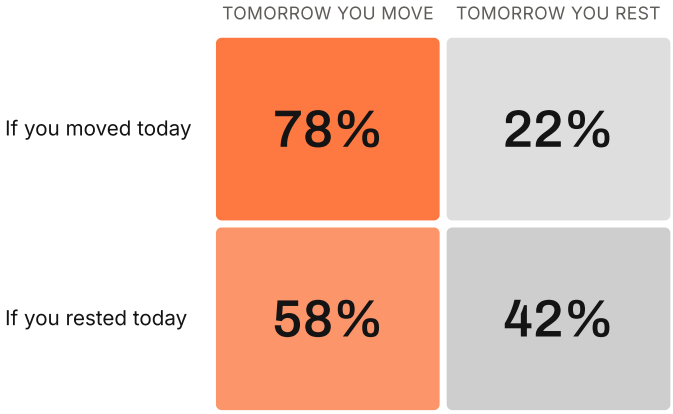
78%
went out again the day after a day out

58%
went out the day after a zero day

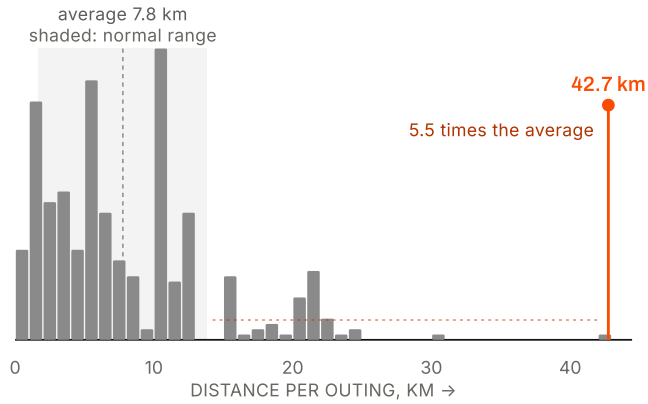
0.37
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

5.5×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I went out the next day and the right box the chance I rested.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

THE STORY

Three weeks of the year had less than 10 km on foot, and the quietest had 3 km.

The biggest week began on 26 Jun, and 27 weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 5.5 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2022.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

42.7 km

in a single outing

MAY 2022

LONGEST ON FOOT

3 h 25 min

of moving time in one outing

JUN 2022

MOST CLIMBED

1,425 m

of climb in one outing

JUN 2022

HARDEST EFFORT

705

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

MAY 2022

PRS

40

best times on Strava segments

2022

MOST CHEERED

92

kudos on one trail run

AUG 2022

EVERESTS

1.4×

the height of Everest, from 12,623 m climbed

2022

DAR TO DODOMA

6.5×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

2,907 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2022 was 6.1 km, so the furthest, 42.7 km in May, was 7.0 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

I set 40 PRs on Strava segments, 4 more than in 2021.

17 WHERE IT HAPPENED

A first trip to Kenya.

In December I went with a group to Naivasha and the Masai Mara. The climbing was mostly in Morogoro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

216

outings with a GPS start point

2

countries

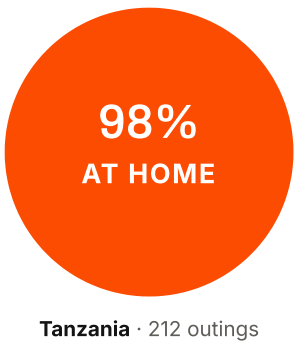
9

regions of Tanzania

39%

of outings in Dodoma

HOME AGAINST AWAY

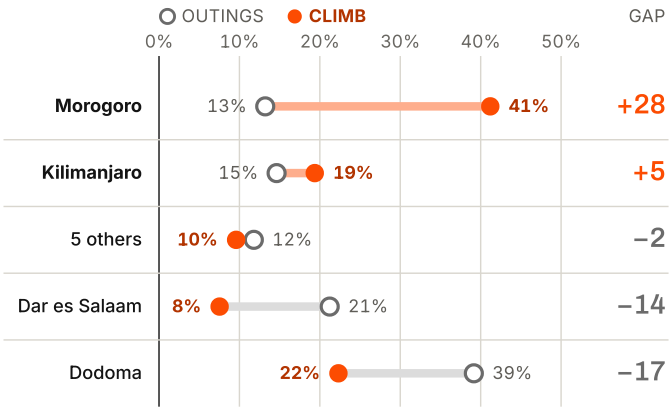


Tanzania · 212 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 4 OUTINGS

Kenya — 4 — 2022

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

227 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in nine regions of Tanzania this year.

Four regions were new to my log this year: Zanzibar Urban/West, Mara, Iringa and Mbeya.

Four outings began outside Tanzania.

18 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

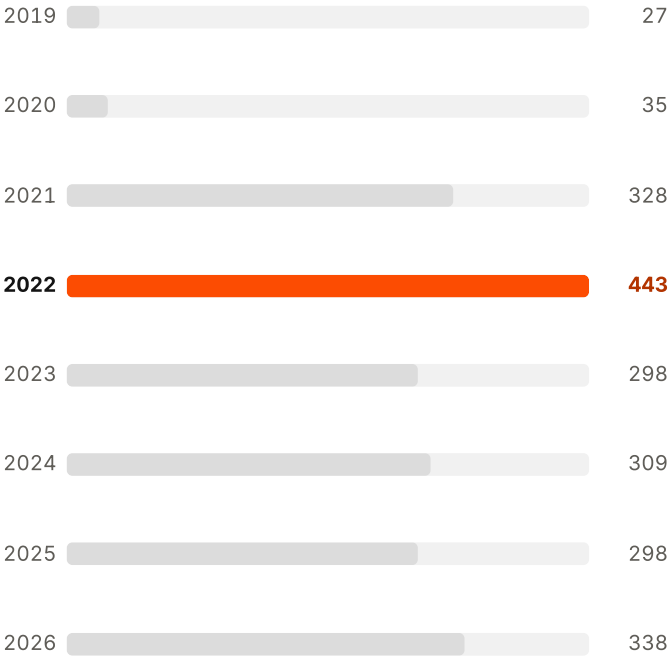
First of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes first, and for climbing fourth.

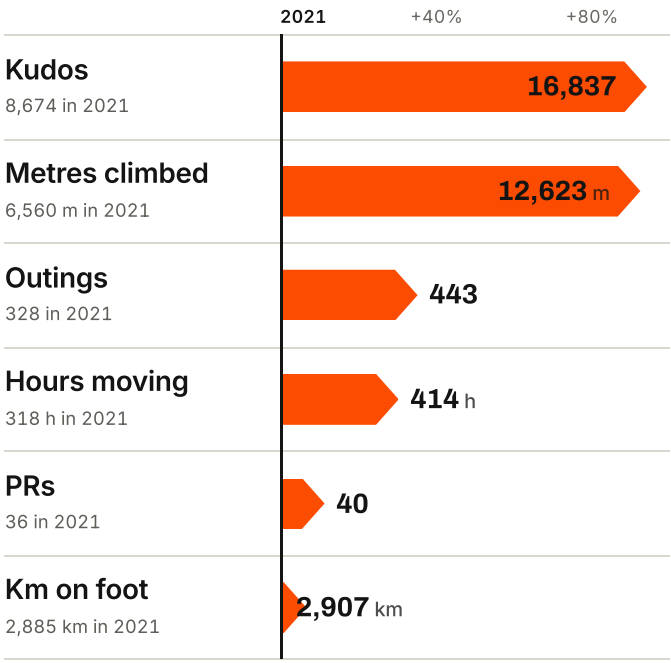
2022 AGAINST 2021

+35%	+1%	+92%	+11%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



EVERY MEASURE UP ON 2021



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2022 in orange.

HOW TO READ · EVERY MEASURE UP ON 2021

Every bar starts at the 2021 total and points to 2022, with the 2022 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes second, by PRs fifth and by kudos first.

It is my best year for distance on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes fourth of the eight years, at 7.6 km each.

THE BUSIEST

My busiest year.

The habit was strong enough now for a big day, and in May came my first marathon. It was also the first year I walked more often than I ran.



2023

The year of the hills.

Fewer outings can still mean more. I went out a bit less than in 2022, but I went to the hills more. In March alone I climbed more than 5,000 m, most of it in Kilimanjaro, and over the year I ran 303 km on trails.

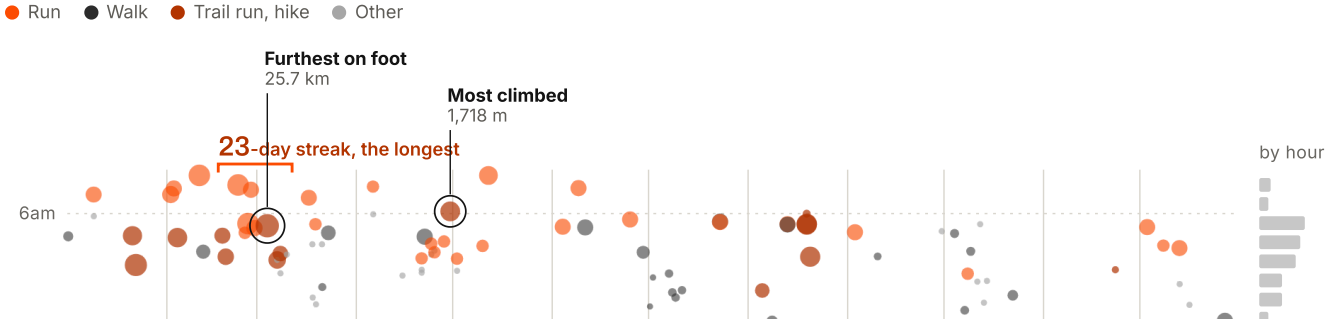
2023 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2022

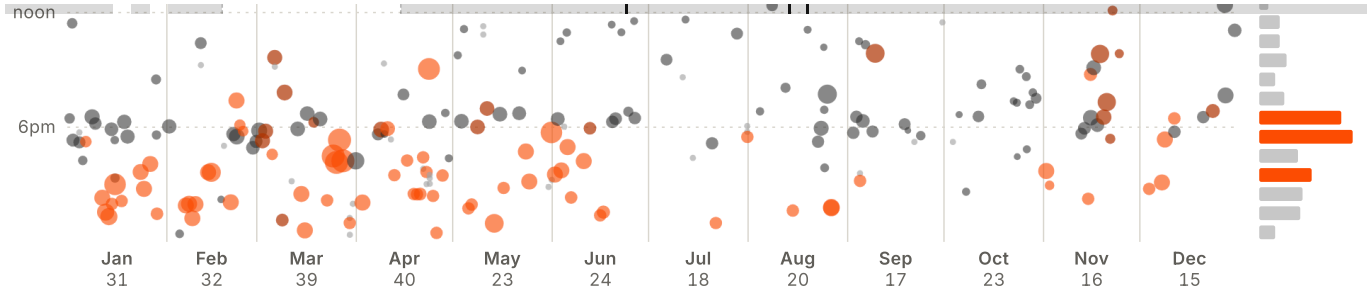
298
outings, down 33%

1,769 km
on foot, down 39%

21,490 m
climbed, up 70%

361 h
moving, down 13%





THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2023, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 361 hours I spent moving in 2023 come to about 15 full days and nights. 2023 holds 13% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 12,455 kudos over the year, about 42 for each outing, and I set 96 PRs on Strava segments.

10 MONTH BY MONTH

April was the busiest.

The most distance came in March, with 297 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month.

2023 BY THE MONTH

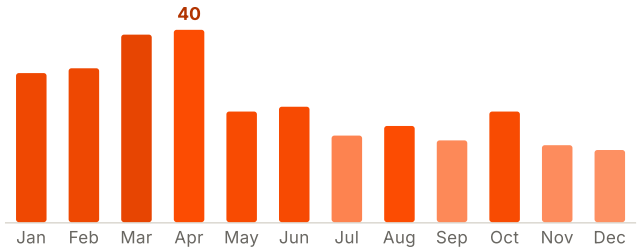
40
outings in April

15
in December, the quietest

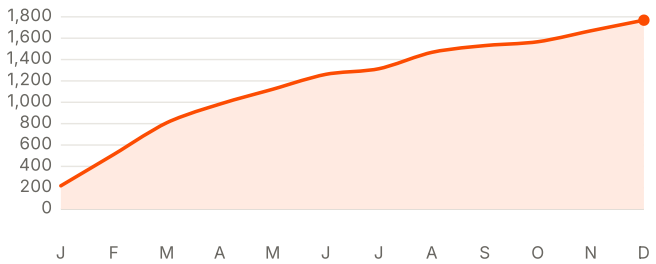
25
outings in an average month

147 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 1,262 km on foot, and in the last six 507 km. The line flattens as the year goes on.

Eight of the twelve months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was March, with 5,279 m on foot.

Month against month, one of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2022.

11 HOW IT MOVED

Walks led 2023.

Walks led the year, 115 of my 298 outings, against 100 runs and 33 trail runs or hikes. Running still gave me most of my distance, and trail running gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 303 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

39% walks

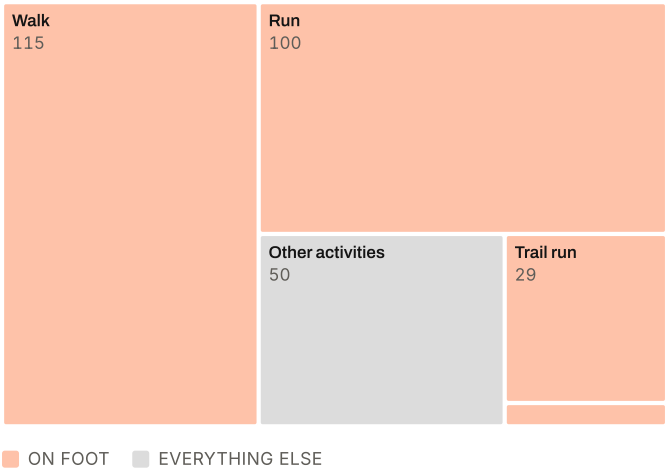
34% runs

11% trail runs and hikes

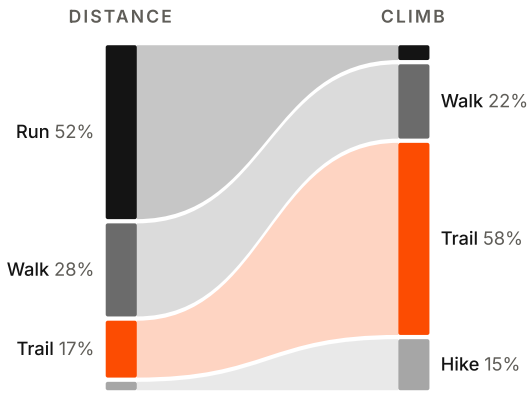
17% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

83% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 4.3 km and my average run 9.3 km. The longest walk was 15.7 km.

85 of my 100 runs were on the treadmill.

I did 29 trail runs and four hikes. Together they gave 73% of the year's climbing.

The other activities were 17% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

12 WHEN IT HAPPENED

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2023, and 6pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest. 35% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

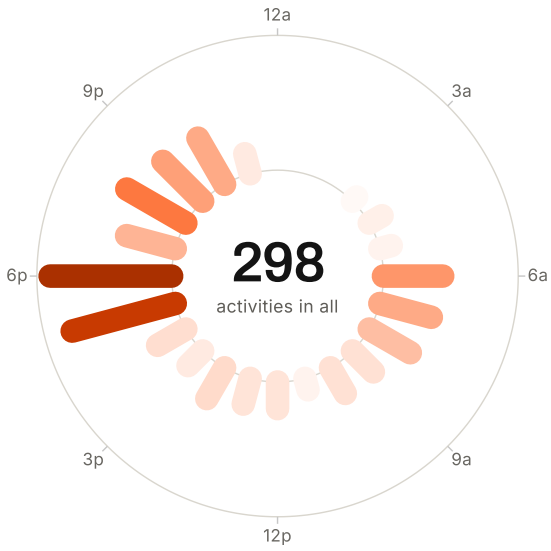
25% before 10am

17% between 10am and 4pm

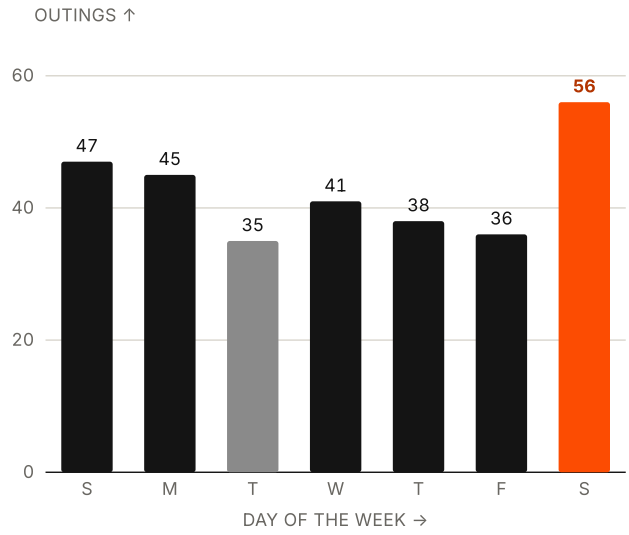
43% between 4 and 9pm

15% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 03:01 on 11 Feb, and the latest at 23:37 on 29 Mar.

The mornings and the evenings held different outings. Runs were 39% of my outings before 10am, and walks were 52% of my outings between 4 and 9pm.

Eleven outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 8.2 km, against 6.5 km on a weekday. The weekend is when the longer outings fit.

13 EVERY DAY OF THE YEAR

Out on 59% of days.

My longest streak went from 17 Feb to 11 Mar. My longest layoff ended on 12 Nov.

THE DAYS OF 2023

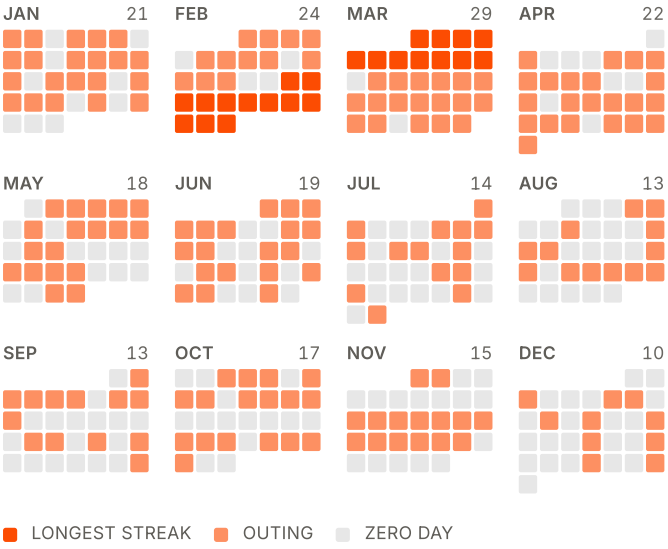
215 days
with an outing, of 365

23 days
the longest run in a row

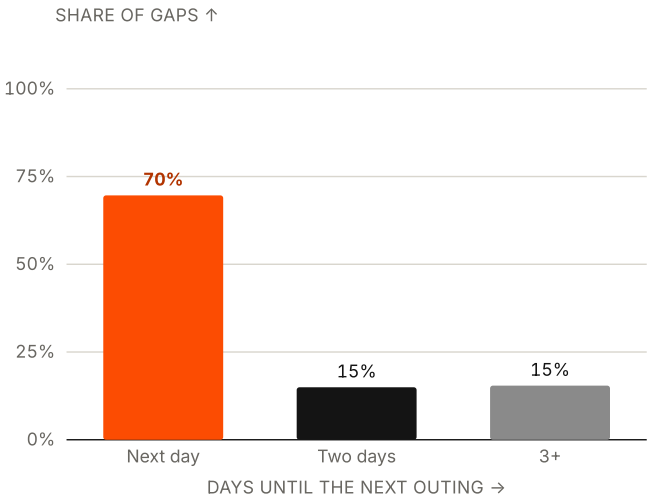
9 days
the longest layoff

70%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2023



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2023

Every day of 2023 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 150 zero days in 2023. More of them fell on a Tuesday than on any other day of the week.

The longest streak was 23 days, from 17 Feb to 11 Mar. In the calendar it is the deep orange stretch.

Five full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 60 days I doubled up.

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in March.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

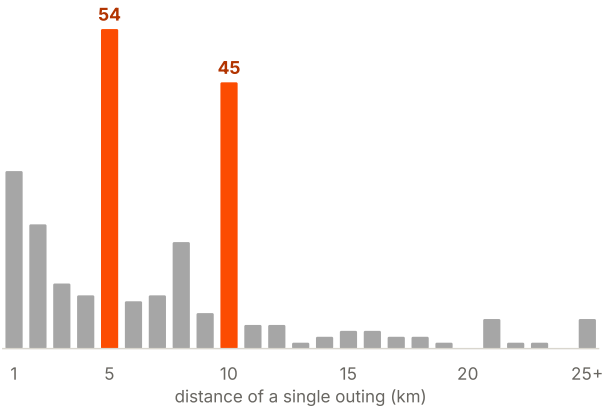
5.3 km
the middle outing

7.2 km
the average outing

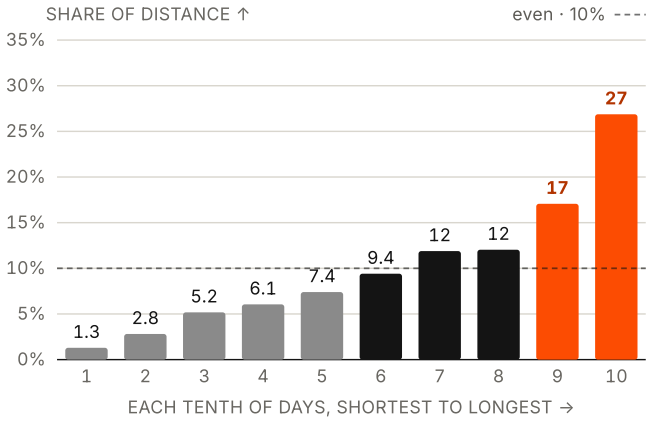
25.7 km
the longest

27%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

31% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and twelve were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 58% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, 61 outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 25.7 km, a trail run in March.

One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a zero day, I usually rested again. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 107 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

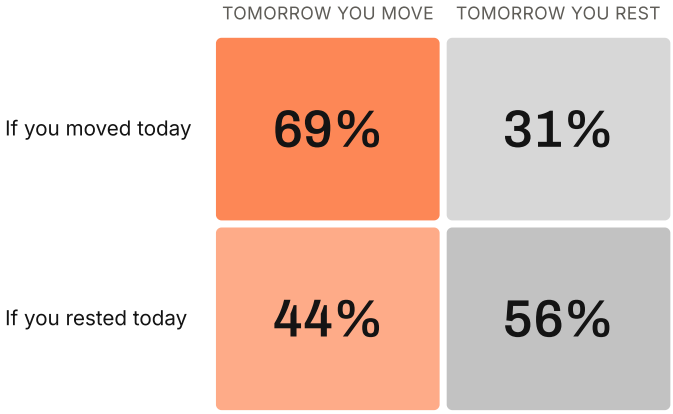
69%
went out again the day after a day out

44%
went out the day after a zero day

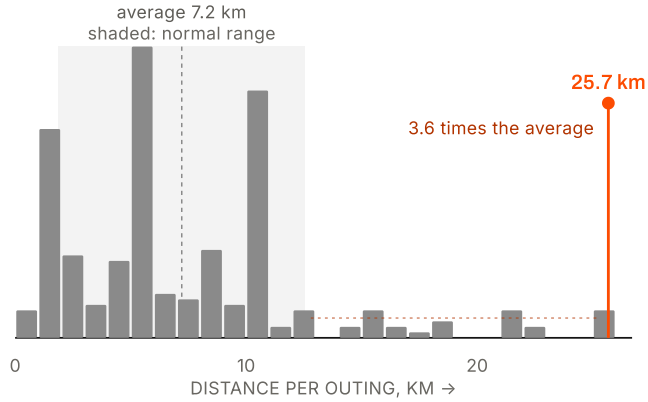
0.39
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.6×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I went out the next day and the right box the chance I rested.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

THE STORY

Twelve weeks of the year had less than 10 km on foot, and some had none at all.

The biggest week began on 26 Feb, and 13 weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 3.6 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2023.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

25.7 km

in a single outing

MAR 2023

LONGEST ON FOOT

8 h 38 min

of moving time in one outing

APR 2023

MOST CLIMBED

1,718 m

of climb in one outing

APR 2023

HARDEST EFFORT

644

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

AUG 2023

PRS

96

best times on Strava segments

2023

MOST CHEERED

125

kudos on one run

FEB 2023

EVERESTS

2.4×

the height of Everest, from 21,490 m climbed

2023

DAR TO DODOMA

3.9×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

1,769 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2023 was 5.3 km, so the furthest, 25.7 km in Mar, was 4.8 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

I set 96 PRs on Strava segments, 56 more than in 2022.

17 WHERE IT HAPPENED

Twelve regions, no border.

All of them were in Tanzania. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

175

outings with a GPS start point

1

country

12

regions of Tanzania

33%

of outings in Dodoma

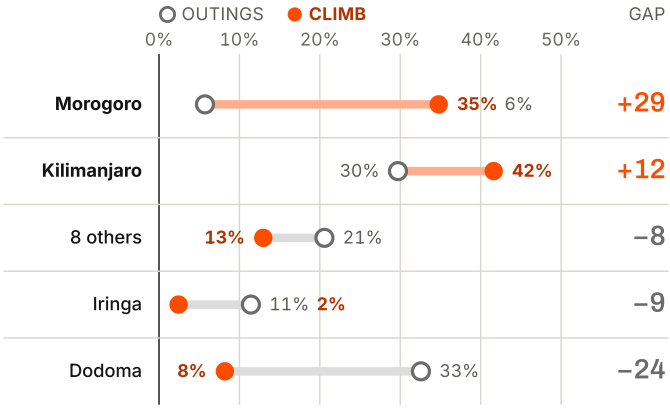
HOME AGAINST AWAY



Tanzania · 175 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 0 OUTINGS

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

123 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in twelve regions of Tanzania this year.

Two regions were new to my log this year: Tanga and Zanzibar Central/South.

18 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

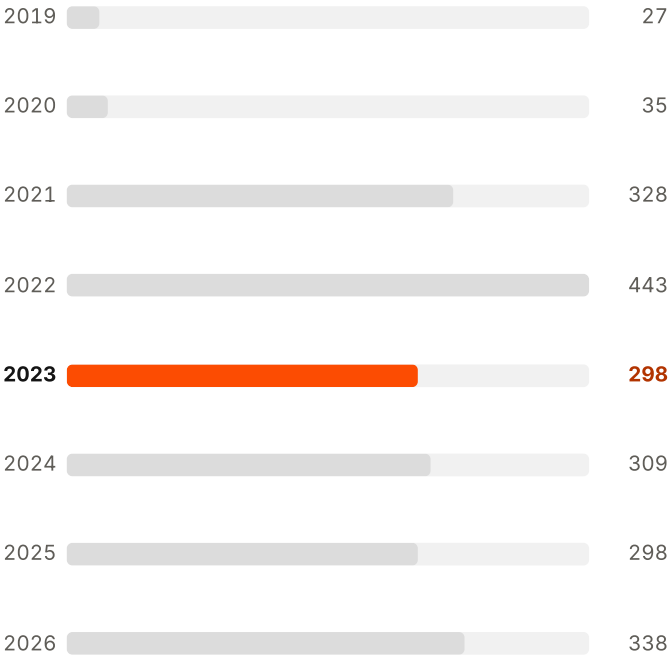
Fifth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes fourth, and for climbing first.

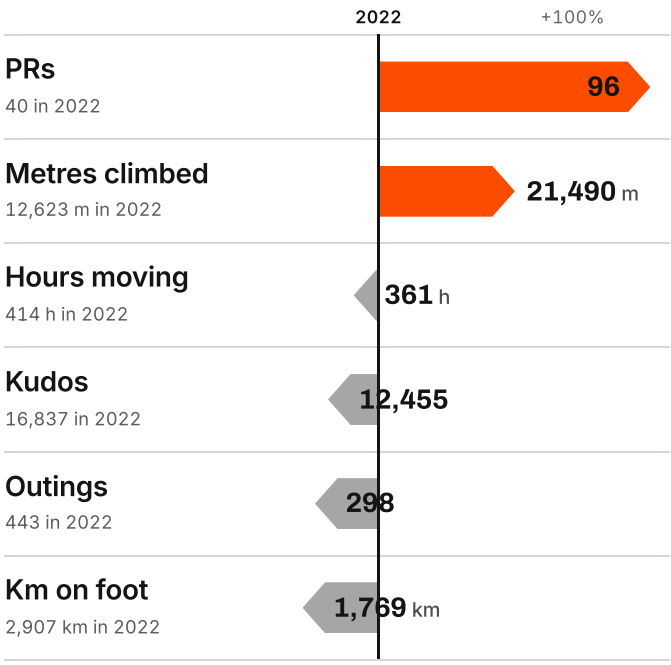
2023 AGAINST 2022

−33%	−39%	+70%	+140%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



ALL DOWN ON 2022 BUT METRES CLIMBED AND PRS



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2023 in orange.

HOW TO READ · ALL DOWN ON 2022 BUT METRES CLIMBED AND PRS

Every bar starts at the 2022 total and points to 2023, with the 2023 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes fourth, by PRs second and by kudos second.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 61% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes fifth of the eight years, at 7.1 km each.

THE SUMMIT

To the top of Kilimanjaro.

In March I went up Kilimanjaro with four friends and reached Uhuru Peak. Later that month I took a challenge from the Activate Uganda team, 25 km a day on the treadmill, four evenings in a row. In April came the longest day in my log, on Hanang.

21,490
METRES CLIMBED

303
KM ON TRAILS

My biggest month for climbing was **Mar**, with 5,279 m.

2024

The travel year.

Even in a low year, the days can hold. It was my travel year, with outings in five countries, and my lowest distance since the habit started. Still, I went out on 234 days.

2024 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2023

309
outings, up 4%

1,214 km
on foot, down 31%

8,117 m
climbed, down 62%

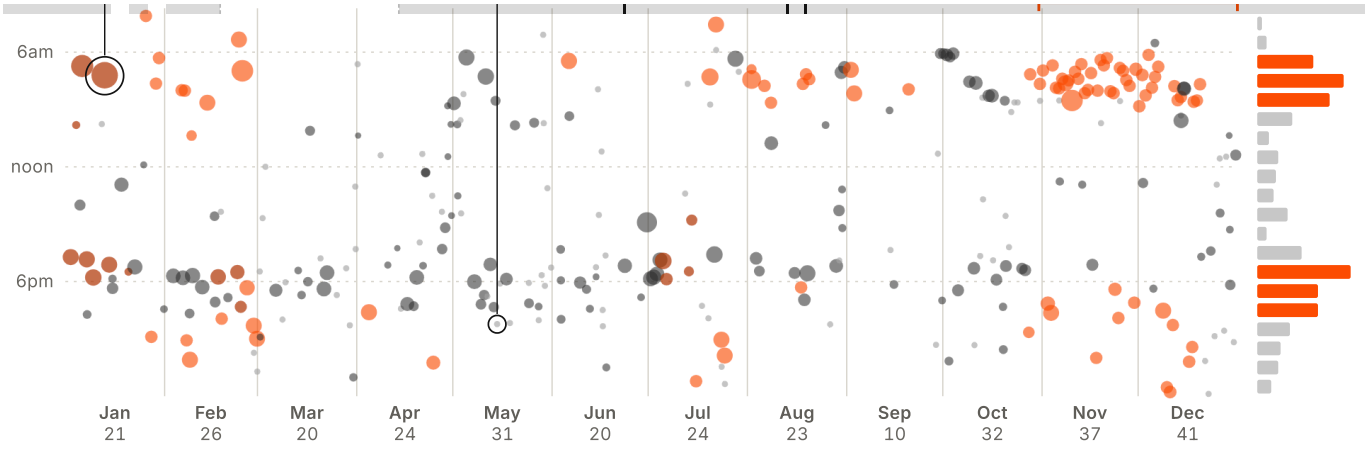
307 h
moving, down 15%

● Run ● Walk ● Trail run, hike ● Other

Furthest on foot
34.8 km

Longest out
13 h 33 min

67-day streak, the longest by hour



THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2024, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 307 hours I spent moving in 2024 come to about 13 full days and nights. 2024 holds 9% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 11,566 kudos over the year, about 37 for each outing, and I set 46 PRs on Strava segments.

10 MONTH BY MONTH

December was the busiest.

The most distance came in November, with 194 km on foot. The year started slowly and grew stronger as it went. There was no empty month.

2024 BY THE MONTH

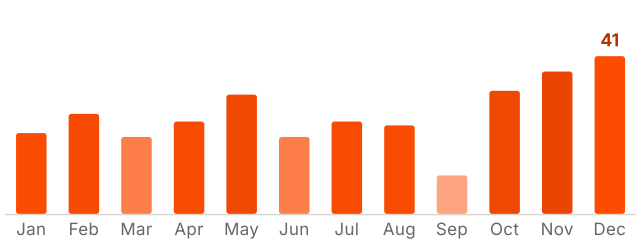
41
outings in December

10
in September, the quietest

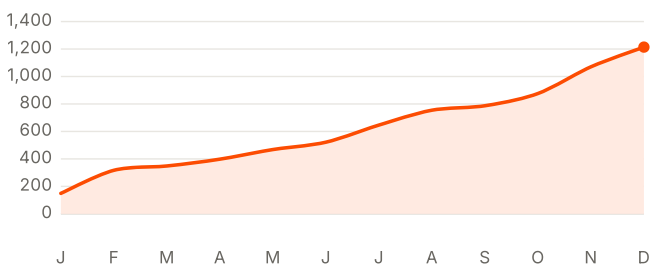
26
outings in an average month

101 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 522 km on foot, and in the last six 692 km. The line gets steeper as the year goes on.

Six of the twelve months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was January, with 2,574 m on foot.

Month against month, six of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2023.

11 HOW IT MOVED

Walks led 2024.

Walks led the year, 125 of my 309 outings, against 88 runs and 15 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance and the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 138 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

40% walks

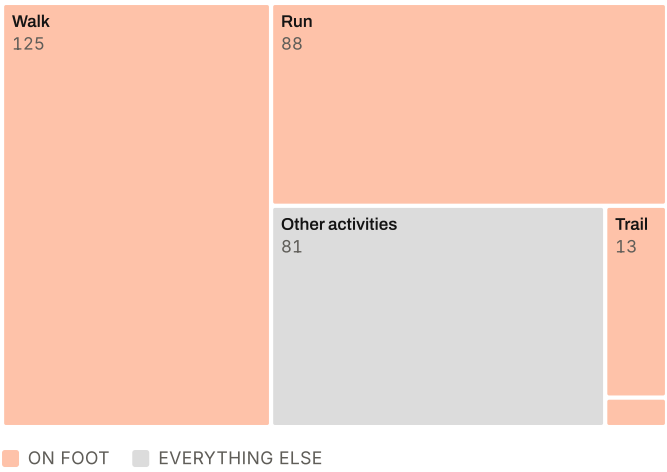
28% runs

5% trail runs and hikes

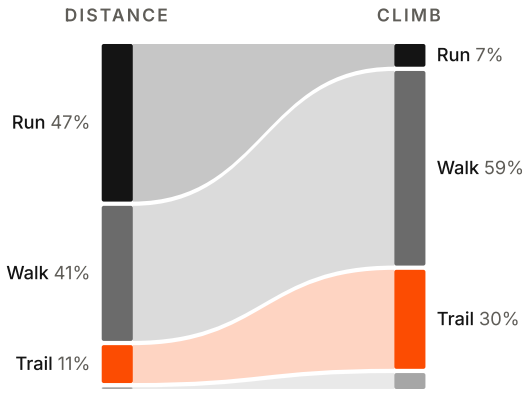
26% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

74% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 3.9 km and my average run 6.5 km. The longest walk was 18.0 km.

84 of my 88 runs were on the treadmill.

I did 13 trail runs and two hikes. Together they gave 35% of the year's climbing.

The other activities were 26% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

12 WHEN IT HAPPENED

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2024, and 5pm was the busiest hour. Saturday was my busiest day and Tuesday the quietest. 33% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

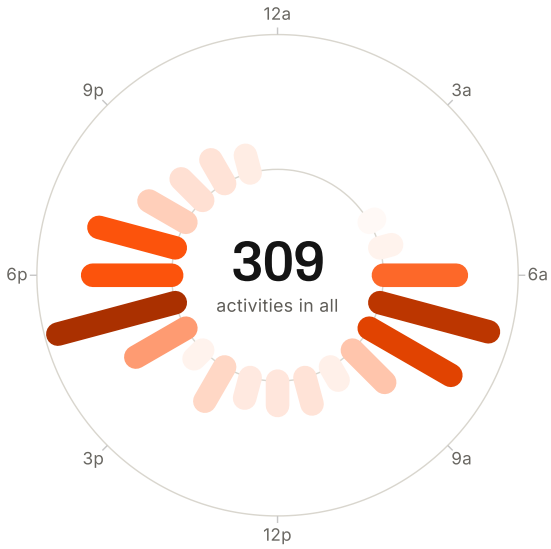
37% before 10am

15% between 10am and 4pm

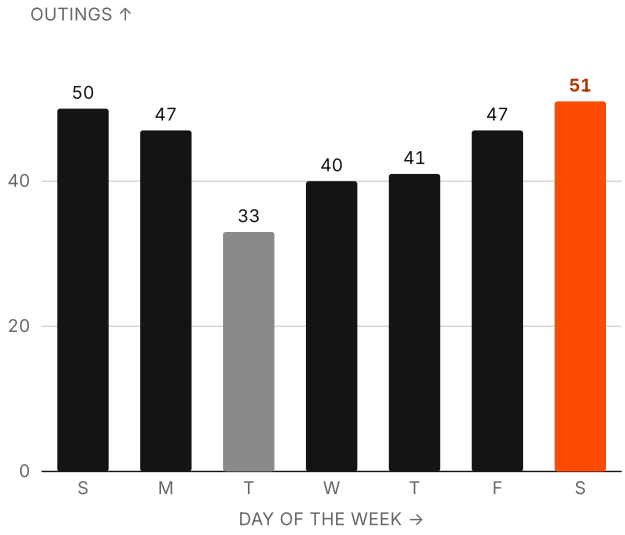
40% between 4 and 9pm

8% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 04:08 on 26 Jan, and the latest at 23:53 on 22 Dec.

The mornings and the evenings held different outings. Runs were 54% of my outings before 10am, and walks were 54% of my outings between 4 and 9pm.

Six outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 6.4 km, against 4.8 km on a weekday. The weekend is when the longer outings fit.

13 EVERY DAY OF THE YEAR

Out on 64% of days.

My longest streak went from 31 Oct to 5 Jan 2025. My longest layoff ended on 14 Sep.

THE DAYS OF 2024

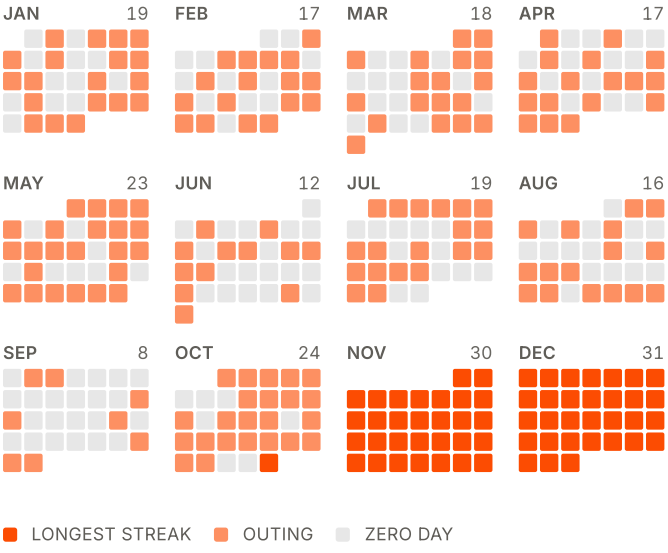
234 days
with an outing, of 366

67 days
the longest run in a row

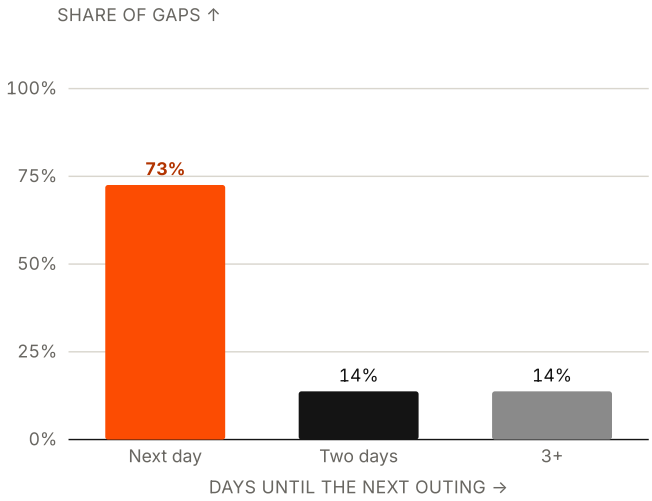
10 days
the longest layoff

73%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2024



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2024

Every day of 2024 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 132 zero days in 2024. More of them fell on a Tuesday than on any other day of the week.

The longest streak was 67 days, from 31 Oct to 5 Jan 2025. 62 of those days fall in 2024, the deep orange stretch in the calendar.

Twelve full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 67 days I doubled up.

14 THE TYPICAL OUTING

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 1 km or 5 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in January.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

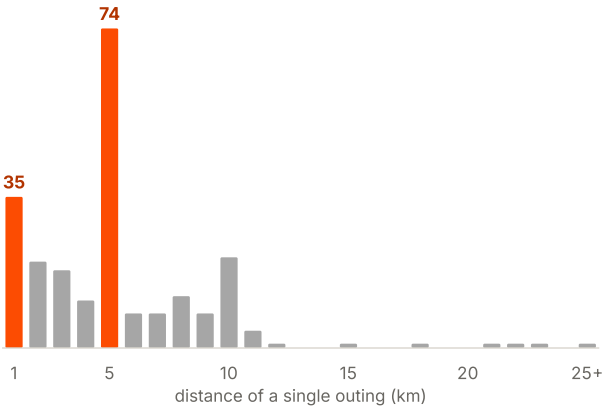
5.0 km
the middle outing

5.4 km
the average outing

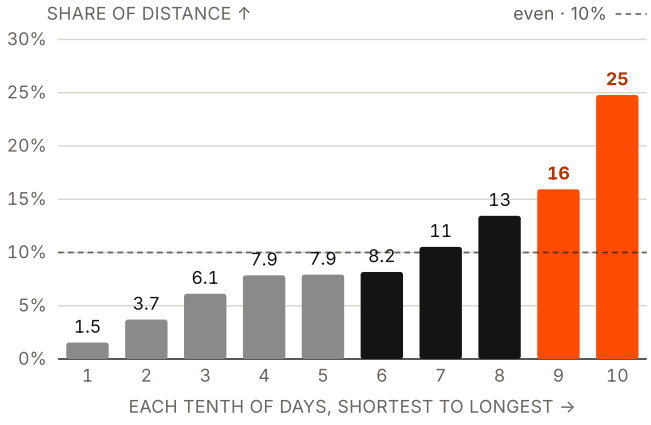
34.8 km
the longest

25%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

14% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and four were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 33% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, 67 outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 34.8 km, a trail run in January.

15 HOW STEADY IT WAS

One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a zero day, I usually rested again. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 68 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

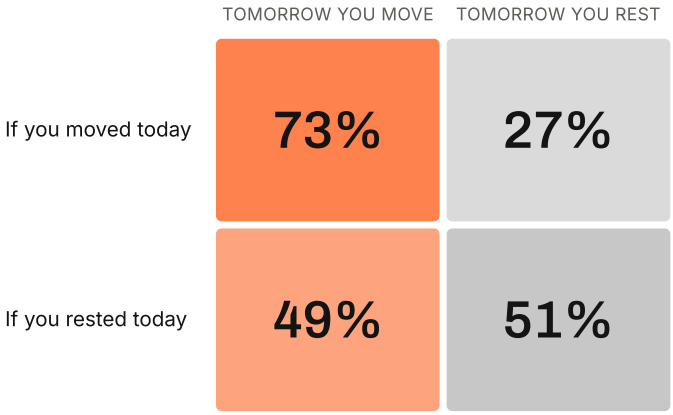
73%
went out again the day after a day out

49%
went out the day after a zero day

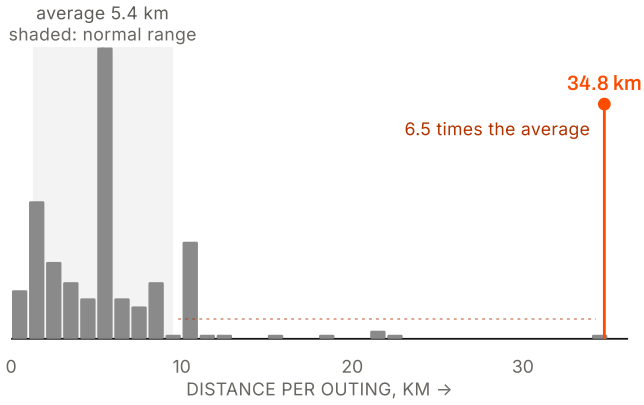
0.35
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

6.5×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I went out the next day and the right box the chance I rested.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

THE STORY

16 weeks of the year had less than 10 km on foot, and some had none at all.

The biggest week began on 30 Jun, and four weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 6.5 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2024.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

34.8 km

in a single outing

JAN 2024

LONGEST ON FOOT

7 h 41 min

of moving time in one outing

JAN 2024

MOST CLIMBED

841 m

of climb in one outing

JAN 2024

HARDEST EFFORT

387

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

JUL 2024

PRS

46

best times on Strava segments

2024

MOST CHEERED

90

kudos on one run

FEB 2024

EVERESTS

0.9 ×

the height of Everest, from 8,117 m climbed

2024

DAR TO DODOMA

2.7 ×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

1,214 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2024 was 5.0 km, so the furthest, 34.8 km in Jan, was 6.9 times a normal day out.

The furthest outing was also the longest in time and the one with the most climbing. One day held all three records of the year.

I set 46 PRs on Strava segments, 50 fewer than in 2023.

Across the border.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in South Africa, Kenya, Rwanda and Malawi, plus one outing I count as others. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

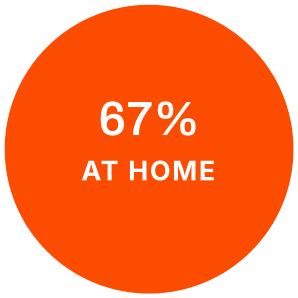
187
outings with a GPS start point

5
countries

7
regions of Tanzania

44%
of outings in Dodoma

HOME AGAINST AWAY

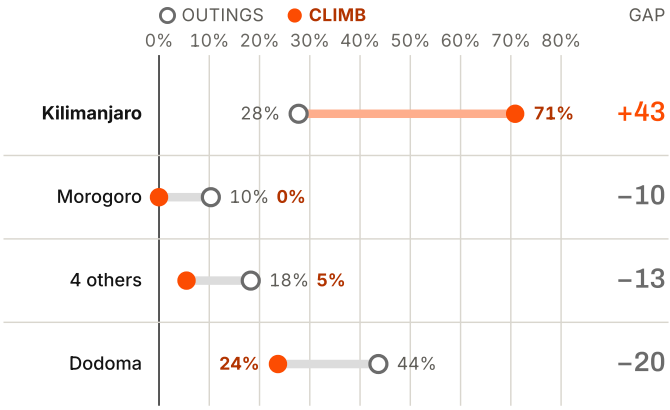


Tanzania · 126 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 61 OUTINGS

Malawi	23	2024
Kenya	22	2024
South Africa	13	2024
Rwanda	2	2024
Others	1	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

122 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in seven regions of Tanzania this year.

No region of Tanzania was new to my log this year.

61 outings began outside Tanzania.

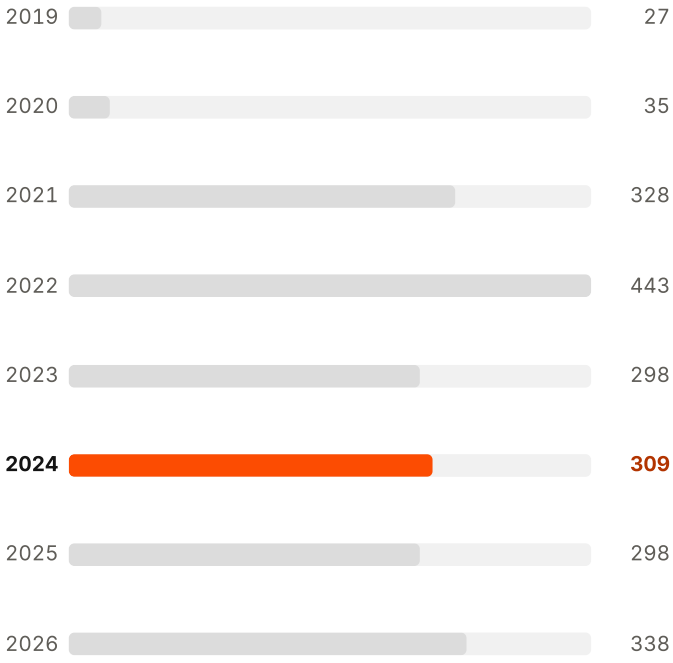
Fourth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes sixth, and for climbing fifth.

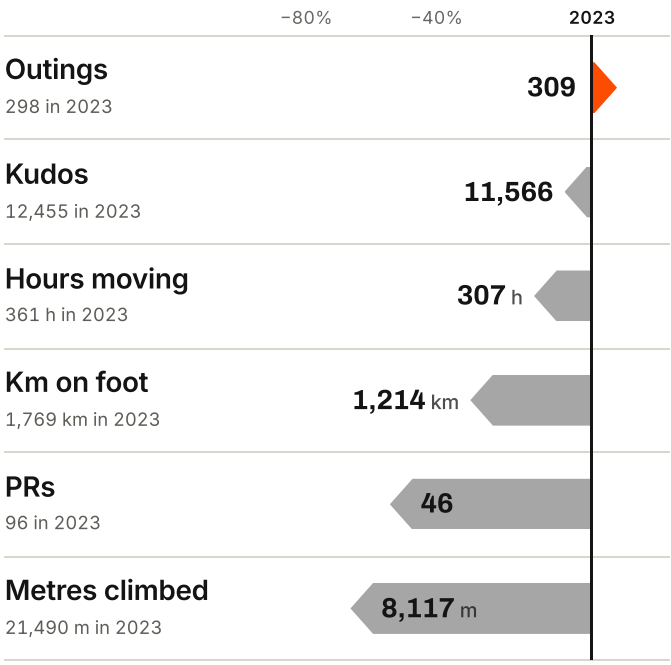
2024 AGAINST 2023

+4%	−31%	−62%	−52%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



ALL DOWN ON 2023 BUT OUTINGS



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2024 in orange.

HOW TO READ · ALL DOWN ON 2023 BUT OUTINGS

Every bar starts at the 2023 total and points to 2024, with the 2024 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes sixth, by PRs fourth and by kudos fourth.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 42% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes eighth of the eight years, at 5.3 km each.

TRAVELLING

The map at its widest.

A remote job and a few consultancies took me across borders, and the shoes always came along. Wherever the work was, I found time to go out.

Tanzania 126	Malawi 23	Kenya 22
South Africa 13	Rwanda 2	Others 1

2025

The year of walking.

Walking became my main thing. It was 47% of my outings, and in February I walked 30 km in one go, my longest walk. For the third year in a row I logged about three hundred activities.

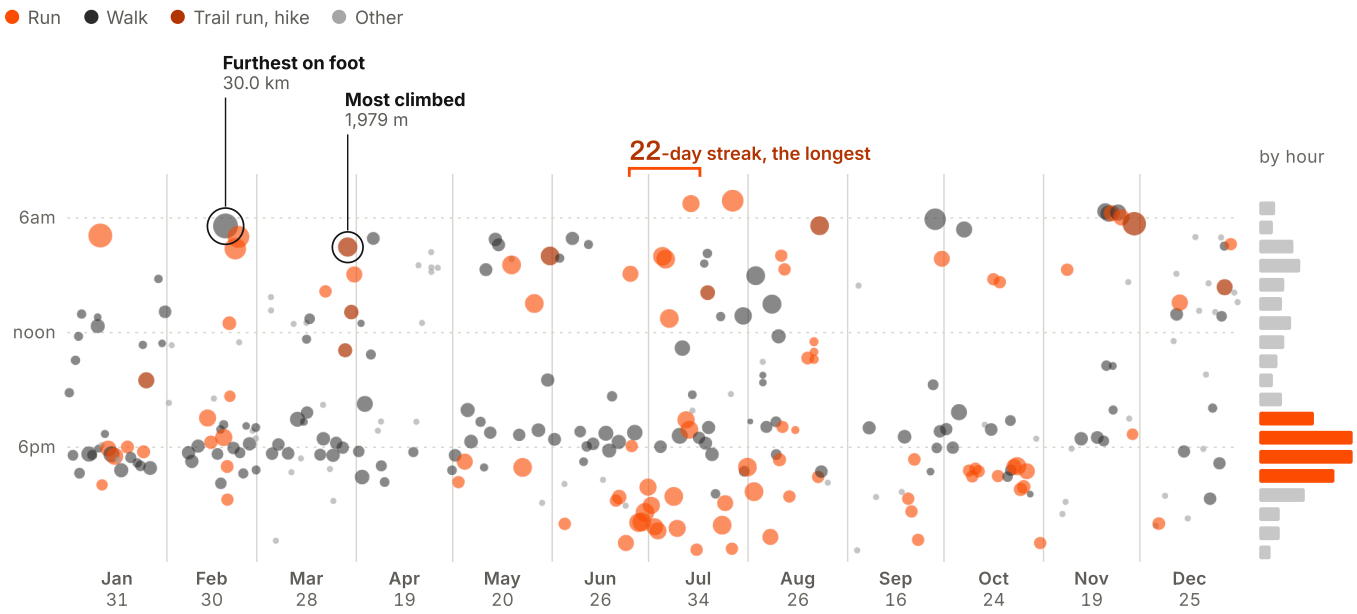
2025 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2024

298
outings, down 4%

1,609 km
on foot, up 33%

16,218 m
climbed, up 100%

379 h
moving, up 23%



THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2025, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 379 hours I spent moving in 2025 come to about 16 full days and nights. 2025 holds 12% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 11,616 kudos over the year, about 39 for each outing, and I set 48 PRs on Strava segments.

10 MONTH BY MONTH

July was the busiest.

July was my biggest month for distance too, with 299 km on foot. The months stayed fairly even from start to end. There was no empty month.

2025 BY THE MONTH

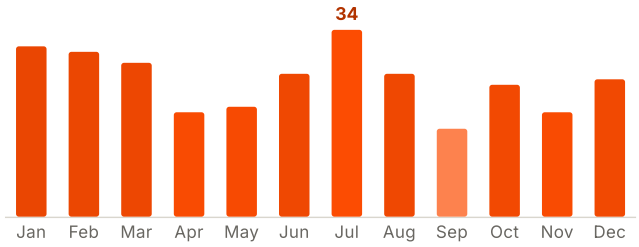
34
outings in July

16
in September, the quietest

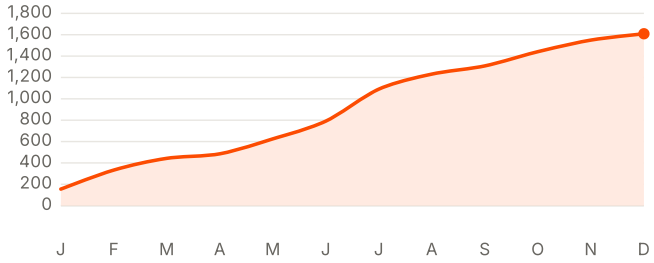
25
outings in an average month

134 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 792 km on foot, and in the last six 817 km. The line climbs at an even slope.

Nine of the twelve months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was March, with 3,193 m on foot.

Month against month, seven of the twelve months had more outings than the same month of 2024.

Walks led 2025.

Walks led the year, 141 of my 298 outings, against 87 runs and 9 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance and the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 69 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

47% walks

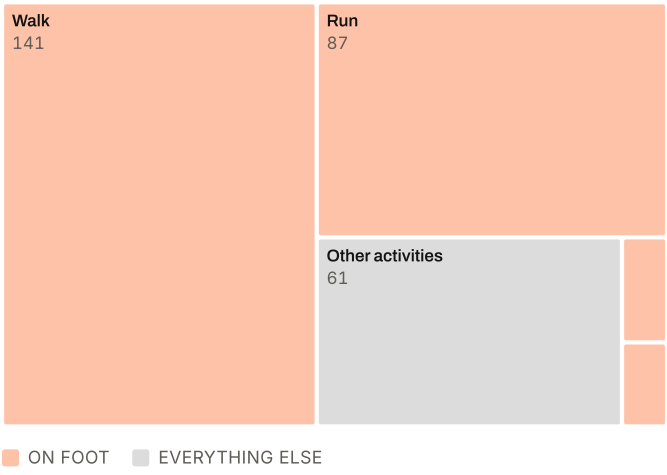
29% runs

3% trail runs and hikes

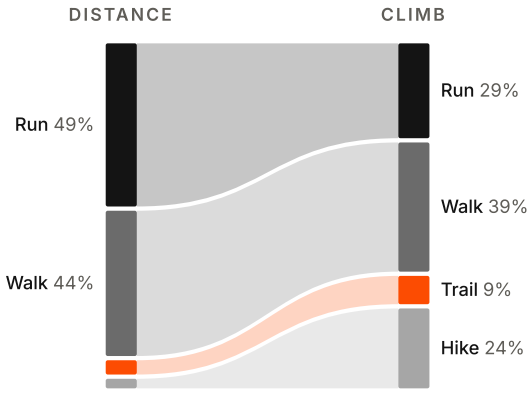
20% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

80% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 5.0 km and my average run 9.1 km. The longest walk was 30.0 km.

51 of my 87 runs were on the treadmill.

I did five trail runs and four hikes. Together they gave 33% of the year's climbing.

The other activities were 20% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2025, and 5pm was the busiest hour. Friday and Saturday were my busiest days and Tuesday the quietest. 29% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

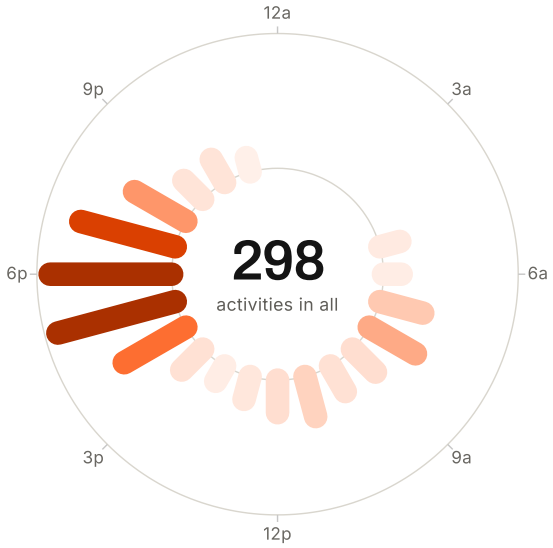
19% before 10am

20% between 10am and 4pm

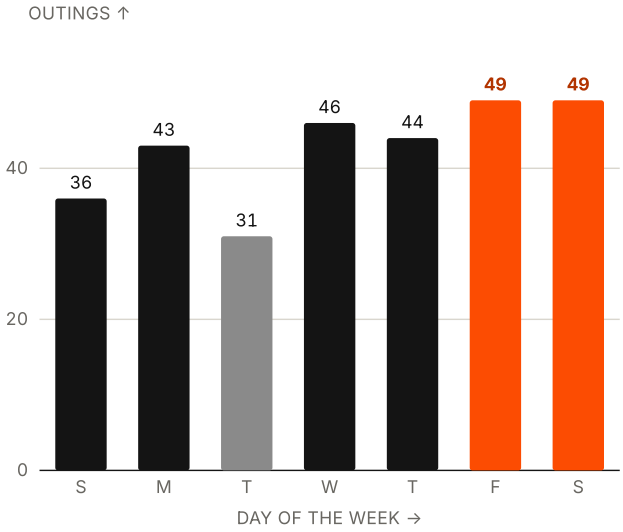
53% between 4 and 9pm

8% after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 05:07 on 27 Jul, and the latest at 23:23 on 3 Sep.

The mornings and the evenings held different outings. Runs were 35% of my outings before 10am, and walks were 58% of my outings between 4 and 9pm.

Seven outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 8.3 km, against 6.1 km on a weekday. The weekend is when the longer outings fit.

Out on 66% of days.

My longest streak went from 25 Jun to 16 Jul. My longest layoff ended on 18 Apr.

THE DAYS OF 2025

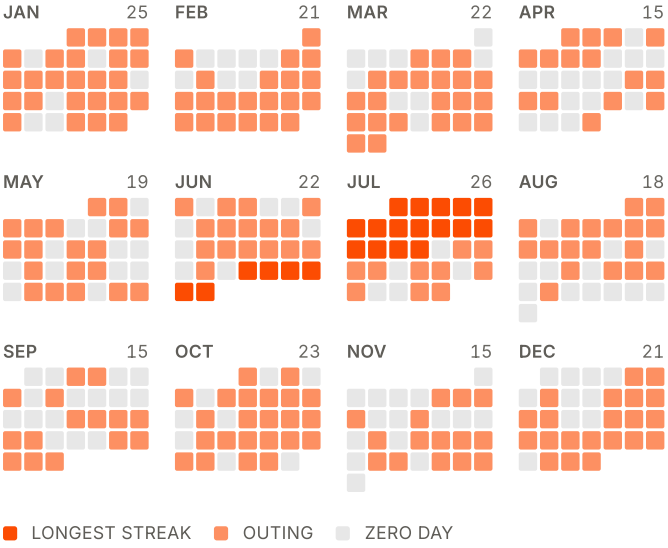
242 days
with an outing, of 365

22 days
the longest run in a row

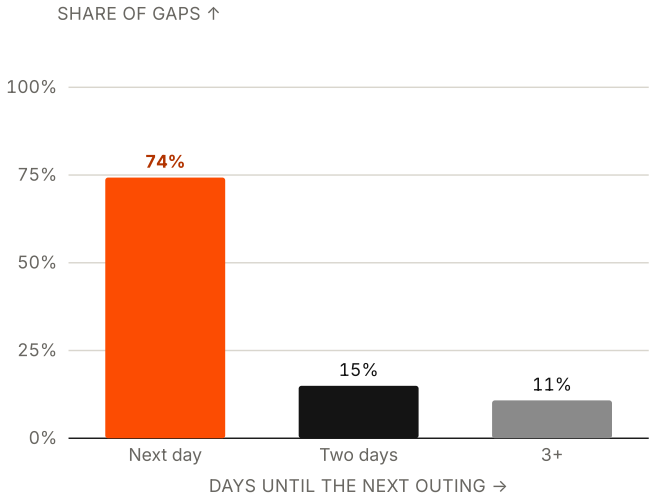
8 days
the longest layoff

74%
of outings followed the very next day

EVERY DAY OF 2025



HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2025

Every day of 2025 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days.

HOW TO READ · HOW SOON THE NEXT OUTING CAME

After each day out, how soon the next outing came: the next day, two days later, or three days or more.

THE STORY

There were 123 zero days in 2025. More of them fell on a Tuesday than on any other day of the week.

The longest streak was 22 days, from 25 Jun to 16 Jul. In the calendar it is the deep orange stretch.

Four full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 43 days I doubled up.

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 2 km or 5 km. A few long days pulled my average above my usual outing. The longest came in February.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

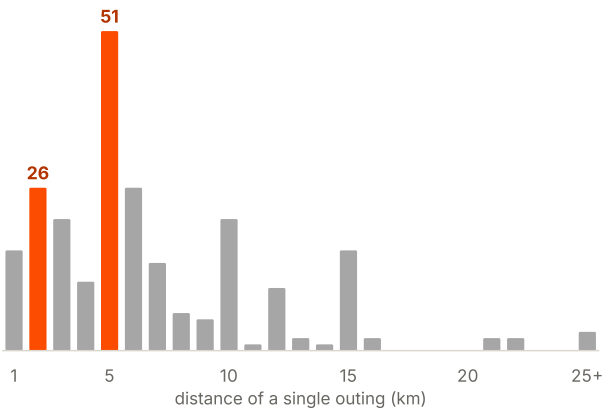
5.3 km
the middle outing

6.8 km
the average outing

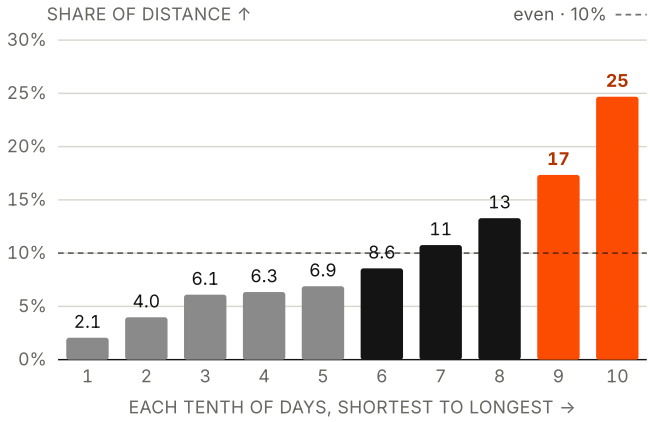
30.0 km
the longest

25%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

25% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and six were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 51% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, 50 outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 30.0 km, a walk in February.

One day led to the next.

After a day out, I usually went out again. After a zero day, it could go either way. My weeks went up and down a fair bit. My biggest week was 102 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

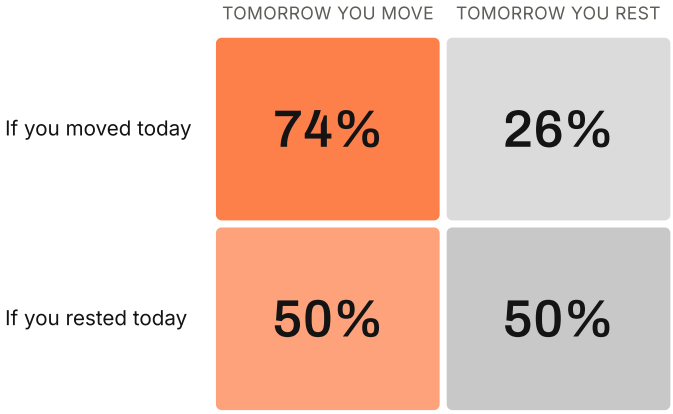
74%
went out again the day after a day out

50%
went out the day after a zero day

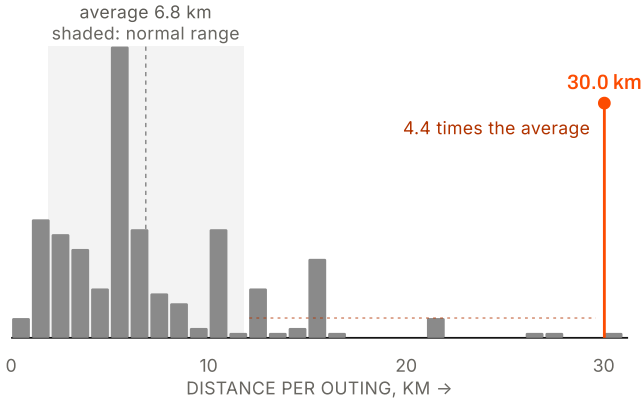
0.36
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

4.4×
my longest outing against the average one

GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · GIVEN TODAY, THE CHANCE OF TOMORROW

Read it by row. The top row starts from a day I went out, the bottom row from a zero day. In each row the left box is the chance I went out the next day and the right box the chance I rested.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

THE STORY

Ten weeks of the year had less than 10 km on foot, and some had none at all.

The biggest week began on 16 Feb, and nine weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 4.4 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2025.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

30.0 km

in a single outing

FEB 2025

LONGEST ON FOOT

10 h 59 min

of moving time in one outing

NOV 2025

MOST CLIMBED

1,979 m

of climb in one outing

MAR 2025

HARDEST EFFORT

211

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

NOV 2025

PRS

48

best times on Strava segments

2025

MOST CHEERED

96

kudos on one run

FEB 2025

EVERESTS

1.8×

the height of Everest, from 16,218 m climbed

2025

DAR TO DODOMA

3.6×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

1,609 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2025 was 5.3 km, so the furthest, 30.0 km in Feb, was 5.7 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

I set 48 PRs on Strava segments, 2 more than in 2024.

17 WHERE IT HAPPENED

Kenya again.

Besides Tanzania, I went out in Kenya, plus one outing I count as others. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

192

outings with a GPS start point

2

countries

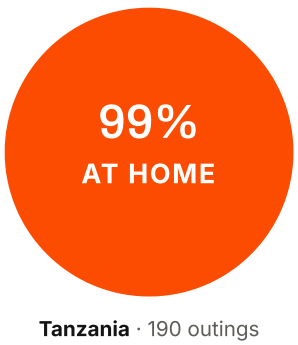
12

regions of Tanzania

34%

of outings in Kilimanjaro

HOME AGAINST AWAY

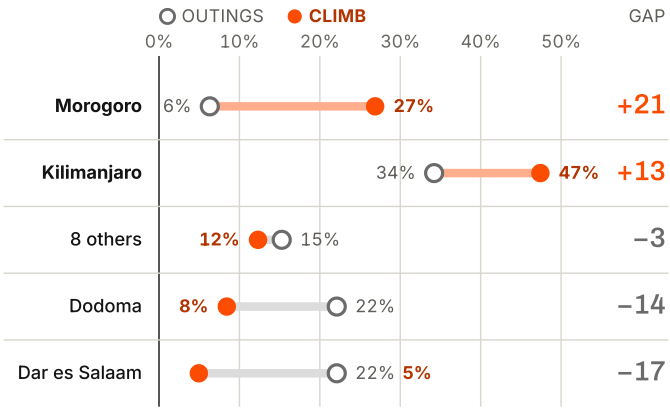


Tanzania · 190 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 2 OUTINGS

Kenya	1	2025
Others	1	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

106 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in twelve regions of Tanzania this year.

No region of Tanzania was new to my log this year.

Two outings began outside Tanzania.

18 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

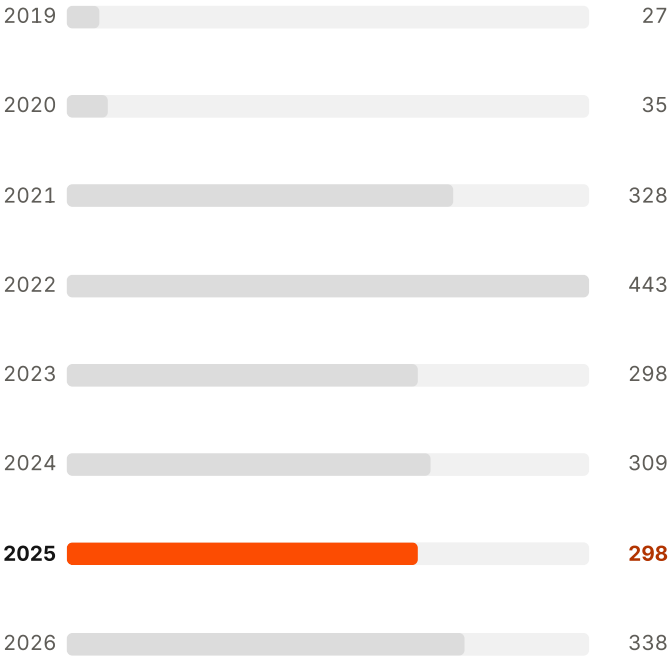
Fifth of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes fifth, and for climbing third.

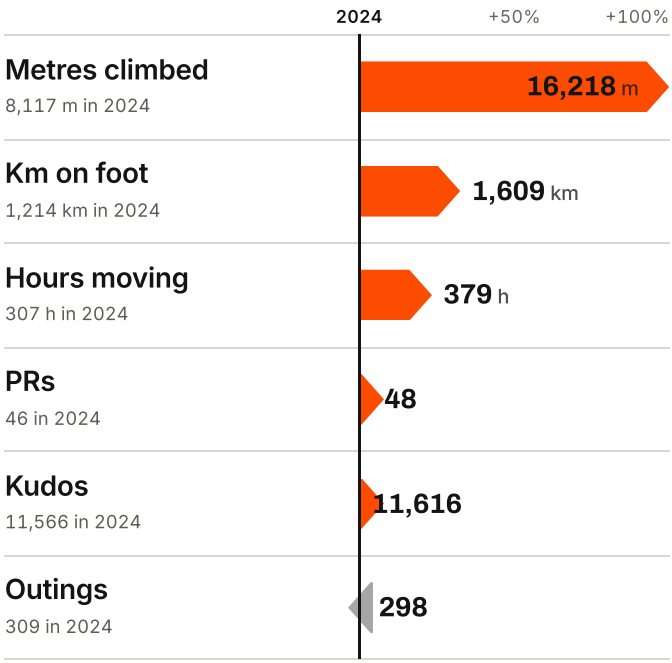
2025 AGAINST 2024

−4%	+33%	+100%	+4%
outings	distance on foot	metres climbed	PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



ALL UP ON 2024 BUT OUTINGS



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2025 in orange.

HOW TO READ · ALL UP ON 2024 BUT OUTINGS

Every bar starts at the 2024 total and points to 2025, with the 2025 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes third, by PRs third and by kudos third.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 55% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes seventh of the eight years, at 6.8 km each.

THE HIGHEST POINT

My biggest climb.

On Bondwa Peak, in rain so heavy that everything was slippery, I climbed more than on any other outing I have done. Then, in the last days of the year, I decided to stop missing days.

1,979
METRES IN A DAY

16,218
METRES IN THE YEAR

2026 still running

Every day so far.

Going every day has made it simpler. I have not missed a day this year, and in August my fiftieth trip to Ras Kilomoni was also my 2,000th outing. I am thankful the body has carried me this far.

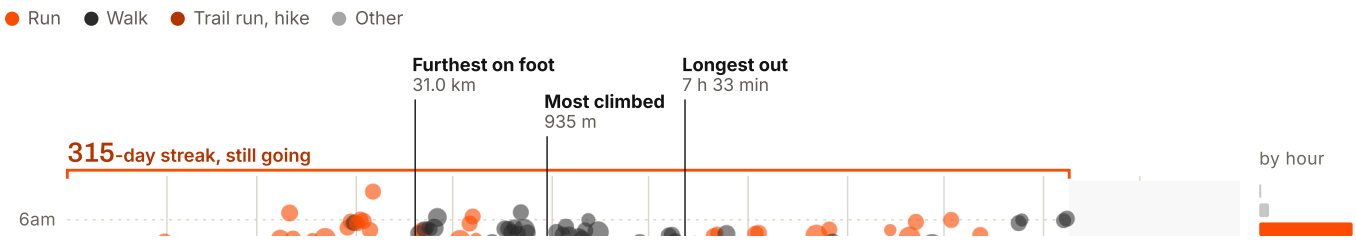
2026 IN FOUR NUMBERS, AGAINST 2025

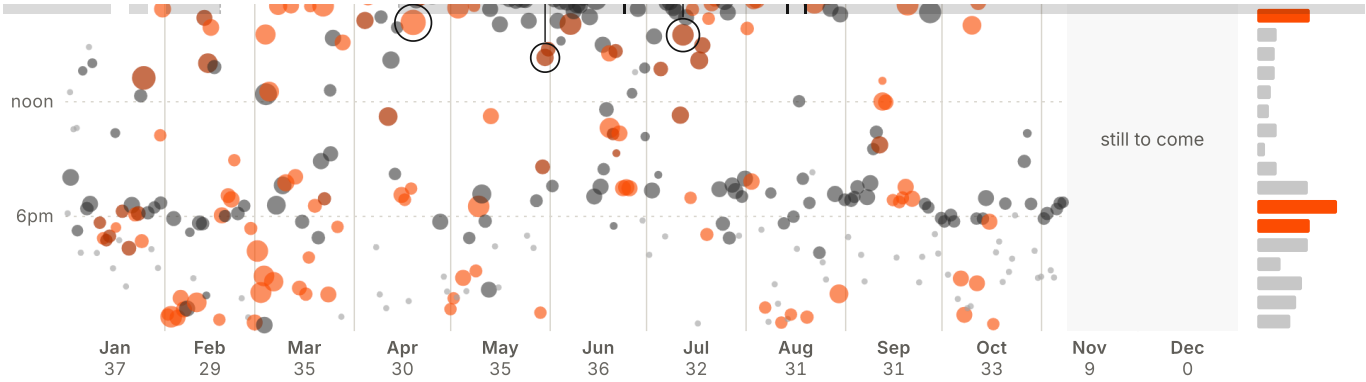
338
outings, up 13%

2,488 km
on foot, up 55%

20,040 m
climbed, up 24%

546 h
moving, up 44%





THE STORY

Each dot above is one outing of 2026, placed by its day across the year and by the hour it started, and a bigger dot is a longer distance. The marks pick out the longest silence of the year, the longest run of days and the three biggest days.

The 546 hours I spent moving in 2026 come to about 23 full days and nights. 2026 holds 19% of all the kilometres I have covered on foot. The people who follow me gave 11,537 kudos over the year, about 34 for each outing, and I set 121 PRs on Strava segments.

10 MONTH BY MONTH

January was the busiest.

The most distance came in March, with 393 km on foot. The year started strong and slowed down later. There was no empty month. November is not finished yet.

2026 BY THE MONTH

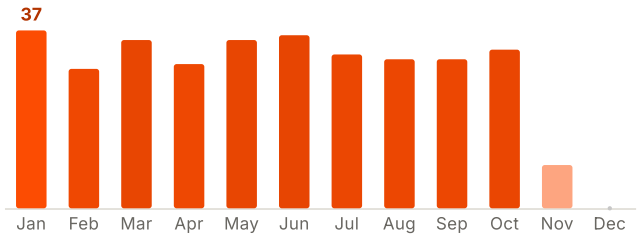
37
outings in January

9
in November, the quietest

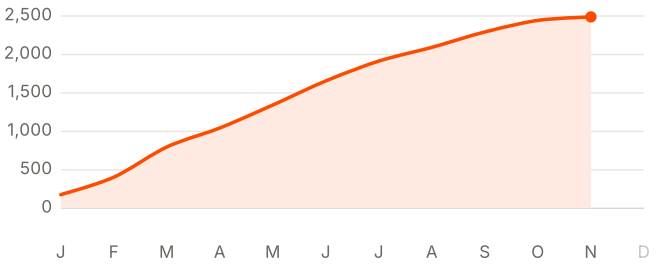
31
outings in an average month

226 km
on foot in an average month

OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH



THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, MONTH BY MONTH

One bar for each month, as tall as the number of outings that month. The busiest month is labelled.

HOW TO READ · THE KILOMETRES ADDING UP

The line adds up my kilometres on foot through the year, month by month. A steep part is a big month and a flat part is a quiet one.

THE STORY

In the first six months I covered 1,656 km on foot, and in the last five 832 km. The last month is not finished yet.

Ten of the eleven months passed 100 km on foot.

My biggest month for climbing was July, with 3,513 m on foot.

Month against month, eight of the eleven months had more outings than the same month of 2025.

11 HOW IT MOVED

Walks led 2026.

Walks led the year, 142 of my 338 outings so far, against 105 runs and 25 trail runs or hikes. Walking gave me most of my distance, and trail running gave me the biggest share of the climbing. I ran 267 km on trails.

SHARE OF ALL OUTINGS

42% walks

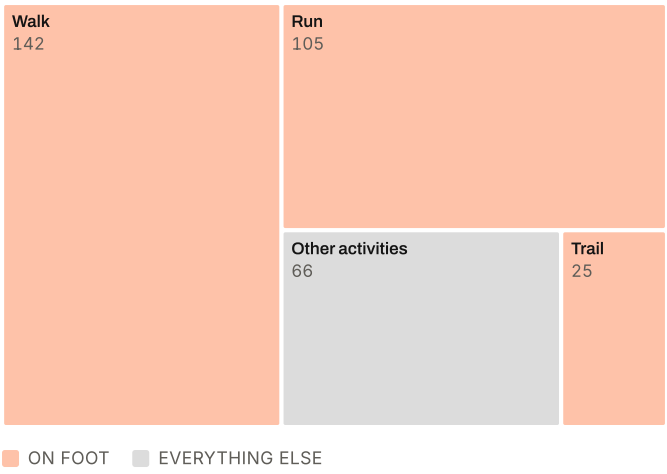
31% runs

7% trail runs and hikes

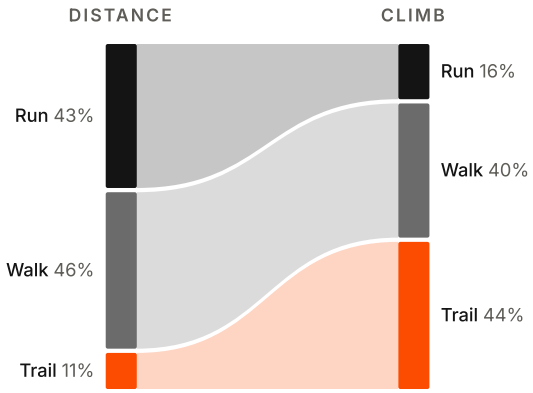
20% other activities

EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

80% of all my outings are on foot.



DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY SPORT

Each block is a kind of outing, sized by how many times I did it. Everything that is not on foot sits together in one grey block called other activities.

HOW TO READ · DISTANCE AGAINST CLIMB, ON FOOT

Two stacked columns: on the left each sport's share of my distance on foot that year, on the right its share of the climbing. A ribbon joins the two shares of the same sport, so a ribbon that widens climbs more than its distance.

THE STORY

My average walk this year was 8.1 km and my average run 10.1 km. The longest walk was 22.8 km.

47 of my 105 runs were on the treadmill, fewer than half.

I did 25 trail runs. Together they gave 44% of the year's climbing.

The other activities were 20% of my outings. They count as days out, and they add nothing to the distance or the climb.

12 WHEN IT HAPPENED

The evenings led.

The evenings were my time in 2026, though the single busiest hour was 6am. Sunday and Friday were my busiest days and Monday the quietest, but not by much. 30% of my outings were on a Saturday or Sunday, about what an even week would give.

WHEN OUTINGS STARTED

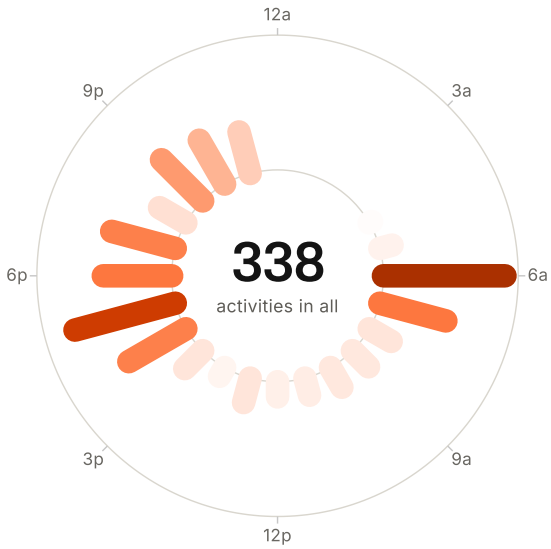
30%
before 10am

14%
between 10am and 4pm

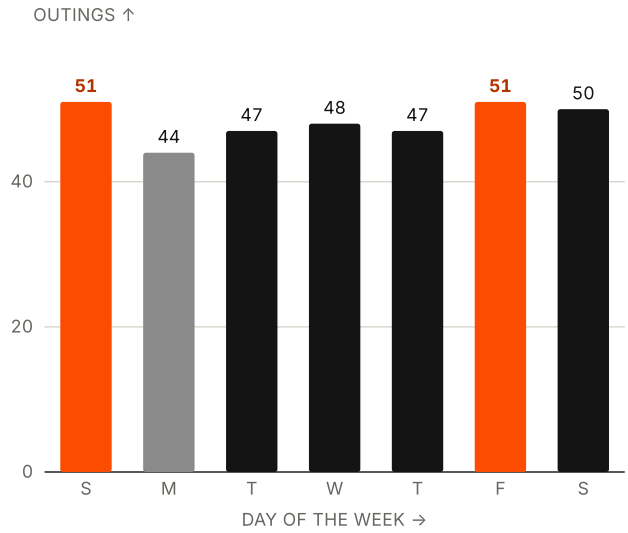
39%
between 4 and 9pm

18%
after 9pm

EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN



EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY THE HOUR IT BEGAN

A 24-hour clock with midnight at the top and noon at the bottom. Each spoke is one hour, and its length is the number of outings that started in that hour.

HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING, BY DAY OF THE WEEK

One bar for each day of the week, counting every outing that started on it. The orange bar is the busiest day and the grey bar the quietest.

THE STORY

The earliest start of the year was at 04:32 on 6 Apr, and the latest at 23:41 on 3 Mar.

Walks led both ends of the day: 52% of my outings before 10am and 48% of those between 4 and 9pm.

Six outings started before 6am.

My outings on foot at the weekend averaged 10.8 km, against 8.4 km on a weekday. The weekend is when the longer outings fit.

13 EVERY DAY OF THE YEAR

Not one day missed so far.

Not one day was skipped. Some days it was only something small, but it was something, and the days add up when none of them is skipped.

THE DAYS OF 2026

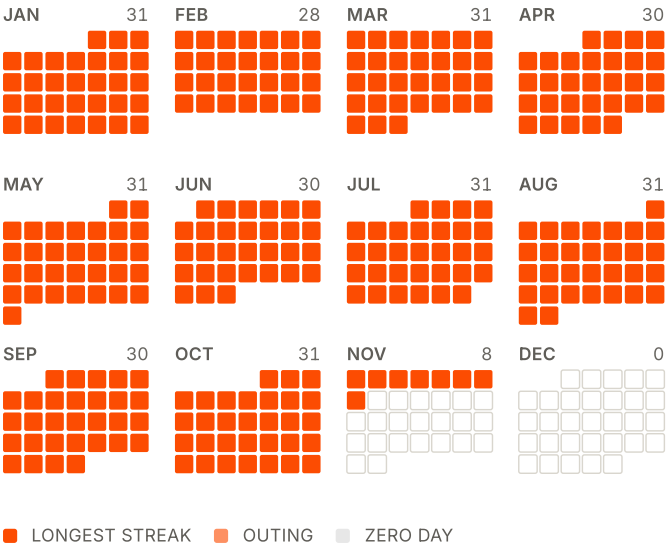
312 days
with an outing, of 312

315 days
in a row, still going

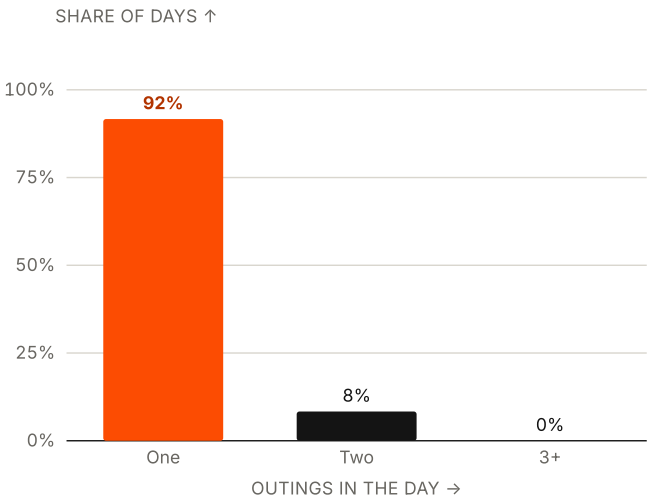
0 days
the longest break

8%
of days were doubles

EVERY DAY OF 2026



HOW MANY OUTINGS EACH DAY HELD



HOW TO READ · EVERY DAY OF 2026

Every day of 2026 as a wall calendar, one small month per block with Sunday first. Orange days had an outing, deep orange marks the longest streak, and faint days are zero days. Days still to come are left as outlines.

HOW TO READ · HOW MANY OUTINGS EACH DAY HELD

The share of days that held one outing, two, or three or more.

THE STORY

There is no faint day in the calendar. Some of those days held only a short walk or one of the other activities, and each one counted.

The longest streak was 315 days, from 29 Dec 2025 to now, still going. 312 of those days fall in 2026, the deep orange stretch in the calendar.

44 full weeks, Sunday to Saturday, had an outing on every day.

On 26 days I doubled up.

14 THE TYPICAL OUTING

The usual outing.

Most of my outings on foot were around 5 km or 10 km. The short days pulled my average below my usual outing. The longest came in April.

DISTANCE ON FOOT

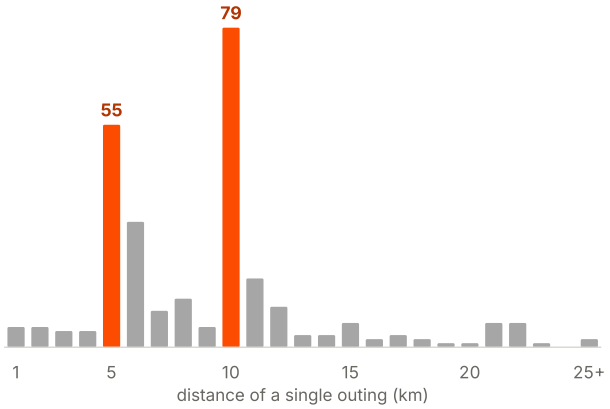
10.0 km
the middle outing

9.1 km
the average outing

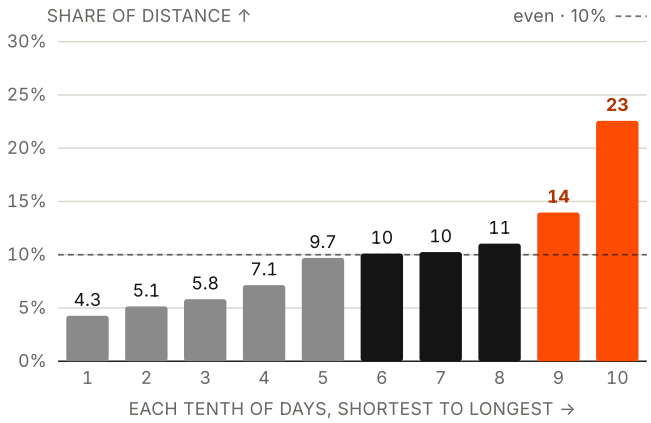
31.0 km
the longest

23%
of the distance on the busiest tenth of days

EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE



EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT, BY DISTANCE

Every outing on foot grouped by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre, one bar each. The orange bars are the distances I came back to most, and the last bar gathers everything of 25 km or more.

HOW TO READ · EACH TENTH OF DAYS, BY ITS SHARE

All my days on foot that year, cut into ten equal groups from the shortest to the longest. Each bar is that group's share of the year's distance, and the dashed line at 10% is what equal days would give.

THE STORY

52% of my outings on foot this year were 10 km or more, and 15 were a half marathon or longer.

The outings of 10 km or more gave 71% of the year's distance on foot. At the other end, twelve outings were shorter than 3 km.

The longest was 31.0 km, a run in April.

No zero day in 2026 so far.

My weeks were fairly steady. My biggest week was 160 km on foot.

THE YEAR IN NUMBERS

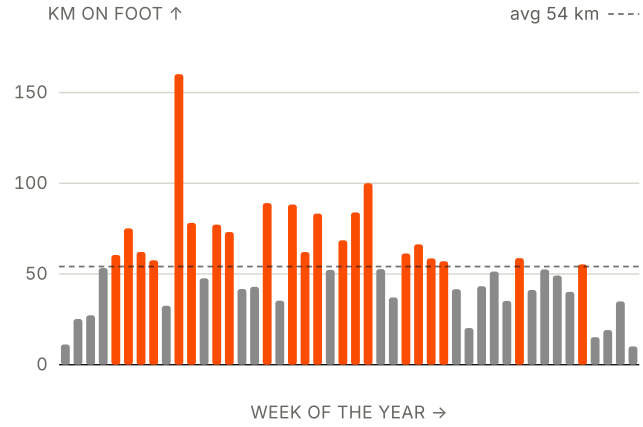
100%
went out again the day after a day out

54 km
in an average week

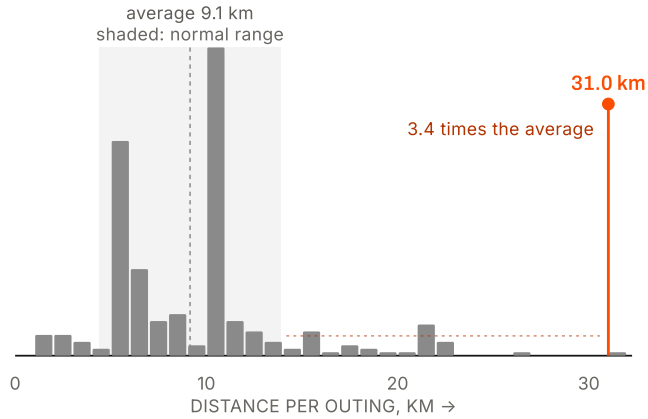
0.27
how uneven my days were, where 0 is all the same

3.4×
my longest outing against the average one

DISTANCE ON FOOT, WEEK BY WEEK



THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS



HOW TO READ · DISTANCE ON FOOT, WEEK BY WEEK

Each bar is one week of the year, as tall as my distance on foot that week. Orange weeks were above the average week, and the dashed line is the average.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OUTING AGAINST ALL THE OTHERS

Every outing on foot as a small histogram by distance. The shaded band is the normal range, and the orange mark is the longest outing of the year, with how many times the average it was.

THE STORY

Not one week of the year fell under 10 km on foot. The quietest had 10 km.

The biggest week began on 1 Mar, and 26 weeks of the year passed 50 km.

The longest outing stands far out on its own, 3.4 times my average outing. Days like that are rare, and they are what the normal days make possible.

The biggest days of 2026.

FURTHEST ON FOOT

31.0 km

in a single outing

APR 2026

LONGEST ON FOOT

7 h 33 min

of moving time in one outing

JUL 2026

MOST CLIMBED

935 m

of climb in one outing

MAY 2026

HARDEST EFFORT

729

relative effort, Strava's score for how hard it was

MAR 2026

PRS

121

best times on Strava segments

2026

MOST CHEERED

94

kudos on one run

MAR 2026

EVERESTS

2.3×

the height of Everest, from 20,040 m climbed

2026

DAR TO DODOMA

5.5×

the road from Dar es Salaam to Dodoma, on foot

2,488 KM ON FOOT

THE STORY

A big day sits far from an ordinary one. My usual outing on foot in 2026 was 10.0 km, so the furthest, 31.0 km in Apr, was 3.1 times a normal day out.

The three biggest days of the year were three different outings: the furthest, the longest in time and the one with the most climbing each came on its own day.

I set 121 PRs on Strava segments, 73 more than in 2025.

17 WHERE IT HAPPENED

Three new regions.

Rukwa, Njombe and Singida were new this year, and in Kenya I walked the Ngong Hills. The climbing was mostly in Kilimanjaro.

WHERE THE OUTINGS WERE

222

outings with a GPS start point

2

countries

11

regions of Tanzania

52%

of outings in Dar es Salaam

HOME AGAINST AWAY

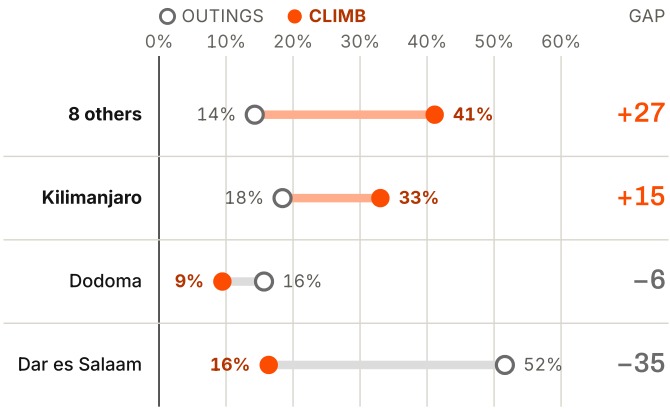


Tanzania · 217 outings

OUTSIDE TANZANIA · 5 OUTINGS

Kenya	4	2026
Others	1	

INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB



HOW TO READ · HOME AGAINST AWAY

The big disc is Tanzania, and the number in it is the share of the year's outings with a GPS start that began there. Other African countries are listed beside it, and anything outside Africa is counted as others.

HOW TO READ · INSIDE TANZANIA: SHARE OF OUTINGS AND OF CLIMB

Each region of Tanzania has two bars: the first is its share of my outings there that year, the second its share of the climbing. The number at the end is the gap.

THE STORY

116 outings this year had no GPS start, mostly on the treadmill, so they are not part of these two charts.

I went out in eleven regions of Tanzania this year.

Three regions were new to my log this year: Rukwa, Njombe and Singida.

Five outings began outside Tanzania.

18 AGAINST THE OTHER YEARS

Second of 8 years.

For distance on foot it comes third, and for climbing second, and it is not finished yet.

2026 AGAINST 2025

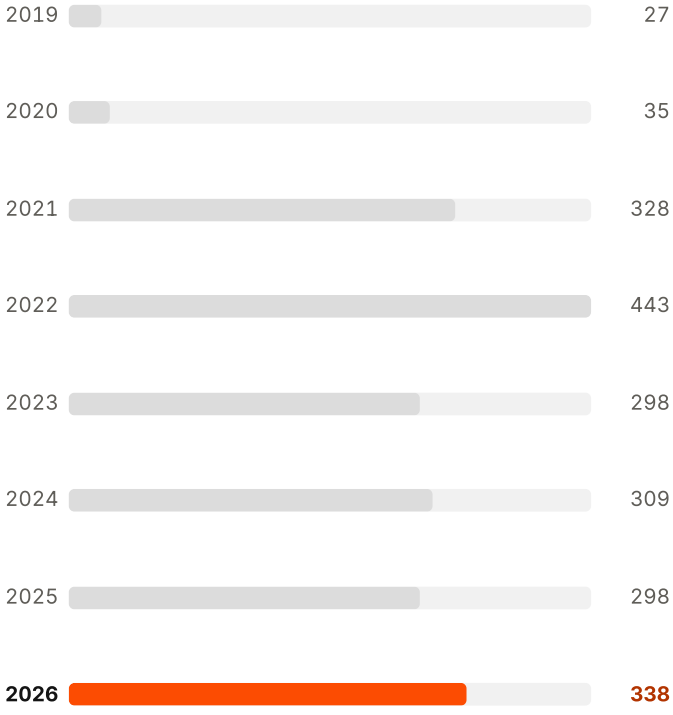
+13% outings

+55% distance on foot

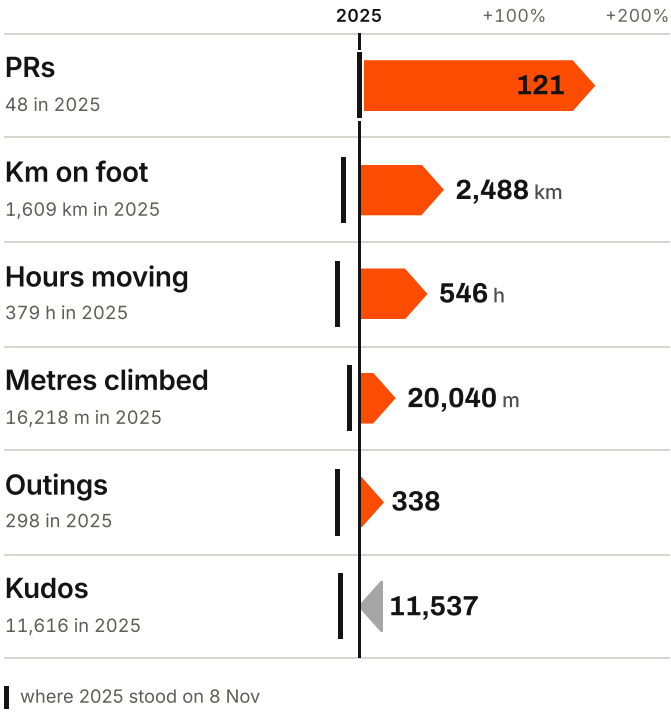
+24% metres climbed

+152% PRs

OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR



ALL UP ON 2025 BUT KUDOS



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS, YEAR BY YEAR

Every year of my record by its number of outings, with 2026 in orange.

HOW TO READ · ALL UP ON 2025 BUT KUDOS

Every bar starts at the 2025 total and points to 2026, with the 2026 total at its tip. Orange went up, grey went down, and the longest bar changed the most. When one measure grew many times over, the scale counts in times as many. 2026 is not finished, so the black mark shows where 2025 stood on 8 Nov.

THE STORY

By hours moving it comes first, by PRs first and by kudos fifth.

Against my best year for distance, 2022, it covered 86% as many kilometres on foot.

For distance per outing on foot, it comes second of the eight years, at 9.1 km each.

The year is not finished, so it can still move up these lists.

EVERY DAY

One day at a time.

I started this streak on purpose, and my first target is to reach 31 December without a zero day. So far every day of the year has an outing, in Tanzania and away.

315
DAY STREAK

546
HOURS MOVING

CHAPTER 8

08 Sports

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“If you do it, you will feel better when it is over. If you do not, you will feel worse. So go do it.”

Running and walking do very different work for me. I move on foot in four ways: I run, I walk, I hike and I run on trails, and this chapter puts them side by side on ground covered, hours, speed and climb.

The sports are not the same kind of effort, so the chapter compares them on more than one measure. A sport can lead on distance and trail on hours, or climb the most while being the rarest. The sections follow those measures one by one, and later ones look at how the sports sit together in a single day.

Running has a story of its own here. For a long time most of it was on the treadmill, a hard session when time was short, and over the years more of it moved outside. Walking took me outside from the start. Several sections follow that move.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

Each sport keeps one colour in every chart of this chapter, and in the rest of the book. The charts here also show distributions, the whole spread of outings, because a single average pace or distance would hide how different the sports really are.

THE WHOLE PICTURE

Runs cover the ground.

What my log calls the treadmill is running indoors, wherever I am: at first a loop inside, and the marathon was one, later running in place, sometimes barefoot on a carpet. No machine is needed. It is not the most effective way, but I sweat and the body stays active. It is flat, quick and always the same, so on this page I keep it apart, and in the chart below it sits alone on the left.

THE FOUR SPORTS ON FOOT

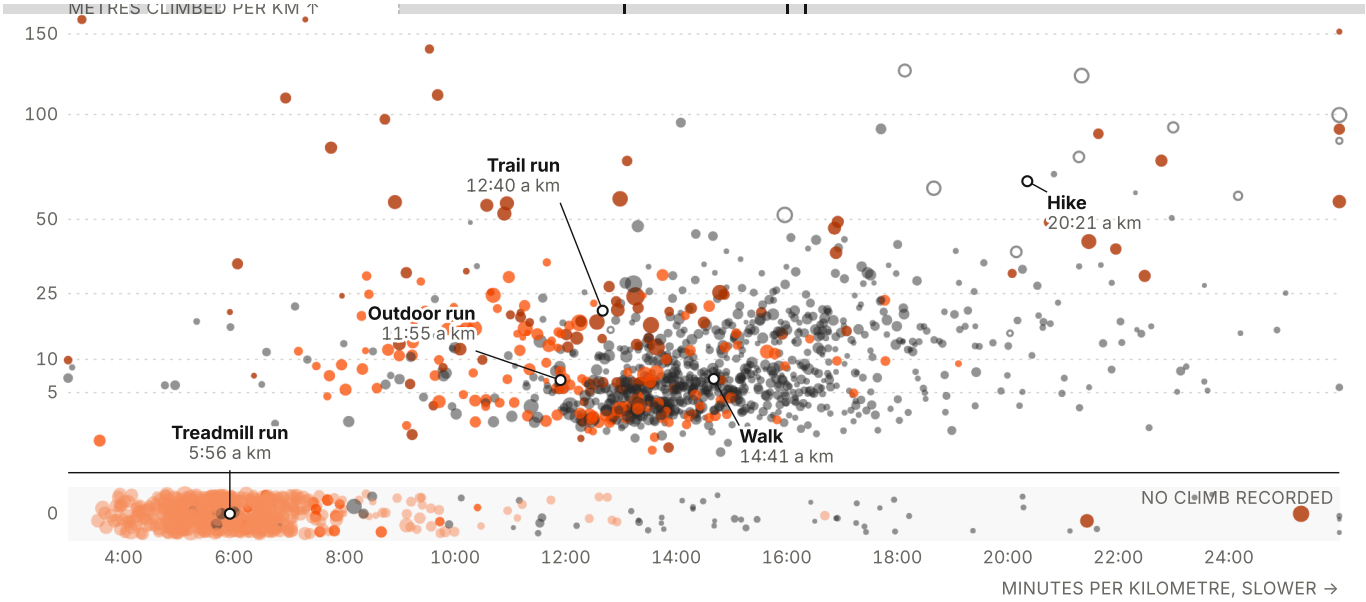
1,740
outings on foot, of 2,076 in all

13,295 km
covered on foot

85,159 m
climbed on foot

2,120 h
moving on foot

Treadmill run 629 · Outdoor run 153 · Trail run 80 · Walk 865 · Hike 13



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING ON FOOT

Each dot is one outing on foot. Across is the pace, quicker to the left, and up is the climb for each kilometre. A bigger dot is a longer outing and the colour is the way of moving. Outings with no climb at all, such as every treadmill run, sit in a lane under the axis.

HOW TO READ · WHAT THE CLOUDS SAY

Each way of moving gathers into its own cloud, named at its middle. Where two clouds overlap, the two ways of moving are alike in pace and climb; where a cloud stands apart, it is a different kind of effort.

DESIGN LESSON · FOUR MEASURES IN ONE SCATTER

One scatter can carry four measures at once if each goes to the right channel. Position is the most exact channel the eye has, so it holds the two measures that matter most. Size and colour are rougher, so they hold the measures that only need to be read roughly or by group.

In your own work. Before you add size or colour to a scatter, check that each extra measure can still be read at a glance. If it cannot, give it a chart of its own.

Walks took more hours.

A run and a walk do different jobs for me, though they share my hours almost equally. A run takes me further, about 10.1 km against 4.0 km for a walk. The hills belong to the few trail runs and hikes: one hike in Morogoro climbed as much as all my running climbs in a whole year.

EACH SPORT'S BIGGEST SHARE

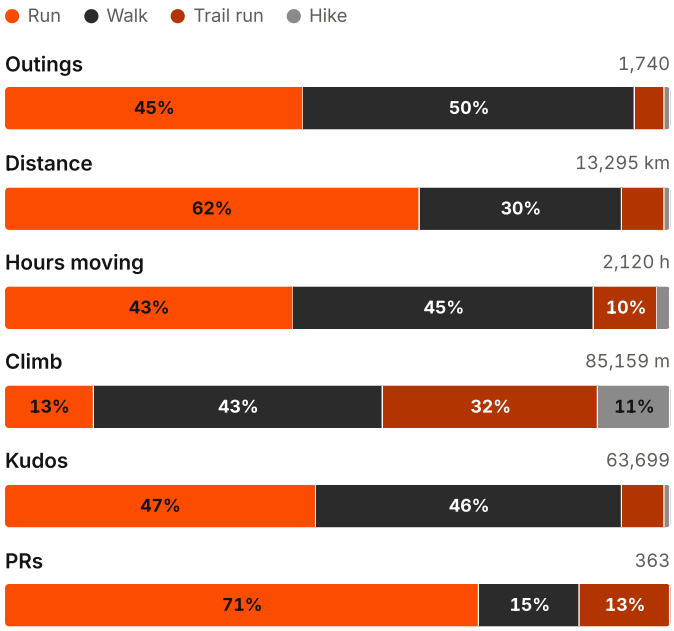
62% of the distance was run

45% of the hours were walked

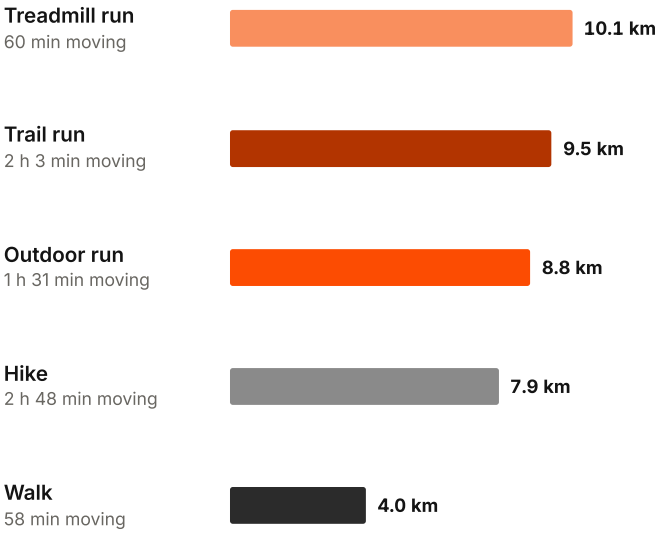
32% of the climb came on trail runs

11% of the climb came on 13 hikes

EACH SPORT'S SHARE OF THE RECORD



THE TYPICAL OUTING OF EACH



HOW TO READ · EACH SPORT'S SHARE OF THE RECORD

Each row is one thing I can count, and the bar is cut into the four sports so the parts add up to the total on the right. Run your eye down one colour and watch it change: runs own the distance, walks the hours and the climb, and the small trail and hike parts grow big on the climb row.

HOW TO READ · THE TYPICAL OUTING OF EACH

The usual outing of each kind, by distance, longest at the top. The line under each name is the usual time moving for that kind of outing.

DESIGN LESSON · ROWS OF SHARES FOR MANY MEASURES

Each row is one measure cut into the sports' shares, all rows the same length. Reading down one colour shows how one sport's share changes from measure to measure.

In your own work. Line up 100% bars when you want to compare the same parts across several totals.

DESIGN LESSON · LAY BARS ON THEIR SIDE FOR LONG NAMES

When each row has a long name, like a date with a line of detail under it, horizontal bars let every name sit level at the start of its row. Upright bars would force the names to slant or shrink.

In your own work. If your labels are longer than a word or two, turn the chart on its side.

THE STORY

Which sport matters most depends on what I count. By outings, walks lead. By distance, runs lead by far. By hours, walks and runs are almost level. By climb, walks lead again, and trail runs and hikes come close behind.

PRs lean heavily to running: 71% of them came on runs and 15% on walks. Kudos follow the outings more evenly, with runs and walks taking almost the same share.

02 THE MIX, YEAR BY YEAR

In 2026, walks went further.

Walking took over slowly, year after year. In 2021 I walked only 473 km against more than 2,000 km of running. This year my walking passed my running two days into January and never fell behind again. Trail running arrived at the end of 2021, when I started going to the hills.

2026 SO FAR, AGAINST THE RUNNING PEAK

1,157 km
walked in 2026 so far

1,065 km
run in 2026 so far

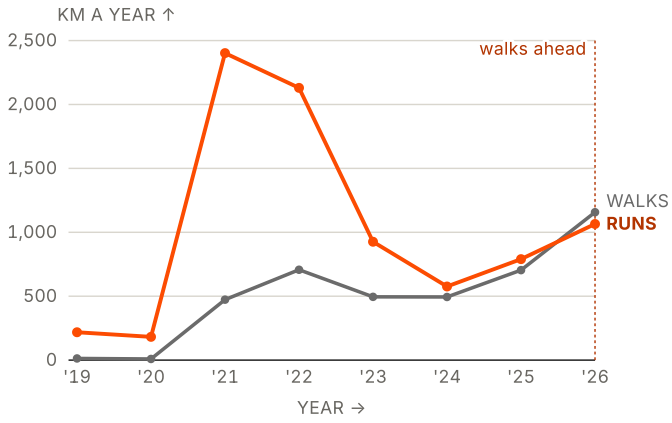
2,402 km
run in 2021

303 km
on trails in 2023, the trail peak

KILOMETRES ON FOOT, YEAR BY YEAR



WALKING AGAINST RUNNING



HOW TO READ · KILOMETRES ON FOOT, YEAR BY YEAR

Each column is a year, stacked by sport, and the number on top is the total kilometres on foot. The column with a star is the year still running.

DESIGN LESSON · STACKS: THE BOTTOM PIECE IS THE EASY ONE

Each column is a total cut into parts. The total and the bottom piece are easy to compare across columns, because they sit on the same floor. The pieces higher up float, so their sizes are harder to judge.

In your own work. Put the part you most want compared at the bottom of the stack, and keep the number of parts small, four at most.

HOW TO READ · WALKING AGAINST RUNNING

Two lines: the kilometres I walked each year and the kilometres I ran. The mark shows the year the walking line first went above the running line.

DESIGN LESSON · MARK THE MOMENT THAT MATTERS

The point where one line overtakes the other is marked and dated. A crossing is often the whole story of a line chart, and an unmarked one is easy to miss.

In your own work. Annotate the one turning point your reader should remember, right on the chart.

THE STORY

My two biggest years on foot were 2021 and 2022, both close to 2,900 km, and both were built on running, most of it on the treadmill. 2024 was my smallest year since the comeback, at 1,214 km. Since then each year has grown again, and 2026 is already at 2,488 km with the year not finished.

The trail kilometres come and go with my trips to the hills. There was almost nothing before 2022, then a peak in 2023, and 2026 is my second biggest trail year so far.

03 THE TREADMILL

83% of running was indoors.

More of my running is outside every year. The treadmill years peaked with a full marathon in one room, 42.7 km, and in 2026, for the first time, more than half of my running was on roads and trails. The treadmill still shows in my habits: I tend to stop when the screen shows a round number.

RUNNING INDOORS

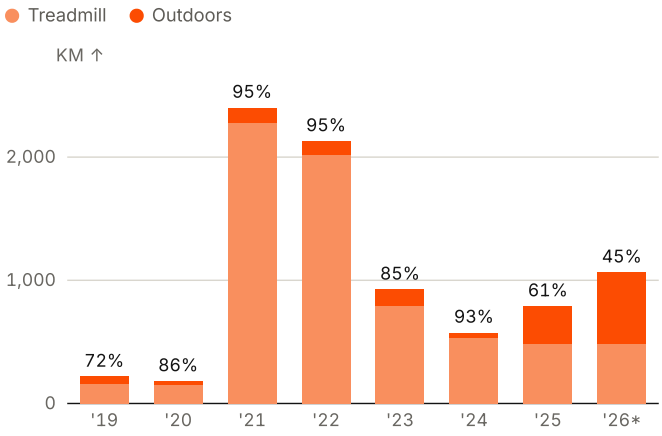
629
treadmill runs

95%
of running km indoors in 2021

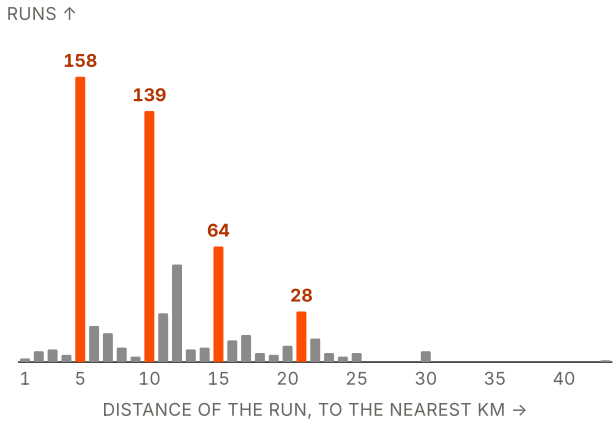
45%
indoors in 2026 so far

45%
of treadmill runs stopped on a whole 5 km

RUNNING KILOMETRES, INDOORS AND OUT



WHERE THE TREADMILL STOPPED



HOW TO READ · RUNNING KILOMETRES, INDOORS AND OUT

Each column is a year of running, split into kilometres on the treadmill and kilometres outside. The number on top is the share that was on the treadmill.

DESIGN LESSON · PRINT THE TOTAL ON TOP

A stacked column hides its total in the sum of its pieces, so the total is printed above each column. The reader gets the whole and the parts without doing arithmetic.

In your own work. When you stack, always give the total. Readers should never have to add.

HOW TO READ · WHERE THE TREADMILL STOPPED

Every treadmill run counted by its distance, rounded to the nearest kilometre. The tall spikes stand on 5, 10, 15 and 21 km, the round numbers where I tend to stop.

DESIGN LESSON · LET THE EXCEPTIONS BREAK THE PATTERN

The bars are thin and grey, except a few that stand out in orange with their counts. The spikes are the finding: runs that stopped on round numbers.

In your own work. In a histogram, narrow bins reveal spikes that wide bins would smooth away.

THE STORY

The spikes are my habits on the screen. Rounded to the nearest kilometre, 158 treadmill runs come out at 5 km and 139 at 10 km. Those two numbers alone hold 47% of all my treadmill runs.

Outside, my running grew quickly once it started. In 2024 I ran outside only 4 times. In 2025 it was 36, and in 2026 so far 58. That is how the outdoor part of the columns finally passed the treadmill.

04 PACE

Each sport has its pace.

The treadmill makes me look faster than I am. On it my usual kilometre takes under six minutes; on the road at the Kilimanjaro Half in 2026 each one took about ten. Running indoors is tiring and dull, and I do it without music, a lesson from David Goggins: when life hits you, there is no background music. After two hard years, a move to remote work in 2024 and a job lost when USAID funding was cut in 2025, I set goals for 2026 and pushed, and my indoor kilometre got more than a minute quicker.

MEDIAN MINUTES PER KILOMETRE

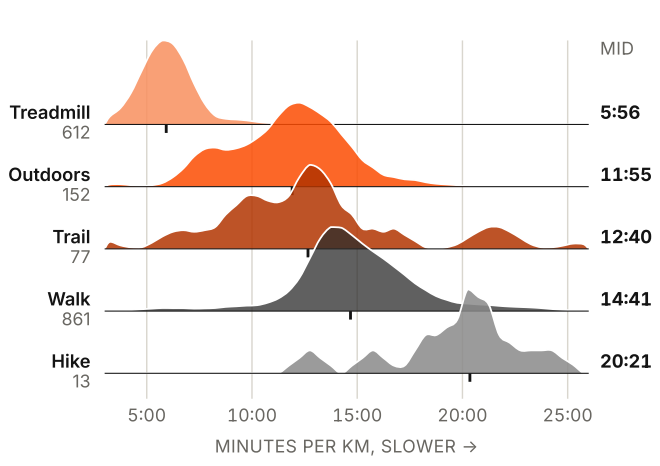
5.9 min
a treadmill km

11.9 min
an outdoor run km

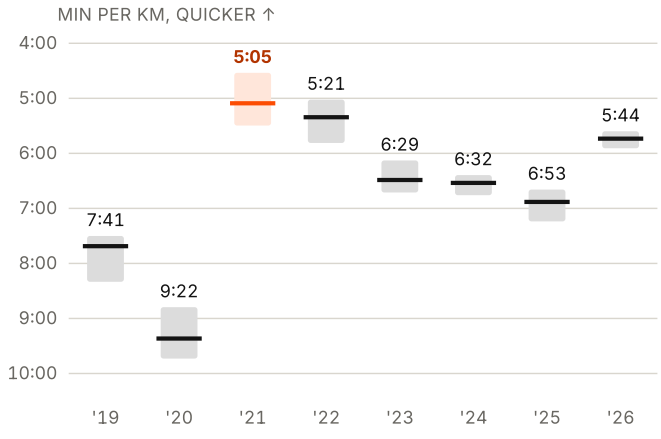
14.7 min
a walking km

20.4 min
a hiking km

EVERY OUTING BY PACE



TREADMILL PACE, YEAR BY YEAR



HOW TO READ · EVERY OUTING BY PACE

One ridge for each way of moving, showing how many outings went at each pace. Left is quicker and right is slower, and the mark is the usual pace. The treadmill sits far to the left on its own.

DESIGN LESSON · LOOK AT THE SHAPE BEHIND THE AVERAGE

An average or a median is one number, and very different groups can share it. A smoothed distribution for each group shows what the single number hides: two humps, a long tail, a hard edge.

In your own work. Before you report an average, draw the distribution. If it has two humps, the average describes almost nobody.

HOW TO READ · TREADMILL PACE, YEAR BY YEAR

One column per year for my treadmill runs. The bold tick is the usual pace that year and the band covers the middle half of my runs. The axis is upside down, so a quicker year stands taller.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW THE MIDDLE HALF BESIDE THE AVERAGE

A single average hides whether a year was steady or all over the place. Setting the middle half of the values next to the median answers both questions, with very little ink.

In your own work. Report the spread next to the centre. A band and a tick are enough.

THE STORY

My quickest treadmill year was 2021, at a usual 5:05 a kilometre. After that the usual pace slowed year by year, to 6:53 in 2025, and in 2026 it came back to 5:44.

The slower kilometres outside are real work too. Each outdoor running kilometre climbs about 8 m on average, and a treadmill kilometre climbs nothing. The ridges show the result: outside, my running sits much closer to my walking than to the treadmill.

The typical walk grew.

My walks got longer. From 2021 to 2024, about half of them were short, under 3 km. In 2025 that started to change, and now almost every walk is a proper outing of many kilometres. In September 2026 I walked 22.8 km on a Sunday in Dar es Salaam, and it felt like an ordinary weekend walk.

THE WALK, 2021 AGAINST 2026

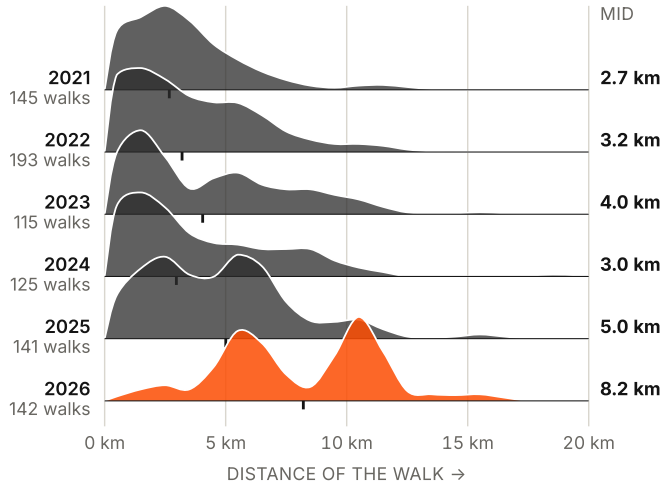
2.7 km
the median walk of 2021

8.2 km
the median walk of 2026 so far

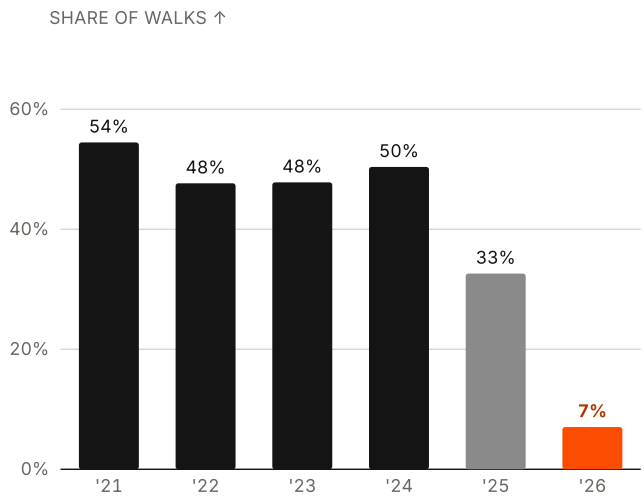
54%
of 2021 walks under 3 km

7%
of 2026 walks under 3 km

EVERY WALK BY DISTANCE, YEAR BY YEAR



SHARE OF WALKS UNDER 3 KM



HOW TO READ · EVERY WALK BY DISTANCE, YEAR BY YEAR

One ridge for each year, showing how many walks I did at each distance from 0 to 20 km. The mark is the usual walk of that year. Read down the years and the hump moves to the right.

DESIGN LESSON · SCALE EACH ROW TO ITSELF, AND SAY SO

Each ridge is scaled to its own highest point, so the shapes line up and can be compared. The price is that heights can no longer be compared between rows: a tall ridge is a common value within its own row, nothing more.

In your own work. When you rescale to compare shapes, tell the reader that the heights are no longer counts.

HOW TO READ · SHARE OF WALKS UNDER 3 KM

The share of each year's walks that were shorter than 3 km. The bars fall almost to nothing in the last year.

THE STORY

In 2026 so far, 66 of my 142 walks were 10 km or more. Before 2025, no year had more than 9 walks that long.

The longest walks are new as well. Every walk of 20 km or more in my log came in 2025 or 2026.

A walk used to fill a gap in the day. Now it is the main outing of the day.

06 THE LONG DAYS

Long days moved outdoors.

Long days used to mean the treadmill. Before my first half marathon outside, 22.7 km on the trails of Morogoro in 2023, every long day in my log had been indoors. Now most of them are outside, on roads, trails and long walks. Only the marathon, run indoors in 2022, is still longer than any of them.

HALF MARATHON OR LONGER

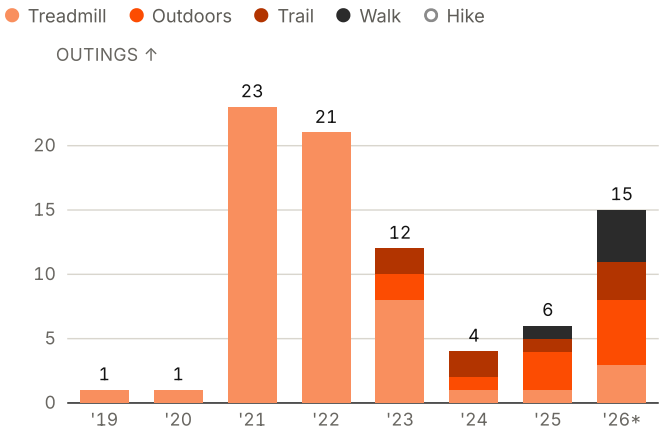
83
outings of 21.1 km or more

71%
of them on a treadmill

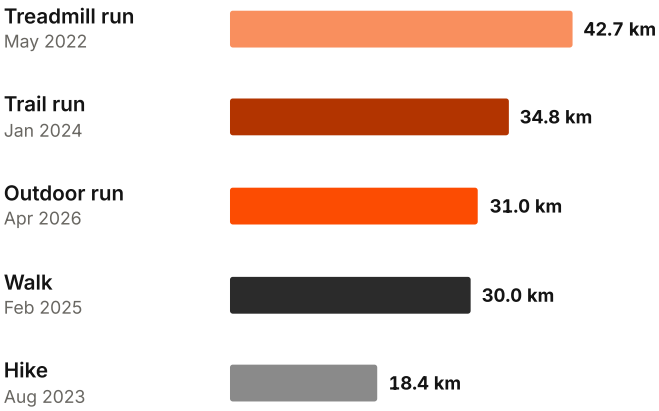
15
in 2026 so far

12
of those 15 outside

OUTINGS OF 21.1 KM OR MORE, YEAR BY YEAR



THE LONGEST OF EACH



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS OF 21.1 KM OR MORE, YEAR BY YEAR

Each column counts the outings of a half marathon or more in one year, split by how I did them: treadmill, outdoor run, trail run, walk or hike.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST OF EACH

The longest single outing of each kind, with the month it happened.

DESIGN LESSON · SORT A LIST FROM THE TOP

The rows are sorted, biggest first, so the order itself carries the ranking and the eye reads it like a list. The first row is the answer to the question in the title.

In your own work. For any ranking, sort before you draw. A ranking in alphabetical order makes the reader do the sorting.

THE STORY

My long days came in two waves. The first was 2021 and 2022, with 23 and 21, almost all on the treadmill. Then they became rare, only 4 in 2024. The second wave is now, and this time most of them are outside.

Walks now count among my long days too. Four of my walks in 2026 so far reached 21.1 km or more.

The longest of each kind tells the same story. Only the indoor marathon is from the first wave. The longest trail run, outdoor run and walk all came later, once the long days had moved outside.

07 THE CLIMB

Hikes climb the most.

Climbing is slow work, and it happens outside. My 629 treadmill runs together climbed nothing at all, while one hike in Morogoro climbed almost 2,000 m in 16 km. Walks sit between the two: 30% of my distance and 43% of my climbing.

METRES CLIMBED FOR EACH KILOMETRE

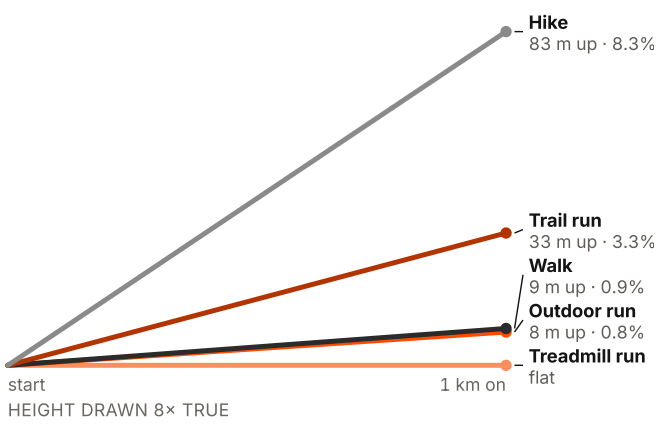
83 m
per km on a hike

33 m
per km on a trail run

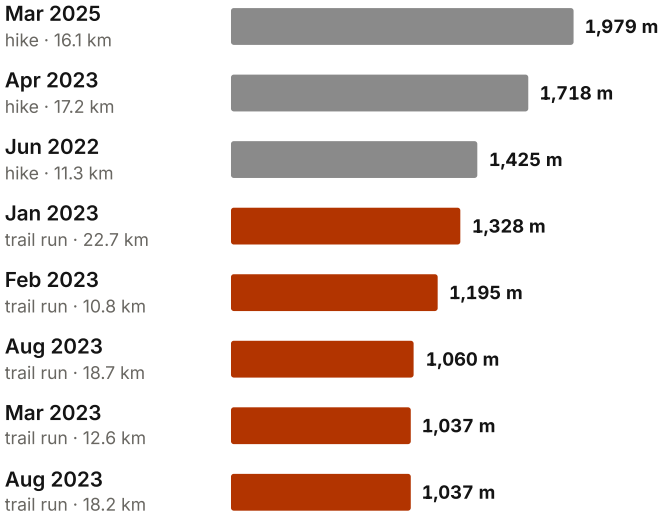
9 m
per km on a walk

1,979 m
my biggest single climb

IF EACH SPORT WERE A ROAD



THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS



I drew the slopes steeper than they really are.

HOW TO READ · IF EACH SPORT WERE A ROAD

Each line is a road one kilometre long, climbing at that sport's real average slope. I drew the rise steeper than it really is so the gentle ones can be told apart, and the number at the end is the true metres climbed.

HOW TO READ · THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS

My biggest single climbs, largest at the top, with the month, the sport and the distance.

DESIGN LESSON · EXAGGERATE ON PURPOSE, AND SAY SO

True to scale, most gradients on foot would look flat and the differences between them would vanish. Stretching the height makes them visible, and printing the real values keeps the stretch honest.

In your own work. If you stretch a scale to make differences visible, print the real numbers and state the stretch.

DESIGN LESSON · CONTEXT UNDER THE LABEL

Each row has a second, quieter line under its name, such as the number of outings or the place. The detail sits where the eye already is, so there is no table or footnote to look up.

In your own work. Put the one extra fact a reader will want right under the label, in a smaller and lighter type.

THE STORY

My three biggest climbs are all hikes. After them come the trail runs of 2023, my year of the hills, with five climbs of more than 1,000 m in that year alone.

Walks did the most climbing in total, and no single walk comes near the top of the list. A walk climbs a little at a time, and over hundreds of walks that adds up to more than any other sport.

08 WHEN

Treadmill runs at night.

The treadmill is for the days short on time, so it takes the hours nothing else wants: it is busiest at 7am and again late in the evening. Walks come around 5pm, after the office. Outdoor runs start early, around 6am, or late in the afternoon. Trail runs and hikes need a free day, so they wait for the weekend.

HOURS AND DAYS

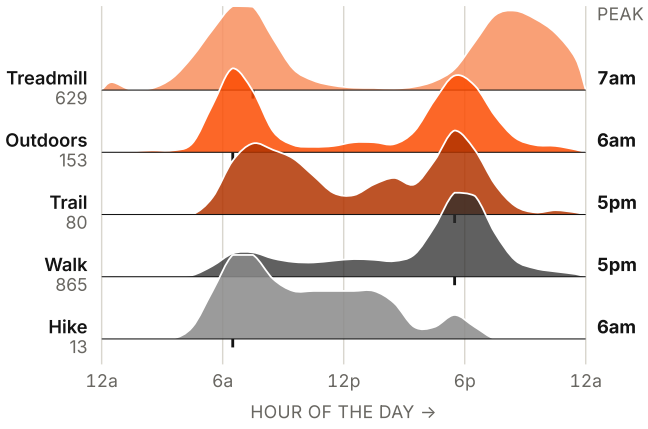
37%
of treadmill runs after 8pm or before 5am

48%
of walks between 4 and 7pm

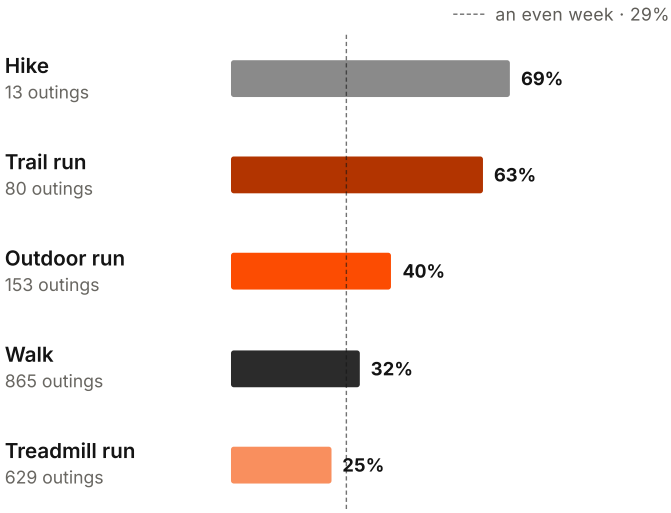
63%
of trail runs at the weekend

25%
of treadmill runs at the weekend

THE HOUR EACH OUTING STARTED



SHARE OF EACH ON A SATURDAY OR SUNDAY



HOW TO READ · THE HOUR EACH OUTING STARTED

One ridge for each way of moving, showing the hour its outings started, from midnight on the left to midnight on the right. The mark is the busiest hour.

HOW TO READ · SHARE OF EACH ON A SATURDAY OR SUNDAY

The share of each kind of outing that fell on a Saturday or Sunday. The dashed line is 29%, what an even week would give.

DESIGN LESSON · THE VALUE AT THE END OF THE BAR

The number sits just past the end of each bar, so the length and the exact value are read in one look.

In your own work. Leave space at the right of the longest bar for its label. A number crammed inside a bar is hard to read.

THE STORY

Hikes lean on the weekend even more than trail runs, with 69% of them on a Saturday or Sunday. A hike needs a whole day and a trip, and the weekend is when I have both.

The treadmill is the opposite. It is my weekday tool, and it works at hours when the road is dark, late in the evening or before dawn. The walks fill the evening, after the working day.

09 A RUN AND A WALK ON THE SAME DAY

A run and a walk, hours apart.

As the habit settled, I stopped splitting my days. In the early years I often did doubles, a run in the morning and a walk in the evening, and only 14 pairs were less than half an hour apart. Now one longer outing usually takes their place.

DAYS WITH BOTH

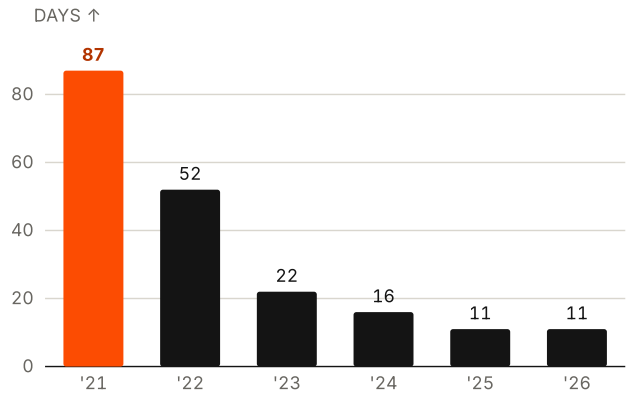
199 days
with a run and a walk

65%
of them with the run first

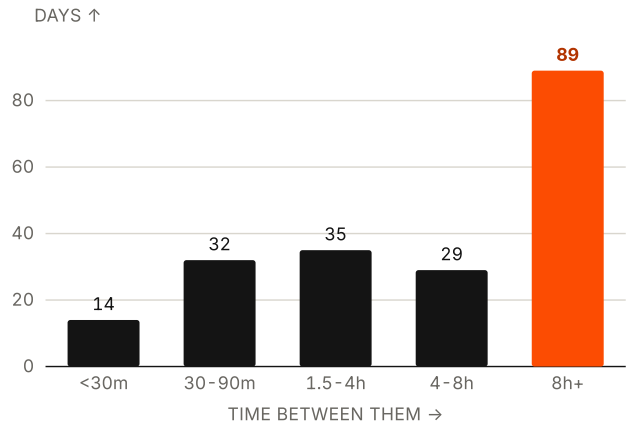
6.5 h
between them, the median

87 days
in 2021, the most

DAYS WITH A RUN AND A WALK, YEAR BY YEAR



TIME BETWEEN THE TWO



HOW TO READ · DAYS WITH A RUN AND A WALK, YEAR BY YEAR

The number of days in each year with both a run and a walk.

HOW TO READ · TIME BETWEEN THE TWO

The same days, sorted by the time from the end of the first outing to the start of the second. The tallest bar, eight hours or more, is one outing in the morning and the other in the evening.

THE STORY

Most pairs were far apart. 89 of the 199 days had eight hours or more between the two, so these were two separate parts of the day. Only 14 pairs came close together, one straight after the other.

The doubles belong to the years when I was building the habit. 2021 had the most, and in 2026 so far there have been 11.

Treadmill runs work hardest.

What people cheer and what my heart feels are different things. The people who follow me cheer the trail runs most, and my most cheered outing is the Kilimanjaro Half of 2023, with 125 kudos. By then I had made many friends on Strava, strangers at first, by giving kudos almost every day, and some follow me for the Jocko Willink lines I put in my descriptions. That race was a big day outside, and they all saw it. Per hour, my heart works hardest on the treadmill and least on a walk. Relative effort is Strava's score for how hard my heart worked.

EFFORT PER HOUR, KUDOS AND RECORDS PER OUTING

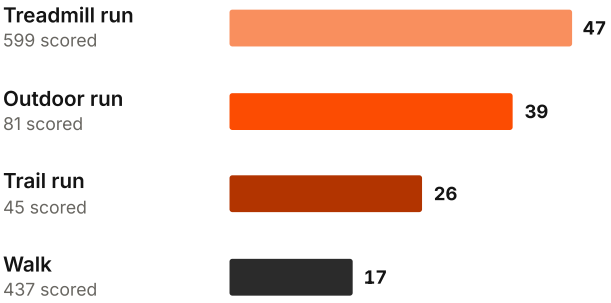
47
effort per hour, treadmill run

17
effort per hour, walk

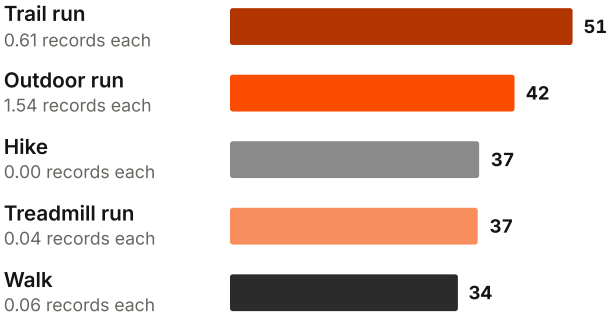
51
kudos per trail run

1.5
PRs per outdoor run

RELATIVE EFFORT PER HOUR MOVING



KUDOS PER OUTING



HOW TO READ · RELATIVE EFFORT PER HOUR MOVING

Strava's relative effort, a score from my heart rate, divided by the hours moving, for each way of moving with enough scored outings. A longer bar means my heart worked harder for each hour.

HOW TO READ · KUDOS PER OUTING

The average kudos each kind of outing received. The line under each name is the PRs it set per outing.

DESIGN LESSON · THE SAME COLOUR, THE SAME MEANING

The colour of each bar follows a fixed code, and the same thing keeps the same colour in every chart where it appears. A reader learns the code once and can then read every chart that uses it.

In your own work. Fix one colour for each category across a whole report and never reuse a colour for something else.

THE STORY

Kudos grew over the years. In 2021 an outing got about 26 kudos on average. Since 2022 it has stayed between 34 and 42.

Hikes are left off the effort chart, because too few of them have a heart-rate score.

The two charts point in different directions. The treadmill is where my heart works hardest for each hour, and it gets fewer kudos than the trail runs. The trail runs score lower per hour, and they get the most cheers.

11 TWO SMALL FINDINGS

Longer runs, quicker km.

Two small findings surprised me. On the treadmill, my longer runs were quicker per kilometre. My usual 5 km went at 6:28 a km and my usual 21 km at 5:18. And over whole weeks, running and walking pulled against each other only a little: a big running week usually meant a bit less walking.

WHAT THE FITS FOUND

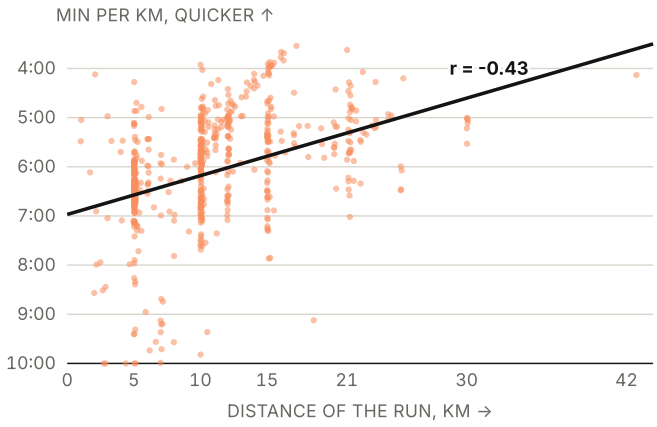
−0.43
treadmill distance against pace

5 s
quicker per km for each extra km

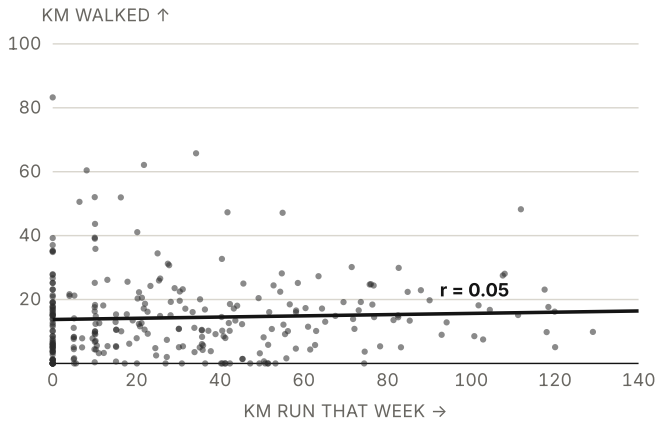
69 s
per km quicker at 21 km than at 5 km

0.05
weekly running km against walking km

TREADMILL RUNS: DISTANCE AGAINST PACE



EACH WEEK: KILOMETRES RUN AGAINST WALKED



HOW TO READ · TREADMILL RUNS: DISTANCE AGAINST PACE

Every treadmill run as a dot: across is the distance and up is the pace, with quicker kilometres higher. The line is the best straight fit through the dots, and the number on it shows how strong the link is, from 0 for none to 1 for a perfect line.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW EVERY POINT BEFORE THE SUMMARY

Every outing is a dot, and the fitted line comes after them. The line is a summary; the dots are the evidence. Seeing both shows how well the line fits, which a single number cannot.

In your own work. Never show a trend line without the points behind it, unless there are too many to draw.

HOW TO READ · EACH WEEK: KILOMETRES RUN AGAINST WALKED

Every week since 2021 as a dot: across is the kilometres I ran that week and up is the kilometres I walked. A flat line and a number near zero mean the two did not move together.

DESIGN LESSON · GIVE THE LINE ITS STRENGTH

A fitted line can look steep while the dots scatter widely around it. The correlation, r, where 0 means no link and 1 means every dot sits on the line, says how far the line can be trusted, so it is printed with the line.

In your own work. Print the strength of a relationship next to the line, and describe it in words: weak, moderate or strong.

THE STORY

The link on the treadmill is moderate, so it is a tendency and not a rule. Plenty of short runs were quick and some long ones were slow. On average, each extra kilometre came with about 5 seconds quicker per kilometre.

The weeks show a calm picture. A week with a lot of running could have almost any amount of walking. From one week to the next there is a small pull between the two, and The Habit on Trial tests it in case 10.

12 BIGGEST DAYS

Each sport’s biggest day.

TREADMILL RUN

42.7 km

the longest, a marathon indoors

1 MAY 2022

OUTDOOR RUN

31.0 km

the longest on the road

19 APR 2026

TRAIL RUN

34.8 km

the longest, with 841 m of climb

13 JAN 2024

WALK

30.0 km

the longest, with 833 m of climb

19 FEB 2025

HIKE

1,979 m

climbed in 16.1 km, the most of any outing

29 MAR 2025

RUNNING STREAK

45 days

in a row with a run or trail run

31 OCT 2024 TO 14 DEC 2024

CHAPTER 9

09 Records

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Something is better than nothing. Do what you can.”

Most of my records came early, when every outing was new ground. This chapter is about the edges of the record: the longest days, the biggest climbs, the quickest times and the records I have broken against myself, each one set against my own earlier days.

A record means little without the ordinary days around it, so the charts show each record inside the crowd it came from. The last sections ask a harder question: do my records break more often than chance would give? The answer is tested, and it is printed with the test.

Mtaka cha mvunguni sharti ainame, whoever wants what is under the bed must bend down. No record here came easily or from one day alone. Each one stands on the weeks of plain outings before it.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

The charts of this chapter are built to show extremes honestly. A record is drawn on top of every ordinary effort, a staircase holds each record flat until the day it falls, and a ring shows what chance alone would have given.

Against my own longest.

Records come fast when everything is new. In the first years the distance record kept moving: 10 km on my second day, a half marathon a few months later, 30 km in August 2021. Then came the marathon, run indoors on a loop, and nothing has beaten it since. It was raining outside that day and I wanted to break the marathon barrier, so I stayed indoors and took a few pauses. By the end I could not feel my fingernails. They were fine afterwards.

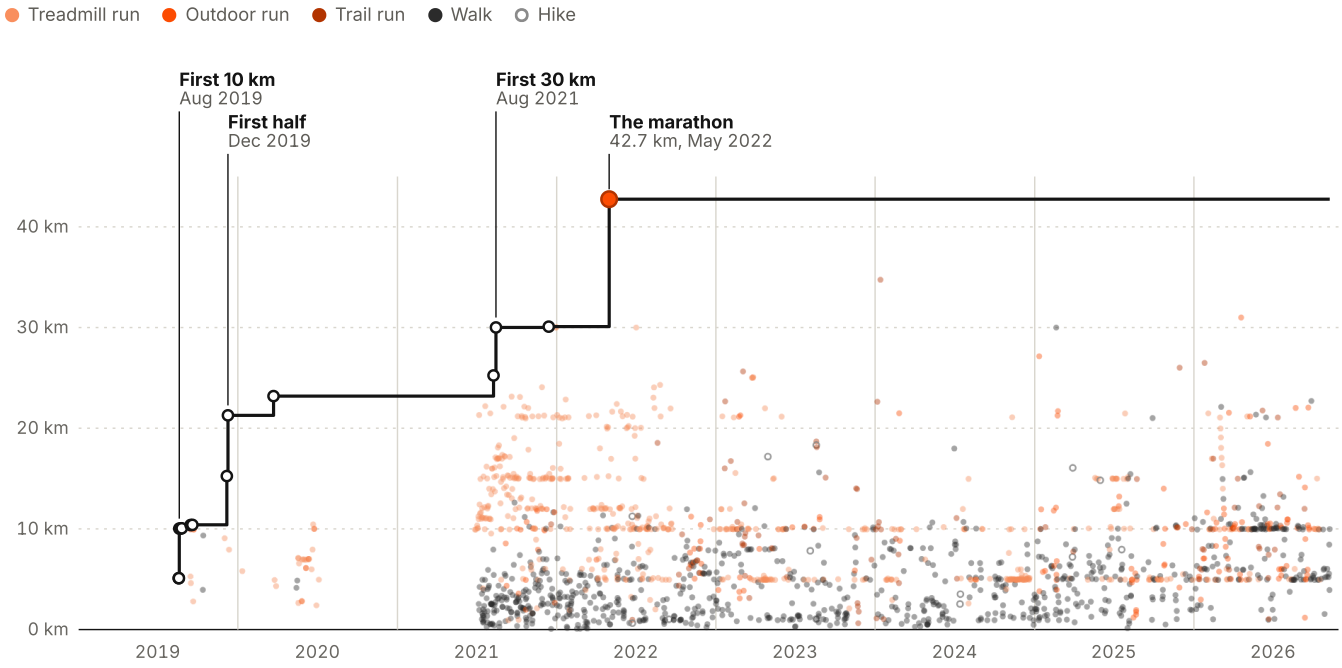
THE LONGEST OUTING ON FOOT

14
times the record broke

42.7 km
the record now

1,652 days
it has stood

1,228
outings since, none longer



HOW TO READ · THE DISTANCE RECORD

Each dot is one outing on foot, placed by its date and its distance and coloured by the way of moving. The staircase is my longest outing so far: it runs flat while the record holds and rises on the day a longer outing beats it.

HOW TO READ · READING THE STEPS

Tall steps close together mean the record was moving fast; a long flat stretch means it held. The dots under the staircase are every outing that did not beat it, so the gap between the cloud and the line shows how far a record sits above an ordinary day.

DESIGN LESSON · A STAIRCASE FOR RECORDS

Choose the shape of a line to match how the value really changes. A slope between two points says the value grew smoothly between them; a step says it stayed the same and then jumped. A record jumps, so a staircase is the honest shape.

In your own work. Use step lines for values that change in jumps: records, prices, rules.

The longest days.

The long days left the treadmill. Every run past 30 km on it came between August 2021 and July 2022, and since then the long days have all been outside. The longest of them is 34.8 km on the trails of Kilimanjaro, up to Mweka Gate, with more than 800 m of climbing.

LONG OUTINGS ON FOOT

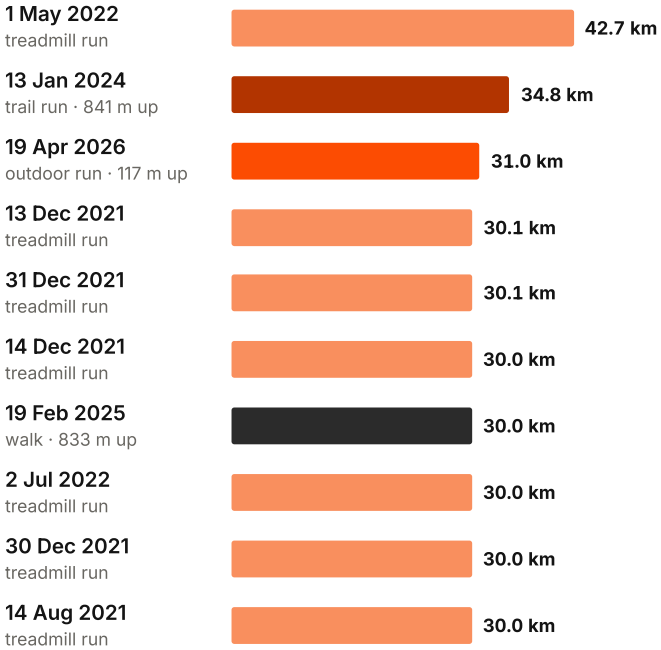
83
outings of 21.1 km or more

10
outings past 30 km

7
of those on a treadmill

30.0 km
the longest walk

THE TEN LONGEST OUTINGS



THE BIGGEST DAYS ON FOOT



HOW TO READ · THE TEN LONGEST OUTINGS

My ten longest single outings, longest at the top, with the date, the kind of outing and the climb where there was any.

HOW TO READ · THE BIGGEST DAYS ON FOOT

My biggest days on foot, adding up every outing of the day. The line under each date gives the number of outings and the time moving.

THE STORY

Seven of my ten longest outings were on the treadmill, all from August 2021 to July 2022, the months when I was building distance indoors. The others are newer, and they came outside: a trail run in January 2024, an outdoor run in April 2026 and a walk in February 2025.

My biggest days are not always one outing. The second biggest, 19 Feb 2025, was three outings that added up to 40.6 km. Only one day has ever gone past 42 km, and that is the marathon.

From walks to hikes.

My climbing records needed a bigger mountain each time. The first ten were all walks, the biggest only 665 m. Then the hikes took over, and the record climbed with them to almost 2,000 m in one day in Morogoro.

THE BIGGEST CLIMB ON FOOT

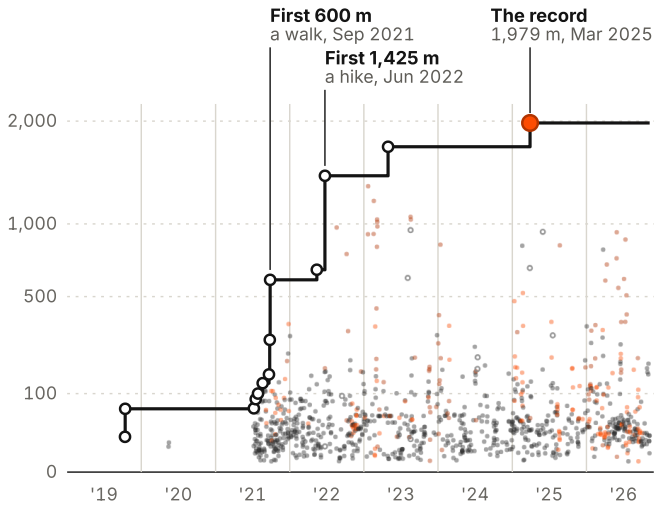
13
times the record broke

1,979 m
the record now

589 days
it has stood

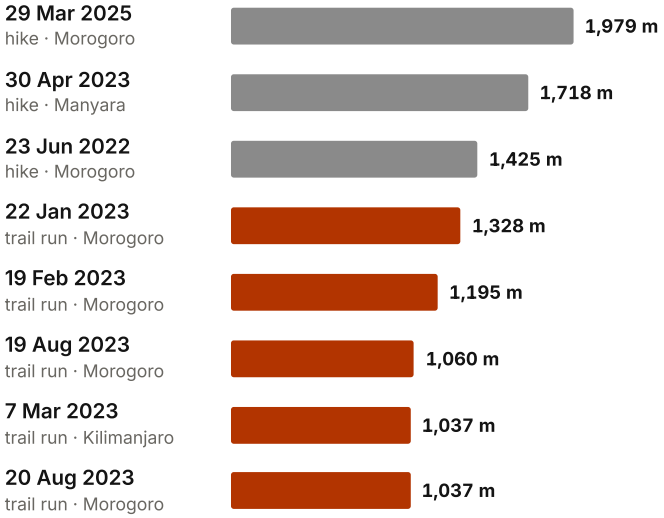
2,074 m
in one day, 19 Aug 2023

THE CLIMBING RECORD OVER TIME, IN METRES UP



The bottom of the scale is stretched so the small climbs show.

THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS



HOW TO READ · THE CLIMBING RECORD OVER TIME, IN METRES UP

Every outing that climbed, placed by its date and its metres up, with the record as a staircase. The scale squeezes the top so the small climbs can still be seen.

HOW TO READ · THE EIGHT BIGGEST CLIMBS

My eight biggest single climbs, biggest at the top, with the date, the kind of outing and the region.

THE STORY

For a long time the climbing record belonged to walks, and it grew a little at a time. The first hike changed that in one day: in June 2022 it more than doubled the record, to 1,425 m.

Six of my eight biggest climbs started in Morogoro. The hills there are where I went to climb, again and again.

March 2023 climbed the most.

Distance and climbing peaked in different seasons of my life. August 2021 gave me more than 550 km and almost no height, nearly all of it indoors: I was still chasing quick results after the comeback, with sessions morning and evening and a big Strava challenge that month, the Athletic Brewing 70.3. March 2023 gave me more than 5,000 m of climbing from under 300 km, most of it on Kilimanjaro.

THE BIGGEST STRETCHES

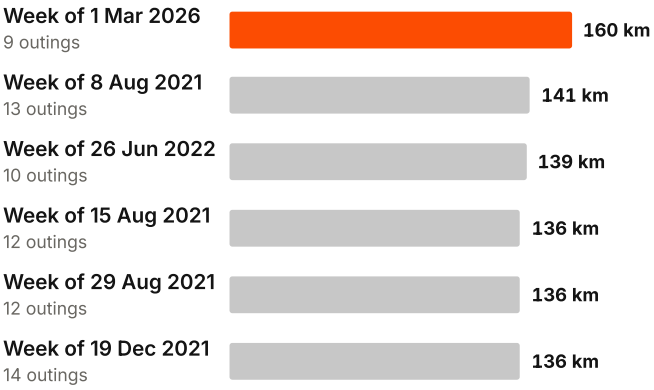
160 km
in the week of 1 Mar 2026

559 km
in August 2021

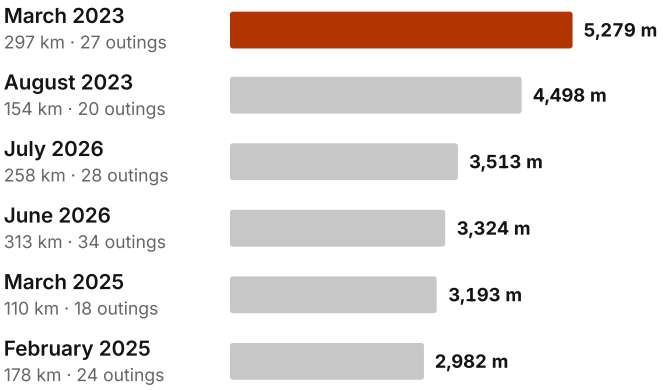
5,279 m
climbed in March 2023

60%
of an Everest in that month

THE BIGGEST WEEKS BY DISTANCE



THE BIGGEST MONTHS BY CLIMB



HOW TO READ · THE BIGGEST WEEKS BY DISTANCE

My biggest weeks by distance on foot, biggest at the top. The line under each week is the number of outings it took.

HOW TO READ · THE BIGGEST MONTHS BY CLIMB

My biggest months by climbing, with the distance and the number of outings that month.

THE STORY

My biggest week is a recent one, and it took only nine outings. The weeks just behind it are from 2021 and 2022, and they needed 10 to 14 outings each. The distance is the same, now in fewer and longer pieces.

Four of my six biggest climbing months come from the last two years. The hills used to be a 2023 story, and now they are a regular part of my year.

04 THE MOUNTAINS

Three records were set on mountains.

The highest point

Kilimanjaro, chapter 2

The longest day

Hanang, chapter 3

The biggest climb

Uluguru, chapter 4

The kilometres came faster.

Pole pole ndio mwendo, slowly is the way. The first 1,000 km took me two years, with the long gap inside them. The last 2,500 km took about a year, and each Everest of climbing now comes much sooner than the first did.

THE RUNNING TOTALS

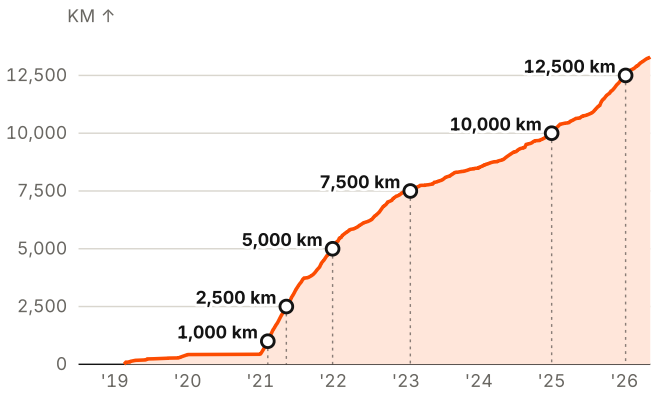
13,295 km
on foot in all

9.6
Everests climbed

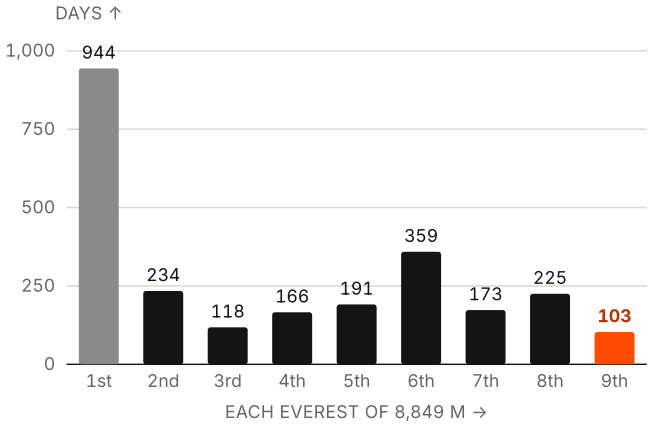
944 days
for the first Everest

103 days
for the ninth

KILOMETRES ON FOOT, ADDING UP



DAYS TO CLIMB EACH EVEREST



HOW TO READ · KILOMETRES ON FOOT, ADDING UP

The line adds up every kilometre on foot from the first day. Flat stretches are quiet times and steep stretches are busy ones. Each mark is a milestone, with the day it was passed.

HOW TO READ · DAYS TO CLIMB EACH EVEREST

Each bar is one Everest of climbing, 8,849 m, and its height is the days it took me to climb it. The lower the bar, the quicker it came.

DESIGN LESSON · MILESTONES AS DROPPED LINES

Each milestone is marked where the line crossed it, with a dashed line down to the date. The reader can read both how much and when without a table.

In your own work. Mark round-number milestones on a running total; they give the eye steps to climb.

THE STORY

The line is almost flat for its first two years. Then it turns steep: from 1,000 km on 7 Aug 2021 to 2,500 km on 8 Nov 2021, 1,500 km in about three months. That was the start of the habit, and it is still the steepest stretch of the whole line.

In 2023 and 2024 the line eases, the years of fewer kilometres and more hills. From 2025 it steepens again.

The Everests show the climbing side. The first took the longest by far, and most of those days came before I had ever climbed a hill. The latest came the quickest of all.

Beating my own times.

PRs come from going back to the same road. The Kilimanjaro Half gave me 18 in one morning in 2023, and I matched that on the same course every year since. A PR, short for personal record, here means I beat my own earlier time on a Strava segment, a short timed stretch of road or trail. The treadmill gives almost none, because segments need GPS.

SEGMENT BESTS ON FOOT

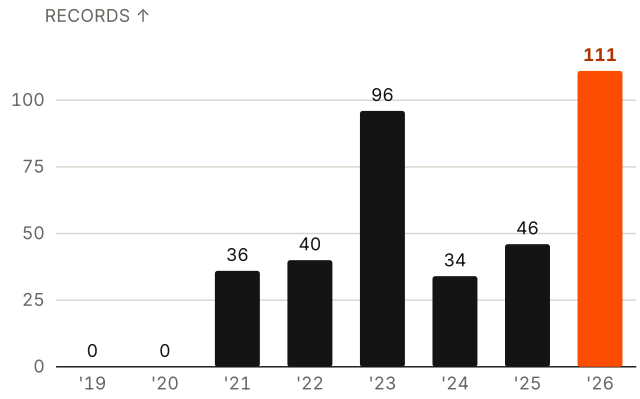
363
PRs in all

118
outings that set at least one

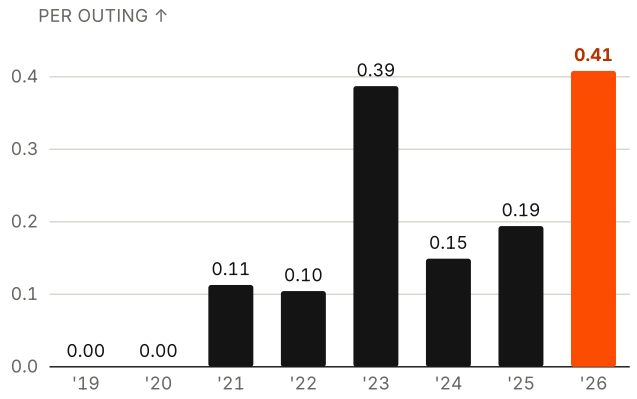
111
in 2026 so far

0.41
per outing in 2026

PRS, YEAR BY YEAR



PRS PER OUTING



HOW TO READ · PRS, YEAR BY YEAR
The number of PRs I set each year on Strava segments.

HOW TO READ · PRS PER OUTING
The same records divided by the outings of that year, so a busy year does not look better only because it had more outings.

THE STORY

Two years stand out, 2023 and 2026. In 2023 I went to the trails and the hills, and I ran the Kilimanjaro Half for the first time. In 2026 more of my running moved outside than ever before, and the records followed, the most of any year.

The right chart is the fair one. In 2021 and 2022 I did many outings, and almost all were on the treadmill, where there are no segments to beat. Per outing, those years are the lowest of the habit.

Every day since December 2025.

I started this streak on purpose, and I do not take it for granted: the same record holds the long gap, from July 2020 to June 2021, when I did not go out at all. Every week since December 2023 has had an outing, more than two years now.

IN A ROW

315 days
with an outing, still going

154 weeks
with at least one outing

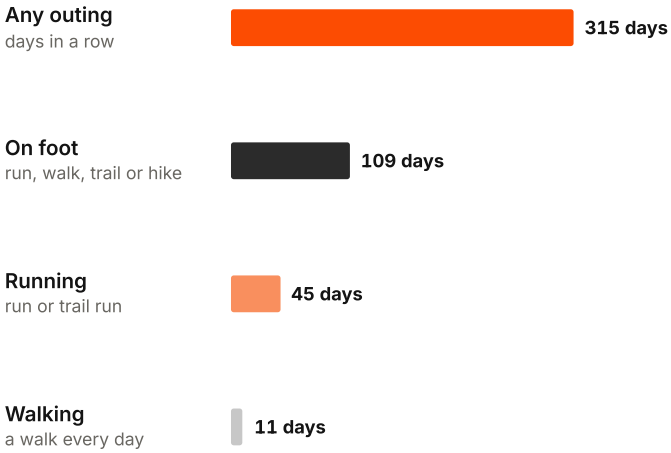
45 days
running in a row

353 days
the longest layoff

THE EIGHT LONGEST RUNS OF DAYS



THE BEST STREAK OF EACH KIND



HOW TO READ · THE EIGHT LONGEST RUNS OF DAYS

My eight longest streaks, longest at the top, with the month each began and the day it ended.

HOW TO READ · THE BEST STREAK OF EACH KIND

The best run of days for each kind of streak: any outing, any outing on foot, a run every day, and a walk every day.

THE STORY

The 315 days were never one sport. My longest run of days on foot is 109, so on some days of this streak the only outing was one of the other activities. It still counts as a day out, and it kept the chain.

Running and walking alone never come close. My longest running streak is 45 days and my longest walking streak 11. The habit holds because I can choose, day by day, whatever fits.

Morogoro has my big climbs.

Every big climb in my log needed a trip, to Morogoro, Kilimanjaro or Manyara, because the ground where I go out most is fairly flat. The hike on Hanang, in Manyara, went up more than 1,700 m and held the record for almost two years.

CLIMBS BY REGION OF TANZANIA

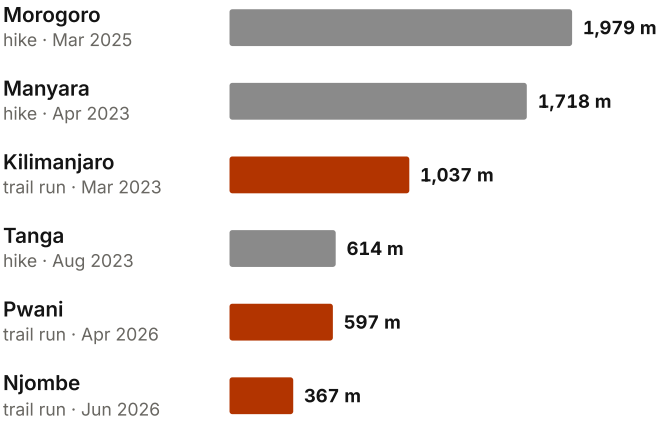
12
of the top 20 climbs in Morogoro

1,979 m
the biggest, in Morogoro

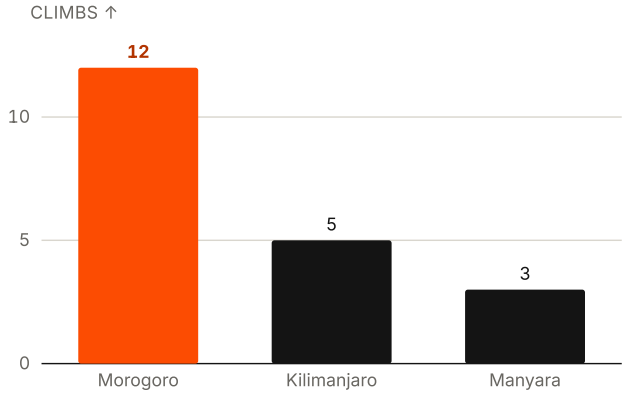
1,718 m
the biggest in Manyara

1,037 m
the biggest in Kilimanjaro

THE BIGGEST CLIMB IN EACH REGION



WHERE THE 20 BIGGEST CLIMBS STARTED



HOW TO READ · THE BIGGEST CLIMB IN EACH REGION

The biggest single climb in each region of Tanzania, with the kind of outing and the month.

HOW TO READ · WHERE THE 20 BIGGEST CLIMBS STARTED

Where my twenty biggest climbs started, counted by region.

THE STORY

None of my twenty biggest climbs started in Dodoma or Dar es Salaam, where I go out most. Every one of them needed a trip, to Morogoro, Kilimanjaro or Manyara.

Pwani and Njombe are on the list because of trips in 2026. Each new region I visit can add a line to this chart.

More records than chance.

My records were not luck alone. If my outings had come in a random order, the distance record would have broken far fewer times than it did. I was going further, slowly. The marathon has now stood for more than four years.

RECORDS AGAINST CHANCE

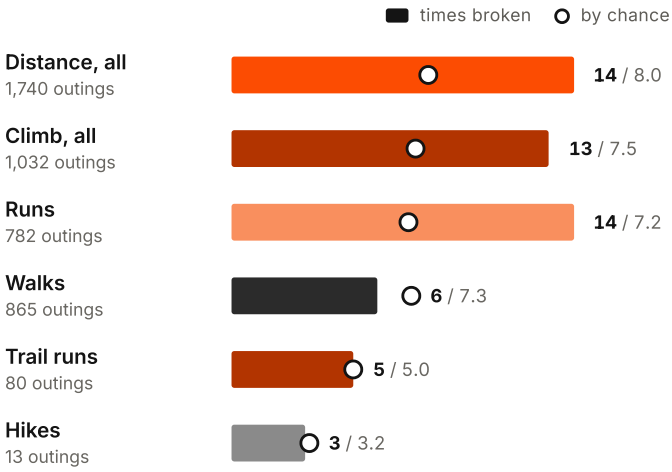
14
times the distance record broke

8.0
times chance would give

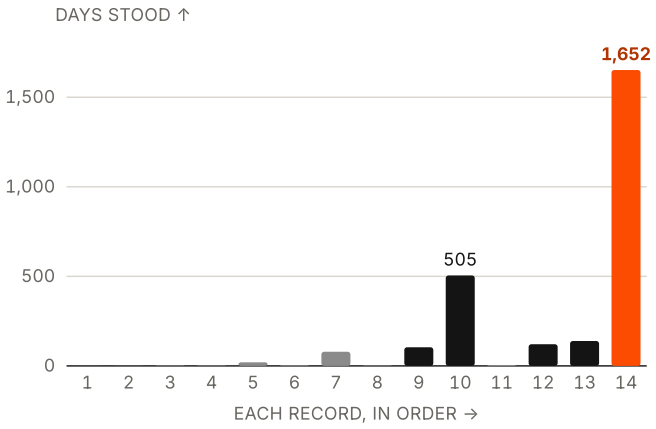
1.9×
chance, for runs alone

29%
chance the record would stand this long

TIMES EACH RECORD BROKE, AGAINST CHANCE



HOW LONG EACH DISTANCE RECORD STOOD



HOW TO READ · TIMES EACH RECORD BROKE, AGAINST CHANCE

Each row is a kind of record. The bar is how many times it actually broke, and the ring is how many times it would break, on average, if the same outings had come in a random order. A bar past its ring broke more often than chance.

DESIGN LESSON · COMPARE WITH WHAT CHANCE WOULD GIVE

A count on its own cannot be called high or low. Setting it next to what a random order of the same outings would give turns it into an answer: above chance or not.

In your own work. Show the expected value next to the observed one. Without it, a count has nothing to be measured against.

HOW TO READ · HOW LONG EACH DISTANCE RECORD STOOD

Each bar is one distance record, in order, and its height is the days it stood before the next one beat it. The last bar, still standing, is the marathon.

THE STORY

Runs broke their record almost twice as often as chance would give. That is the shape of real progress: I was going further over time, so new bests kept coming. Walks are the exception, 6 times against 7.3, close to chance.

The tall bar in the middle is the 23.2 km run of March 2020. It stood for 505 days, right through the long layoff, until I came back and beat it.

10 ALL MY RECORDS

My record book.

LONGEST OUTING

42.7 km

a marathon indoors, on a loop

1 MAY 2022

BIGGEST CLIMB

1,979 m

a hike of 16.1 km

29 MAR 2025

BIGGEST DAY OF CLIMB

2,074 m

the Selous Trail Marathon in Morogoro, 39.4 km

19 AUG 2023

BIGGEST WEEK

160 km

the countdown to the Kilimanjaro Half

WEEK OF 1 MAR 2026

BIGGEST MONTH

559 km

from 59 outings

AUGUST 2021

LONGEST STREAK

315 days

in a row, still going

FROM 29 DEC 2025

CHAPTER 10

10 Where

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Taking ownership of your life is not easy, and living a life of discipline is not easy. In fact, it is hard. That is why it works.”

To climb, I have to travel. This chapter is about the ground under the outings: most of my record is in Tanzania, a few regions carry most of the outings, and a few others carry most of the climbing.

The chapter moves from the country to the regions and then outside the border, to the other African countries where I went out on foot. It also counts the outings with no place at all, the ones on the treadmill with no GPS start.

The flat ground is where the habit lives from day to day. The hills are where I go to test it, and the two kinds of place give two very different kinds of outing.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

Maps are the obvious chart for places, and this chapter uses them, shaded on a log scale so home does not wash out everywhere else. But a map is poor at ranking, so every map comes with ranked bars or a list beside it.

ACROSS AFRICA

94% began in Tanzania.

I do not travel much, and my trips are short. Most of my trips across the border came in 2024, when a remote job and a few consultancies took me away. Three outings abroad I count as others.

THE OUTINGS BY PLACE

5
countries with an outing

1,092
outings in Tanzania

73
outings outside Tanzania

911
outings with no GPS start

AFRICA, BY OUTINGS



less more outings none

EACH COUNTRY, BUSIEST FIRST

1,092 Tanzania
5,901 km on foot · 82,166 m up · 897 days
first on foot Aug 2019

32 Kenya
98 km on foot · 1,625 m up · 25 days
first on foot Dec 2022

23 Malawi
49 km on foot · 586 m up · 19 days
first on foot Oct 2024

13 South Africa
17 km on foot · 288 m up · 8 days
first on foot Apr 2024

2 Rwanda
15 km on foot · 281 m up · 2 days
first on foot Aug 2024

3 Others
4 km on foot · 71 m up · 3 days
from Apr 2024

DESIGN LESSON · A LOG SCALE ON A MAP

Home has so many outings that a straight colour scale would paint it dark and leave every other region pale. A log scale gives each tenfold step the same change in shade.

In your own work. When one place dominates a map, shade it on a log scale and say so in the key.

DESIGN LESSON · A LIST CAN BE THE CHART

The countries are set as a ledger, busiest first, with the count in a large figure and the details in small type under each name. With a handful of rows, a well-set list is clearer than any bars.

In your own work. When there are only a few items and each has several facts, set them as a ranked list with one big number per row.

Three places carry most of it.

Dodoma is where the habit took hold. I started going out there a few weeks after I came back, and it still holds more of my days out than anywhere else. In 2026 Dar es Salaam took the lead. Kilimanjaro and Morogoro are for the hills, and most other regions came from trips.

INSIDE TANZANIA

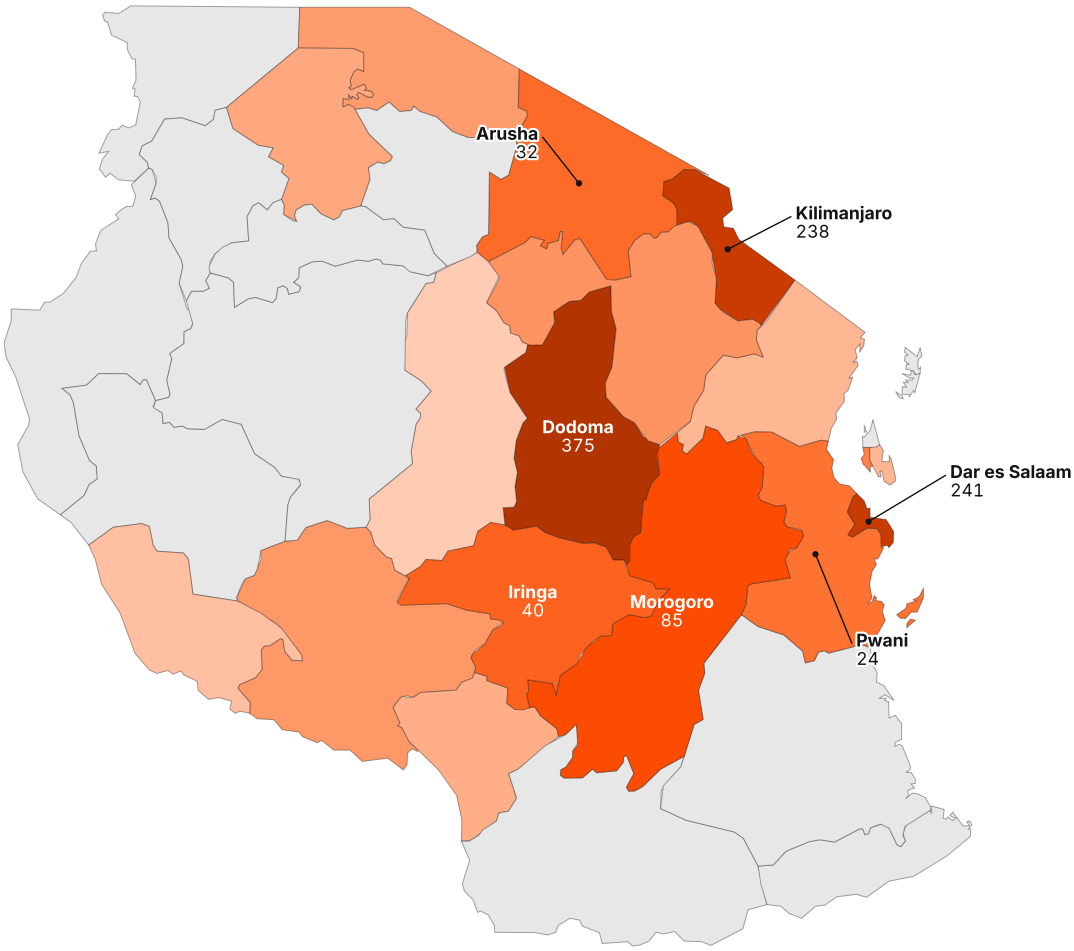
17
regions with an outing

34%
of the outings in Dodoma

37%
of the climb in Kilimanjaro

897 days
out in Tanzania

TANZANIA, BY REGION



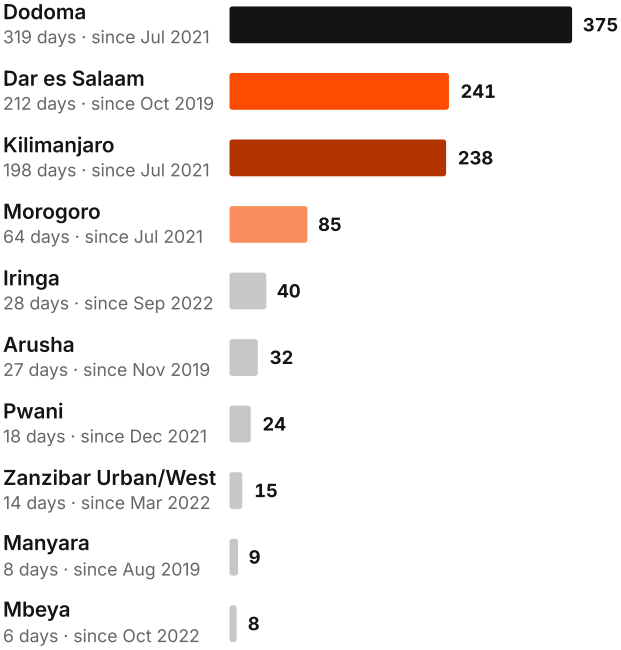
less more outings none

DESIGN LESSON · NAME THE PLACES ON THE MAP

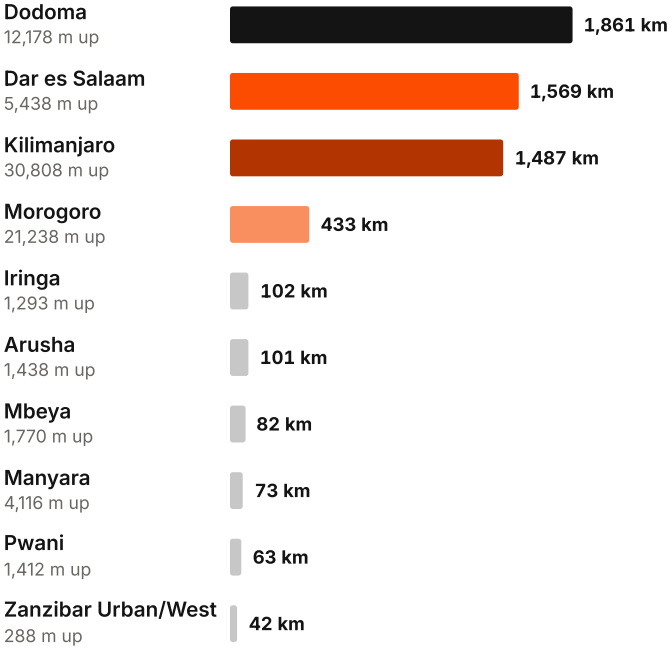
Only the places the story needs are named, right on the map, with a thin leader line where a place is too small to hold its name. The places with nothing logged stay pale grey and unnamed, so the eye goes to where the outings are.

In your own work. Label a few places directly on a map and let the rest stay quiet. A map with every name printed reads like an atlas.

OUTINGS BY REGION



KILOMETRES ON FOOT BY REGION



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS BY REGION

My ten busiest regions by the number of outings that started there. The line under each name gives the days I went out there and the month of my first outing.

HOW TO READ · KILOMETRES ON FOOT BY REGION

The same regions ranked by the kilometres I covered on foot there. The line under each name gives the metres climbed.

THE STORY

The map above is shaded by outings, so the darker a region, the more often I went out there. Dodoma, Dar es Salaam and Kilimanjaro stand out, and most of the country is still pale or empty.

Dar es Salaam and Kilimanjaro have almost the same number of outings, 241 and 238. The difference is the ground. Kilimanjaro climbed 30,808 m and Dar es Salaam 5,438 m, so Kilimanjaro gave about 6 times as much. One is flat and busy, and the other is where I go for the hills.

The climbing is in two regions.

To climb, I have to travel. Dar es Salaam gives me about 3.5 m of climbing for every kilometre. Morogoro gives 49, so one kilometre there climbs as much as 14 in Dar es Salaam. Most of my trail runs and hikes, 64 of them, started in those hilly regions.

METRES CLIMBED FOR EACH KILOMETRE

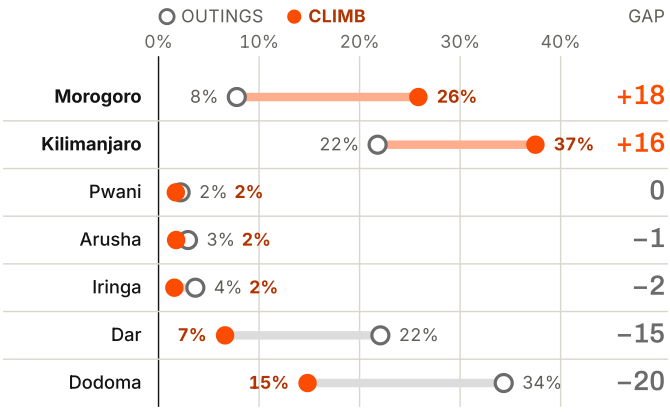
49 m
per km in Morogoro

21 m
per km in Kilimanjaro

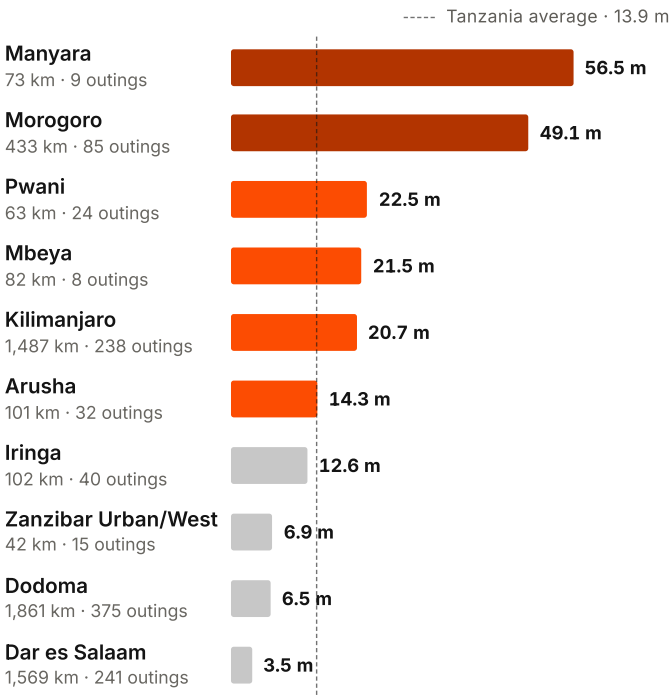
6.5 m
per km in Dodoma

3.5 m
per km in Dar es Salaam

SHARE OF THE OUTINGS AGAINST SHARE OF THE CLIMB



METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE, BY REGION



HOW TO READ · SHARE OF THE OUTINGS AGAINST SHARE OF THE CLIMB

Each region has two bars: the first is its share of my outings in Tanzania, the second its share of my climbing. The number at the end is the gap. A region with more climb than outings is hilly ground.

HOW TO READ · METRES CLIMBED PER KILOMETRE, BY REGION

The metres I climbed for every kilometre on foot in each region, steepest at the top. The dashed line is the average for all of Tanzania. Regions with fewer than eight outings are left out.

THE STORY

Manyara is the steepest region in my log, but I have been out there only nine times. Morogoro is the steep region I know well, with 85 outings.

Dodoma, where I have gone out the most, climbs 6.5 m for every kilometre, below the Tanzania average of 13.9 m.

Dodoma led for four years.

My busiest region moves with my work and my trips: Dodoma from 2021 to 2024, Kilimanjaro in 2025 and Dar es Salaam in 2026.

THE LEAD, YEAR BY YEAR

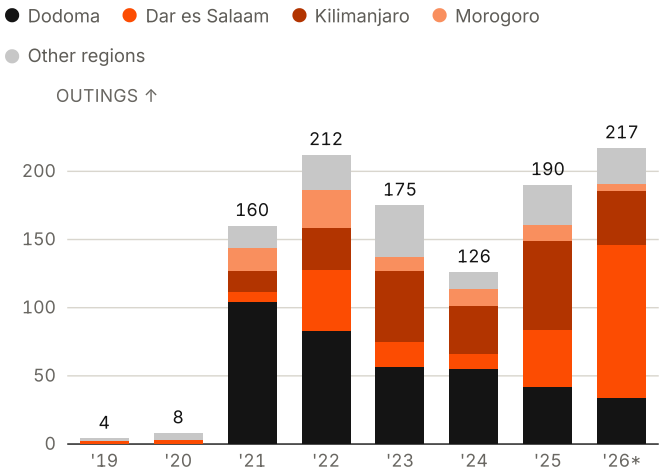
33%
Dodoma in 2023

44%
Dodoma in 2024

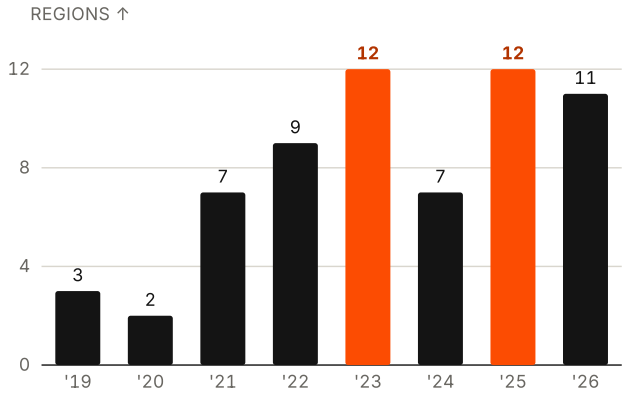
34%
Kilimanjaro in 2025

52%
Dar es Salaam in 2026 so far

OUTINGS IN TANZANIA BY REGION, YEAR BY YEAR



REGIONS VISITED EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS IN TANZANIA BY REGION, YEAR BY YEAR

Each column is a year of outings in Tanzania, split by region, with the busiest regions in their own colours and the rest together. The number on top is the year's total.

HOW TO READ · REGIONS VISITED EACH YEAR

The number of regions of Tanzania I went out in each year. The orange bar is the widest year.

THE STORY

Kilimanjaro and Morogoro appear in every year since the comeback. Those are my hill trips, and I go back each year.

2023 and 2025 were my widest years, with outings in twelve regions. Those were years of many short trips around the country.

17 regions in 7 years.

Every new region came with a trip, so they arrived in bunches, in the years I travelled. The latest is Singida, my seventeenth. Fourteen of the 31 are still waiting. The newest came from trips I chose: a 15 km race at the Kalambo Falls tourism festival in Rukwa, the trails of Kitulo National Park in Njombe, a place on my list for many years that I will go back to, and a visit to a friend in Singida, looking for hills near Dodoma that I can reach often, the way I reach Morogoro.

NEW REGIONS

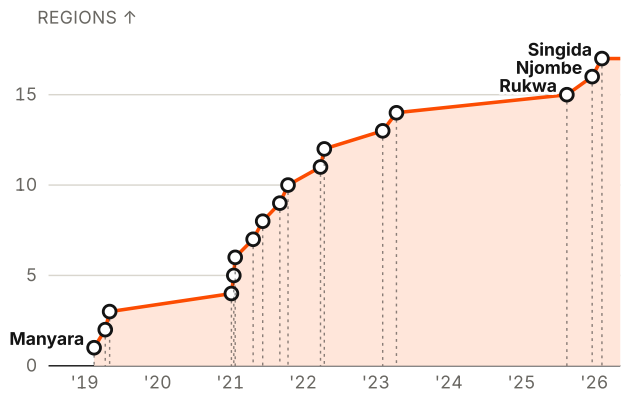
17
regions of 31 with an outing

5
new in 2021, the most

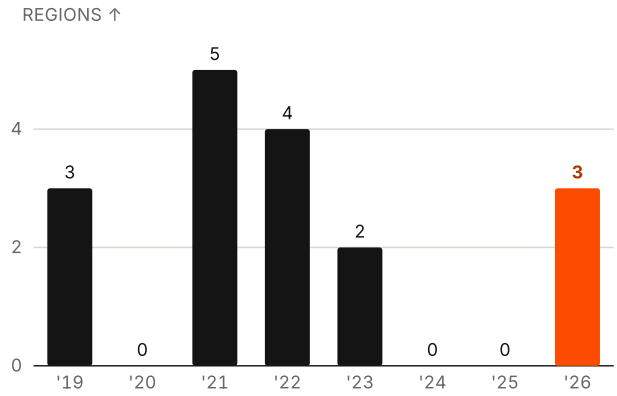
3
new in 2026 so far

13
regions still blank

REGIONS WITH AN OUTING, ADDING UP



NEW REGIONS EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · REGIONS WITH AN OUTING, ADDING UP
The line counts the regions where I had gone out at least once, rising by one each time I went out in a new region. The labels name the first region and the newest ones.

HOW TO READ · NEW REGIONS EACH YEAR
The number of new regions in each year.

THE STORY

The map grew in bunches. 2021 brought five new regions as I came back and started to travel again: Kilimanjaro, Dodoma, Morogoro, Mwanza and Pwani.

Then it went quiet. In 2024 and 2025 there was no new region at all, because my trips went across the border or back to places I already knew. In 2026 it grew again with Rukwa, Njombe and Singida.

73 outings outside Tanzania.

The habit travels with me. Even on a trip of a few days, I find time to go out. In Malawi I went out 23 times in two months: walking to work and back, a morning walk alone in the forest at the Lilongwe Wildlife Centre, and a day walking the course with friends during a tournament at Lilongwe Golf Club. In South Africa a consultancy left time for a tour of Pilanesberg National Park and a morning walk to Waterfall City in Sandton. Kenya was the first, in July 2020, and in December 2022 I went back with a group to Naivasha and the Masai Mara. The other three I count as others.

OUTSIDE TANZANIA

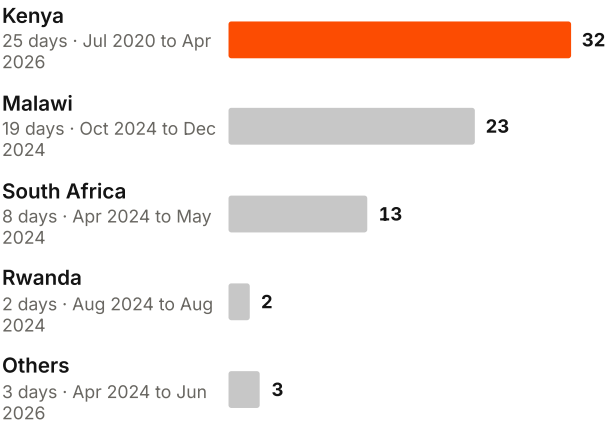
73 outings outside Tanzania

4 other countries

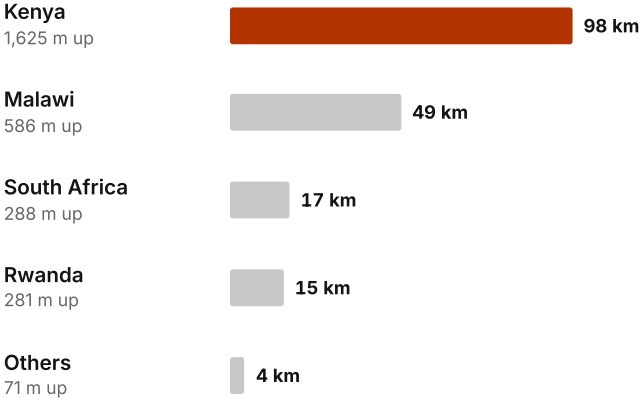
184 km on foot abroad

57 days out abroad

OUTINGS IN EACH COUNTRY



KILOMETRES ON FOOT IN EACH COUNTRY



HOW TO READ · OUTINGS IN EACH COUNTRY

My outings in each country outside Tanzania, busiest at the top. The line under each name gives the days out there and the months of the first and last outing.

HOW TO READ · KILOMETRES ON FOOT IN EACH COUNTRY

The kilometres I covered on foot in each country, with the metres climbed underneath.

THE STORY

Kenya was my first country outside Tanzania, in July 2020. 2024 brought three new countries in one year: Malawi, South Africa and Rwanda.

Kenya is the country I have returned to, in more than one year.

Malawi, South Africa and Rwanda each came in one year only.

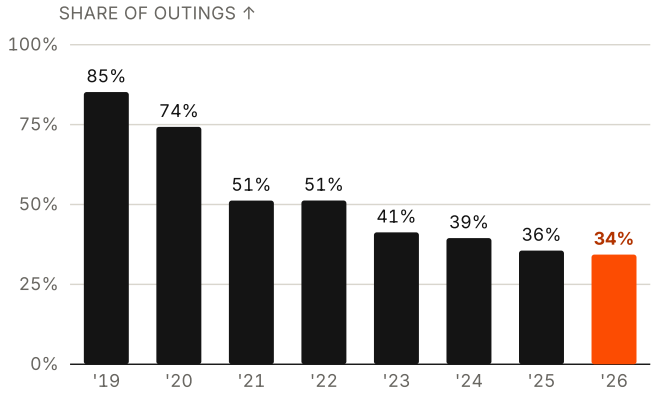
Fewer outings without GPS.

As I moved outside, the maps filled in. In my first year nearly every outing was on the treadmill, with no start point to place on a map. Each year since, those indoor outings have been a smaller part.

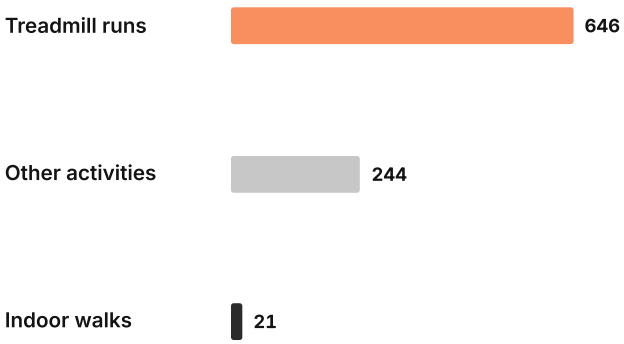
OUTINGS WITH NO GPS START

911	646	85%	34%
outings in all	treadmill runs	of 2019 outings	of 2026 outings so far

SHARE OF EACH YEAR WITH NO GPS START



WHAT THE OUTINGS WITH NO PLACE WERE



HOW TO READ · SHARE OF EACH YEAR WITH NO GPS START

The share of each year's outings that had no GPS start, so they could not be placed on a map.

HOW TO READ · WHAT THE OUTINGS WITH NO PLACE WERE

What those outings were. Most are treadmill runs, then other activities, and only a few indoor walks.

THE STORY

Indoor walks are rare, only 21 in all, so almost every walk I have done has a place on the map. The treadmill runs are the big gap in the maps, and they are also the reason the first years look so empty there.

As the share without GPS fell, every chart in this chapter grew more complete. In 2026 so far, 66% of my outings have a place.

How widely they spread.

My outings are more spread across Tanzania than they used to be. In my narrowest year, Dodoma had 65% of my outings. Later years spread out as I travelled and as my busiest region moved.

HOW THE OUTINGS SPREAD

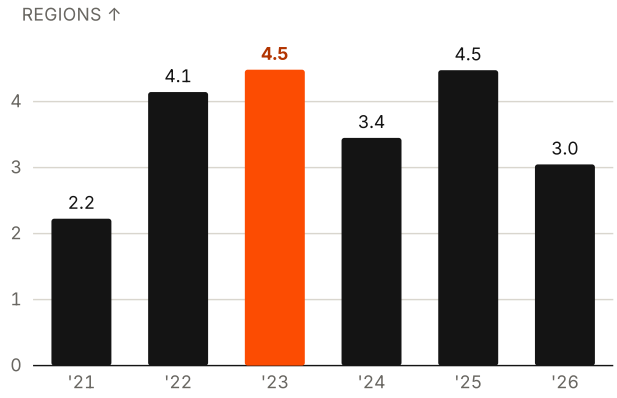
4.5
as spread out as this many equal regions

4.5
in 2023, the widest

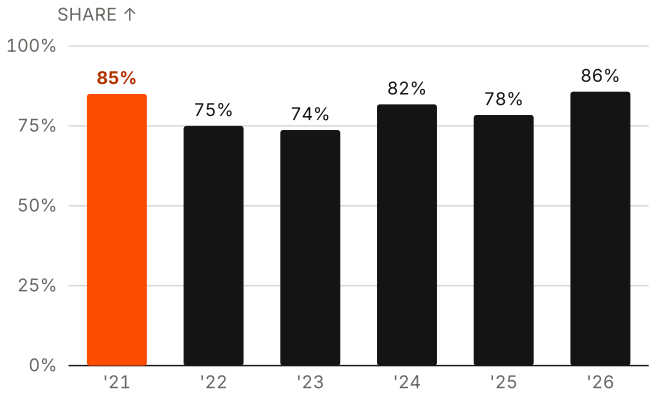
2.2
in 2021, the narrowest

78%
of outings in the busiest three

HOW SPREAD OUT EACH YEAR WAS



SHARE OF THE OUTINGS IN THE TOP THREE REGIONS



A year that scores four is as spread out as four regions with equal shares. Years with fewer than 50 outings in Tanzania are left out.

HOW TO READ · HOW SPREAD OUT EACH YEAR WAS

The effective number of regions for each year. If a year shows four, my outings were spread as if they had been shared equally between four regions. Higher means more spread out.

HOW TO READ · SHARE OF THE OUTINGS IN THE TOP THREE REGIONS

The share of each year's outings in Tanzania that were in my three busiest regions of that year.

THE STORY

The two charts tell the same story from two sides. When the effective number goes up, the share of the top three goes down.

Even in my widest years, three regions held at least 74% of my outings. Most of my life on foot happens in a few places, and the trips add a little colour around them.

CHAPTER 11

11 Timeline

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“Ease is a greater threat to progress than hardship.”

DENZEL WASHINGTON

The gaps tell as much as the outings. This chapter lays the whole record along one line of time, from my first upload to the last day in this edition, and it watches where the habit broke and how it came back.

The first sections look at the breaks: how long they were and how they became shorter. Then the chapter follows the change from the treadmill to the hills, and it ends with a chronicle of the moments that mattered, each one in its place on the line.

Pole pole ndio mwendo, slowly is the way to go. The timeline shows that the habit did not appear in one day. It grew over seasons, with a long silence in the middle.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

A timeline is the simplest chart there is, and the hardest to keep readable when many things happen. The chronicle in this chapter solves it with lanes: one row for each kind of event, all sharing the same time axis.

AUG 2019 TO NOV 2026

No long gap since then.

A habit gets easier the longer you keep it. The first 500 outings took me almost three years. The last 500 took eighteen months. My 2,000th outing was also my fiftieth trip to Ras Kilomoni, the target I set for this year. I was happy when the two landed on the same day, and I had waited patiently for Strava's badge for it. That milestone is why this site exists: I wanted to tell the story once I reached it.

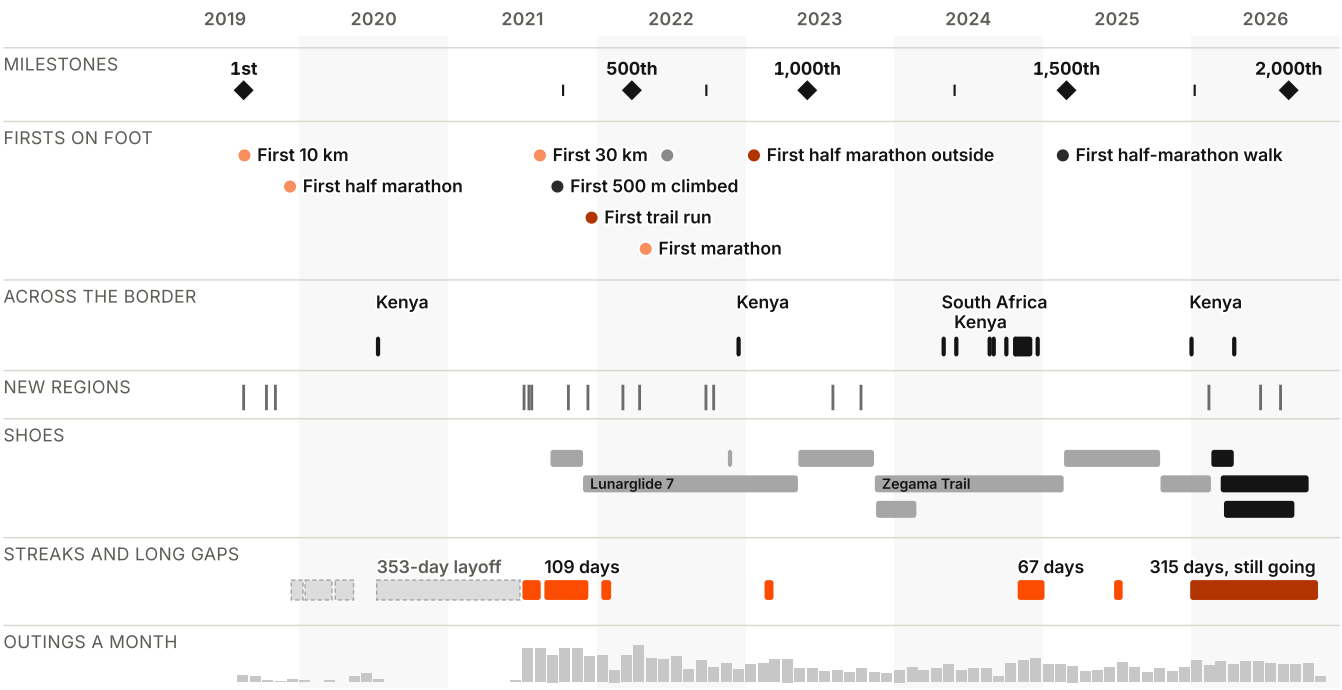
THE RECORD IN TIME

2,641 days
from the first outing to the latest

2,076
outings in that time

353 days
the silence, Jul 2020 to Jun 2021

10 days
the longest layoff since



◆ every 500th outing, ticks every 250th · ● treadmill run · ● outdoor run · ● trail run · ● walk · ○ hike · ▬ a trip across the border · ▬ a pair of shoes, black while still in use · ▬ streaks of 20 days or more · ▬ layoffs of 30 days or more

DESIGN LESSON · LANES FOR DIFFERENT KINDS OF EVENTS

Time runs left to right, and each lane holds one kind of moment: milestones, firsts, trips, shoes, streaks. Sorting events into lanes keeps a busy timeline readable, because the eye can follow one kind at a time or read straight down for one moment.

In your own work. For a timeline with many kinds of events, give each kind its own row on a shared time axis.

Shorter breaks.

Once the habit settled, the gaps closed. The first 250 outings took me more than two years, with the long gap inside them. Since then every 250 has come in less than a year, and the breaks between outings got shorter too. In 2026 so far there has been no break at all.

EVERY 250 OUTINGS

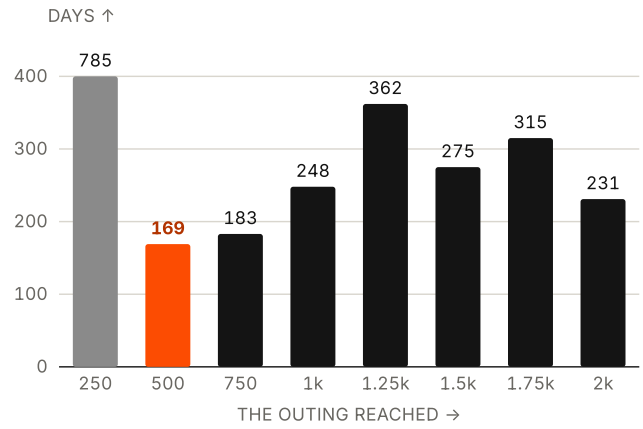
785 days
to the 250th

169 days
the quickest 250, to the 500th

362 days
the slowest since, to the 1,250th

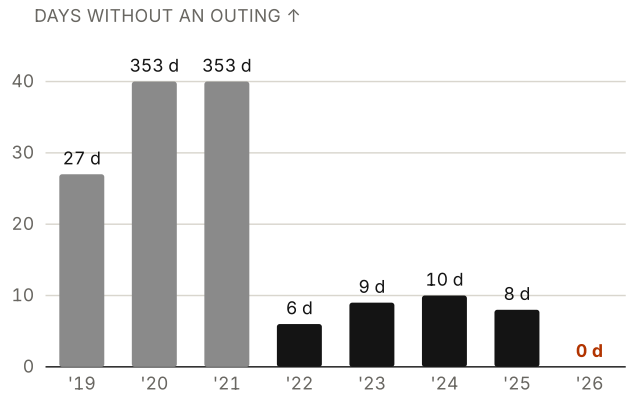
231 days
to the 2,000th, the latest

DAYS TO EACH 250 OUTINGS



The first bar includes the long gap, so it is cut off.

THE LONGEST BREAK EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · DAYS TO EACH 250 OUTINGS

Each bar is the number of days it took me to log 250 more outings, in order from the first 250 to the latest. A shorter bar means those outings came faster.

HOW TO READ · THE LONGEST BREAK EACH YEAR

The longest gap between two outings in each year, counted in full even when it runs across New Year. The long layoff covers parts of 2020 and 2021, so those two bars run off the top: the scale stops at 40 days so the small gaps can still be seen.

THE STORY

The faint bars under the chronicle above are my outings in each month. In the first two years they are thin and broken, and then comes the empty stretch of the long layoff. After I came back the row never drops to zero again: 66 months in a row, each with at least one outing.

Since the comeback my longest layoff in any year has been ten days, and layoffs of a week or more have happened 9 times in all. In 2026 so far there has been none.

At my pace now, 250 outings take about 8 months. The bars are not getting shorter every time, and that is fine. Since I took on longer outings, a day of one outing counts the same as a day of two, and the chain matters more than the count.

From the treadmill to the hills.

New firsts are harder to find now. My distance firsts, the 10 km, the half marathon, 30 km and the marathon, all came indoors, where there is no terrain or weather to fight, so I pushed further to make each session count. The later ones needed a trail, a hill or a long walk outside. My first trail run was a trail race around Lake Duluti in Arusha, through the forest, when a group of friends I trained with every day decided to go out and explore.

FIRSTS ON FOOT

10
firsts on foot

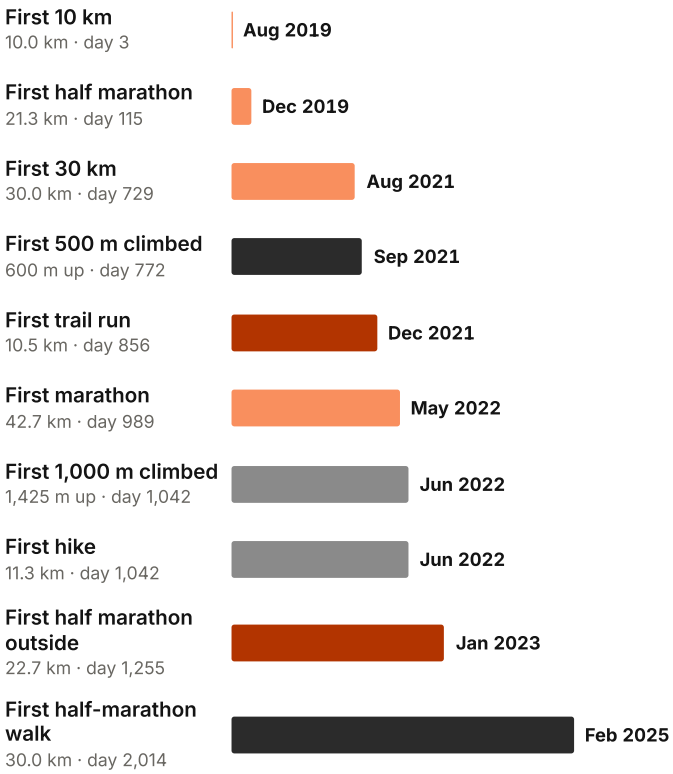
4
of them on the treadmill

3
in 2021, the most in a year

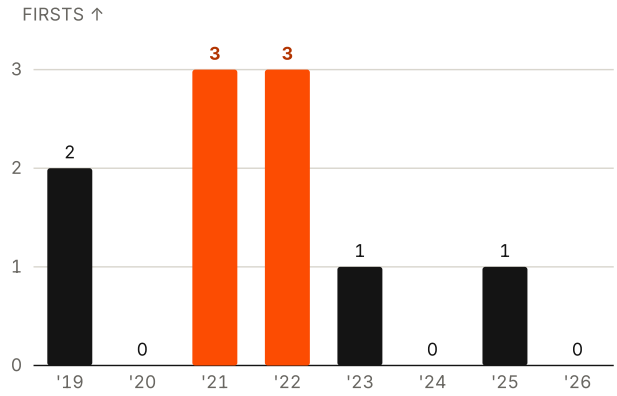
5.5 years
from the first to the latest

HOW LONG EACH FIRST TOOK

Treadmill run · Outdoor run · Trail run · Walk · Hike



FIRSTS EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · HOW LONG EACH FIRST TOOK

Each bar is one first on foot, and its length is how many days into my log it came. The colour shows how I did it, and the line under each name gives the detail and the day of the log.

HOW TO READ · FIRSTS EACH YEAR

The number of firsts in each year. Years with none are grey.

THE STORY

Eight of my ten firsts came by the end of 2022. Since then they have come one at a time, each one needing a trip or a long day.

There has been no new first in 2026 yet. This year is about the days, and every day so far has had an outing.

03 YEAR BY YEAR

55 moments in seven years.

2019

17 Aug — ◆ MILESTONE
My first outing
where my log starts

12 Oct — NEW REGION
Dar es Salaam
region 2 of 31

17 Aug — NEW REGION
Manyara
region 1 of 31

3 Nov — NEW REGION
Arusha
region 3 of 31

19 Aug — FIRST ON FOOT
First 10 km
10.0 km

9 Dec — FIRST ON FOOT
First half marathon
21.3 km

2020

15 Jan — SILENCE
67 days with nothing
back out on 22 Mar 2020

7 Jul — FIRST TRIP TO
Kenya
1 day out on that trip

9 Jul — SILENCE
353 days away
a new job, a move and COVID-19, then back on 27 Jun 2021

2021

2 Jul — STREAK
46 days in a row
to 16 Aug 2021

25 Jul — NEW REGION
Morogoro
region 6 of 31

9 Sep — NEW SHOES
Air Zoom Pegasus 37
1,204 km in them

28 Nov — NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 7
1,778 km in them

6 Jul — NEW REGION
Kilimanjaro
region 4 of 31

14 Aug — FIRST ON FOOT
First 30 km
30.0 km

26 Sep — FIRST ON FOOT
First 500 m climbed
600 m up

10 Dec — NEW REGION
Pwani
region 8 of 31

18 Jul — NEW REGION
Dodoma
region 5 of 31

25 Aug — STREAK
109 days in a row
to 11 Dec 2021

23 Oct — NEW REGION
Mwanza
region 7 of 31

19 Dec — FIRST ON FOOT
First trail run
10.5 km

2022

6 Mar — NEW REGION
Zanzibar Urban/West
region 9 of 31

1 May — FIRST ON FOOT
First marathon
42.7 km

26 Sep — NEW REGION
Iringa
region 11 of 31

28 Mar — ◆ MILESTONE
My 500th outing
169 days after the 250th

23 Jun — FIRST ON FOOT
First 1,000 m climbed
1,425 m up

15 Oct — NEW REGION
Mbeya
region 12 of 31

16 Apr — NEW REGION
Mara
region 10 of 31

23 Jun — FIRST ON FOOT
First hike
11.3 km

19 Nov — NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 6
25 km in them

2023

22 Jan — FIRST ON FOOT
First half marathon outside
22.7 km

2 Jun — MILESTONE
My 1,000th outing
248 days after the 750th

15 Nov — NEW SHOES
Zegama Trail
697 km in them

9 Mar — FIRST ON FOOT
Uhuru Peak
the top of Kilimanjaro, first attempt

4 Aug — NEW REGION
Tanga
region 13 of 31

18 Nov — NEW SHOES
Pegasus Trail (ZoomX)
127 km in them

11 May — NEW SHOES
Lunarglide 5
140 km in them

12 Oct — NEW REGION
Zanzibar Central/South
region 14 of 31

2024

27 Apr — FIRST TRIP TO
South Africa
8 days out on that trip

31 Oct — STREAK
67 days in a row
to 5 Jan 2025

18 Aug — FIRST TRIP TO
Rwanda
2 days out on that trip

20 Oct — FIRST TRIP TO
Malawi
16 days out on that trip

2025

19 Feb — FIRST ON FOOT
First half-marathon walk
30.0 km

17 Oct — NEW SHOES
Everun XT 900
588 km in them

22 Feb — NEW SHOES
Charged Impulse
1,027 km in them

29 Dec — STREAK
315 days in a row
and still going

28 Feb — MILESTONE
My 1,500th outing
275 days after the 1,250th

2026

13 Feb — NEW REGION
Rukwa
region 15 of 31

22 Mar — NEW SHOES
Juniper Trail
180 km in them, and still wearing them

28 Aug — MILESTONE
My 2,000th outing
231 days after the 1,750th

19 Feb — NEW SHOES
Zoom Winflo 5
520 km in them, and still wearing them

20 Jun — NEW REGION
Njombe
region 16 of 31

8 Nov — MILESTONE
2,076 outings
my latest on record

14 Mar — NEW SHOES
Comfort Footbed
565 km in them, and still wearing them

8 Aug — NEW REGION
Singida
region 17 of 31

12 Goals

FROM THE LOGBOOK

> “I wanted to show that it is beautiful to be strong, to have drive, to have will, to not fail, to give it your all.”
>
> KERSTIE ENNIS

A target helps only if I can check it in my head on an ordinary morning. Each year I aim for three on foot: a distance walked, a distance run and a height climbed. This chapter follows them year by year, shows the day each one was met, and estimates the chance of meeting the ones still open this year.

It also has two goals of a different kind. One is a race I have run again and again on the same course, which makes it a fair test of one year against another. The other is a place I set out to reach fifty times. Near the end comes a goal I never set, the unbroken chain of months with at least one outing.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

Goals have a clear shape: met or not met, ahead or behind. The charts of this chapter use that shape. Rings close when a target is met, grey years race against the year in progress, and a forecast is shown as many possible endings to the year rather than one line.

THREE TARGETS, EVERY YEAR SINCE 2021

One of three rings closed so far.

Each year I aim for the same three targets: 1,200 km walking, 1,200 km running and 24,000 m of climbing on foot. That is about 100 km a month of each, and 2,000 m of climbing a month, which sends me to the mountains, the trails and the hikes every month to keep fit. Climbing is the one I have never reached. Most of my outings are on flat ground and the hills are far, so it is the hardest of the three for me.

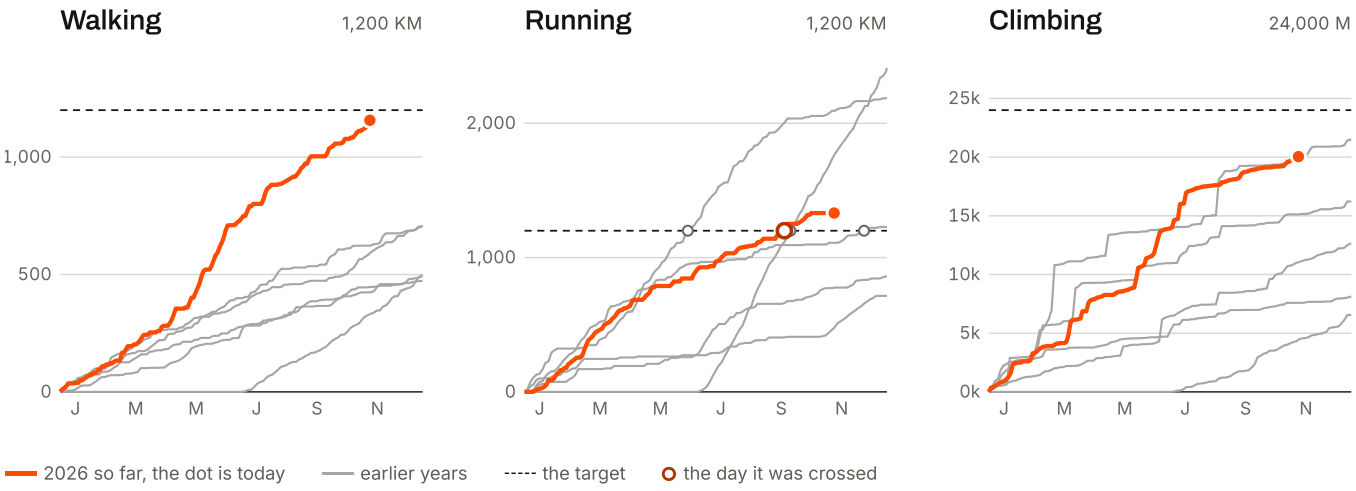
2026 SO FAR

1,157 km
walked, 96% of the target

1,331 km
run, 111% of the target

20,040 m
climbed on foot, 84% of the target

53 days
left in 2026



DESIGN LESSON · MANY YEARS, ONE RACE

Putting every year on one set of axes, with the past years in grey and the current year in colour, turns a question about one year into a comparison with all of them. The grey years are the context; the coloured one is the question.

In your own work. Put the current period on top of grey past periods to show whether it is ahead or behind.

THE STORY

Each small panel is one target. The year runs from left to right and the line climbs as the total grows. Every earlier year is a grey line, this year is orange, and the dashed level is the target. Where a line crosses the dashed level, the ring for that year closed.

The climbing panel is the one still open this year. At this point of the year, 2026 is ahead of five of the five earlier years.

Running closed four times.

The rings follow my story. Running was strongest at the start: in 2021 I ran more than twice the target. As walking took over, running fell short in 2024 and 2025, while my walking stayed under 800 km a year until 2026. The climbing came closest in 2023, at 90%.

RINGS CLOSED, 2021 TO 2026

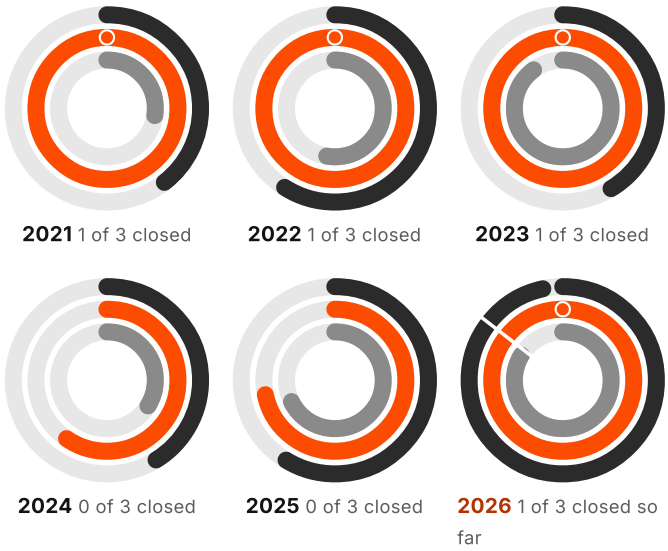
4
running, best 2,412 km in 2021

0
walking, best 1,157 km in 2026

0
climbing, best 21,490 m in 2023

0
years with both 1,200 km rings closed

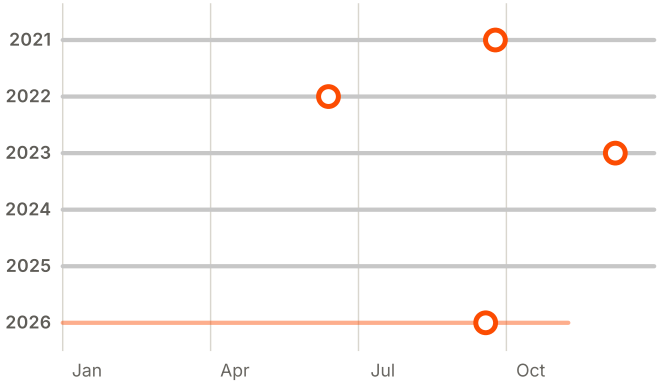
EACH YEAR AS THREE RINGS



2021 1 of 3 closed
2022 1 of 3 closed
2023 1 of 3 closed
2024 0 of 3 closed
2025 0 of 3 closed
2026 1 of 3 closed so far

● outer ring, walking 1,200 km ● middle ring, running 1,200 km
● inner ring, climbing 24,000 m

THE DAY EACH RING CLOSED



HOW TO READ · EACH YEAR AS THREE RINGS

Each year is drawn as three rings: walking on the outside, running in the middle and climbing inside. A ring fills as the year's total grows toward its target, and a closed ring is a full circle. For the year in progress, a small notch shows how far through the year we are.

HOW TO READ · THE DAY EACH RING CLOSED

One row for each year, with the calendar running across. A coloured ring sits on the day a target was crossed. Targets that were not met that year are listed at the end of the row with the share I reached.

DESIGN LESSON · RINGS FOR PROGRESS TOWARD A TARGET

Each ring fills to its share of a target and closes when the target is met. Rings are quick to read as done or not done, though comparing the length of two arcs is harder than comparing two bars.

In your own work. Use rings for a few goals that are either met or not; use bars when the exact shares matter.

DESIGN LESSON · PUT EVENTS ON THE CALENDAR

When the question is when something happened, a date in a list is hard to compare. Placed on a shared time axis, early and late can be seen at a glance, and a row with nothing on it says as much as a row that is full.

In your own work. Plot dates on a time axis rather than listing them.

THE STORY

Walking is my hardest 1,200 km, even though I walk more often than I run. For five years the walking ring stayed open, because my walks were short and the kilometres did not add up. In 2026 the walks got longer, and the ring came within 43 km with weeks to go.

Running closed in 2021, 2022 and 2023, and then it stayed open for two years. When more of my running moved outside, the running ring came back and closed again in 2026.

02 WILL IT CLOSE?

Close, but not yet.

Walking needs only 43 km more, so the climb is the ring in doubt. If I keep to my average, I will finish just short. I played out the rest of the year many times, using my own days of 2026 picked at random, to see how often it gets there. Since 1 September I have climbed only 29 m a day. Lately I have chosen walking, for the enjoyment and to build perseverance, and the climbing has slowed with it.

THE CLIMB, 2026

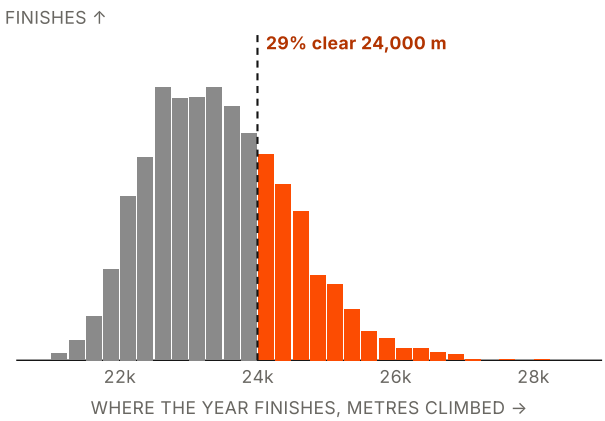
3,960 m
still to climb in 53 days

75 m
a day needed from here

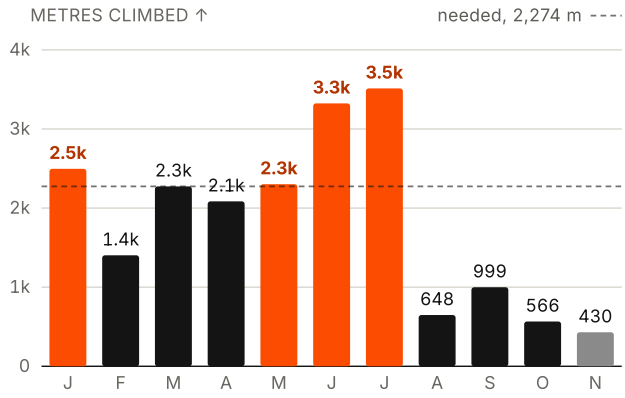
64 m
a day so far in 2026

29%
of 4,000 replays close the ring

WHERE 4,000 REPLAYS OF THE YEAR FINISH



METRES CLIMBED EACH MONTH OF 2026



HOW TO READ · WHERE 4,000 REPLAYS OF THE YEAR FINISH

I played out the rest of the year 4,000 times, each time picking days at random from my own days of 2026, and noted where the climb would finish. Each bar counts the finishes in that band. The dashed line is the target, and the orange bars are the finishes that reach it.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW UNCERTAINTY AS MANY OUTCOMES

A forecast given as one number pretends to know more than it does. Drawing many possible endings shows the range honestly, and the share that clears the target gives the chance in a form anyone can check by eye.

In your own work. For a forecast, show the whole range of outcomes.

HOW TO READ · METRES CLIMBED EACH MONTH OF 2026

The metres I climbed in each month of this year. The dashed line is what I need each month from here to reach the target, and the grey bar is the month still running.

THE STORY

The months show why the ring is still open. June and July each gave more than 3,000 m. Then August, September, October and November gave 2,643 m together.

To close it, I need the climbing of my good months back in the weeks that are left. That means more trips to the hills, and the next weeks will decide it.

A little faster each time.

This is the race in Moshi, my hometown, and I go back every year. In 2026 it moved from February to 22 March, to make room for the fasting before Eid, and I turned the three weeks before it into a countdown: 21 km on the first day, one less each day after, and never under 5 km in the last days. A walking challenge with a friend in Addis Ababa added more on top, and the first week became my biggest week ever. Most of what I gained came on the way back down. Going up to the turnaround I kept much the same speed after my first year. Coming down I got quicker every year, and in 2026 I ran two long stretches of the descent.

FOUR EDITIONS OF ONE RACE

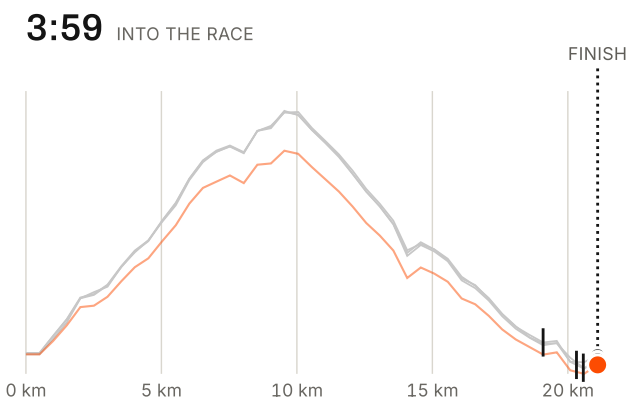
22.1 min
quicker in 2026 than in 2023

13.9 min
of it gained on the way down

8.2 min
gained on the way up

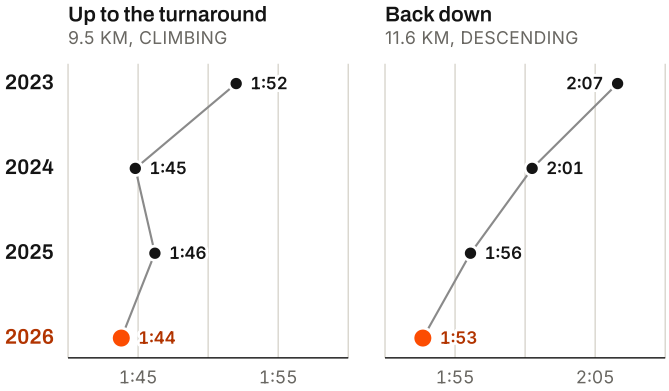
5.8 km
run in 2026, the rest walked

ALL FOUR EDITIONS, RACED AT ONCE



2026	2025	2024	2023
3:37	3:42	3:45	3:59
the quickest	0.5 km behind when 2026 finished	0.8 km behind when 2026 finished	2.0 km behind when 2026 finished

THE TWO HALVES, EACH EDITION



HOW TO READ · ALL FOUR EDITIONS, RACED AT ONCE

The course is drawn as its height profile, climbing to the turnaround and coming back down. Each edition is a runner on its own line, moving at the pace I really went. When the quickest edition reached the finish, the others are marked where they were on the course.

DESIGN LESSON · MOVEMENT WHEN TIME IS THE STORY

On the site this race plays out as motion, because the story is who passed whom and when. Paper cannot move, so the printed chart is frozen at a moment that matters, and the times are written beside it.

In your own work. Animate only when the change over time is the point, and always make a still version that tells the story on its own.

HOW TO READ · THE TWO HALVES, EACH EDITION

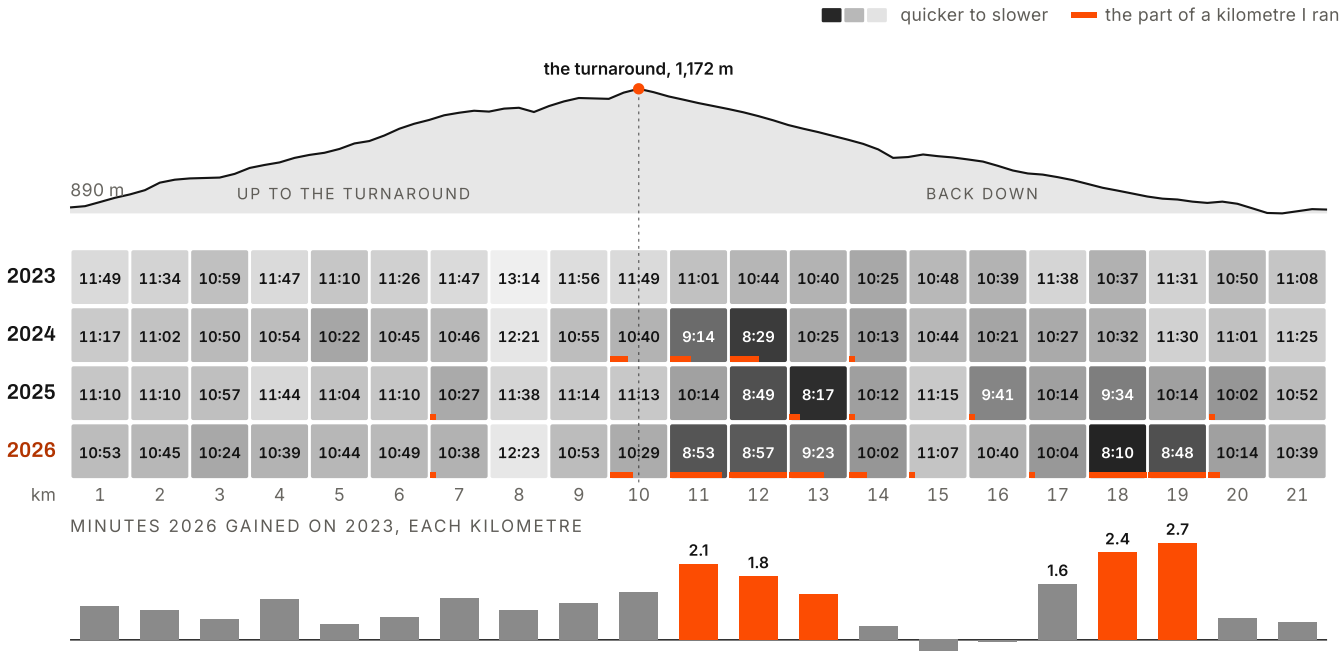
The way up and the way down, one panel each, and both panels cover the same number of minutes. One dot for each edition, the oldest at the top. The line joins them in order, so each half can be followed from year to year.

DESIGN LESSON · SAME SPAN, SO THE STEPS COMPARE

The way up and the way down each get a panel, and both panels cover the same number of minutes. A step of five minutes is as wide on one side as on the other, so the reader sees at once which half changed more. The scale starts near the times, since dots are compared by where they sit and need no zero.

In your own work. When one measure is split into parts, give every part the same scale, so the changes can be compared directly.

EVERY KILOMETRE, FOUR TIMES



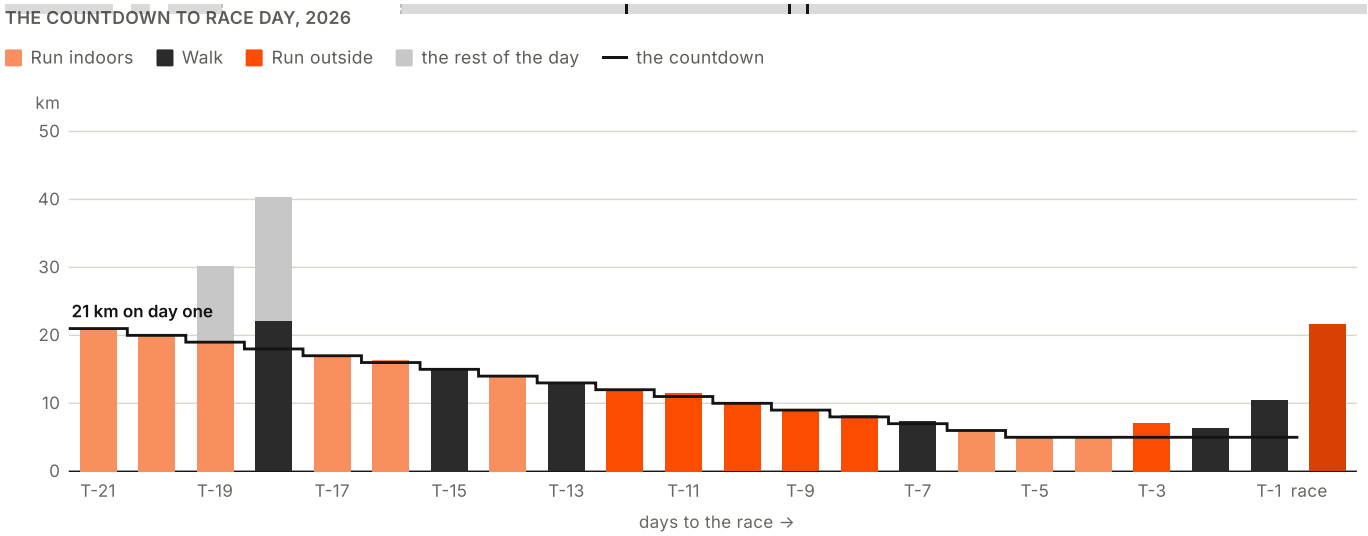
HOW TO READ · EVERY KILOMETRE, FOUR TIMES

One row for each edition and one cell for each kilometre, set under the piece of road it covers. The darker the cell, the quicker I was. The orange line at the foot of a cell is the part of that kilometre I ran. The bars at the bottom are the minutes 2026 gained on 2023 on each kilometre, orange where I ran in 2026.

DESIGN LESSON · ONE ROW FOR EACH TIME THE SAME ROAD

Every kilometre of every edition is a cell, darker where I was quicker, and the course is drawn above so each column sits under its piece of road. The years become rows that can be read across, and the road becomes columns that can be read down.

In your own work. When the same course is covered many times, give each time a row on one grid, and line the grid up with the ground.



Each column is a day before the race. I met the countdown on 21 of 21 days and covered 286 km on foot in those three weeks, then ran my quickest edition.

HOW TO READ · THE COUNTDOWN TO RACE DAY, 2026

Each column is one of the 21 days before the race, with race day at the end. The coloured part is the longest outing of the day, in the colour of how I moved; the grey part above it is the rest of that day on foot. The black steps are the countdown: the kilometres I set out to cover that day.

THE STORY

The climb is where I hold steady. The descent is where I find time.

The kilometres I ran in 2026 are the ones where I gained the most. Walking, I can only go so fast downhill. Running, the same road gave me about two minutes a kilometre.

Haba na haba hujaza kibaba, little by little fills the measure. A few minutes each year added up to 22.

Fifty trips to Ras Kilomoni.

Bandu bandu humaliza gogo, chip by chip finishes the log. In 2026 I set myself a different kind of target: to reach the headland at Ras Kilomoni fifty times. I counted the trips in Roman numerals, I to L, 34 walks and 16 runs. For the first three months I kept a steady count. Then June came with 14 trips, and after that the target was within reach. The route runs from the beach to the headland, through baobab trees and then on hard gravel. It misses the morning traffic and the heat of Dar es Salaam, and the gravel made it a good test of endurance. I knew trip L would also be my 2,000th outing. Fifty times on that ground is no small thing, and it was a beautiful, happy day.

RAS KILOMONI

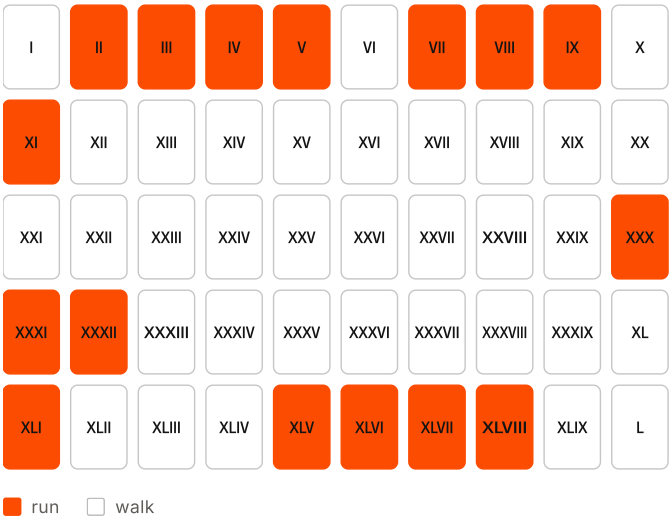
50
trips, the target met exactly

173 days
9 Mar to 28 Aug

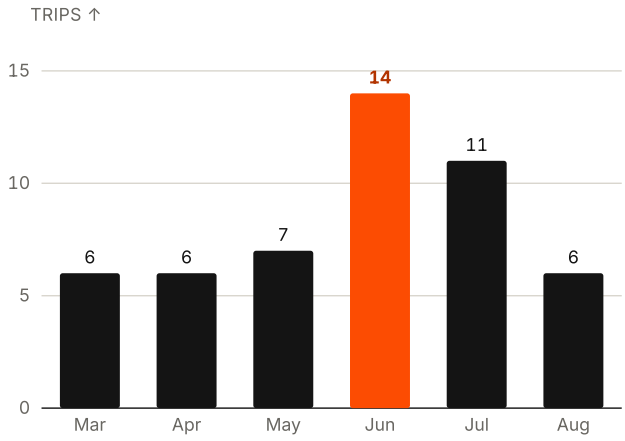
535 km
there and back, 10.7 km a trip

2,000
outings in all by trip L

EVERY TRIP, IN THE NUMBERS I COUNTED THEM



TRIPS EACH MONTH



HOW TO READ · EVERY TRIP, IN THE NUMBERS I COUNTED THEM

One tile for each trip, numbered in Roman numerals the way I counted them, from I to L. An orange tile was a run there and back, a plain one a walk.

DESIGN LESSON · COUNT WITH MARKS

Each trip is one numbered tile, run or walk, in the order I made them. A tally is the oldest chart there is, and it still works: the wall fills as the trips add up.

In your own work. When each item matters on its own, draw one mark per item instead of a single bar.

HOW TO READ · TRIPS EACH MONTH

The number of trips in each month, from the first trip to the fiftieth.

THE STORY

A walk there and back was about 10.8 km on average, and a run about 10.4 km. The same place gave me two kinds of outing, and I used both.

A place is a good kind of target. It does not ask for a pace or a distance, only that I get there. Each trip was one more number, and at L the target was done.

05 A GOAL I NEVER SET

Every month since June 2021.

I never set this one as a target. It came on its own, from going out week after week, even in the quiet months.

EVERY CALENDAR MONTH

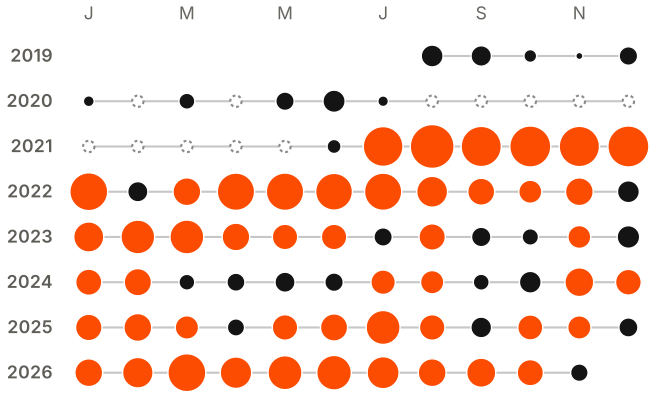
66 months
in a row with an outing, since Jun 2021

49 months
with 100 km or more on foot

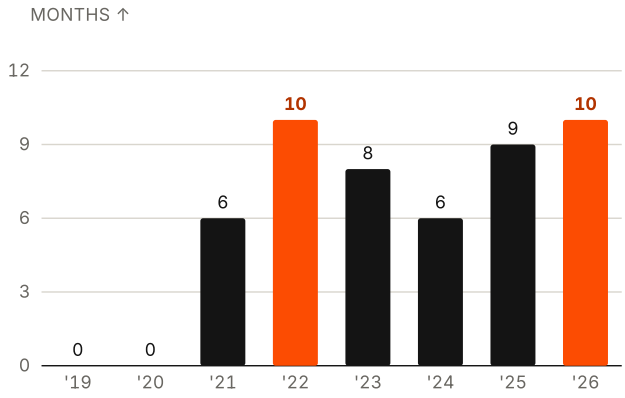
10 of 11
months of 2026 past 100 km

12 months
with no outing, all before Jun 2021

EVERY MONTH AS A BEAD



MONTHS PAST 100 KM, EACH YEAR



HOW TO READ · EVERY MONTH AS A BEAD

One string for each year and one bead for each month. The size of a bead is the distance on foot that month, orange beads passed 100 km, and an empty ring is a month with no outing at all.

DESIGN LESSON · MAKE THE ZEROS VISIBLE

A month with nothing is easy to miss if it is just a gap. Drawing it as an empty ring keeps it on the page, so the reader sees where the record was silent as clearly as where it was full.

In your own work. Make missing data and zero visible on purpose. A blank space is easy to overlook.

HOW TO READ · MONTHS PAST 100 KM, EACH YEAR

The number of months in each year with 100 km or more on foot.

THE STORY

The best year so far had 10 months past 100 km.

The beads show the size of each year at a glance: big beads all through 2021 and 2022, smaller ones in 2023 and 2024, and big again lately. The empty rings are all in the first two years, before the habit.

06 ALL MY GOALS

Met, and still open.

RUNNING RING

4 times

closed, best 2,412 km

2021, 2022, 2023 AND 2026

WALKING RING

96 %

of 1,200 km in 2026 so far, my best walking year

43 KM TO GO

CLIMBING RING

84 %

of 24,000 m in 2026 so far

29% CHANCE IT CLOSES

THE MARATHON

2:56:44

42.7 km in under three hours, indoors on a loop

MAY 2022

THE FOUR-DAY CHALLENGE

100.3 km

in four days back to back, 25.1 km a day

24 MAR TO 27 MAR 2023

KILIMANJARO HALF

3:37

the quickest of four, 22 min under 2023

2026 EDITION

RAS KILOMONI

50 trips

535 km, target met exactly

9 MAR TO 28 AUG 2026

MONTHS IN A ROW

66 months

with at least one outing, still going

SINCE JUN 2021

V

The proof

Twelve things I believe about my habit, each one tested against the log.

CHAPTER 13

13 The Habit on Trial

FROM THE LOGBOOK

“We should discipline ourselves in small things, and from these progress to things of greater value.”

MARCUS AURELIUS

A habit is easy to tell stories about, so this chapter checks mine. I took twelve claims that the book makes, or that I believed about myself, and put each one on trial with a statistical test that could prove it wrong.

Each case has the same parts: the claim, what I tested, the methods, the results, a chart, a plain reading of what it shows and its limits. Some claims are proven, some are supported, and some are not proven. The ones that failed are printed as fully as the ones that passed.

Ukweli ni mchungu, the truth is bitter. At the end, the tests are corrected for the fact that many were run at once, and each method is explained in full.

THE DESIGN OF THIS CHAPTER

Evidence charts have one extra job: they must show uncertainty. The charts of this chapter draw the world where nothing is going on next to the real data, size points by how much evidence they hold, and give every estimate its interval.

HOW I TESTED

Twelve claims, on trial.

Haraka haraka haina baraka, hurry hurry has no blessing. The other chapters say what my log shows. This one tries to prove it. I took twelve things I believe about my habit and tested each one against the 2,076 outings in my log, with more than one method for each, so that no single test decides. Seven held up fully, three held up with a weaker second check and two did not hold up.

THE DATA

2,076 activities from 17 Aug 2019 to 8 Nov 2026. Most tests use the 1,961 days from the comeback on 27 June 2021, so the long layoff does not decide the result. A day

TRIANGULATION

Each claim gets two to four methods that rest on different assumptions: a model, a test that assumes very little, and a resampling check. A claim is only called proven when they agree.

THE VERDICTS

PROVEN every method agrees and the result survives correction. SUPPORTED the main result holds, with a weaker second check. NOT PROVEN the data does not back the claim.

counts as active if it held any outing, and a week runs from Sunday to Saturday.

THE VERDICTS

The verdicts at a glance.

#	THE CLAIM	KEY RESULT	VERDICT
01	Yesterday decides today	odds ×4.65 · p = 5×10^{-18}	PROVEN
02	A chain gets stronger, a break gets stickier	Weibull shape 0.78 (0.72–0.84)	PROVEN
03	My record has four eras, found blind	two of three breaks agree to the week	SUPPORTED
04	Saturday is my surest day, Tuesday my weakest	+13.6 points (7.5–19.9)	PROVEN
05	August and September are my quiet season	annual cycle p = 7×10^{-4}	SUPPORTED
06	On the treadmill I stop on round numbers	100 runs at 5 km vs 17 expected	PROVEN
07	My treadmill pace slowed for four years, then turned	+0.55 min/km a year · 2026 −1.09	PROVEN
08	Hills slow my walks	+48 s/km per 10 m/km climb	PROVEN
09	Hills slow my runs	ρ = 0.01 · p = 0.89	NOT PROVEN
10	Running and walking do not compete for my time	week to week ρ = −0.17 · p = 0.004	NOT PROVEN
11	A long day does not call for a rest day	90% vs 82% out next day	SUPPORTED
12	Kudos follow the kind of outing	trail run +40% · distance +3%	PROVEN

CASE 01 PROVEN

Yesterday decides today.

My days out are not coin flips. Whether I go out today depends on yesterday, and the day six or seven days back still counts after the days in between are taken into account.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: each day since the comeback is an independent draw with the same chance of an outing, 73.9%. If that were true, yesterday would tell me nothing about today.

METHODS

01 Logistic regression of today on yesterday.

02 Likelihood-ratio test of a model with the last seven days against a model with yesterday only.

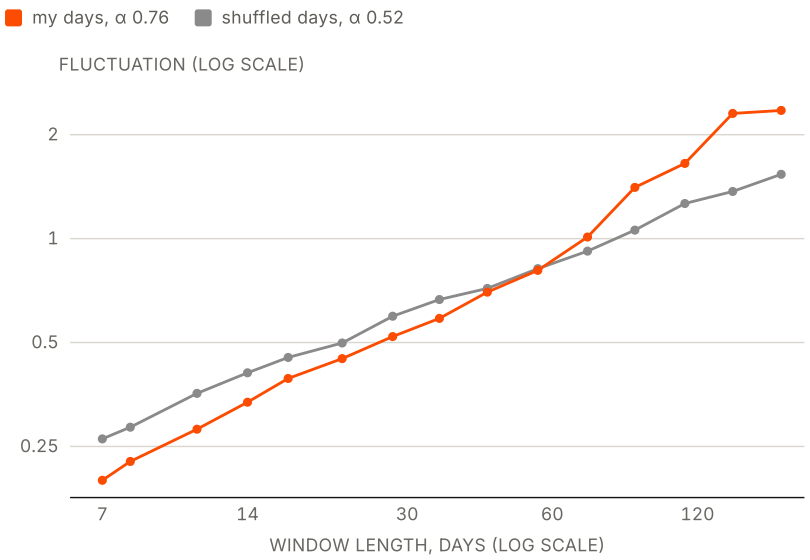
03 Wald–Wolfowitz runs test, which counts how often the series switches between active and rest.

04 Detrended fluctuation analysis (DFA), which measures memory over weeks and months, compared with the same days shuffled 200 times.

RESULTS

Odds of going out after a day out	×4.65 (3.73–5.79)
7 days against 1 day, χ^2 (df 6)	93.93 · $p = 5\times10^{-18}$
Day 6 back, coefficient	0.43 · $p = 8\times10^{-4}$
Day 7 back, coefficient	0.29 · p = 0.023
Days 4 and 5 back	p = 0.12 and 0.30
Runs: observed against expected	515 vs 758 · z = −14.2
DFA exponent α, real days	0.76
DFA α, shuffled days (95% range)	0.52 (0.47–0.57)

MEMORY OVER WEEKS AND MONTHS



Detrended fluctuation of my active days against the window length, both on log scales. A slope of 0.5 means no memory. My days climb at 0.76, so windows of weeks and months are more uneven than chance allows: good spells and quiet spells last.

DESIGN LESSON · LOG SCALES FOR PATTERNS ACROSS SIZES

Both axes are on log scales, so each equal step along them is a doubling of the window. On log scales a power law, the signature of a long memory, becomes a straight line, and its slope can be read by eye.

In your own work. When values span many sizes, from days to months, try log scales on both axes. Label the ticks with real values, never with logarithms.

WHAT IT SHOWS

Four methods, four different assumptions, one answer.

After a day out, the odds of going out the next day are 4.7 times higher. My days come in far fewer and longer runs than chance would give, 515 against 758, and the memory reaches past a week.

There is a weekly beat inside it: the day six or seven days ago still matters.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

The lesson I take is that today is never only about today. Since the comeback I went out on 74% of my 1,961 days, and 82% of those days out came straight after another day out.

So I look after the chain one day at a time. A day out is the best help I can give to the day after it.

Limits. These tests look at whether I went out, and leave out how far. The runs test and DFA treat the series as one piece, so they show that memory exists without showing where it comes from.

CASE 02 PROVEN

A chain gets stronger.

The longer I have gone out day after day, the more likely I am to go out again. The longer I have rested, the less likely I am to start again.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: the chance of a streak ending is the same on day 2 as on day 20, and the chance of a break ending is the same after one zero day as after five. That is the memoryless (geometric) pattern.

METHODS

01 Discrete-time hazard model: a logistic regression of tomorrow on the log of how long the current streak or break has lasted.

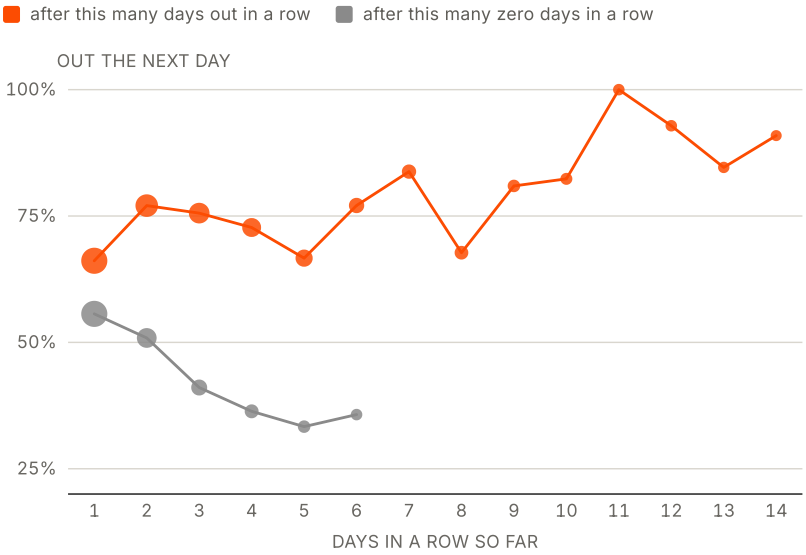
02 Weibull survival fit to the 258 streaks since the comeback, with the current streak counted as still running (censored). A shape below 1 means the risk of ending falls with age.

03 Life table: the share of streaks and breaks that continue at each length.

RESULTS

Streak goes on, slope per log-day	+0.44 · $p = 8\times10^{-8}$
Break ends, slope per log-day	−0.39 · p = 0.006
Weibull shape of streaks	0.78 (0.72–0.84)
Out again after day 1 of a streak	66% (170/257)
Out again after day 7	84% (31/37)
Out again after days 11 to 14	48 of 52
Out after 1 zero day	56% (143/257)
Out after 5 zero days	33% (7/21)

CHANCE OF GOING OUT TOMORROW



Orange: after this many days out in a row. Grey: after this many zero days in a row. The dot size is the number of cases behind each point.

DESIGN LESSON · LET THE DOT SHOW HOW MUCH EVIDENCE IT HOLDS

Each dot is sized by the number of days behind it. The small dots at the far end rest on a few long streaks, the big ones on hundreds of days, so the reader knows which points to trust before reading a single number.

In your own work. When some points rest on far more data than others, size them by their sample, or fade the thin ones.

WHAT IT SHOWS

Momentum and rust are both real and both measurable.

The first day back is the easiest one to lose: 34% of new streaks end there. By the second week a streak nearly carries itself. Zero days work the other way: each extra zero day makes the next one more likely.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

The days to guard are the first ones. Since the comeback I have started 258 streaks, and only eleven of them reached two weeks. The one I am on now has reached 315 days.

Once a chain is past its first week, it mostly looks after itself. A new one needs me to show up on purpose, even for a short walk.

Limits. Only eleven streaks reached two weeks, so the right end of the orange line rests on small numbers. The Weibull model is continuous and streaks are counted in whole days, so I treat its shape as a check on the hazard model, which fits the daily counts directly.

CASE 03 SUPPORTED

My record has four eras.

My habit did not grow smoothly. It changed in steps, and the steps can be found from the numbers alone, without telling the method any dates.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: the number of active days per week drifts without clear jumps, so any split into eras is my own story laid on top of the data.

METHODS

01 PELT changepoint detection on active days per week, 378 weeks from Sunday to Saturday, with a penalty that grows with the length of the series and a minimum era of 8 weeks.

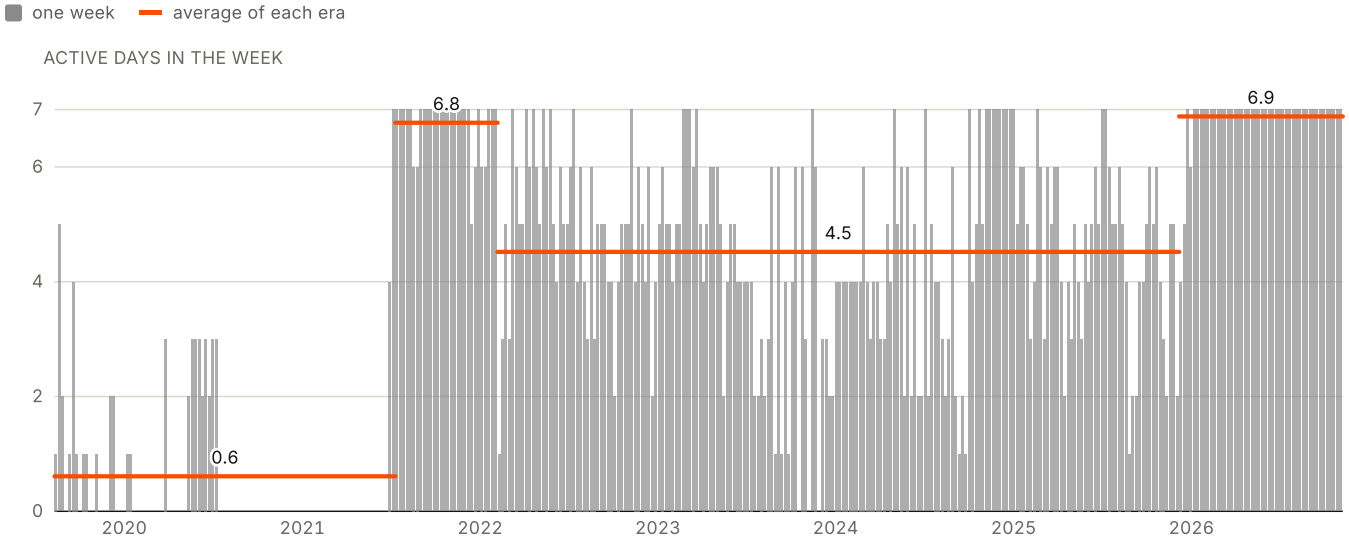
02 Binary segmentation, a different search, asked for the three strongest breaks.

03 CUSUM: the lowest point of the running sum of deviations from the overall mean marks where low weeks end and high weeks begin.

RESULTS

PELT breaks, week of	2 weeks after the comeback · 6 Feb 2022 · 7 Dec 2025
Binary segmentation, week of	2 weeks after the comeback · 6 Feb 2022 · 11 Jan 2026
CUSUM low point, week of	20 Jun 2021
Era 1, active days a week	0.61
Era 2	6.77
Era 3	4.52
Era 4	6.88

ACTIVE DAYS PER WEEK



One bar per week, Sunday to Saturday. The orange steps are the eras found by the changepoint test, at their average level.

DESIGN LESSON · SUMMARISE THE ERAS OVER THE RAW DATA

The grey bars are every week; the flat lines are the average of each era the test found, with the value written above. The summary sits on the data instead of replacing it, so the reader can check that each step is real.

In your own work. Draw the model on top of the data it was fitted to, and make the model the darker of the two.

WHAT IT SHOWS

PELT and binary segmentation work in different ways. They agree on the first two breaks to the week: the comeback in the middle of 2021, and the first burst settling into a steady rhythm early in 2022. CUSUM puts the end of the low weeks in the week of 20 June 2021, one week before the comeback.

On the last break they land five weeks apart, in the weeks of 7 December 2025 and 11 January 2026. My current streak of 315 days began on 29 December 2025, between the two. That is why this case is supported: the eras are clear, and the exact week of the last change is not pinned down.

The last era runs at 6.9 active days a week, the level of the first burst, and it has already lasted longer.

The first burst settled when the group of friends I trained with every day in Dodoma could no longer find the same hours, and we went out together less often.

Limits. The penalty decides how many breaks a changepoint method reports. The agreement between methods that search in different ways is what makes these breaks stand out.

CASE 04 PROVEN

Saturday is my surest day.

Since the comeback, some days of the week are skipped more than others. Saturday is the day I skip least, and Tuesday is the day I skip most.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: the chance of a day being active is the same on every day of the week, from Sunday to Saturday.

METHODS

01 χ^2 test of independence on active and zero days by weekday.

02 Logistic regression with errors clustered by week, because days in the same week are not independent (case 1). This makes the test stricter.

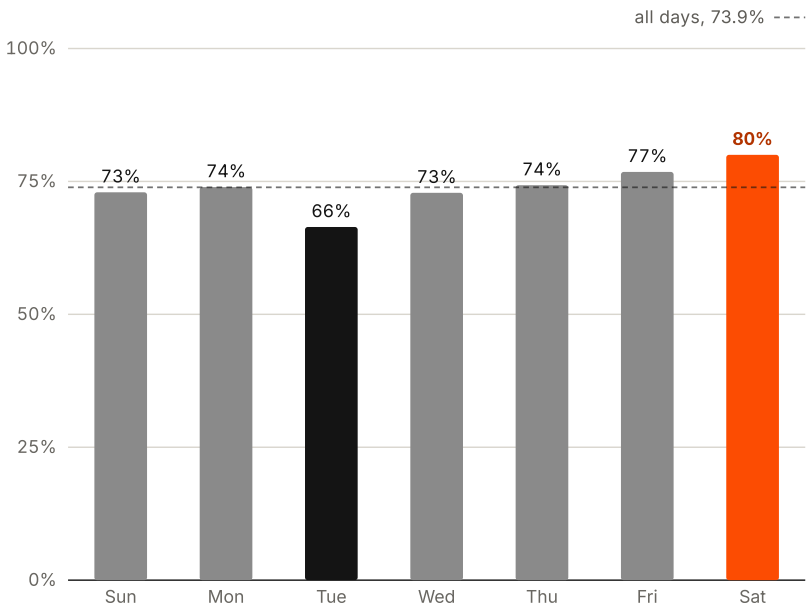
03 Block bootstrap: whole weeks resampled 2,000 times to get an interval for the Saturday minus Tuesday gap.

04 A χ^2 goodness-of-fit test on the number of outings by weekday.

RESULTS

Saturday active	80.0% (224/280)
Tuesday active	66.4% (186/280)
χ^2 (df 6)	15.02 · p = 0.020
Clustered Wald test	18.56 · p = 0.005
Saturday − Tuesday, 95% CI	13.6 points (7.5–19.9)
Outings by weekday, χ^2	9.61 · p = 0.14

SHARE OF DAYS WITH AN OUTING, BY WEEKDAY



Since the comeback, Sunday first. Orange is Saturday, black is Tuesday, and the dashed line is the average of all days.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The weekday pattern survives the strictest version of the test.

Saturday is the day I skip least, and Tuesday is the day I skip most. The total number of outings does not differ much by weekday, so the difference is about which days get skipped. Saturday is my Sabbath, the day the jobs and the busy week give way and I go outside.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

The other five days sit close together: on each of them I went out between 73% and 77% of the time. Only Saturday rises above them, and only Tuesday falls below.

Knowing my weak day helps me. When Tuesday comes, I already know it is the one most likely to slip, and a short outing is enough to keep it.

Limits. Seven weekdays and one comparison chosen after looking at the data: the Saturday and Tuesday gap is the largest of 21 possible pairs, so its interval describes this gap and should not be read as a test planned in advance.

CASE 05 SUPPORTED

I have a quiet season.

Across the years, I go out least often around 1 September and most often around 2 March. August and September are my quietest months.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: the chance of an active day does not follow the calendar. I used the four full years 2022 to 2025, 1,461 days, so that partial years do not tilt the result.

METHODS

01 Harmonic logistic regression: a smooth yearly wave (one sine and one cosine), with a separate level for each year, errors clustered by week.

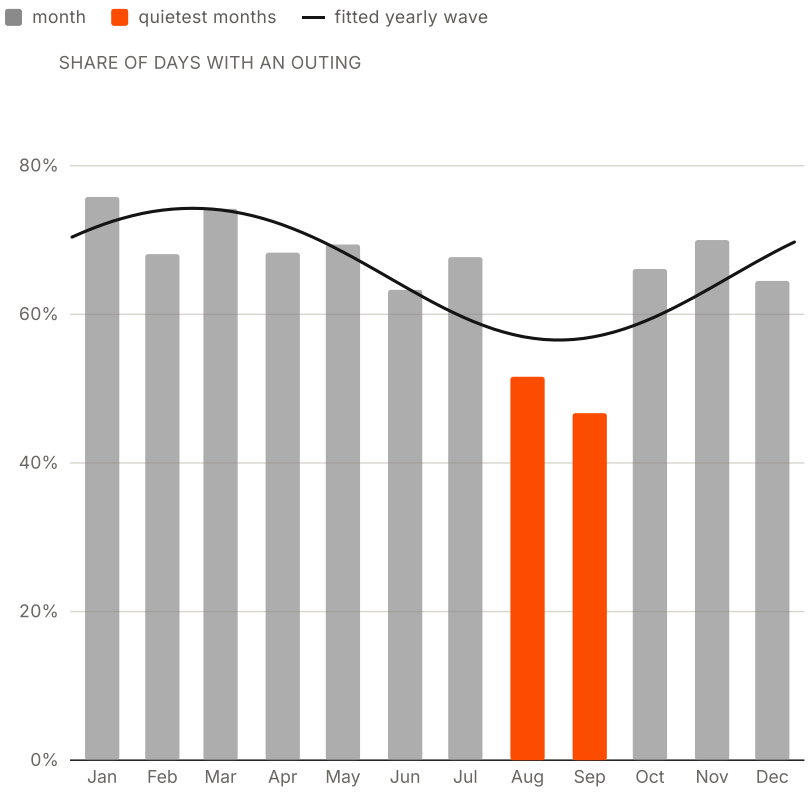
02 Kruskal–Wallis test of monthly active shares across the 12 months.

03 Friedman test, the same comparison with each year as its own block.

RESULTS

Yearly wave, clustered Wald (df 2)	14.62 · p = 7×10^{-4}
Low point of the wave	about 1 September
High point	about 2 March
Active share, top to bottom of wave	74% to 56%
September and August (lowest months)	46.7%, 51.6%
Kruskal–Wallis across months	p = 0.42
Friedman, years as blocks	p = 0.21

SHARE OF DAYS WITH AN OUTING, BY MONTH, 2022 TO 2025



The four full years together. The line is the fitted yearly wave, and the orange bars are the two quietest months.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW THE MODEL AND THE DATA TOGETHER

The bars are each month's real share of days out; the curve is a fitted yearly wave. Where the bars and the curve agree, the season is regular; where they part, it is not.

In your own work. Draw a fitted curve as a thin dark line over lighter data, never alone.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The wave is there, and it is strong enough to pass a strict test that respects the weekly clustering.

In each of the four years, August or September is one of the three quietest months.

The month-by-month tests that assume very little do not confirm it, because each month has only four values, one per year. That is why I call this supported and stop short of proven.

In my own experience these months are a breather: after many busy months the body asks for a pause, and then I pick it up again for the festive season.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

My best months are January and March, when I went out on about three days in four. In August and September it was about one day in two.

So the dip does not surprise me any more. Those are the two months where a plan matters most for me.

Limits. One sine wave is a simple shape. A second wave (two peaks a year) did not improve the fit ($p = 0.063$). Four years is a short record for a yearly pattern.

CASE 06 PROVEN

I stop on round numbers.

My treadmill runs end at 5, 10 and 15 km far more often than a natural spread of distances would allow.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: near any distance, runs are spread evenly, so the share that ends within 60 m of a round number should match the width of that window. Inside a window of ±560 m, a ±60 m slice should hold about 10.7% of the runs.

METHODS

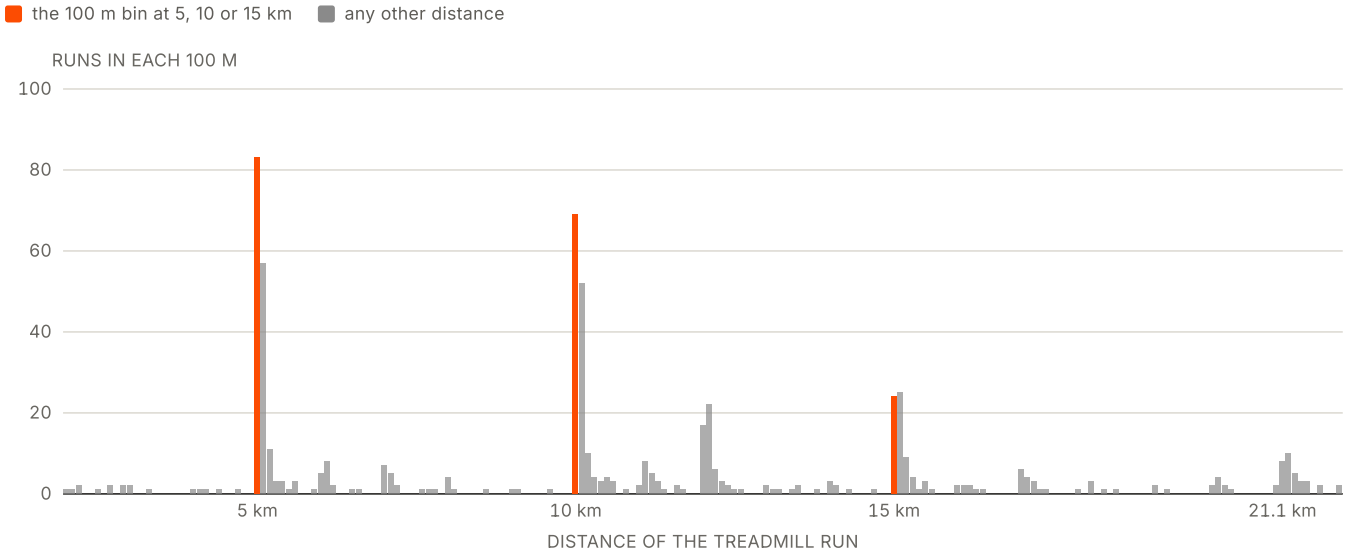
01 One-sided binomial test at each round distance, against that even spread.

02 Gaussian mixture model on the log of every foot distance: if distances pile up on exact values, the model keeps adding very narrow components.

RESULTS

5 km: within 60 m, of 159 near	100 vs 17.0 expected · $p = 3\times10^{-56}$
10 km	81 of 144 vs 15.4 expected · $p = 1\times10^{-40}$
15 km	29 of 67 vs 7.2 expected · $p = 9\times10^{-12}$
21.1 km	8 of 31 vs 3.3 expected · p = 0.014
Mixture BIC, 1 to 4 components	4,293 → 2,743
Narrowest component	5.05 km, width under 1%

EVERY TREADMILL RUN, BY DISTANCE



All 629 treadmill runs in 100 m bins. The spikes at 5, 10 and 15 km are the round numbers.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The pile-up at round numbers is one of the strongest results in this chapter.

At 5 km, 63% of the runs in the window end within 60 m of the mark. The mixture model sees it too: it keeps finding a razor-thin bump at 5.05 km, which is what point masses look like to a model that expects smooth hills.

Limits. The 21.1 km result does not survive the Holm correction (adjusted p = 0.057), so I only claim 5, 10 and 15 km. Outdoor runs are not included, since GPS distance adds its own noise.

CASE 07 PROVEN

My treadmill pace turned.

From 2021 to 2025, my usual treadmill kilometre took longer every year. In 2026 it came back down by 1:05 per kilometre.

WHAT I TESTED

Two opposite claims: that treadmill pace had no trend from 2021 to 2025, and that 2026 is no different from 2025. I used treadmill runs of 3 to 25 km, 598 in all.

METHODS

01 Theil–Sen estimator: the median of all pairwise slopes, a trend line that a few odd runs cannot pull.

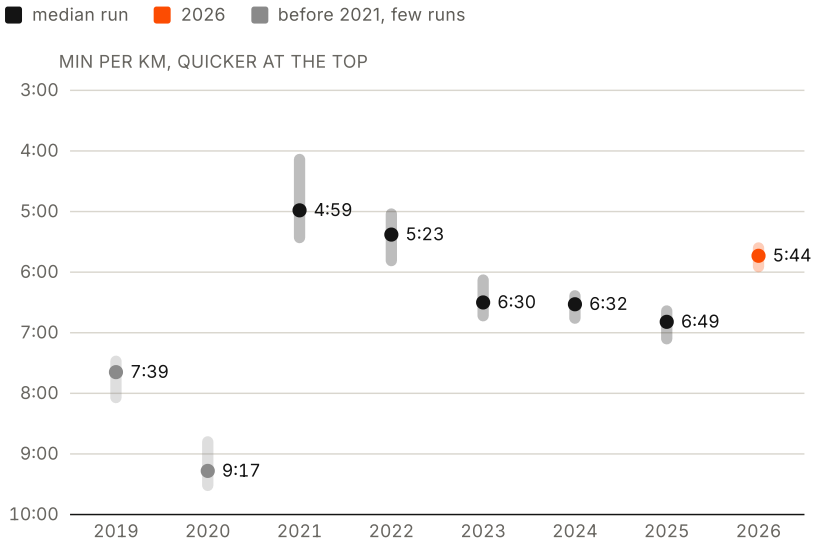
02 Kendall's τ, a rank test for a steady trend in time.

03 Mann–Whitney U test of 2026 runs against 2025 runs.

RESULTS

Median pace 2021 → 2025	4:59 → 6:49 min/km
Theil–Sen slope, 2021–2025	+0.55 min/km a year (0.50–0.60)
Kendall τ	0.53 · $p = 1\times10^{-73}$
Same trend, distance held fixed	+0.48 min/km a year · $p = 5\times10^{-54}$
Median 2026 against 2025	5:44 vs 6:49 min/km
Mann–Whitney (47 and 46 runs)	$p = 6\times10^{-16}$

TREADMILL PACE BY YEAR



The dot is the median run and the bar the middle half of runs. Quicker paces sit higher. The years before 2021 had few runs and are shown in grey.

DESIGN LESSON · A DOT AND A LINE FOR A TYPICAL VALUE AND ITS SPREAD

Each year is a dot at its median pace and a line covering its middle half of runs. It is the simplest way to show a centre and a spread, and it takes a fraction of the ink of a box plot.

In your own work. For a few groups, a dot with a line through the middle half is clearer than a full box plot.

WHAT IT SHOWS

Both halves of the claim hold with room to spare.

The slowdown was steady, about 33 seconds per kilometre each year, and the 2026 turn is just as clear. My indoor running has no belt to set the speed: on a loop or in place, the pace is the effort I chose to give, year by year. In 2026 I set goals after two hard years and pushed, without music.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

The treadmill runs also became fewer as they slowed, from 161 in 2022 to 46 in 2025.

In 2026 I have done 47 of them so far, about as many as in 2025, and I set the belt faster again. The number of runs stayed low, and the effort came back.

Limits. Pace and distance travel together, so I also fitted a model that holds distance fixed. It gives almost the same trend, +0.48 min/km a year. The 2026 year is not finished.

CASE 08 PROVEN

Hills slow my walks.

Each extra 10 m of climb per kilometre adds about 48 seconds to every kilometre of a walk.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: walking pace does not depend on how steep the route is, once the length of the walk and the year are taken into account. I used 837 outdoor walks and hikes. Walks with more than 250 m of climb per km are left out.

METHODS

01 Linear regression of pace on climb per kilometre, the log of distance and the year, with robust (HC3) standard errors.

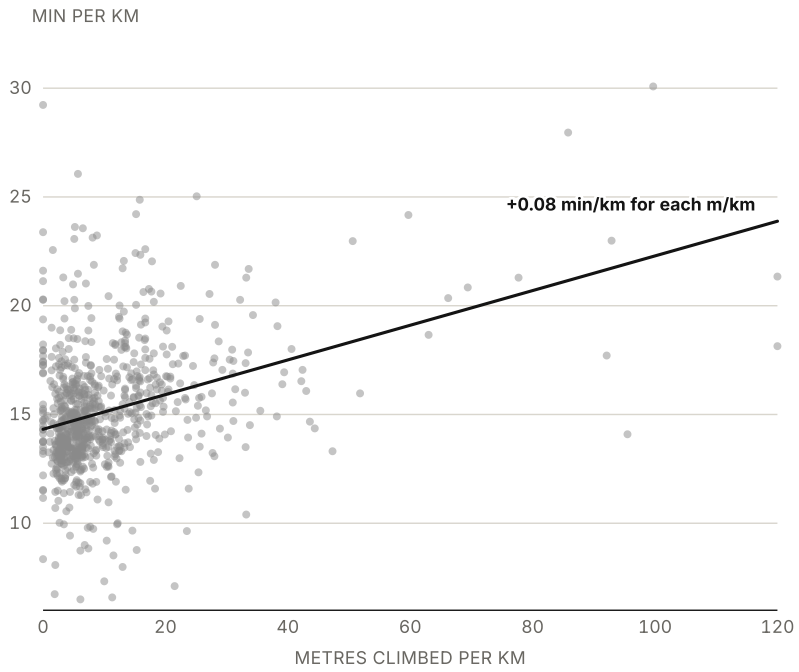
02 Spearman rank correlation between pace and climb, which needs no straight-line assumption.

03 A plain comparison of medians for flat and steep walks.

RESULTS

Slope, min/km per m/km of climb	0.080 (0.058–0.102)
Same, per 10 m/km	+48 s per km
p-value	2×10^{-12}
Spearman ρ	0.30 · $p = 1\times10^{-18}$
Median pace, under 10 m/km	14.3 min/km
Median pace, 40 m/km or more (21 walks)	18.1 min/km

WALKING PACE AGAINST CLIMB



Every outdoor walk and hike: climb per kilometre across, pace up. The line is the fitted effect of climb at the average distance.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The model, the rank test and the medians all point the same way.

A steep walk is a slow walk, and the price can be put in seconds: on a route with 40 m of climb per kilometre, each kilometre takes about 3:11 longer than on flat ground.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

When I plan a walk in the hills, I add time for the climb. At 40 m of climb per kilometre, a 10 km walk takes about 32 minutes longer than the same distance on flat ground.

Pace alone does not tell me how hard a walk was. A slow kilometre on a steep road can be the best work of the week.

Limits. The model explains a quarter of the spread in walking pace ($R^2 = 0.25$). Stops, company and the ground under my feet are not in the log.

CASE 09 NOT PROVEN

Hills slow my runs.

I expected the same effect on my outdoor runs. The data does not show it.

WHAT I TESTED

The same model as in case 8, on 217 outdoor runs and trail runs: pace on climb per kilometre, distance and year, with a marker for trail runs. Runs with more than 150 m of climb per km are left out.

METHODS

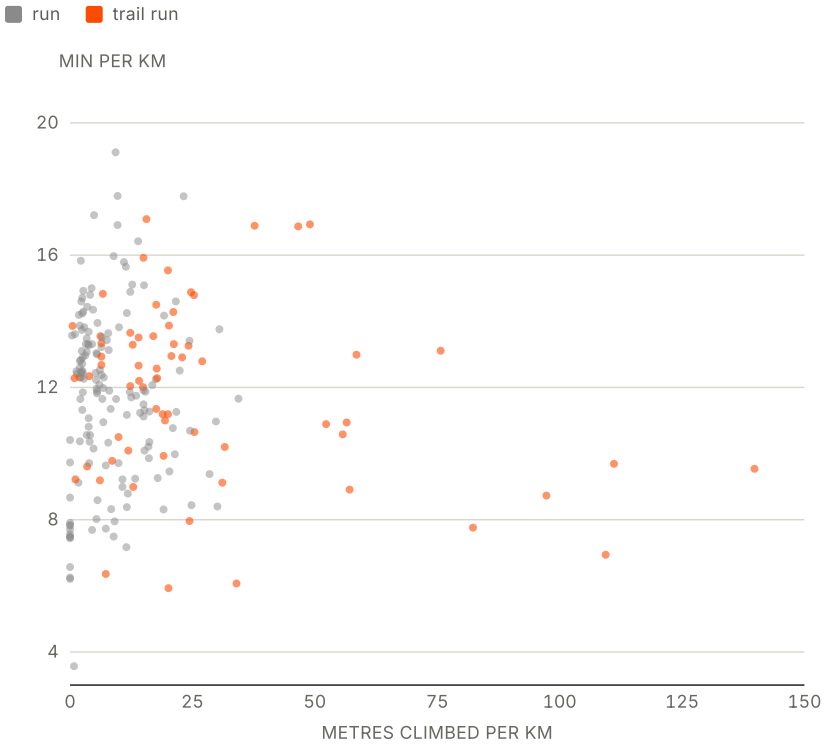
01 Linear regression with robust errors.

02 Spearman rank correlation.

RESULTS

Slope, min/km per m/km	−0.018 (−0.035 to 0.000)
Spearman ρ	0.01 · p = 0.89
Trail run marker	+0.58 min/km · p = 0.25

RUNNING PACE AGAINST CLIMB



Every outdoor run, climb per kilometre across, pace up. The cloud has no slope: steep runs are spread over the same paces as flat ones.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The rank test finds no link at all, and the model's slope points the wrong way. I keep this case in on purpose. A chapter that only reports the claims that worked would not be honest about how the testing went.

My 217 outdoor runs mix road runs, trail runs and races, and climb per kilometre does not line up with their pace.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

This case taught me to test what I believe. I was sure the hills slowed my runs the way they slow my walks, and 217 outdoor runs said no.

65 of those runs were trail runs, mixed in with road runs and races, and a single number for climb does not sort them out. I keep the walking result and let this belief go.

Limits. A small negative slope in one model and no rank correlation is a null result. It does not show that hills make me faster.

CASE 10 NOT PROVEN

Runs and walks do not compete.

A big running week does not take kilometres away from walking, or the other way round. They behave like two separate habits.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: weekly running and walking distance trade off, which would show as a negative correlation. I used the 280 full weeks since the comeback, Sunday to Saturday.

METHODS

01 Spearman correlation of weekly running and walking kilometres.

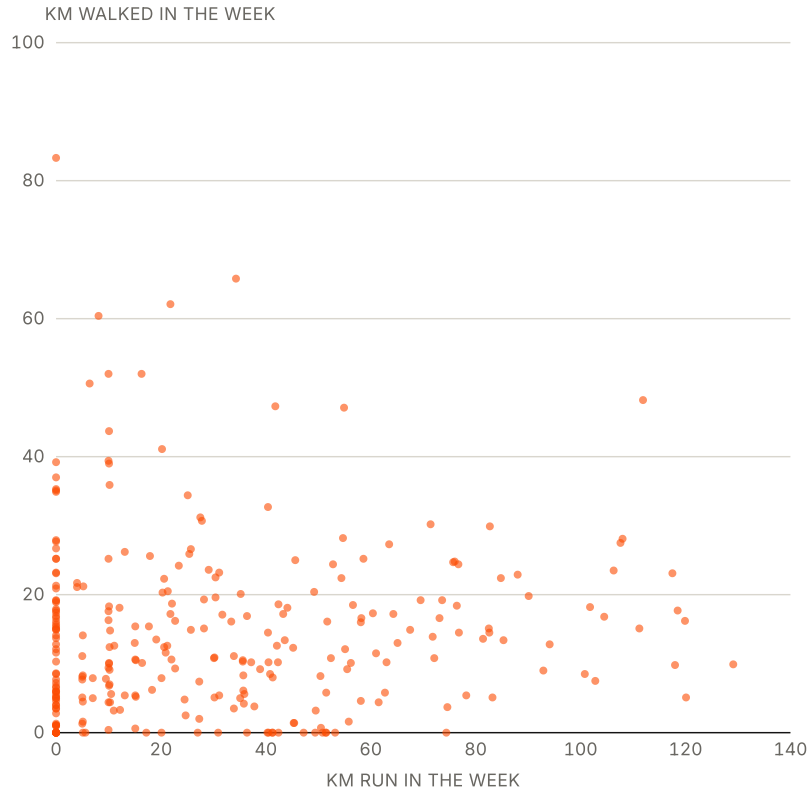
02 The same on week-to-week changes, which removes slow trends.

03 The same after subtracting a 13-week moving average from each.

RESULTS

Weekly totals	ρ = 0.10 · p = 0.10
Week-to-week changes	ρ = −0.17 · p = 0.004
Week-to-week, Holm-adjusted	p = 0.030
Detrended	ρ = −0.13 · p = 0.028
Smallest correlation this sample could detect	about ±0.12

RUNNING AND WALKING, WEEK BY WEEK



One dot per week since the comeback: kilometres run across, kilometres walked up.

WHAT IT SHOWS

The weekly totals show no trade-off (ρ = 0.10). The changes do. In a week when I run more than the week before, I usually walk a little less than the week before, and the other way round (ρ = −0.17). The detrended series agrees (ρ = −0.13).

The link is weak: a correlation of −0.17 accounts for about 3% of the spread in the changes. It still survives the correction for many tests, so the claim that the two never compete does not hold as I wrote it. Over a whole week they mostly live side by side, and at the margin one gives a little way to the other.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

I do not have to pick one. Of the 280 weeks since the comeback, 193 had both a run and a walk in them.

Limits. These are correlations between weekly totals. They show how the two move together, and they say nothing about why.

CASE 11 SUPPORTED

A long day needs no rest day.

After a day of 21 km or more on foot, I am more likely to go out the next day, and to go further.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: a long day is followed by rest or a short day, as a recovery rule would suggest. I compared the day after 120 long days with the day after the 1,328 other active days since the comeback.

METHODS

01 Fisher's exact test on going out the next day.

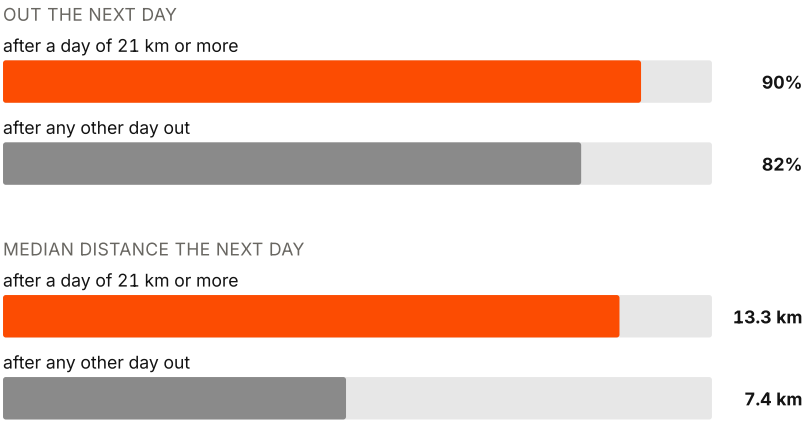
02 Mann–Whitney U test on the next day's distance, when there was one.

03 Lag-1 autocorrelation of weekly kilometres, and what follows a top-10% week.

RESULTS

Out next day, after a long day	90% (108/120)
Out next day, after other days	82% (1,083/1,328)
Fisher odds ratio	2.04 · p = 0.018 (Holm 0.057)
Next day median distance	13.3 vs 7.4 km · p = 1×10^{-13}
Weekly km, lag-1 autocorrelation	0.70
Week after a top-10% week	75% of its distance (median)

THE DAY AFTER



The share of next days with an outing, and how far the next day went when there was one.

DESIGN LESSON · A FULL TRACK BEHIND EACH BAR

Each bar runs inside a pale track that marks the whole scale, so a short bar reads as short against something. Rows in two groups use the same scale, so the groups compare directly.

In your own work. Give bars a faint track to the end of the scale when the reader must judge each one against the full range.

WHAT IT SHOWS

Long days come in blocks. The day after a long one is usually another long one, 13.3 km against 7.4 km, and a big week is followed by a week that keeps most of it: weekly kilometres have a lag-1 correlation of 0.70, and the week after a top-10% week keeps 75% of its distance.

The distance result is strong. The going-out result is just short of the strict line after correction, so I call the whole claim supported.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

So I do not plan a zero day after a long one. In my record, the days after a long one were usually good days too.

Limits. This shows what follows a long day in my record. It does not show that a long day causes the next one.

CASE 12 PROVEN

Kudos follow the sport.

The people who follow me cheer trail runs and runs more than walks. How far or how high I went adds almost nothing once the kind of outing is known.

WHAT I TESTED

The opposite claim: kudos grow with the size of the effort, distance and climb, whatever the sport. I used the 1,686 activities from 2022 on.

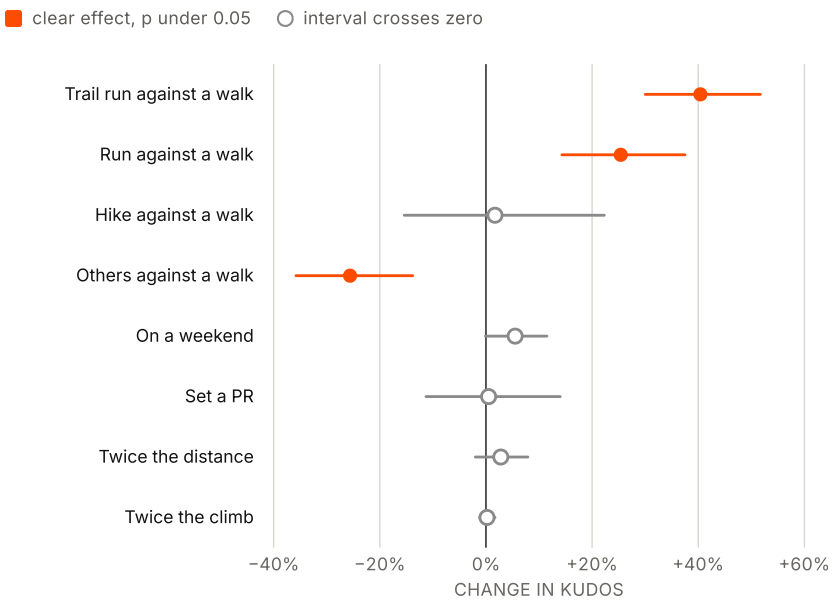
METHODS

01 Linear regression of log(1 + kudos) on sport, log distance, log climb, a personal-record marker, weekend and year, with robust errors. Effects are shown as percent change in kudos.

RESULTS

Trail run against a walk	+40% (30 to 52) · $p = 7\times10^{-18}$
Run against a walk	+25% (14 to 38) · $p = 2\times10^{-6}$
Set a PR	+1% (−11 to 14) · p = 0.94
Twice the distance	+3% (−2 to 8) · p = 0.26
Twice the climb	+0% (−1 to 2) · p = 0.79
Share of variation explained, R^2	0.157

CHANGE IN KUDOS FOR EACH FACTOR



Each factor with its 95% interval, the others held fixed. Intervals that cross zero are not significant.

DESIGN LESSON · SHOW THE UNCERTAINTY AROUND EACH ESTIMATE

Each factor is a dot for its best estimate and a line for its 95% interval. A line that crosses the zero line is an effect the data cannot tell apart from none, and those dots are left hollow.

In your own work. Whenever you show an estimate, show its interval, and mark zero or no change clearly so the reader can see which intervals cross it.

WHAT IT SHOWS

Once the sport is known, the size of the outing barely moves the kudos. A trail run earns about 40% more than a walk of the same length and climb, and a run about 25% more.

The model explains 15.7% of the spread in kudos, so a single outing stays hard to predict, while the pattern across hundreds of outings is clear. Many of the people who cheer started as strangers on Strava and became friends, kudos for kudos.

WHAT I TAKE FROM IT

Kudos tell me what my friends like to see more than how hard I worked. So I read them as company on the road, and I leave the measure of the effort to my own log.

Limits. Outings before 2022 are left out: their median kudos were 0, 1 and 26 a year from 2019 to 2021, against 34 to 40 from 2022 on, so they follow a different pattern.

Correcting for many tests.

These are the 19 main tests of this chapter, before and after the Holm correction. Under them, each method I used is explained in full.

TEST	P	HOLM-ADJUSTED P	HOLDS AT 0.05
Habit memory, likelihood ratio	4.6×10^{-18}	6.9×10^{-17}	YES
Runs test	8.3×10^{-46}	1.4×10^{-44}	YES
Streak momentum	8.2×10^{-8}	7.3×10^{-7}	YES
Rust after breaks	0.006	0.031	YES
Weekday, clustered	0.005	0.030	YES
Season, clustered	6.7×10^{-4}	0.005	YES
5 km on the treadmill	3.0×10^{-56}	5.5×10^{-55}	YES
10 km on the treadmill	1.1×10^{-40}	1.8×10^{-39}	YES
15 km on the treadmill	9.3×10^{-12}	9.3×10^{-11}	YES
21.1 km on the treadmill	0.014	0.057	NO
Treadmill pace trend	1.0×10^{-73}	1.9×10^{-72}	YES
Treadmill 2026 against 2025	5.7×10^{-16}	7.4×10^{-15}	YES
Climb and walking pace	1.9×10^{-12}	2.1×10^{-11}	YES
Climb and running pace	0.887	0.887	NO
Running and walking	0.103	0.206	NO
Running and walking, week to week	0.004	0.030	YES
Out the day after a long day	0.018	0.057	NO
Distance the day after a long day	1.3×10^{-13}	1.5×10^{-12}	YES
Kudos, trail run against walk	7.1×10^{-18}	9.9×10^{-17}	YES

THE METHODS

The p-value

Every test here starts from the opposite of the claim, a world where the pattern does not exist. The p-value is the chance of seeing a pattern at least as strong as mine if that world were real. A small p-value says my data would be very surprising there, which counts as evidence for the claim.

It is not the chance that the claim is true, and a large p-value does not prove the opposite. It only says the data are not strong enough to rule the opposite out. The usual line is 0.05, one chance in twenty. Very small values are written in powers of ten: 7×10^{-18} means a decimal point followed by seventeen zeros and then a 7.

Holm correction

When many tests are run, a few small p-values turn up by luck alone. With twenty tests at the 0.05 line, about one would pass even if every claim were false. The Holm method guards against that across the whole set of tests at once.

It sorts the p-values from smallest to largest, multiplies the smallest by the number of tests, the next by one fewer, and so on, keeping the order. A test holds if its adjusted value stays under 0.05. It controls the chance of even one false finding in the whole family, and it gives up less power than the simpler Bonferroni rule, which multiplies every p-value by the full number of tests. This chapter corrects 19 tests together.

Logistic regression

A model for outcomes that are yes or no, such as whether I went out on a given day. It does not model the chance directly. It models the log of the odds, and each input moves those log odds up or down by a fixed amount.

Taking the exponent of a coefficient gives an odds ratio. In case 1, ×4.65 means the odds of going out are 4.7 times higher after a day out than after a zero day. Odds are not chances: a move from 50% to 82% is an odds ratio of about 4.6. I used it in cases 1, 4 and 5, each time with the day's outing as the outcome. Its standard version treats every day as separate evidence, which is why cases 4 and 5 also cluster the errors by week.

Likelihood-ratio test

A way to ask whether extra terms in a model earn their place. I fit a smaller model and a bigger one that contains it, and compare how well each explains the data, measured by the log-likelihood.

If the extra terms add nothing, twice the gain in log-likelihood follows a χ^2 distribution, with one degree of freedom for each extra term. A large χ^2 means the bigger model explains the data much better than chance would allow. In case 1 the smaller model knew only yesterday and the bigger one knew the last seven days, so the test had six degrees of freedom, and it gave $\chi^2 = 93.9$.

Runs test

A run is an unbroken stretch of the same value, such as five active days in a row followed by a zero day. The Wald–Wolfowitz runs test counts the runs in a sequence and compares the count with what a random shuffle of the same days would give.

When values cluster, there are fewer and longer runs than expected. The result is a z-score: how many standard deviations the observed count sits from the expected one. My days since the comeback have 515 runs where a shuffle would give about 758, a z-score of -14.2. The test assumes nothing about why days cluster, which makes it a plain check beside the regression in case 1.

Detrended fluctuation analysis

DFA measures memory over many time scales at once. The series of active and zero days is first turned into a running total of how far each day sits from the average. That total is cut into windows of a given length, a straight line is fitted inside each window, and the average distance from those lines is the fluctuation for that length.

Repeating this for windows from a week to half a year, and plotting fluctuation against window length on log scales, gives a line whose slope is the exponent α. With no memory α is about 0.5. Above 0.5, good spells and quiet spells last longer than chance allows. Fitting a line inside each window removes slow trends, such as a busier year, so they do not pass as memory. My days give $\alpha = 0.76$, against 0.52 for the same days shuffled 200 times.

Hazard model

A hazard is the chance that something ends at a given moment, given that it has lasted until then. For a streak it is the chance that tomorrow is a zero day after so many days out. For a break it is the chance that tomorrow I go out again after so many zero days.

A discrete-time hazard model fits that chance with a logistic regression on how long the streak or break has lasted, here on the log of its length. A flat hazard means the past does not matter, the memoryless pattern. In case 2 the slope is +0.44 for streaks and -0.39 for breaks: a streak gets more likely to go on the longer it runs, and a break gets less likely to end.

Weibull shape

The Weibull distribution is a common model for how long things last, from machine parts to streaks of days. Its shape parameter says how the risk of ending changes with age. A shape of 1 is a constant risk, the memoryless case. Below 1 the risk falls the longer something has lasted, so the survivors get sturdier. Above 1 the risk rises with age, as with wear.

A streak still running at the end of the record is counted as censored: the model knows it lasted at least that long without pretending it ended. My 258 streaks have a shape of 0.78, with a 95% interval of 0.72 to 0.84, below 1 all the way.

Changepoint detection

These methods split a series into stretches with a steady level and find the points where the level changes. Each possible split is scored by how well flat segments fit the data, plus a penalty for every extra break, so the method cannot explain everything with a hundred tiny segments.

PELT (Pruned Exact Linear Time) finds the best set of breaks for a given penalty exactly, and fast. Binary segmentation works greedily: it takes the single best break, then searches each side again, and so on. Because they search in different ways, agreement between them is a good sign that a break is real. In case 3 both ran on active days per week, Sunday to Saturday, with a minimum era of eight weeks.

CUSUM

The cumulative sum adds up, week after week, how far each week sits above or below the overall average. While weeks are below average the sum keeps falling. When they move above average it starts to climb.

Its lowest point therefore marks the switch from a low period to a high one. It needs no model and no penalty, which makes it a simple outside check on the changepoint methods in case 3. It finds one switch at a time, so I used it for the biggest one, the comeback.

Clustered errors and block bootstrap

Days in the same week are not independent: case 1 shows that one active day makes the next more likely. A test that treats every day as separate evidence then looks more certain than it should.

Clustered standard errors fix this by measuring the spread from whole weeks instead of single days, which widens the error bars. The block bootstrap does the same by resampling: it draws whole weeks at random, with replacement, recomputes the result 2,000 times, and reads the 95% interval from the middle of those results. I used both in case 4, and clustered errors again in case 5, so the weekday and season results are not inflated by the habit's own memory.

χ^2 tests

A χ^2 test compares the counts in a table with the counts expected if there were no pattern. Each cell adds the squared gap between observed and expected, divided by expected, and the total is checked against the χ^2 distribution.

The test of independence in case 4 used a table of weekday against active or rest. The goodness-of-fit version compares outings per weekday with an even split across the seven days. Both assume every day is a separate piece of evidence, which is why case 4 also has a clustered test.

Harmonic regression

A way to find a yearly cycle without cutting the year into months. Each day's place in the year is turned into the sine and the cosine of the same angle, and both enter the model as inputs. Together they can draw any smooth wave with one high point and one low point a year, and the two coefficients give the size of the wave and where its peak falls.

Adding a second pair at twice the frequency allows two peaks a year, and a likelihood-ratio test says whether that helps. In case 5 the wave sat inside a logistic regression with a separate level for each year, so a busier year does not pass as a season.

Kruskal–Wallis and Friedman

Rank tests replace each value with its rank, so a few extreme values cannot dominate. Kruskal–Wallis asks whether several groups, here the twelve months, come from the same distribution.

Friedman asks the same question when the data come in blocks, here years, and compares the months only within each year, which removes the difference between busy and quiet years. Both assume very little about shape. The price is power: with only four values per month they need a large effect before they show it, which is what happened in case 5.

Binomial test

A test for a count out of a fixed number of tries. If every treadmill run near 5 km had the same chance of ending anywhere in a window of ±560 m around the mark, the share ending within 60 m of it would be set by the width of that slice, about 10.7%.

The binomial test asks how likely it is to see as many runs in that slice as I did if that were true. At 5 km, 100 of the 159 runs in the window end on the mark, against about 17 expected. The test is one-sided: the claim is only about too many runs on the mark.

Gaussian mixture and BIC

A Gaussian mixture describes a distribution as a sum of bell curves, each with its own centre, width and weight. It is fitted by the expectation-maximisation algorithm, which goes back and forth between assigning each value to the curves and moving the curves to fit their values.

BIC, the Bayesian information criterion, scores each model by its fit minus a penalty that grows with the number of curves, and the lowest BIC wins. I fitted it to the log of every distance on foot. If distances were smooth, BIC would settle on a few curves. On mine it keeps falling as curves are added, and the narrowest curve sits on 5.05 km with a width under 1%, which is how point masses on round numbers look to this model.

Theil–Sen and Kendall's τ

The Theil–Sen estimator draws a trend line from the median of the slopes between every pair of points. One odd run changes a few of those slopes but barely moves their median, so the line resists outliers far better than ordinary least squares.

Kendall's τ is the matching test. It counts how often a later run is slower than an earlier one against how often it is quicker, and turns the balance into a number from −1 to 1. In case 7, $\tau = 0.53$ means that for about 77% of pairs of treadmill runs from 2021 to 2025, the later run was the slower one.

Mann–Whitney U

A test that compares two groups by ranks. All values from both groups are ranked together, and the test asks whether one group's ranks sit higher than chance would allow. It needs no bell-shaped data and is little moved by outliers.

I used it to compare 2026 treadmill runs with 2025 runs in case 7, and in case 11 to compare how far I went the day after a long day (median 13.3 km) with the day after an ordinary day out (median 7.4 km).

Robust (HC3) errors

Ordinary regression assumes the scatter around the line is the same everywhere. Real outings rarely behave like that, and when the scatter is uneven the usual error bars come out too narrow in some places and too wide in others.

HC3 is a sandwich estimator that measures the scatter point by point instead, with an extra correction for points that pull hard on the line. It changes the error bars and the p-values, never the fitted line itself. I used it for every linear regression in cases 7, 8, 9 and 12.

Spearman ρ

Spearman's correlation is the ordinary correlation computed on ranks. It runs from −1 to 1. Positive means the two rise together, negative means one falls as the other rises, and near 0 means no steady link.

Because it uses ranks, it catches any steady rise or fall, straight or curved, and outliers cannot drive it. Its p-value tests the claim that the true value is 0. With 280 weeks, a ρ of about ±0.12 is the smallest this record can tell apart from zero, which is the line I gave in case 10.

Fisher’s exact test

A test for a two-by-two table, here a long day or not against out the next day or not. It works out the exact probability of every table with the same row and column totals and asks how unusual the observed one is, without the large-sample shortcut of the χ^2 test.

It also reports an odds ratio. In case 11, 2.04 means the odds of going out after a day of 21 km or more were about twice those after an ordinary day out.

All results come from my public activity log (activities.csv) and were run in Python with scipy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, ruptures and lifelines. Random steps (shuffles, bootstraps, mixtures) use fixed seeds, so every number can be reproduced. The script runs again with every weekly update, and the verdicts above follow whatever it finds.

Epilogue

The last activity in this edition is from 8 November 2026. I am on a 315-day streak, and the habit that started in 2021 has now lasted 1,961 days.

None of these totals came from one big effort. They came from 2,076 ordinary outings, most of them short, early in the morning or in the evening, on days like any other. The log will keep growing, and the next edition will have the new numbers.

Added together, those outings come to 2,400 hours on the move, 13,295 km on foot and 85,159 m of climbing, in five African countries and 17 regions of Tanzania.

Mvumilivu hula mbivu, the patient one eats the ripe fruit. The biggest lesson in this book is a plain one: the days matter more than the distance. When the distance came back, the days were already there to build on. My first target for this streak is 31 December 2026, without a zero day.

I will be out tomorrow.

Gerald Tesha

ANNEX A

How this book was made

This book started as a website, My Strava Journey, where I laid out my Strava history so anyone could read it. None of the figures are typed in by hand. They are all worked out from my activity log, which I refresh every week.

Each week I pull my latest activities from Strava through an MCP server. MCP, the Model Context Protocol, is an open standard that lets an AI assistant connect to other tools and data. Here it connects to my Strava account and gives back every activity in one raw CSV file.

A set of Python scripts then rebuilds everything from that file: the activity log, the totals on foot, the places, the streaks, the records and the tables behind each chart. Before anything is published, activity names, Strava IDs and exact GPS points are taken out. Then the checks run and the site goes live with the new numbers. This edition has 2,076 activities, up to 8 November 2026.

I built it with Claude, Anthropic's AI model, helping with the code and the analysis. I decided the questions, the design and how it should read. Claude wrote the code, dug through the data and checked each number against the log before it went into the text.

DATA SOURCE	My Strava activity history, pulled weekly through an MCP server
PIPELINE	Python, standard library only: rebuild, foot-only totals, derived tables, privacy pass
DATA STORE	32 CSV tables that every number comes from
SITE	React 18 and Vite 5, React Router with hash links, PapaParse to read the CSVs
CHARTS	Drawn by hand in SVG and canvas, without a chart library
TYPE AND COLOUR	Archivo and Inter on a simple grid, with Strava orange kept for the data
QUALITY	Data validation, tests, an axe accessibility audit and layout checks at phone widths
HOSTING	GitHub Pages, from the repository github.com/hpgerald/my-strava-journey
BOOK	The site printed through headless Chromium to an A4 PDF

The weekly pipeline

01 Strava
Every outing I record lands in my Strava account.

02 MCP pull
Each week the latest activities come out through an MCP server, as one raw CSV.

03 Build
Python scripts rebuild the activity log and every table derived from it.

04 Privacy
Names, Strava IDs and exact GPS points are removed, and places are kept to country and region.

05 Checks
The data rules, tests, accessibility and phone layouts are checked.

06 Site
The site reads the tables in the browser and draws every chart from them.

07 Book
The same pages print as this book, and I make a new PDF with each refresh.

ANNEX B

About the data

Where the numbers come from

Every activity comes from my Strava export: the date and time, sport, distance, moving and elapsed time, climb, heart-rate effort, kudos and PRs. Places come from each activity's GPS start point, kept only to country and region.

Distance and climb only count the four sports on foot: runs, walks, trail runs and hikes. Everything else counts as other activities. Those still count as outings and days out, but they add no distance or climb, and I do not name them.

A treadmill run is one that Strava marks as done indoors. Those have no GPS, so they never show up on a map and set almost no segment records.

Relative Effort	Strava's score for how hard a session was, based on the time spent in each heart-rate zone. The higher it is, the harder my heart worked.
Kudos	A thumbs-up from someone on Strava, the same idea as a like.
PR	Short for personal record: my best time on a segment or over a set distance.
Streak	Days in a row with at least one outing.
Zero day	A day with no outing at all.
Layoff	A long stretch of zero days in a row.
Doubles	Two or more outings on the same day.
Streak saver	A short outing that keeps the streak going on a tired or busy day.
Down week	A week far below my usual distance on foot.
Achievement	A badge Strava gives on a segment, for a top-10 time or a personal best.
Elevation gain	All the metres climbed in an activity, added up over every uphill stretch.
Moving time	The time I was actually moving, with the pauses taken out. Elapsed time includes the stops.
Trainer	An indoor session, like a treadmill run, as marked by Strava. These have no GPS.

THE AUTHOR

Get in touch.

I am Gerald Tesha. I work in monitoring, evaluation and data, and this book is what I did with my own numbers. If you would like something like this made from your own data, or would like to work together, I will be happy to hear from you.

EMAIL
hpgerald@gmail.com

PHONE
+255 763 453 400

LINKEDIN
linkedin.com/in/gtesha

STRAVA
strava.com/athletes/gtesha

GITHUB
github.com/hpgerald

WEBSITE
hpgerald.github.io/my-strava-journey

Strava is a trademark of Strava, Inc. This is a personal project, not affiliated with or endorsed by Strava.

2,076 outings.
13,295 km on foot. One habit.